

ZION'S TRUMPET

1851 Welsh Mormon Periodical

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Translated and Edited by
Ronald D. Dennis



RELIGIOUS STUDIES CENTER
BRIGHAM YOUNG UNIVERSITY



DESERET
BOOK



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BOOK**

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Dedicated to William S. Phillips

“A sterling and tried man”

When Captain Dan Jones arrived in Merthyr Tydfil in December 1845 to preside over all the missionary work in Wales, William S. Phillips had already been a member of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints for two years. His baptism on 17 December 1843 made him the fiftieth person to convert to Mormonism in Merthyr Tydfil, and he became part of the member-missionary effort that would add many more adepts in that area during the next nine years.¹

Dan Jones showed his confidence in William Phillips at a 12 July 1846 conference held in Merthyr Tydfil by calling him to serve as the treasurer of the newly formed Missionary Society for all of Wales.² Soon afterwards Phillips was called to serve as the President of the Merthyr Tydfil Branch, the largest branch of the Church not just in Wales but in all of Britain as its membership climbed to over seven hundred members.³

On 3 October 1847 Phillips was called to be President of the Monmouthshire Conference, this in addition to his other responsibilities.⁴ Thus, in early 1849, as Dan Jones prepared to journey to Utah at the end of his first mission to Wales, it is not surprising that he called thirty-four-year-old William Phillips as his replacement. In his report to Orson Pratt, Jones described Phillips as “a sterling and tried man.”⁵

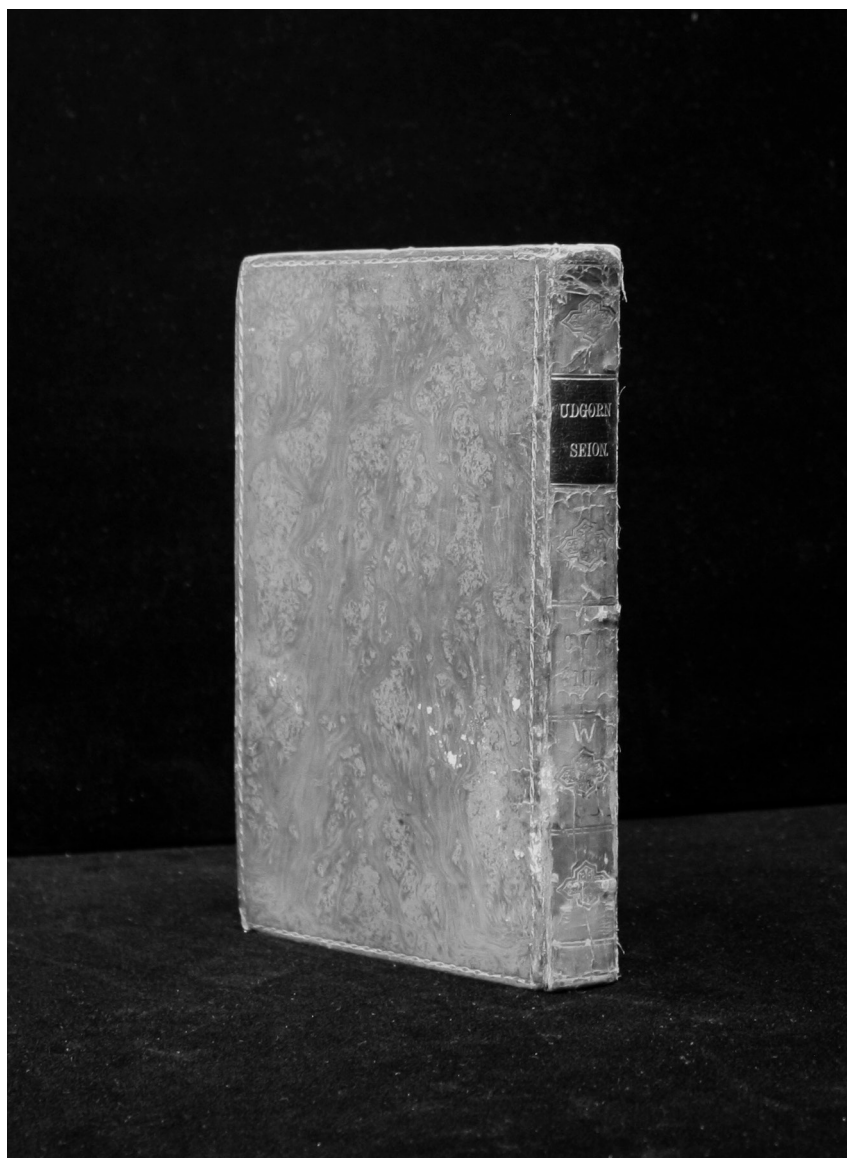
During the next five years as the leader of the Latter-day Saints in Wales, Phillips gave further evidence of the accuracy of Jones’s

epithet. He was tireless in his efforts to build the kingdom—he traveled constantly, held conferences, gave sermons, instructed the Saints, coordinated the emigration of numerous Welsh converts, and was a regular contributor to *Zion's Trumpet*. He baptized an ordained Baptist minister who, after being confirmed in his own chapel, presented the chapel key to Phillips and declared it to be Mormon property as of that moment.⁶ He received personal letters from Elder John Taylor⁷ and shared a frightening experience with Elder Lorenzo Snow in the town of Tredegar when they received night visitors in their hotel room who were bent on doing them serious harm.⁸

Following ten years of faithful service in various Church callings in Wales, William S. Phillips, the “sterling and tried man,” received permission to take his wife and children to Utah. Traveling with him was his new son-in-law, Richard Vaughan Morris, who had served as a full-time missionary under Phillips for three years.⁹

Notes

- 1 A list of baptisms during 1843–44 in Penydarren, Wales, prepared by Edward Roberts. LDS Church Historian's Library, LR 122087.
- 2 *Prophet of the Jubilee*, Vol. 1 (1846), p. 55.
- 3 *Prophet of the Jubilee*, Vol. 3 (1848), p. 9.
- 4 *Prophet of the Jubilee*, Vol. 2 (1847), p. 179.
- 5 *Millennial Star*, Vol. 11 (1849), p. 40.
- 6 *Udgorn Seion*, Vol. 3 (1851), p. 141.
- 7 *Udgorn Seion*, Vol. 2 (1850), p. 339–40; Vol. 3 (1851), p. 395–99.
- 8 *Udgorn Seion*, Vol. 3 (1851), p. 366–69.
- 9 Many entries concerning William Phillips are in Richard Vaughan Morris's missionary journal, a transcription of which is posted on <http://welshmormonhistory.org>. Further information about William Phillips is also posted on this website.



Udgorn Seion, volume 3 (1851)

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TRANSLATIONS

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UDGORN SEION,

NEU

Seren y Saint.

RHIF. 1.]

IONAWR 11, 1851.

[PRIS 1g.

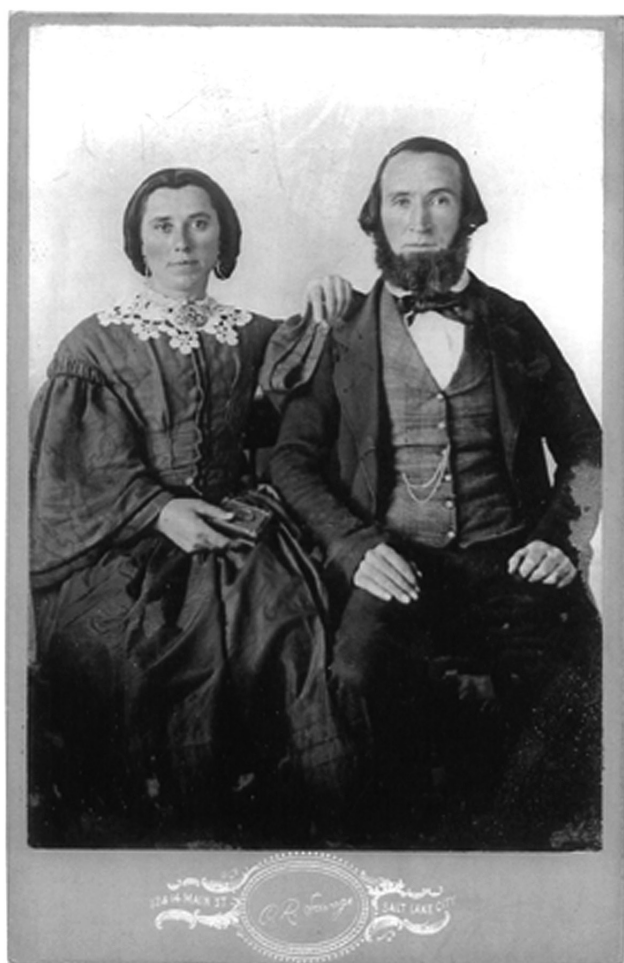
YR ANERCHIAD BLYNYDDOL.

HYNAWS DDARLLENWYR,—Wele ni etto yn dechreu blwyddyn newydd, ac yn eich cyfarch chwithau â “Blwyddyn Newydd Dda:” bydded i chwi gael derbyn mwy o ddaioni Duw y flwyddyn hon nag a dderbyniasoch erioed; bydded i chwi galenig y nefoedd. Ni wna Duw attal hendithion i’r cyfryw o’i blant ag sydd yn fyddlawn ac yn cyflawni ei ewyllys.

Gyda phleser yr edrychwn yn ol ar yr yrfa a redasom er pan gymmerasom UDGORN SEION i’w udganu; ystyriwn y ddwy flynedd ddiweddaf y rhai meithaf a welsom erioed, nid o herwydd ein bod yn blino ar y gwaith, ond o herwydd fod gwaith mawr wedi ei wneyd. Gwyddom am flynyddoedd a dreuliasom yn nheyrnas y tywyllwch, y rhai a ymddangosent yn fyrion, o herwydd nad oedd craig yno i gadw ein gwaith rhag cael ei ysgubo ymaith gan lifeiriant amser. Mae yr hyn a wnaethom yn nheyrnas y goleuni yn sefyll yn weledig, a chyfrifwn amser wrth y gwaith a gyflawnwyd. Gobeithiwn yr ymddangosa y flwyddyn hon, a blynyddau dyfodol, yn feithach fyth, fel y gallom ddywedyd etto, mai da oedd i ni barhau yn ein swydd o wasanaethu ein cyd-genedl. Llanwer ein blynyddoedd, nid o synydau ac oriau, eithr o weithredoedd da, y rhai a fyddant yn weledig pan na fyddo amser mwyach. Er troi o’r haulwen yn entrych y nen, a mesur amser dyn; etto, pe na effeithiai gynhesiad y ddaear, a thyfiad yr eginyn, ni fuasai ond megys peth na fu. Gweithredoedd Duw

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1851 <i>Udgorn Seion</i> title page	facing translation



John S. and Elizabeth Phillips Davis

INTRODUCTION

In January 1849, twenty-six-year-old John S. Davis was given full responsibility for the publications of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in Wales. His calling was to fill the shoes of Captain Dan Jones, his predecessor, who was about to take a group of more than three hundred Welsh Mormon converts to America. It was while setting type for some of Dan Jones's publications only three years earlier that John S. Davis had converted to Mormonism.

Davis published the first two volumes of *Udgorn Seion* in monthly issues, each one having a four-page printed wrapper. For this third volume, however, Davis decided to increase the frequency to twice monthly, decrease the number of pages per issue to sixteen, and eliminate the wrapper.

Davis was also assigned the task of translating and publishing the Doctrine and Covenants in Welsh, the first non-English version of this book of Latter-day Saint scripture. He carried out this assignment by distributing sixteen-page signatures of his translation along with the bimonthly issues of *Udgorn Seion*. The first signature of Doctrine and Covenants was sent out with the 22 February 1851 issue of the periodical; the twentieth and final signature was distributed twenty-seven weeks later with the 23 August 1851 *Udgorn Seion*.

The completion of the Welsh translation of the Doctrine Covenants was also the beginning of the Welsh translation of the Book of Mormon. Davis sent out the first signature of the Book of Mormon with the 20 September 1851 *Zion's Trumpet* and the final signature with the 17 April 1852 issue. Thus during the entire year of 1851 Davis served two masters—that of the bimonthly periodical and that of the translation and publication of Mormon scripture.

Compared to the first two volumes of *Udgorn Seion*, this third volume contains relatively few writings of its editor. Davis's printing of the 1822 Welsh translation of the early Jewish work "Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs" in the first fourteen issues of his 1851 periodical may well have been a convenient "filler" to allow him to devote more of his time and effort to the task of translating and publishing the Doctrine and Covenants. The reprinting of "The Nature of Miracles," an article by Davis published four years earlier in a Baptist periodical, the inclusion of Dan Jones's lengthy account of the "Southern Expedition," and Jones's previously unpublished and incomplete writings on the "Coming of the Son of Man" could possibly be classified as "filler" as well.

In the 29 November issue of this year's periodical (p. 385), Davis admits to being somewhat overwhelmed with his two major tasks, but he also declares that *Udgorn Seion* "is not being neglected at present, for in it there are many very interesting things." He also declares that when he has more time he promises to "make it much more worthy of being received by writing more ourselves."

Davis's response to a twenty-four-page anti-Mormon treatise by a William Jones from North Wales constitutes a significant break from printing borrowed writings. The first of two parts of Davis's review appears in the 6 September *Udgorn Seion*, two weeks following the distribution of the last signature of his translation of the Doctrine and Covenants and two weeks prior to the distribution of the first signature of his translation of the Book of Mormon.

As with the English translations of the two preceding volumes of *Udgorn Seion*, this 1851 volume is being published in a "facsimile translation" format to provide the reader with something of

the appearance and flavor of the original Welsh publication. For John S. Davis to have produced the twenty-six issues of this periodical during 1851 constitutes a respectable accomplishment; for him to have also concurrently translated and published the entire Doctrine and Covenants and half the Book of Mormon in Welsh is mind-boggling.

Ronald D. Dennis

FACSIMILE TRANSLATION CONSIDERATIONS

1. **Size.** The size of the page and the print of the original has been enlarged by about 30 percent to facilitate reading.

2. **Leading and point size.** Whatever variations occur in the space between lines and print size in the original are imitated in the translation.

3. **Pagination.** The content of each translated page may vary by as much as four or five lines from the content of the Welsh original; all major and minor headings are on the same page as the original.

4. **Paragraphs and sentences.** The tendency of nineteenth-century writers was to use fewer paragraph breaks and much longer sentences than might seem appropriate today. However, for the sake of flavor, the inordinate paragraph size and the seemingly interminable sentence length are imitated in the translation.

5. **Brackets and parentheses.** The only editorial comments in the translation are those of John Davis from the original; consequently, all brackets and parentheses are his.

6. **Italicized words.** Italics in the original are retained in the translation. Besides the normal practice of italicizing the names of periodicals, books, ships, and so on, the editor used italics either to provide emphasis or to indicate the use of a borrowed word or phrase from English.

7. **Poetry.** The primary focus in translating the poetry of *Udgorn Seion* has been its content; thus, poetry translations are informational rather than poetic.

8. **Titles of foreign-language publications.** To facilitate reading, I have used the English translations for all foreign-language titles that appear in the text and in the Annotated Contents. The following is a list of these translated titles and their corresponding Welsh or French titles. For the items authored by John Davis or Dan Jones, I have indicated the page reference in *Welsh Mormon Writings* where further information is available.

The Baptist	<i>Y Bedyddiwr</i>	
Book of Mormon	<i>Llyfr Mormon</i>	WMW, 149
Book of Doctrine and Covenants	<i>Llyfr Athrawiaeth a'r Cyfammodau</i>	WMW, 142
The Compilement	<i>Y Casgl</i>	WMW, 143
Dual Hymnal	<i>Llyfr Hymnau Dwyieithog</i>	WMW, 149
The Enquirer	<i>Yr Ymfynydd</i>	
The Evangelist	<i>Yr Efanglydd</i>	
Father, son, & daughter	<i>Y tad, y mab, a'r ferch</i>	WMW, 124
The Great First Cause, or the Self-moving Forces of the Universe	<i>Yr Achos Mawr Cyntaf, neu Alluoedd Hunan-symudawl y Bydysawd</i>	WMW, 129
Letter of Capt. D. Jones to Wm. Phillips	<i>Llythyr oddiwrth Capt. D. Jones at Wm. Phillips</i>	WMW, 134
The Old Hymnal	<i>Yr Hen Llyfr Hymnau</i>	WMW, 33
Review. Principles of the Latter-day Saints weighed in the Scales of Reason and the Scriptures	<i>Adolygiad. Egwyddorion Saint y Dyddiau Diweddaf yn Cael euPeyso yn Nghlorianau Rhesymau ac Ysgrythyrau</i>	WMW, 146
The Scriptural Treasury	<i>Yr Eurgrawn Ysgrythyrol</i>	WMW, 65
Star of Gomer	<i>Seren Gomer</i>	
The Welsh Woman	<i>Y Gymraes</i>	

9. **Punctuation.** Some changes in punctuation and capitalization have been made to facilitate reading.

10. **Typesetting errors.** The typesetters of the original sometimes inverted letters, cited verses that did not match the accompanying scriptural quotation, left incomplete sentences, misspelled words, or committed other typesetting errors. Lacking an unobtrusive method of indicating such aspects of the original in the translation and fearing that confusion would result for today's reader if such flaws were duplicated, I decided to correct these kinds of imperfections in the translation.

11. **Place names.** The modern spelling is used for all place names. The name in English is used for places that have both an English name and a Welsh name (e.g., Swansea for Abertawe, Cardiff for Caerdydd, and Blackwood for Coed-duon).

12. **Proper names.** I have corrected the spelling of biblical and historical names; however, I have preserved the spelling used for all other proper names even when the same individual's name has variant spellings.

13. **Annotated contents.** Instead of detracting from the facsimile appearance of the translation by inserting numbers and notes, I have prepared an article-by-article commentary of all twelve issues and the wrappers. In many instances I give simply a brief statement of the article's contents, together with an indication of a source if the article is borrowed. I provide more detailed observations for those articles that contain historical information pertinent to the nineteenth-century movement of the Latter-day Saints in Wales.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

To Marilyn Davies of Prestatyn, North Wales, I express my deep appreciation for solving numerous “translation traumas” which I suffered during the translation of this third volume of *Udgorn Seion*. I am very grateful to Sara Seamons of the Humanities Publications Center, Brigham Young University, for her remarkable skills in setting the type for this facsimile translation.

My thanks also to Devan Jensen and Brent R. Nordgren of the Brigham Young University Religious Studies Center and their student assistants Jacob F. Frandsen, Jonathon R. Owen, Heidi K. Bishop, Matt Larsen, and Nyssa L. Silvester for reading the final proofs and making the final preparations.

ANNOTATED CONTENTS

Title page

Identical in every respect to the title page for volume II (1850) of *Zion's Trumpet* except for three—the volume number, the year, and John Davis's address which had changed from Nantygwenith Street to John Street. Both addresses were situated in the area of Merthyr Tydfil known as Georgetown. The 1851 title page was printed and distributed at the same time as the December 27 issue, along with the foreword and the contents.

Foreword

In this paragraph (dated 24 December 1851) John Davis declares that it was “only by the Lord's mercy” that he was sustained during the year in the “greatest responsibility of [his] life.” Part of this responsibility was no doubt the translating and publishing of the Doctrine and Covenants in twenty signatures between February and August. Also from September to December he had translated and published about half of the Book of Mormon. Davis asks for an interest in the prayers and faith of his readers.

Contents

An alphabetical listing of one-hundred-and-four major headings. The translation is also arranged alphabetically, making the order different from the original. Three headings (“‘Nature of Miracles’ Again,” p. 48, “Mormonism,” p. 119, and “Healing of a Burn,” p. 203) were omitted in the original. The various subheadings under “Miscellaneous” are not listed in this table of contents. Nine incorrect page references in the original are corrected in the translation.

JANUARY 11

The Annual Greeting5

Among his various exhortations for the new year Davis encourages his readers to “refrain from listening to the small souls, who are tolerated by God to be in the Church, because they are too insignificant to be damned.” These, says Davis, “are kept in the Church to perfect the patience of the Saints.” He also cautions the Welsh not to “disregard” their language and to remember that “God understands Welsh, and that yet thousands of Welsh call on his name, and for Him to save them.”

Greeting of the Apostle J. Taylor to the Welsh Saints7

John Taylor writes from France and makes complimentary comments in his letter about his reception by the Welsh during his third visit to Wales. He then proceeds to explain that although elders preach without purse or scrip they still need sustenance. And Church members should provide that sustenance freely so the elders do not have to rely wholly on “the world” for their physical needs.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs10

This is the first of twelve installments in *Zion’s Trumpet* of an early Jewish work generally classified with the Pseudepigrapha. Davis states that it was “at the request of many of [his] readers” that he had decided to publish this “interesting book.” At the time he was in the throes of translating the Doctrine and Covenants into Welsh while publishing a 16-page issue of *Zion’s Trumpet* every two weeks—this instead of the monthly 32-page issue during the previous year. The procedure he used for sending out the 16-page signatures of his Welsh translation of the Doctrine and Covenants was to distribute them along with the bimonthly issues of the periodical. The first of twenty signatures was distributed on 22 February 1851, and the last just twenty-six weeks later on 23 August 1851. This meant that more often than not Davis was able to send out two signatures of Doctrine and Covenants with an issue of *Zion’s Trumpet*—possibly producing as many as ninety-six published pages in a single month! One might suspect that at

least part of his reason for including segments of “Testament of the Twelve Patriarchs” in his periodical was to transfer the workload of one obligation to another. The text of the “Testament” was taken directly from an 1822 Welsh translation published by L. E. Jones in Caernarfon. And this Welsh version was translated from a Latin version of the original Greek prepared by the Reverend Robert Grosseteste (Grosseteste), Bishop of Lincoln, in the thirteenth century. To include a few pages of “Testament” in each of the first twelve issues (11 January through 14 June) of the 1851 *Zion’s Trumpet* was just a matter of setting the type for the segments borrowed from the 1822 Welsh version. Several English versions were sources for the English translation used herein. That Davis published only one hundred copies of “Testaments” as a 74-page pamphlet would indicate a low expectation of sales. (See my *Welsh Mormon Writings from 1844 to 1862: A Historical Bibliography* [Provo, Utah: Brigham Young University Religious Studies Center], 140–42.)

“The Nature of Miracles” 14

Someone by the name of Gwilym ab Dewi had published an article in the August 1846 Baptist magazine *Seren Gomer* (Star of Gomer) about miracles (pp. 233–35). The author claimed that miracles were no longer needed in the modern era. Using the pseudonym “I. M.,” Davis writes a letter to the editor of the periodical to clarify this and other erroneous ideas about miracles put forth by Gwilym ab Dewi. Surprisingly, Davis’s letter was printed in the October 1846 *Seren Gomer* (pp. 301–03). The reason he gives for printing it more than four years later in *Zion’s Trumpet* (in the 11 January and the 25 January 1851 issues) is so that more of the Saints, most of whom did not read *Seren Gomer*, could benefit from his explanation. He originally used a pseudonym so that his family and friends would not know of his conversion to Mormonism about six months earlier.

Letter of Capt. D. Jones to Elders W. Phillips and J. Davis . . 17

Dan Jones announces to Phillips and Davis that Brigham Young had counseled him to move to Manti, about 130 miles from Salt Lake City. Jones exulted at having received a copy of the 1849

Zion's Trumpet. After greeting all the Saints in Wales he reported that his health had not improved much.

Statistical Report for the Conferences in the British Isles . . . 19

Statistics taken from the *Millennial Star* reporting the presidents of each conference (district) and the number of branches, priesthood holders, and members. The report shows that Wales has 121 branches and 4,937 members.

Married 20

John Davis announces his marriage to Elizabeth Phillips on 30 December 1850 in the parish church of Merthyr Tydfil. Only marriages performed by the Church of England were recognized by the British government.

Doc. and the Cov. 20

Davis is glad that the number of subscribers has increased and declares that it is likely that each segment will be priced at a penny and a half.

Verse 20

A four-line poem by “I. R.” in the form of a prayer for the fortunate Saints to be taken out of the “land of the scowl” to Zion.

Payments from December 22 to January 9 20

Payments received from seventeen branches are shown.

(No title) 20

Conference minutes will no longer be published unless something unusual transpires.

(No title) 20

All correspondence, requests, and book payments are to be sent to John Davis at his new address on John’s Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil, instead of his old address on Nantygwenith Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil. He had lived on Nantygwenith

Street since April 1849. In the *Zion's Trumpet* wrappers for March and April 1849 he listed his address as simply "Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil." And in the wrappers for January and February 1849 he listed his address as Priory Street, Carmarthen. The January and February issues of the periodical were printed in Carmarthen, after which he moved himself and his press to Merthyr Tydfil.

JANUARY 25

- Minutes of the General Conference . . . held September 6, 1850 21
 Welsh translation of part of these minutes from *Millennial Star* 13 (15 January 1851): 17–22.
- Gift of the Holy Ghost 27
 An explanation of the difference between receiving the gift of the Holy Ghost and receiving enlightenment from the Spirit of God. Since the article is unsigned it is likely that the author is John Davis.
- Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs 29
 The second installment—the testament of Jacob. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.
- "Nature of Miracles" 32
 The second and concluding part of the article written by John Davis. See the discussion presented for the first part in the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.
- Great God of the Sectarians 35
 A poem composed by John Richards of Craig Ddu of ten stanzas of four lines each. It is a portrayal of God as interpreted by the sectarians, or, in other words, by all those who belonged to religions besides The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in Wales. The poet scoffs at the numerous misconceptions about God and ends with an appeal to Him to hasten in bringing all His

children to a knowledge of the “covenant” (The Church of Jesus Christ), in order for them to have a clearer understanding of His nature. It appeared six years later in the 15 August 1857 issue of *Zion’s Trumpet* (pp. 258–59).

(No title)36

A brief bit of humor about a young student and his professor, Dr. Parr.

(No title)36

A quotation from Diogenes about foolishness and wisdom.

(No title)36

An observation about innocence and modesty.

(No title)36

A brief formula as to how to become rich.

Payments from January 9 to January 2336

Payments received from seven branches are shown.

(No title)36

John Davis encourages more frequent payments from the book distributors lest their debt result in their leaving the Church.

Visit of J. Taylor36

Davis apologizes to his readers for not having the space in this issue to give an account of the visit of Apostle John Taylor to the Saints in Merthyr Tydfil and also in the Tredegar District.

“J. M.”36

Davis’s cryptic response to “J. M.” to the effect that he should send his request to the conference distributor and not to Davis.

(No title)36

Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

FEBRUARY 8

Minutes of the General Conference . . . held September 6, 1850	37
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Welsh translation of the remaining portion of these minutes from *Millennial Star* 13 (15 January 1851): 17–22.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs	42
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The third installment—the testament of Reuben. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

Who professes miracles?	46
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The Baptists, the Independents, the Methodists, and other Protestant churches in Wales were very critical of the Latter-day Saints' belief in modern-day miracles. John Davis subtly accuses them of hypocrisy by quoting from a publication of the Independents an account of the miraculous healing in 1830 of a Miss Fancourt, daughter of a London minister. Doctors had failed to cure the chronic weakness in her limbs or even alleviate the pain, but a minister, “the Rev. Mr. G.,” found the solution. He asked Miss Fancourt if she believed that mercy could restore her health. Receiving an affirmative answer he then told her to arise and walk. All her pain ceased, and she walked down the stairs. Davis makes no further comment, but the implication is clear—despite their constant declaration to the contrary, miracles did exist among the Protestants.

Mormon Library	47
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The New York Picayune for 4 January 1851 reported that Congress had appropriated \$5,000 for the start of a library in the Territory of Utah. The writer makes a number of favorable comments about the Mormons. Davis includes the Welsh translation of the article in his periodical to show Mormons in Wales this slight improvement in the Church's standing in

America.

“Nature of Miracles” Again 48

Someone using the pseudonym “Meurig” posed a question in the December 1846 *Seren Gomer* (Star of Gomer), p. 378, in relation to Davis’s article about the nature of miracles in the October 1846 issue of this Baptist periodical. Davis’s response, again over the pseudonym of “I. M.”, was allowed space in the January 1847 issue of *Seren Gomer*, p. 16. At this point Davis was but twenty-four years old and had received his baptism to become a Mormon only eight months earlier.

The Saints in London 50

Eli B. Kelsey, president of the London Conference, intends to take advantage of the “world’s great fair” in London during 1851 by ordering a huge number of Mormon publications from Liverpool and opening a shop near Patemoster Row. See *Millennial Star* 13 (1 February 1851): 33.

Departure of Elder Orson Pratt 50

A brief report of the farewell party held on 22 January 1851 in Liverpool in Elder Pratt’s honor. See *Millennial Star* 13 (1 February 1851): 43.

To all the Saints throughout Great Britain and Ireland 51

Notice from Franklin D. Richards that he had contracted the American ship *Olympus* to sail to New Orleans on 28 February 1851. All who wished to emigrate on this ship were to send in their names, ages, occupations, and a £1 deposit.

The Father, the Son, and the Daughter 51

The Welsh translation by Benjamin Davies of the English version of a poem composed by John Taylor. The poem consists of six 4-line verses, each with a two-line chorus. A father reluctant to journey to Zion because of his advanced years is persuaded by his son and daughter to put his trust in the Lord and join with his children in emigrating. See my *Welsh Mormon Writings from 1844 to 1862: A Historical Bibliography* [Provo, Utah: Brigham Young University Religious

Studies Center], 124–25 for additional details of the two poems.

(No title) 52

Davis's advice to understand before chastising.

Payments from January 23 until February 6 52

Payments received from seven branches are shown.

(No title) 52

Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.

FEBRUARY 22

Fourth General Epistle of the Presidency of the Church of
Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints 53

Welsh translation of this Epistle from the *Millennial Star* 13 (15
February 1851): 49–54.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs 64

The fourth installment—the testament of Simeon. For details of
this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated
Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

An Extraordinary Event 67

William Phillips gives an account of the displacement of hun-
dreds of tons of earth near the top of Aberdare Mountain where
a few weeks earlier he and Apostle John Taylor along with some
others had placed some stones as a remembrance of their having
passed by.

(No title) 68

Davis's comment about those who deserve nothing.

(No title) 68
Davis’s comment about success and failure.

Good news 68
An announcement from F. D. Richards that money from the Perpetual Emigrating Fund was to be available to help the poor Saints go to America.

To the Branches 68
Davis’s instructions concerning profit for selling issues of *Zion’s Trumpet* and segments of the Doctrine and Covenants.

Doc. and Cov. 68
Davis’s announcement that the first segment of the Doctrine and Covenants had been sent out. He also offers to publish a segment of the Doctrine and Covenants every week instead of every fortnight for a penny-and-a-half each.

Payments from February 6 to February 20 68
Payments received from eight branches are shown.

(No title) 68
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

MARCH 8

To Welsh Christians 69
An open letter, probably written by John Davis, to all Welsh Christians in the form of nine questions. All the questions are basically, “Why do you not recognize the need you have to convert to Mormonism?”

Counsels to the Presidents of Districts and Branches 72
William Phillips instructs Church leaders to make sure they call men who possess the Holy Ghost to positions of leadership under their jurisdiction. He also gives instruction concerning the Perpetual Emigrating Fund. John Davis adds a footnote explaining

that he has been receiving letters that should have been sent to William Phillips and that to resolve the confusion Church leaders should take care to send letters to the right person.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs. 73

The fifth installment—the testament of Levi. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

Conversation between Wesley and a Saint. 81

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Silliness 82

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Laying on of Hands 82

A quotation from the biography of the Rev. W. R. Davies published in *Seren Gomer* (Star of Gomer), a Baptist periodical, in which an explanation is given as to how this arch-enemy of Mormonism “prayed” the practice of the laying on of hands out of the church.

(No title). 82

Davis's observation on a splendid skill and splendid bravery.

Moved 83

An appeal in the *Deseret News* for its printers to remain undisturbed following the relocation of the press to the State House in Salt Lake City. This is Davis's subtle way of requesting that members of the Church in Wales leave him undisturbed also as he prepares things for publication.

Rewarding Drunkenness83
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(No title).83
Davis recommends that men not praise or blame themselves.

Chapel Opening.83
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J. H. Flanigan.83
Elder J. H. Flanigan, president of the Birmingham District has died of smallpox.

(No title).83
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Epitaph of an Enemy of the Saints.84
A four-line poem by “T. H.” about the fate of one who told lies about Mormonism.

Conferences 84

An announcement of conferences to be held in Merthyr Tydfil, Tredegar, Swansea, Llanelli, and Cardiganshire.

“H. E—s” 84

Davis praises “H. E—s” for subscribing to six copies of the Doctrine and Covenants and recommends that all emigrants purchase extra copies as well.

“E. D.” 84

A brief bit of advice to someone named “E. D.”

(No title) 84

Davis has received a response from a majority of the branches indicating their support in his publishing and sending out segments of the Doctrine and Covenants and appeals to those who have not responded to do so.

(No title) 84

Elder William Howells, the former lay Baptist minister who was the first Mormon missionary to France, will be leaving with his family on March 3rd on board the *Olympus*. (See my “William Howells: First Missionary to France” in *Supporting Saints: Life Stories of Nineteenth-Century Mormons*, edited by Donald Q. Cannon and David J. Whittaker [Provo, Utah: Brigham Young University Religious Studies Center, 1985]: 43–81.) Elder William Henshaw, sent by Elder Lorenzo Snow in early 1843 as the first missionary to the heartland of Wales in Merthyr Tydfil, will also be leaving with his family on board the *Olympus*. (See the individual file for William Henshaw on <http://welshmormonhistory.org>)

(No title) 84

Davis announces his intent to publish the Welsh translation of Orson Pratt’s First Great Cause.

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(No title).84
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MARCH 22

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Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs86
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Quotation from the “Great First Cause, or the Self-moving
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 The Welsh translation of a few pages of this pamphlet by Orson
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(No title)	100
Davis announces that the Welsh translation of Orson Pratt's <i>Great First Cause</i> will be published within a week.	
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Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

APRIL 5

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Wheat Sowing	103
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wheat they possibly can to satisfy the growing demand. The article first appeared in *Deseret News* for 2 November 1850.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs 105

The seventh installment—the testament of Issachar. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion’s Trumpet*.

A Dream 108

William Phillips relates a recent dream he had about six Baptist ministers meeting in a secret room to discuss what to do about the Latter-day Saints. All their attempts to disprove the teachings of the Mormons in Wales and hinder their success in Wales had come to naught. After expressing their frustration in detail the ministers decided to pray for the Lord or an angel to come to them and bestow the priesthood on them to avoid having to convert to Mormonism themselves.

The Journey from the Bluffs to the Valley 112

A quotation from the *Frontier Guardian* for 7 February 1851 with suggestions as to how to have a successful trek across the plains to the Salt Lake Valley.

Laments of the Saints 113

A poem of six 4-line stanzas, each with a 2-line chorus, by John Wilkins of Clynmil, an area of Merthyr Tydfil. The lament is that the Latter-day Saints are living in oppressive circumstances in “Babylon” (Wales) yearning for the opportunity of going “home” (Salt Lake Valley).

Healing 114

James Ellis, Cardiff, gives a brief account of administering a priesthood blessing to Rebecca Flowers and witnessing an immediate recovery from her paralytic stroke.

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A poem of two 12-line stanzas encouraging the Saints to flee from their enemies in Babylon (Wales) and journey homeward to Zion. The poem is unsigned, suggesting John Davis to be the author.	
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“T. H.” (probably Thomas Harries) tells of a conversation between a Methodist and a Latter-day Saint about miracles. The latter proves to be the more clever of the two.	
Busts (Pictures) of Joseph and Hyrum	116
These are available for purchase through President Phillips. The profit will facilitate missionary work in France.	
Appointment	116
Thomas Pugh is to preside over the West Glamorgan District. Evan Williams is to serve as traveling elder.	
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Payments from March 21 to April 1	116
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Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

10 APRIL

The Church is Twenty-one Years Old. 117

Davis exults that the Church is now of age. He encourages all Latter-day Saints in Wales to rejoice and sing. And he even includes a song of his composition for them to sing.

Mormonism 119

Davis quotes from the *Family Herald* for 13 March 1851 an article about “Mesmerism, Mormonism, and Monasticism.” He is satisfied with the observations about Mormons in the article and wishes for his readers to know the judgment of the world about them.

Why were the prayers of the religious denominations not heard? 123

John Richards of Craig-ddu answer the question posed in the title by offering nine reasons why prayers are not heard. He urges those with the various religious denominations to come to the Saints, as he had done, so their prayers will be heard.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs. 124

The eighth installment—the testaments of Zebulon and Dan. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion’s Trumpet*.

Acrostic 132

John Argust, Merthyr, writes this acrostic poem in praise of the Perpetual Emigrating Fund, the way out of Babylon (Wales) for the faithful Saints who wish to journey to Zion (Salt Lake Valley). The first letter of each of the sixteen lines of poetry is on its side so the reader can hold the poem at an angle and see “Y DRYSORFA YMFUDOL,” the Welsh words for “The Emigrating Fund.”

Time	132
Davis observes that every minute is a part of life and that the memory of its use will be a source of joy or sadness.	
(No title).	132
Anyone who does good will be rewarded, but not necessarily right away.	
“W. M.”	132
To a request from “W. M.” as to how he should act in a dream Davis responds that he already has enough work to instruct men how to act when awake.	
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(No title).	132
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

3 MAY

To District Presidents and Book Distributors	133
Using the ideas of Orson Pratt that appeared in the 1 April 1850 <i>Milennial Star</i> , Davis gives detailed instructions to the district presidents and book distributors as to how book sales and distribution should function.	
“Disappointment of Mormonism”—Letter of Henry Wilkins	135
Henry Wilkins, the son of the Baptist minister James Wilkins, converted to Mormonism in Merthyr Tydfil at the age of seventeen. He first ignored the advice of his father when he converted and again when he sailed for America on board the <i>Joseph Badger</i> in October 1850. The letter he sent to his father after arriving in St. Louis was printed in <i>Y Bedyddiwr</i> (The Baptist), a periodical published in Cardiff by the Baptists. In the letter he expressed profound regret for having left Wales and accused the Mormons	

of deception. In this article John Davis refutes some of Wilkins’ claims and suggests that the young man’s disappointment might be the result of some transgression or disobedience on his part.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs 138

The ninth installment—the testament of Naphtali. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion’s Trumpet*.

Baptism of Two Ministers and Others in Treaman, Near Aberdare 141

Near the town of Treaman in the Cynon River on 27 April 1851 five converts to Mormonism were baptized—the Baptist Reverend David Bevan Jones, the lay Baptist preacher David Rees Davis, and three others. Someone identifying himself as “R. M.” was present at the baptism and sent a detailed report to John Davis who then included it in this issue of *Zion’s Trumpet*. See “From a *Seion* of Lands to the Land of Zion: The Life of David Bevan Jones” by D. L. Davies, in *Mormons in Early Victorian Britain*, edited by Richard L. Jensen and Malcolm R. Thorp [Salt Lake City, Utah: University of Utah Press], pp. 118–41, for further information about David Bevan Jones, more often known by his nom de plume “Dewi Elfed Jones.” Also see <http://welshmormonhistory.org> for individual files on David Bevan Jones and David Rees Davis.

A Friendly Hint to Those of the Saints who Purpose Visiting the Metropolis during the Exhibition 144

Some general instructions to anyone going to London to see the Crystal Palace. See *Millennial Star* 13 (1 May 1851): 137.

Moral Environment 144

The Welsh translation of a letter dated 24 February 1851 from “Evermont” to the editor of the *Frontier Guardian*, Orson Hyde, with a response to Hyde’s sermon the previous day on the judgment.

The Right Kind of Wife	145
The Welsh translation of an article from the <i>Frontier Guardian</i> concerning the frugality of a businessman's wife that helped him start a new business after his old one failed because of the dishonesty of his secretary.	
Truth	146
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Honor	148
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Davis states the importance of striving for self improvement.	
Death	148
Davis's observation on our turning over from time to eternity.	
Friendship	148
Davis presents his thoughts on friendship.	
Appointment	148
Robert Campbell is to be a traveling elder in the West Glamorgan District.	

“J. D.” 148
Davis reminds “J. D.” that the *Great First Cause* has been available
for some time.

Payments from April 17 to April 30 148
Payments received from seven branches are shown.

(No title). 148
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

17 MAY

Henry Wilkins Again—Letter from Him to President
William Phillips 149
William Phillips had written to the young Henry Wilkins about
the accusations Wilkins had made about Phillips and the LDS
Church in the letter that had appeared in *Y Bedyddiwr* (The Bap-
tist). Wilkins, in his 12 April 1851 letter from St. Louis, explains
that he had written to his father in anger and that he is now sorry
for having sent it. He bears his testimony of the truthfulness of
the restored gospel and declares his intention of going to the Salt
Lake Valley as a driver for a Mrs. George from Cardiff. William
Phillips encouraged the Reverend James Wilkins, Henry’s father,
to publish this most recent letter from his son in *Y Bedyddiwr*,
which, of course, did not happen.

Counsels to District Presidents, Traveling Elders, and the
Church in General 151
Among the counsels given by William Phillips are that the dis-
trict presidents and traveling elders when visiting the branches
are to audit the books, make sure that children of members over
the age of eight are baptized, eliminate the giving of the sacra-
ment to children under the age of eight, instruct the members to
read Church publications, and encourage the members to sing
less. Apparently the members often engaged in spontaneous and
prolonged singing after meetings, thereby preventing visiting au-

thorities from giving counsel to various people in the branch.

To the Editor of "*Zion's Trumpet*" 153

"T. J." tells of his careful research into the Bible and asks John Davis in this lengthy letter whether the commandments contained therein are directed to men of the modern age. He also asks concerning the location of Babylon and Zion. Davis replies with a detailed explanation to the questions posed by "T. J." and invites him to read the literature published by the Latter-day Saints and receive baptism from them.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs 158

The tenth installment—the testament of Gad. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

Admonishment to District Presidents and their Scribes . . . 161

Davis calls for the semi-annual reports and expresses hope they will be sent by June 7th so he will not have to wait for them "as usual."

The Voice of "*Zion's Trumpet*" 162

A poem of four 8-line stanzas composed by Dewi Elfed Jones, the Baptist minister who was baptized only three weeks earlier. See *Zion's Trumpet* 3 (3 May 1851): 141. He puts into verse the encouragement that comes through each issue of *Zion's Trumpet* for all to prepare to flee Babylon (Wales) and hasten to Zion (Salt Lake Valley). It would be another nine years before this new convert would be able to leave Wales for America. He settled in Logan, Utah, and died just three years later in 1863.

Warning to Emigrants 163

Davis quotes a portion of a letter sent by Daniel Evans from St. Louis with a detailed explanation of the money system in America. Knowing the system in advance will help them from getting cheated.

Binding Books 163

 Binding multiple volumes of *Zion's Trumpet* together may be cheaper, but they will not last as long as binding each volume separately.

The Latest Welsh Emigrants..... 164

 Davis reports on a group of Welsh who arrived safely in New Orleans on April 6th. For lack of space he is unable to publish as many details as he would like.

(No title)..... 164

 To avoid deathbed regrets act now on small projects rather than waiting for the time to accomplish greater things.

The Human Life..... 164

 Life is constantly plundered by invaders that steal our time.

Time 164

 Regardless of how we use our time we will one day have to give an accounting.

Payments from May 1 to May 15 164

 Payments received from twelve branches are shown.

(No title) 164

 Davis's twelve-page pamphlet *Treatise on Miracles* is now off the press. (See my *Welsh Mormon Writings from 1844 to 1862: A Historical Bibliography* [Provo, Utah: Brigham Young University Religious Studies Center], 130–32.)

(No title)..... 164

 The letter of President Franklin D. Richards to Presidents and Distributors will appear in the next issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

(No title)	164
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Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.

31 MAY

To the Presiding Elders and General Book Agents of the Conferences of the Church in the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland, Together with those of the Isle of Man and Channel Islands	165
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Welsh translation of Franklin D. Richards' general instructions
concerning book payments and other finances. See *Millennial Star*
13 (15 May 1851): 153–56.

Remarkable Healing	169
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An account by John Edmonds of his administering to a young
boy in Aberaman who had broken his leg. During the priesthood
blessing Edmunds felt the bones of the boy's leg come together.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs	170
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The eleventh installment—the testament of Asher and part of
the testament of Joseph. For details of this early Jewish work see
the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the
11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

Loving Evil	180
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Although a man may love sin, there is only one who loves the
sinner.

Prayer	180
------------------	-----

A poem of three 4-line stanzas by P. Hughes asking God to de-
liver his children to “yonder home” (Zion).

(No title)	180
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Davis's brief message to “Saint” asking to see the rest of his “vi-
sion.”

(No title) 180

Davis announces that the “Old Hymn Book” is ready. This has reference to a reprint of the little hymnal that Dan Jones had published in 1846. Davis published a larger hymnal in 1849 whose contents and those of the 1846 hymnal are mutually exclusive. Many of the Welsh Latter-day Saints elected to bind the two together, but they were unable to do so when the supply of the 1846 hymnal was exhausted. Thus, the reprint. In 1852 Davis published a hymnal that included 63% of the contents of the 1846 hymnal and 97% of the 1849 hymnal plus over three hundred new hymns. For further details see my *Welsh Mormon Writings from 1844 to 1862: A Historical Bibliography* [Provo, Utah: Brigham Young University Religious Studies Center], 35–38.

(No title) 180

Davis gives instructions concerning the segments of the Doctrine and Covenants.

(No title) 180

Davis gives instructions concerning subscriptions to *Zion’s Trumpet*.

(No title) 180

Davis announces his hope to finish the “Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs in the next issue of *Zion’s Trumpet* and thus have more space to publish other things.

(No title) 180

Davis’s advice to aspiring poets.

Payments from May 16 to May 28 180

Payments received from eight branches are shown.

(No title) 180

Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

14 JUNE

Address of Orson Hyde at a Conference in Kanesville, Iowa, April 6, 1851.	181
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Welsh translation of the address Orson Hyde presented at Council Bluffs on the twenty-first anniversary of the establishment of the Church. See *Frontier Guardian* for 2 May 1851.

“The Latter-day Saints in Aberdare”	184
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On 27 April 1851 the Baptist minister Dewi Elfed Jones received baptism at the hands of William Phillips. A few hours later in the Gwawr Chapel in Aberaman, the Baptist chapel Jones had gathered funds to build, he was confirmed a member of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. Following his confirmation he handed the key for the Gwawr Chapel to William Phillips and declared the building to be a possession of the Latter-day Saints from that time on. Thomas Price, a neighboring Baptist minister who led the opposition to this transfer of title, wrote a piece for *Yr Amserau* (The Times) giving his interpretation of the happenings in Aberaman. Dewi Elfed Jones responded to his former colleague by sending this question-filled letter to the Editor of *Yr Amserau* and then publishing it in *Zion's Trumpet*.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs.	187
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The eleventh installment—the second part of the testament of Joseph and the testament of Benjamin. For details of this early Jewish work see the discussion presented in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

Epistle of Paul the Apostle to the Laodiceans	192
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The Welsh translation of this epistle is bound with the Welsh translation of the “Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs” published by L. E. Jones in Caernarfon in 1822. See the discussion of the “Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs” in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

To the Churches 193

William Phillips asks John Davis to announce through the periodical some conferences to be held. He also gives some instructions to those who intend to emigrate in September.

Condition of the Church in Monmouthshire 194

Thomas Giles reports some of the latest happenings in his Conference. The individual file for Thomas D. Giles on <http://welshmormonhistory.org> contains the journal and biographical information of this most interesting Welsh convert to Mormonism who later became known as “The Blind Harpist.”

New Song 195

A poem of three 10-line stanzas by Thos. Phillip of Aberaman about the joy the Saints will experience in Zion.

London Conference 196

Davis provides a brief account of his visit, in company with William Phillips and Thomas Pugh, to a conference in London held at Freemasons’ Hall during the world’s fair.

Cefn Branch 196

A new place in Cefncoedycymmer, very near to Merthyr Tydfil, was opened as a meeting place for the Saints.

The Great Exhibition 196

Davis comments about the splendor of the Crystal Palace in London, built as part of the world’s fair held there.

(No title) 196

Davis’s comment about idleness.

(No title) 196

Davis’s comment about lost days.

(No title)	196
Davis's comment about desiring and obtaining.	
"E. M."	196
Davis's response to a question of "E. M." about the sacrament prayers.	
"G. Watkin"	196
Davis's response to "G. Watkin" about contacting the men in Ab-craman.	
Payments from May 29 to June 12	196
Payments received from two conferences and seven branches are shown.	
(No title)	196
Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

28 JUNE

Account of a Journey from Great Salt Lake City, Four Hundred and Fifty Miles to the South [From Capt. D. Jones].	197
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On 22 November 1849 Parley P. Pratt started southward from Salt Lake City with a group of about fifty men on what has become known as the "Southern Expedition." The objective of this expedition was to determine the location of desirable places in which future immigrants could establish settlements. Slightly less than a month earlier the first group of Welsh Mormons under the leadership of Captain Dan Jones had arrived in Salt Lake City after an eight-month journey from Liverpool. Jones was counseled by Brigham Young to join the expedition in order to search for the "Madocians," a tribe of Indians believed by some to be the descendants of a group of Welsh who had arrived in America in 1170 under the leadership of a Prince Madoc. Jones's dream was to find these "Welsh Indians," convert them to Mormon-

ism, and then take some of them back to Wales as missionaries to their distant cousins. (See my “Captain Dan Jones and the Welsh Indians” in *Dialogue: A Journal of Mormon Thought*, Vol. 18, No. 4 [Winter 1985]: 112–17, for more information about the Madocian legend.) Jones’s letter to John Davis about his part in the expedition is dated March 1851 from San Pete and appears in this and the following three issues of *Zion’s Trumpet*. In his account Jones uses the surveyor’s terms of “degrees,” “minutes,” and “seconds” in describing geographical location. John Davis explains in *Zion’s Trumpet* 3 (12 July 1851): 228, that a degree is sixty-nine miles, a minute is 1/60th of a degree or somewhat more than a mile, and a second is 1/60th of a minute. Davis also admits that in several places “second” had been used instead of “minute.” I have made the correction in this translation.

Baptism for the Dead 202

Thomas Davies, of Dinas, tells of being at a funeral in Tonyrefail on 31 May 1851, and seeing a Methodist minister perform what the minister stated was a “baptism for the dead.”

Healing of a Burn 203

Morgan Williams tells of being severely burned at the Ton-ddu iron works on 15 May 1851. After going home and being administered to by Thomas Llewellyn he was able to return to work.

A New Way to Zion 203

Davis had received the 27 May 1851 issue of the *Missouri Republican* containing an abridgement of the Fifth General Epistle. He quotes from the Epistle concerning the plans for having the British Saints journey to the Salt Lake Valley by way of San Diego.

Account of the War between the Romans and the Jews, in which Jerusalem was Taken and Completely Destroyed. . . . 204

The Welsh translation of this account is bound with the Welsh translation of the “Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs” published by L. E. Jones in Caernarfon in 1822. See the discussion

of the “Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs” in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion’s Trumpet*.

Lamentation of Jeremiah 209

A poem of nine 5-line stanzas composed by T. Jeremiah. The poem is a conversation between two persons about the friends of one of them having gone to different religions. He is especially sad about the loss of his friend Edward Davis who had become a Mormon.

Feast of the Saints in London 210

A description of a gathering of Latter-day Saints in London.

Statistical Report for the Conferences in the British Isles,
for the Half Year Ending June 1, 1851 211

Statistics taken from the *Millennial Star* reporting the presidents of each conference (district) and the number of branches, priesthood holders, and members. The report shows that Wales has 127 branches and 5,204 members. The long dash between “Bel-fast” and “Ireland” on p. 212 is in the original.

Book Debts from the Districts, Branches, and Others, for
the Quarter Ending June 26, 1851 212

Over £197 is owing from the various districts and branches of Wales.

Payments from June 13 to June 26 212

Payments received from eight branches are shown.

(No title) 212

Davis announces that the letter written by Captain Jones to William Phillips will be published separate from *Zion’s Trumpet* as a penny pamphlet. See *Welsh Mormon Writings*, pp. 134–36.

(No title) 212

Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

12 JULY

Fifth General Epistle of the Presidency of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, from Great Salt Lake Valley, State of Deseret, to the Saints Scattered throughout the Earth. 213

The Welsh translation of the Fifth General Epistle as it appeared in *Millennial Star* 13 (15 July 1851): 209–16.

Account of a Journey from Great Salt Lake City, Four Hundred and Fifty Miles to the South [From Capt. D. Jones]. 219

A continuation of the first part of this account that first appears in *Zion’s Trumpet* 3 (28 June 1851): 197–202.

Special General Conference 223

The minutes of a conference held on 7 July 1851 in Merthyr Tydfil for Church leaders in South Wales during which a variety of instructions, counsel, and encouragement were given. Also eighteen new missionaries were called to establish new branches in districts of the South.

A Little Regarding the Death of Paul in Rome 225

The Welsh translation of this brief treatise is bound with the Welsh translation of the “Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs” published by L. E. Jones in Caernarfon in 1822. See the discussion of the “Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs” in Annotated Contents concerning the 11 January 1851 issue of *Zion’s Trumpet*.

A Word of Wisdom. 226

The Welsh translation of what is now Section 89 of the Doctrine and Covenants.

(No title). 228

Deathbed alms are like deathbed repentance.

(No title)	228
A call for men to humble themselves.	
Payments from June 27 to July 10	228
Payments received from four districts and nineteen branches are shown.	
Errata	228
Davis explains that in Captain Jones's account of the Southern Expedition the surveying term "second" was printed in several places instead of the term "minute." He explains that a "minute" is the 60 th part of a degree, or slightly more than a mile, that a "second" is the 60 th part of a "minute," and that a degree is 69 miles.	
(No title)	228
There is no space in this issue for a letter sent by Elizabeth Lewis from Manti.	
(No title)	228
The letter of Captain Jones to William Phillips is off the press and available for one penny. See <i>Welsh Mormon Writings</i> , pp. 134–36.	
(No title)	228
Davis laments not being able to publish a number of things in this issue.	
(No title)	228
Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

26 JULY

Fifth General Epistle of the Presidency of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, from Great Salt Lake Valley, State of Deseret, to the Saints Scattered throughout the Earth. 229

Continuation of the Welsh translation of the Fifth General Epistle as it appeared in *Millennial Star* 13 (15 July 1851): 209–16.

Account of a Journey from Great Salt Lake City, Four Hundred and Fifty Miles to the South [From Capt. D. Jones] . . 237

A continuation of the second part of this account that appears in *Zion’s Trumpet* 3 (12 July 1851): 219–23.

Special General Conference 241

The Welsh translation of the minutes of a conference held 3 June 1851 in London with four members of the Twelve present. See *Millennial Star* 13 (15 July 1851): 218.

To the Churches 242

William Phillips instructs district and branch presidents not to give assistance to missionaries but to allow them to serve their missions without purse or scrip and to receive money, food, clothing, and lodging from “the world” (those not associated with the Church).

(No title) 244

Observations on beauty and innocence.

(No title) 244

Observations on wisdom and foolishness.

(No title) 244

Observations on impetuosity.

Payments from July 11 to July 22	244
Payments received from four districts and four branches are shown.	
“W. T., A-----r”	244
Davis admonishes “W. T., A-----r” to report whatever contradictory things he may see in the Book of Mormon and the Doctrine and Covenants to him for comment in <i>Zion’s Trumpet</i> .	
“W. W.”	244
The date for the next emigration has not yet been determined.	
Book of Mormon	244
Davis requests that all presidents and distributors collect names of subscribers for the Welsh translation of the Book of Mormon.	
(No title)	244
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

9 AUGUST

Minutes of the General Conference of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints	245
The Welsh translation of the minutes for the conference held 6 April 1851 at Salt Lake City as reported in the <i>Deseret News</i> for 19 April 1851.	
Addenda to the Fifth General Epistle	248
The Welsh translation of this Addenda as reported in the <i>Deseret News</i> for 19 April 1851.	
Observations about emigrating, &c.	249
Franklin D. Richards comments on several issues regarding emigration. See <i>Millennial Star</i> 13 (1 August 1851): 234–35.	

Special Conference of the Seventies 252

The Welsh translation of this conference held 18 January 1851 at Salt Lake City as reported in the *Millennial Star* 13 (1 August 1851): 227–28.

Account of a Journey from Great Salt Lake City, Four
Hundred and Fifty Miles to the South [From Capt. D. Jones] . . 254

A continuation of the third part of this account that appears in *Źion's Trumpet* 3 (26 July 1851): 237–41.

Doctrine of Devils 258

Davis wishes for all his readers to read the observations of Franklin D. Richards about this doctrine in *Millennial Star* 13 (1 August 1851): 236–37, as he does not have sufficient space in *Źion's Trumpet* to include them. He does, however, quote one paragraph.

Triplet to the Sign-Seekers 258

Poem of seven 4-line stanzas by J. Richards of Y Graig-ddu about how to deal with those who request a sign.

Prejudice of the Star of Gomer 259

Davis tells of a notice in the *Seren Gomer* (Star of Gomer) that advertising space in the periodical could be purchased. But when he sent a list of Mormon publications to be advertised in the periodical the editor responded that it would not be appropriate to do so.

Letters to the Valley 259

Davis announced that letters can be sent to Utah Territory for a shilling each if they weigh less than half an ounce.

Payments from July 23 to August 7 260

Payments received from five districts and eleven branches are shown.

“W. T.”	260
Davis assures “W. T.” that he will try to publish an answer to his questions in the next issue. Space is provided in four of the next five issues of <i>Zion’s Trumpet</i> to answer the questions posed by “W. T.” (William Thomas).	
Dual Hymnal	260
The 1849 and the 1851 hymnals bound together are now available for purchase. See <i>Welsh Mormon Writings</i> , pp. 35–39.	
Book of Mormon	260
Davis asks for the presidents and the distributors to sell subscriptions to the Welsh translation of the Book of Mormon which will, like the Doctrine and Covenants, be published and distributed in segments. See my “ <i>Llyfr Mormon: The Translation of the Book of Mormon into Welsh</i> ,” in <i>Journal of Book of Mormon Studies</i> 11 (2002): 45–49.	
Doc. and Cov.	260
Davis announces that the final segment of the Welsh translation of the Doctrine and Covenants will be distributed.	
(No title)	260
Davis announces that one hundred copies of the <i>Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs</i> are available for purchase.	
Appointment	260
Announcement of the new presidency for the Carmarthenshire Conference.	
(No title)	260
The Saints are warned not to receive Thomas Davies who has left Llansawel Branch.	
(No title)	260
Announcement of the marriage of Elder Henry Evans to Miss A.	

Browse from St. Malo, France. (See my “William Howells: First Missionary to France” in *Supporting Saints: Life Stories of Nineteenth-Century Mormons*, edited by Donald Q. Cannon and David J. Whittaker [Provo, Utah: Brigham Young University Religious Studies Center, 1985]: 43–81. See also the 27 September 1849 letter of William Howells to Dan Jones linked to the file for William Howells on <http://welshmormonhistory.org> for an account of Ann Browse’s baptism and the gold ring she presented to William Howells on the occasion.)

(No title) 260
Davis laments having to leave many things out of this issue for lack of space.

(No title) 260
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

23 AUGUST

“Word of Wisdom” by the Editor of the “Deseret News” . . 261
The Welsh translation of Willard Richards’ explanation of the benefits and wisdom of observing the “Word of Wisdom.” See *Millennial Star* 13 (15 July 1851): 222–23.

Counsels to the Saints. 264
William Phillips encourages all the Saints to purchase the Doctrine and Covenants, the Book of Mormon, and other publications of the Church in Welsh.

Baptism—the Necessity of it. 267
John Richards explains to the Quakers, the Unitarians, and all others who do not practice baptism that it is necessary for salvation.

Inconsistencies of the Doctrine and Covenants, the Book of Mormon, and the Bible 271
John Davis provides space in *Zion’s Trumpet* to publish the ques-

tions William Thomas has sent him and promises to answer them in the next issue.

Letter from Manti City, Utah Territory, to the Editor of
“Zion’s Trumpet” 272

Elizabeth Lewis, a member of the first group of Welsh Mormon emigrants in 1849, sends a letter for John Davis to publish in *Zion’s Trumpet* in which she asks for the cooperation of all the Saints in Wales who know her parents and siblings to encourage them to join her in Zion. See her file (Elizabeth Jones—1812) in <http://welshmormonhistory.org> for her biography.

Reflection on Zion 275

A poem of one 16-line stanza and one 15-line stanza by William Thomas, Blaen Dowlais, in which he presents his thoughts about life in the Salt Lake Valley. In the following issue of *Zion’s Trumpet* Davis apologizes for the line that was inadvertently omitted. The line before the last line should read “All happy and in beauty.”

Time 275

Although time is our most precious possession we tend to waste it.

The Love of God 276

We cannot have both the love of God and the love of the world.

(No title). 276

Cicero’s comment on an irreligious man.

(No title). 276

God punishes the disobedient with children who are also disobedient.

Payments from August 8 to August 21. 276

Payments received from three districts, ten branches, and one individual are shown.

“W. P.”276
Davis informs “W. P.” of the price for the segments of the Welsh translation of the Book of Mormon.

(No title)276
Copies of the Doctrine and Covenants are complete and ready for binding.

Remember the Book of Mormon276
Davis calls for the presidents to sell subscriptions and report the number by August 31st.

(No title)276
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

6 SEPTEMBER

Pouch (Scrip)277
By one of his readers Davis was asked the meaning of “scrip.” Wanting to be sure of his answer he wrote to Franklin D. Richards with the same question. This is the answer he received from President Richards.

“Inconsistencies” of the Doctrine and Covenants, the Book of Mormon, and the Bible279
Davis’s response to a variety of questions previously posed by William Thomas and printed in *Zion’s Trumpet* for 23 August 1851, pp 271–72.

Review. Principles of the Latter-day Saints weighed in the Scales of Logic and the Scriptures. By William Jones, Bethesda. . . .282
Davis responds to William Jones’s observations and conclusions as presented in the twenty-four-page pamphlet of the above title. This segment and the one in the 20 September 1851 were later combined and published as a sixteen-page pamphlet. See *Welsh*

Mormon Writings, p. 146.

Men who Have Lost their Way 287

Thomas Harries, Georgetown, encourages those who have lost their way to come to the Latter-day Saints for guidance and an explanation of the right way.

The Saints and Zion 291

A poem of six 8-line stanzas by T. Jeremiah depicting how life is in Zion.

Payments from August 22 to September 4 292

Payments received from five districts, and ten branches are shown.

Conferences 292

The dates and places of six conferences to be held.

Book of Mormon Again 292

Davis has received only 1,223 subscribers for the Welsh translation of the Book of Mormon and must delay until "many more" are received.

Error 292

On page 275 of the previous issue a line of poetry was omitted.

(No title) 292

Davis announces the publication of "The Compilement," a collection of his treatises, songs, and letters. See *Welsh Mormon Writings*, p. 143-44.

(No title) 292

Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.

20 SEPTEMBER

Review. Principles of the Latter-day Saints weighed in the Scales
of Logic and the Scriptures. By William Jones, Bethesda..... 293

Continuation from *Zion's Trumpet* for 6 September 1851, pp. 282–
87, of Davis's response to William Jones's pamphlet.

“Inconsistencies of the Doctrine and Covenants, and the Book
of Mormon,” &c., Again 304

William Thomas writes to John Davis with more questions after
reading Davis's first response to his questions in *Zion's Trumpet* for
6 September 1851, pp. 279–82. Davis provides short answers to
Thomas's questions and states that he was not going to answer
any more questions for the time being.

Polygamy of the Mormons 306

Davis denies the rumors that Elizabeth Lewis, who had left her
husband and sister behind in Wales to settle some legal matters,
had become the “spiritual wife” of Captain Dan Jones. The ac-
cusation, however, was true. The practice of plural marriage
among the Mormons was not acknowledged publicly until Janu-
ary 1853 in Britain. Whether Davis knew the truth at the time he
claimed otherwise is not clear.

Call for Welsh Books in England. 307

Franklin D. Richards has ordered one hundred copies of the
Doctrine and Covenants in Welsh and has promised to receive
two hundred copies of the Book of Mormon in Welsh when it is
published.

Railway 307

A railway is being built to transport stone from the quarry to the
construction site for the temple in Salt Lake City.

“Mormons Bog” 307

Copies of the Danish translation of the Book of Mormon are on

their way to Wales.

News from the Valley 307

Things are going well in the Salt Lake Valley with plans being made for a celebration on July 24th.

The Wise Man 308

How the wise man organizes his time.

Wealth 308

Lost time cannot be called back.

Space 308

A four-line poem by W. Roberts, Jr., Dinas, stating that immortality is achieved only in the Lord's dwelling place.

Payments from September 5 to September 18. 308

Payments received from two districts, and twelve branches are shown.

Doc. and Cov.. . . . 308

Davis offers twopence for copies of the 6th segment of the Doctrine and Covenants and asks for the patience of those who have requested odd segments.

Book of Mormon 308

The first segment of the Welsh translation of the Book of Mormon is being sent out with this issue of *Zion's Trumpet*.

(No title). 308

The large posters being sent with this issue of *Zion's Trumpet* are to be placed in meeting houses and other places to notify where Mormon publications can be purchased.

(No title). 308

Money for the Emigrating Fund is to be sent by September 24th.

(No title) 308
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

4 OCTOBER

Coming of the Son of Man 308
The first of five installments of a treatise by Captain Dan Jones about the Second Coming. Apparently these writings were among some of the papers Jones had left behind upon his departure for America nearly three years earlier.

To the Churches 320
William Phillips speaks out against branch and district presidents who disregard instructions sent to them by their leaders. He also condemns those who conceal their sins instead of confessing them and repenting of them.

Failure 323
The effect of one’s failure on his friends.

Book of Mormon Again 323
Because the number of subscribers to the Book of Mormon has increased the price has been dropped to one penny per segment.

Doc. and Cov. 323
The early segments of the Doctrine and Covenants are in short supply. Davis recommends they be acquired from subscribers who did not purchase the total number of segments.

To the Distributors 323
Davis explains why sending out billings for Church publications every fortnight instead of every quarter is not necessary.

Binding Books	323
Davis explains to his readers how they can obtain a handsome binding for their segments of Doctrine and Covenants.	
(No title)	324
Davis warns those who are going into “shameful debt” to be more diligent.	
(No title)	324
The pamphlet entitled “Review of the Treatise of W. Jones, Bethesda, which is called Principles of the Latter-day Saints weighed on the Scales of Reason and Scriptures” is now off the press.	
(No title)	324
The “Bilingual Hymn Book”—the 1849 and the 1851 hymnals bound together—will soon be ready.	
(No title)	324
Davis responds to a question regarding Luke 29:17 with four lines of verse.	
Book Debts from the Districts, Branches and Others, for the Quarter Ending September 30, 1851	324
The total outstanding debt owed for books is over £214.	
Payments from September 19 to October 2.	324
Payments received from four districts, and nine branches are shown.	
(No title)	324
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

18 OCTOBER

Coming of the Son of Man 325

The second of five installments of a treatise by Captain Dan Jones about the Second Coming.

Remarks of W. Gibson on the Book of Mormon 328

David Roberts, Llwynyngell, Ffestiniog, recommends to John Davis the commentary on the Book of Mormon written by William Gibson and published in the *Millennial Star*. The segment that Davis chooses to publish in this issue of *Zion's Trumpet* is from *Millennial Star* 12 (15 July 1850): 209–10. Many other segments from Gibson's commentary are published in later issues of *Zion's Trumpet*.

Translation of the Book of Mormon 331

Thomas Conway, Flint, expresses his elation at having the Book of Mormon in Welsh with a poem of four 8-line stanzas.

The Mormons 332

Davis elects to publish this article from the *New York Tribune* in his periodical because it casts the Mormons in a very favorable light and extols the Mormon work ethic. Davis adds a brief comment to the effect that no one in America dares to claim that Mormons are lazy.

The “Welsh Woman” and the Mormons 333

Davis writes of his first perusal of the periodical *Y Gymraes* (Welsh Woman) and chastises the editor for including the “same old tales” about Mormonism.

The Twenty-fourth of July 334

A brief description of the celebration held in Salt Lake Valley.

William Thomas Again 334

Satisfied with the explanations given him by John Davis through *Zion's Trumpet*, William Thomas announces in his letter that he

has converted to the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

On the Death of Elder J. H. Flanigan. 336

An elegy of four 8-line stanzas composed by John Reynolds, Jr., Merthyr, on the occasion of the death of Elder Flanigan.

Response to “David Tell-the-Truth” in the “Enquirer” for October, Page 236 336

John Richards, Dinas, responds to the points raised by one “David Tell-the-Truth” in a recent issue of *Yr Ymofynydd* (The Inquirer), a periodical published by the Unitarians. Richards had decided against submitting his response to the editor of *Yr Ymofynydd* since a previous response of his had been refused space in the periodical.

Wife—Mistress—Lady 339

The Welsh translation of the English version from the Frontier Guardian which was a translation from German. The unknown author defines the role of wife, mistress, or lady in a man’s life.

(No title). 340

Davis has harsh words for those who send for fewer copies of *Zion’s Trumpet* than they committed to at the first of the year.

Northern Conferences 340

Conference dates for five northern districts.

Payments from October 3 to October 16 340

Payments received from four districts, and nineteen branches are shown.

(No title). 340

Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

1 NOVEMBER

Coming of the Son of Man 341
The third of five installments of a treatise by Captain Dan Jones about the Second Coming.

Duties of the Presidents 346
William Phillips explains the specific duties of presidents and their counselors.

Remarks of W. Gibson on the Book of Mormon 348
A continuation of Gibson’s commentary taken from *Millennial Star* 12 (15 July 1850): 210–212.

Polygamy Again 352
Davis again denies the accusation that plural marriage is being practiced by Latter-day Saints. He then quotes the words of Jacob (Jacob 2:20–32), a Book of Mormon prophet, who condemns plural marriage.

Verses 353
A poem of nine 7-line stanzas by David Roberts, Ffestiniog, about the joy Latter-day Saints will experience at the second coming.

Book of Mormon 355
Davis recommends that the pages of the Welsh translation of the Book of Mormon not be cut until all the segments are published in order to have an unblemished copy for binding.

Doc. and Cov. 355
Bound copies of the Welsh translation of the Doctrine and Covenants are now available for purchase.

The Trumpet 355
Davis encourages his readers not to neglect *Zion’s Trumpet* in favor of the Book of Mormon but rather to strive for more subscribers.

Star	356
Davis calls for an increase in the call for the <i>Millennial Star</i> .	
Appointments	356
Henry Evans is to replace Thomas Pugh as president of the West Glamorgan District, and Thomas Pugh is to replace William Phillips as president of the East Glamorgan District so that President Phillips can devote more time to all the districts in Wales.	
(No title)	356
Davis has several writings of Captain Dan Jones that he intends to publish in <i>Zion's Trumpet</i> .	
(No title)	356
Davis recognizes the excellent quality of a song by "D. E. J." but fears its publication would cause harm; he requests the submission of something of a different nature. This could possibly be a sarcastic poem by Dewi Elfed Jones, the Baptist minister who converted to Mormonism in April, directed at his former colleagues.	
(No title)	356
Davis thanks "D. W." for his treatise but declines to publish it for fear feelings would be hurt.	
Payments from October 17 to October 30.	356
Payments received from two districts, and ten branches are shown.	
Errors	356
Davis corrects the amount paid for books in the previous issue by the Llanilltyd Branch and by the Pontytypridd Branch in the issue before that.	
(No title)	356
Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.	

15 NOVEMBER

Coming of the Son of Man 357

The fourth of five installments of a treatise by Captain Dan Jones about the Second Coming.

Baptism for the Subjects and the Proper Way of Administering It 362

John Richards, Dinas, addresses his article to all who believe in infant baptism by creating a conversation between a “Sprinkler” and a Saint. The Saint explains to the Sprinkler all the reasons that infant baptism is wrong.

Persecution in Tredegar, Monmouthshire 366

William Phillips describes the frightful experience he and the visiting Lorenzo Snow had in the town of Tredegar the night of 4 November 1851. As a postscript Dewi Elfed wrote a four-line poem to express relief that the two were kept safe through the night.

Groans of the Reverends 369

A poem of twenty-one 4-line stanzas, each with a 4-line chorus, by Dewi Elfed, Gwawr Chapel, Aberaman, in which he portrays the lamentations of the ministers of the various religions in Wales as they observe the success of the Latter-day Saints when compared with their failure to stop them.

(No title) 372

Brief observations about overabundance, need, honor, being lifted up, and happiness.

(No title) 372

Contentment is not determined by one’s situation, rather by one’s mind.

(No title) 372

Observations about honor and wealth.

Mormons Bog. 372

The Danish translation of the Book of Mormon is available in Wales. The French, German, and Italian translations are in process.

Payments from Oct. 31 to Nov. 13 372

Payments received from nine districts, and ten branches are shown.

(No title). 372

Thomas Morgan, formerly president of the Anglesey District, has been excommunicated. Someone by the name of Liffin, Caernarvon, has no further connection with the Church.

(No title). 372

The Bilingual Hymnal, containing the 1849 and the 1851 Welsh hymnals and the 1851 English hymnal, is now available for purchase. See *Welsh Mormon Writings*, p. 149.

(No title). 372

Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.

29 NOVEMBER

Coming of the Son of Man 373

The fifth and final installment of a treatise by Captain Dan Jones about the Second Coming. In a bracketed note at the end of the treatise John Davis explains that he had intended to finish these incomplete writings of Dan Jones, but because of other pressing obligations he had to postpone his plans.

Greeting to the Saints in Great Britain 376

The counsel and advice of Elder Lorenzo Snow as he bids farewell to the British Saints. See *Millennial Star* 13 (1 December 1851): 362–65.

Remarks of W. Gibson on the Book of Mormon 380

A continuation of Gibson’s commentary taken from *Millennial Star* 12 (1 August 1850): 225–26.

Valley of the Mountains 383

A poem of five 8-line stanzas in which John Wilkins, Glynmil, expresses his longing to go to Salt Lake Valley.

To the Distributors, Subscribers, and Readers of the
“Trumpet” 384

Davis observes that there may be some Saints who think less about *Zion’s Trumpet* ever since they have been receiving the Welsh translations of the Doctrine and Covenants and the Book of Mormon. He admits that while his work on the translations has kept his main focus away from the periodical his thoughts are now leaning more toward *Zion’s Trumpet* since he is within three months of completing the task of translating. He then promises to make it “more worthy of being received” and calls for leaders to increase the number of subscribers in order to keep the price at one penny per issue.

The Troubled Cry of God’s Children in Great Babylon
of the Latter Days 385

A poem of seven 4-line stanzas and a 9-line chorus by Thomas Conway, Flint, in which God’s children lament their current condition in Wales because of their conversion to the gospel. The chorus is God’s comforting response.

News from the Continent. 387

A hymnal with songs in Danish has been published; the Danish translation of the Doctrine and Covenants is about to go to press; and the German translation of the Book of Mormon is nearing completion.

(No title)	387
Elder Parley P. Pratt is now in South America to preach the gospel.	
Australia.	387
Elders G. W. Wandell and John Murdock are laboring in Australia.	
(No title)	387
Elder David Candland reports a renewal of the work in Nova Scotia.	
Salt Lake Valley	387
Things are going well in Zion.	
(No title)	387
An interesting paradox about titles of honor and the royal imprint.	
New Feminine Attire.	387
Women are beginning to wear trousers and jackets!	
Warning	388
No one is to smoke in the residence of the Editor, or he will see his name published in <i>Zion's Trumpet</i> .	
Denmark	388
The Church is growing rapidly in Denmark.	
(No title)	388
Do not tell lies even when joking.	
(No title)	388
The danger of hypocrisy.	

(No title) 388
The danger of going to the tavern for the company.

(No title) 388
Seek to do good in order to avoid doing evil.

Good Rules to Remember. 388
Six basic rules that will help one to be successful in life.

Payments from Nov. 14 to Nov. 27 388
Payments received from two districts, and eight branches are shown.

(No title) 388
Davis calls special attention to the article in this issue directed to distributors, subscribers and readers of *Zion's Trumpet*.

(No title) 388
Deadline for anyone wishing to have their segments of the Doctrine and Covenants bound in London.

(No title) 388
Davis's address in Merthyr Tydfil.

13 DECEMBER

Writing Letters 389
The Welsh translation of Joseph Smith's thoughts about writing letters taken from the *Evening and Morning Star* for September 1832.

Remarks of W. Gibson on the Book of Mormon. 392
A continuation of Gibson's commentary taken from *Millennial Star* 12 (1 August 1850): 226–28.

Letter from Apostle J. Taylor, to President W. Phillips	395
A lengthy and very friendly letter from John Taylor in Germany to William Phillips in Wales in which Taylor indicates his intention of visiting Wales in January.	
Greeting to the Saints in Great Britain	399
A continuation of the counsel and advice of Elder Lorenzo Snow as he bids farewell to the British Saints. See <i>Millennial Star</i> 13 (1 December 1851): 362–65.	
The Most Available Sin	403
A humorous poem of four 4-line stanzas by Thomas Harries, Georgetown, in which he decides to bid farewell to tobacco.	
Counsel	404
Proper behavior with regard to friends and acquaintances.	
(No title).	404
Do not talk behind a friend's back.	
Conferences	404
Dates and places for seven conferences to be held.	
Representation of Wales	404
The statistical report for Wales shows 137 branches with a total of 5,244 members.	
Payments from Nov. 27 to Dec. 11	404
Payments received from five districts, eight branches, and one individual are shown.	
(No title).	404
Davis tells "J. J." that his poem will appear in the next issue of <i>Zion's Trumpet</i> .	

(No title) 404

There is no space in this issue of *Zion’s Trumpet* for the epistle of Franklin D. Richards, but it will appear in the next.

(No title) 404

Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

27 DECEMBER

Epistle to the Saints comprising the British Conferences . . . 405

The Welsh translation of Franklin D. Richards’ epistle that appears in *Millennial Star* 13 (15 December 1851): 369–75.

“Let Me Go” 415

“The Valley,” a poem of eight 4-line stanzas by John Taylor, was published in *Millennial Star* 12 (1 July 1850): 208. James James, Victoria, prepared in Welsh what he called a “rough translation” or an “imitation” of Taylor’s poem and sent it to John Davis to be published in *Zion’s Trumpet*. Davis included the Welsh translation in this issue under the title “Gadewch i Mi Fynd” (Let Me Go), the first three words of Taylor’s poem in English. James omitted the third stanza from Taylor’s poem and added two of his own—stanzas 8 and 9—addressed to President William Phillips in the form of a direct plea for permission to emigrate. In a bracketed comment following the poem Davis informs James that the Presidency in Wales has authorized his emigration. James’s poem in this facsimile translation is an informational translation, no attempt having been made to imitate the meter or rhyme. For comparison purposes Taylor’s original poem is included in this commentary.

THE VALLEY
BY JOHN TAYLOR

Let me go to the Valley far off in the west,
To my kindred and brethren whom I love best;
Where love and affection our hearts will o’erflow,
To my home in the mountains—oh! there let me go.

Let me go to the Valley, and find me a rest,
And live with the righteous and dwell with the best,
Where contentment and peace, like the rivers do flow;
To the beautiful Valley—oh! there let me go.

Let me go, for my friends and my brethren are there,
With whom I'm united in praise and in prayer;
Who like gold have been tried and are pure as the snow;
To the faithful in Zion—oh! there let me go.

Let me go to my lov'd ones, who've long been oppress'd,
Who have fled to the Valley far off in the west,
Where no feuds can assail nor foul mobs overthrow;
To the lovely and virtous—oh! there let me go.

Let me go to the Saints that in Zion do dwell,
Let me roam in the Valley and rest in the dell;
Let me share in their joys, or partake in their woe,
To the home of the righteous—oh! there let me go.

Let me go to the Zion, which God hath prepared
As the hope of the Saints—as rest and reward,
Where the fountains and rivers in purity flow,
And the earth teems with plenty—oh! there let me go.

Let me go, for the light of eternity's there,
And join with the faithful in praise and in prayer;
Where celestial streams from Jehovah do flow,
To the pure and the just ones—oh! there let me go.

Let me go where the banner of freedom's unfurled
To all creeds and professions throughout the wide world;
Where all tribes, hues and nations in safety may flow,
And be free from oppression—oh! there let me go.

Payments from Dec. 12 to Dec. 24 416

Payments received from five districts, and eleven branches are shown.

(No title) 416
The Sixth General Epistle will be published in the next issue.

(No title) 416
A reminder for all to read Davis’s comment in number 24 of
Zion’s Trumpet about the increase in price.

(No title) 416
The quarterly book debts will appear in the next issue.

(No title) 416
Davis’s address in Merthyr Tydfil.

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

STAR OF THE SAINTS;

CONTAINING

PRINCIPLES OF THE “DISPENSATION OF THE
FULLNESS OF TIMES,”

IN

ESSAYS, LETTERS, ACCOUNTS,
POETRY, &c.

“We would have healed Babylon, but she is not healed; forsake her, and let us go every one into his own country: for her judgment reacheth unto heaven, and is lifted up even to the skies,”—JER. LI, 9.

“O Zion, that bringest good tidings, get thee up into the high mountain.”—ISA. XL, 9.

VOLUME III.



MERTHYR TYDFIL:

PRINTED, PUBLISHED, AND FOR SALE BY J. DAVIS,
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FOREWORD.

DEAR READERS,—The third volume of the TRUMPET is now in your hands, and you can have a look at it to see its contents, so there is no reason to describe them to you in the Foreword. It contains many very valuable things, by the apostles and other worthy brethren, which will be worth reading over many times. This year has been a very special one in the history of the world, as well as in the history of the Church. During it the Crystal Palace was built, a mirror of the earth's nations, which have been able to see one another's accomplishments; also much of the word of God has been published for the various languages of the world. This is the year in which the Welshman has beheld, in his mother tongue, the complete "Doctrine and Covenants," and about half the "Book of Mormon." Also, this is the year during which we ourselves have experienced the greatest responsibility of our life, and felt the greatest burden on our shoulders; and it was only by the Lord's mercy that we were sustained. We thank our God for his great goodness to us and to the Saints; and we also thank our distributors and our correspondents for their tireless work with the TRUMPET. We plead for a continuation of their work this coming year, so that we can sound our trumpet more fervently than ever before, and so the Saints will be edified, and the world enlightened. Pray for us, brethren, and sustain us with your faith; and the Lord will bless you with the gifts of heaven.

Your obedient servant in the truth,

JOHN DAVIS.

December 24, 1851.

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ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 1.]

JANUARY 11, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

THE ANNUAL GREETING.

ESTEEMED READERS,—Here we are again beginning a new year, and greeting you with “Happy New Year.” May you receive more of the goodness of God this year than you have ever received; may you have a New Year’s gift from heaven. God does not withhold blessings from those of his children who are faithful and who carry out his wishes.

With pleasure we look back on the course we have run ever since we received ZION’S TRUMPET to sound; we consider the last two years the longest we have ever experienced, not because we have become weary with the work, but because a great work has been accomplished. We know of years we spent in the kingdom of darkness, which seemed brief, because there was no rock there to keep our work from being swept away by the floods of time. That which we have done in the kingdom of the light stands visible, and we account for time by the work that has been accomplished. We hope that this year, and the coming years, will seem still longer, so that we may be able to say again, that it was good to continue in our office of serving our fellow nation. Let us fill our years, not with minutes or hours, but with good works, which will be visible when there is no more time. Although the sun turns in the canopy of heaven, and measures the time of man; yet, if it did not affect the warmth of the earth, and the growth of the sprouts,

it would be as if it had never existed. The works of God are the reason for remembering the first seven days; he worked for six days, but he was not idle by resting on the seventh, for he blessed it and sanctified it. When we ourselves finish our work, as God did, our days will be numbered, and we may enter into the “rest that is yet held for the people of God,” to be sanctified. Until that time, we are confident that the Spirit of God will testify, at the end of each day, week, month, and year, of each of our good deeds, that it is good, so that we will have an eternal Sabbath to rest with the Lord. May the eternal God hold us in his powerful hand; and by leading us, may he lead us while guiding his children along the path to salvation. Our cry and theirs will ascend to his ears continually, and it will be heard, so that we shall have One in whom we can trust in the face of every circumstance. He is our God, and there is nothing like him; therefore, let us praise him in the congregations of the Saints, and may we respect even the least of his servants.

Until now the Saints continue to pay heed to our voice, and to feed on the bread we offer; for they are aware that it derives from the same place as the bread of the others of our brethren in the priesthood. We shall do our best, while we are at our post, to serve our readers with the best things we can obtain, so that they may be edified in all things. At the same time, let the Saints take care to refrain from listening to the small souls, who are tolerated by God to be in the church, because they are too insignificant to be damned; **who**, were they to go to hell, no one would claim them; and therefore, they are kept in the church to perfect the patience of the Saints. All who exert influence against the efforts made to spread the knowledge of the gospel among our nation of one blood, are opposing the government of God, and such will soon be deprived of the other Comforter; which, when they lose it, will leave them ineffective, unassociated with us, and easily recognized. Beware of wolves and false prophets, for they will go about in Saints' clothing. Our task is to warn, and get our readers to continue to hold fast that which we write from time to time. May we not write to anyone in vain; that discourages us, and weakens us; we expect that all will be read in a timely fashion, and thereby we will be of service to the

particular denomination to which we belong.

We plead for an interest in the prayers of all our brethren, that we may have the strength of God this year again to sound the TRUMPET more effectively than ever before; and we sincerely beg the Saints to do their best to open a way for us to go throughout every corner of Wales. Give us the helping hand of unity, and we shall accomplish a masterpiece; our sound will pervade every corner of the country, and warn every man to flee to Zion for salvation. Our message is to the Welsh nation, and we are desirous of saving it. We were sent to sound forth in our mother tongue, which is the common language of the country, and what Dick John David will attempt to hinder us? Someone who has the Holy Ghost? or someone who intends to save his nation? There is a way for the Welsh to enlighten their English neighbors, without wishing to leave themselves without anything. Do good to everyone, but especially to your brothers of the same blood. Do not disregard your language, even though you can speak a little English, and have been in England; remember that God understands Welsh, and that yet thousands of Welsh call on his name, and for Him to save them. And if we have been placed here by apostles of God, to publish his word in Welsh, the Welsh and English Saints in Wales should support us in our work.

Finally, we wish for the blessing of God to be on all our readers, and for his Spirit to guide the Saints to act according to his will, so that they may be worthy of being lifted up in his kingdom. Thus we say, and do so in the name of Jesus Christ. Amen.

GREETING OF THE APOSTLE J. TAYLOR TO THE WELSH SAINTS.

TO THE EDITOR OF THE ZION'S TRUMPET.

DEAR SIR,—This is the third time for me to visit this place, and I must say that I enjoyed myself greatly during my short stay, upon seeing the honesty, simplicity, faithfulness, fervor, and the generosity shown by the Welsh Saints whom I had the pleasure of seeing; and had it

not been for the other responsibilities that rest on me, I would have had pleasure in visiting all the Saints throughout your principality. As things are, I must be deprived of that pleasure, and be satisfied with greeting you with a few lines through your publication.

The purpose of this greeting at the present time, is to shed a little light on a matter that apparently is a bit of a misunderstanding in your midst. When brother Henshaw came to Wales, he taught the people that the Saints did not preach for wages, nor did they minister for money, which is quite true; for they have a greater purpose than filthy lucre. Their purpose is to teach pure principles of the truth, to proclaim the eternal gospel, and to make known the glorious principles that God intended for the salvation of the human family. But while they are at this important task, they and their families must be sustained. The elders, when they begin to preach, do not become spiritual and ethereal beings, nor do their families; they, like others, must have something with which to sustain their families; and while they minister to you in spiritual things, it is well for you to minister to them in temporal things. I am aware that the elders can blame themselves to a great extent for this reason. When Capt. Jones came to preach in your midst, he was accused by his enemies of seeking money from the people to whom he preached; and, being endowed with an independent spirit, he ran to extremes of the opposite side to avoid having that reputation, which left him with a tendency to mislead many of the other elders. What is the result? Many people suppose that the elders do not need sustenance. But is this true? Not at all. They need, therefore, either to have a way of sustaining themselves, be without anything, or be sustained by personal abundance; and since very few are able to sustain themselves, as a result they must depend on a few friends, whose generosity is overtaxed, or go without, which puts them in a rather difficult situation. But perhaps you ask, are you blaming the people? No, I don't; rather I blame the elders for teaching such principles, and they are beginning to feel the effects of their foolishness, and to discover that they cannot feed or clothe themselves and their families

with air. But are they going without? No, but they are exposed to many difficulties, and are depending on a very small number of friends, whose generosity is overly taxed; whereas, if the burden were divided evenly, it would make things easier for everyone. I speak boldly about this matter, for everyone knows that it has nothing to do with me, since I am laboring in France. But, do you not go without purse or scrip? Yes, I do; but the Lord opens the way before me continually, and I have been supplied with everything I needed, in terms of money and clothes. But how did you get them? Generally the Saints, by learning of my situation, supplied my needs: and frequently people who were not in the church were the ones who supplied me. But I was always supplied, and so have your elders been supplied. I have received £20 or £40, at the same time, from the same person; but you are generally poor, and who can spare that much? but I am certain that you do not wish for your elders to depend on the world. When elders sacrifice their whole time for the ministry, they must be sustained; and that can be done easily with a cooperative effort, without anyone being hurt. Let the deacons, then, do their duty, teaching this principle to those over whom God has made them supervisors; and let all the elders cast their foolishness aside, and assist the deacons in their efforts; and I am certain that there is a generous spirit among the people, who will answer their calls, and assist them in their difficulties. "Unity is strength," and that which is difficult for a few becomes easy for many.

I wish to note that I am greatly pleased with the Presidency of Wales, and with the order of things. Brother Phillips is a good man, as are his counselors; and I can observe that brother Phillips has many visitors from every corner of Wales to feed, besides all the expense that goes with traveling to fulfill his duties, which must be provided from somewhere. Brethren, bless him; and in so doing, you will bless yourselves.

I say also to the officers and their members, uphold your publication, as much as you can, and let the sound of the TRUMPET be heard from the north to the south, and its echo from mountain

to mountain, and let the people in every village and town know that the Latter-day Saints live by the sound of the *horn*. There is no need to mention the *Doctrine and Covenants* in Welsh, since all the Saints appreciate it. And while you are sustaining all these things through your generosity, allow me to plead for an interest in your prayers on behalf of France, so that light, truth, and knowledge may increase, and that the power of God will triumph.

Yours in the eternal covenant,
Merthyr Tydfil, Dec. 30, 1850. JOHN TAYLOR.

P. S.—While looking over the foregoing things, please allow me to say, if any of the brethren feel in their heart to give five, ten, or twenty pounds, to assist in the publication of the Book of Mormon in France, may they send them to brother Phillips, and he then will send them to me. J. T.

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMELY THE SONS OF JACOB;*

To which is added the Epistle of Paul the Apostle to the Laodiceans, and also with respect to the Death of Paul in Rome, under Nero.

[Translated from the Greek by the late Rev. R. Grosthead, bishop of Lincoln.]

TO THE READER.

ALBEIT these our happy days, in some respect, good Christian, have and enjoy divers and sundry works tending to the subversion of Belial, and the erection of godliness; yet considering that as earthly, so we spiritual soldiers seldom run to the watch without alarm; I thought it

* At the request of many of our readers, we publish the foregoing interesting book in the TRUMPET, from the old Welsh translation, and we shall continue with it until it is finished. A copy of it in the Greek, on parchment, is kept at the university in Cambridge. We can compare the Welsh and the English, and make the necessary changes. We shall express our opinion about it some other time.—ED.

convenient to call upon you with this grave and godly book, of long time hid in Hebrew, now come to light in Welsh.—The malice of the Jewish people in concealing it, by reason of Christ the righteous, so often prefigured, was intolerable; but the singular providence of God in preserving it, unspeakable; and now at last, though chargeable, yet fruitful is the expressing, and printing of such a worthy work in our natural language. A golden writ, being of itself, without the accessory painting of eloquent speech, a mirror for princes, a preacher for all Christians—a beautiful glass for women, for children, servants, and such like; a wise, plausible, and most ready schoolmaster, for to apply to every particular estate his peculiar property. Art thou a prince? let Judah rule thee; if thou thinkest upon manly courage, he teacheth valiantness; if thou seek to govern aright, he willeth thee to fly tyranny; if thou thirst after manners of life, he foundeth it out, that vain glory, fornication, and discord, blemish, weaken, and at length utterly consume nobility. Let me proceed further and ask a question; Art thou a bishop? A minister, a preacher of Christ's birth, his life and his death? Behold Levi as a lantern, thou canst teach thyself, but he can teach thee better; thou speakest to others, harken to him that talketh to thee of thy duty, how holy it is, how honorable, the mockers thereof how miserable. O you parents, look upon Jacob, and the twelve godly fathers; in time and order, learn from them to pray for your children, through God in Christ; have regard to their instruction: "For the hearty prayer of a father to the Lord for his children, is a right singular benefit before him; but he that for foolish pity giveth them the bridle, is before God accounted a guilty partaker of their sinful race:" view this book therefore, hearken how to teach yourselves and your children; you have already handled a sick man's salve, enjoy now at length a sick man's tongue, to instruct them when you leave them, and what to leave them when you die, else their end will be lamentation, but yours lamentable misery. And come you hither, you children of the earth, read and see that old father, Reuben, with his good brethren, readily and rightly, describe the blessed path of righteousness, and the forlorn way of Belial, the one to flee, the other to follow. Wilt thou begin with the eldest, for that old age seemeth wisest? Stop not then the ears of thy heart and body to so wise and sweet a charmer. O! the number and uglisome portraiture, of those deadly spirits, that he hath so orderly numbered, Lechery, Envy, Gluttony, Bravery, Pride, Vainglory,

Unrighteousness, Willful ignorance. All these, as they seem, are indeed pernicious; but the former is most detestable, the end whereof is consumption of this earthly body, and destruction of the soul; which wellspring and puddle of evil, if thou wilt have dried up, cease from drunkenness: if not see it, have not a narrow and greedy eye upon a beautiful face; if not drink, yet stop thy mouth from busy questions with women; use labor, tame youthfulness. "For in this, I overshooting myself (saith Reuben to his children), I defiled my father's bed; therefore, look not upon the beauty of women, muse not upon their doings; but keep yourselves occupied either in learning or some work; charge your wives and daughters that they trim not their heads; will them to chasten their looks, for every woman that deals deceitfully in those things is reserved to the punishment of the world to come." Which trade of life to eschew without the fulfilling of the law, and the law partly consisteth in mutual love. Strive with Simeon, the second brother, to avoid Strife, which blindeth the mind, pineth the body, provoketh murder, the remedy whereof is both forgiving and forgetting. Take to thee Joseph's cheerful countenance, just, diligent, steady, and a serene mind, yet set before thine eyes Simeon's withered hand, a right plague for such a sin, all which disquietness and mischief safely to set aside; remember Judah, gather by him experience, That for a man to glory in his own works is sinful, and he which upbraideth another man's vice, standeth slippery. Judah checked his eldest brother (Reuben) with his fornication, but mark who sinned immediately, but envious and railing Judah. Did he not offend after the flesh in the Canaanites' house? Did he not take a wife without consent of his parents? Two great sins, used in our days, yet punished, the one with want, or at least small joy of children, saith father Judah the patriarch; but the other with intolerable danger of body and soul, saith St. Paul: Wherefore abstain from wine, abhor drunkenness, for such an one slandereth not, rehearseth not another man's sins, breedeth no sedition, but embraceth love and charity in a single heart, as good father Issachar, who never railed, nor was hurtful and spiteful to his neighbor, never ate his meat alone, but gave part to the poor; never removed the bounds and marks of other men's grounds, but loved all men as his natural children. O, that as we read this, so we might the same in life and conversation; mercy and love is a precious jewel, the maintainers whereof being jointly connected prosper; once dissevered, come to naught, for Zebulun saith, "When the stones and timber are dissolved, the waters wash away the sand;" whole mercy and singular compassion was rewarded singularly: sift his testament, resemble his rare charity, in

clothing the naked, and feeding the hungry, as well strangers as his countrymen: Let not the spirit of Dan possess your mind, suffer not the wrath of Gad to settle in your hearts, for such work with three of his sore instruments, bitter speech, treachery, and violent hands, yielding fruit not much unlike, as you may read, as you may see; wilt thou be taught the ready path to that thou dost seek? "Two ways there be (saith Asher), vice the one, the other virtue." Naphtali's race embrace the latter, eschew the former; but he that walketh in them both, blindeth men, deceiveth himself, and mocketh God; whose double-faced dealing shall be double punished, such are the covetous, such are they that are merciful in evilness; such are they (saith Asher) that fast from meats, but not from fornication; have therefore a simple heart with righteous Joseph, the blessed of the Lord, who was a true sign of Christ Jesus; for hatred he showed love; being cursed he blessed; being shot through he did not so much as bend his bow; albeit his brethren would have slain him, albeit they cast him into a well, though they sold him as a bond-slave to strangers, who hated shepherds to the death, of whom he was whipped and tormented; yet, when they stood in fear, gave them comfort; when they were well-nigh famished, gave them food; when by his authority he might destroy, he by his authority did preserve; being their Lord, using them as his betters,—being their brother, accepting them as his children, their unkindness not spoken of; their conspiracies forgotten, their cruel dealing most lovingly, most mercifully forgiven; you have heard his love towards his neighbor, hearken his obedience toward God. When he was miserably afflicted, did he rage and swell? When he was made a bond-slave of a free man's son, did he cry out to Heaven, being utterly forsaken? Did he impatiently accuse God's justice? No, but waiting, he waited on the Lord; and the Lord, which hid his face, did show his countenance, and lifted him from the lowest rank in respect, to being a free man, wealthy, of a wealthy subject, and honorable personage, president of the whole of Egypt; whom the Egyptians being alive loved, and after his death also; whom living neither wealth nor woe could make to swell, neither promise or threats of the Egyptian strumpet could make slide; and therefore being dead, neither world, devil, nor man's policy could make forgotten. O that our mortal race might thus begin and finish; yea, thus, O Lord, most happily finish. "The spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak." Learn therefore of Benjamin, to inflame thy heart, that thou mayst be ready both in body and soul. "Let us commend (saith the preacher), let us behold the noble famous men, and the generation of our fore elders, for many glorious acts hath the Lord done in them, and showed his

great power ever since the beginning." Upon the consideration whereof, and especially for that I would have nothing wanting in this book that might serve thy contentation, I thought it as well pertinent to deal with the righteous father, as with the godly children, for to shadow a face only without a body, hath his deserved commendation; but whoso painteth a leg without a body, or a body without a head, it shall not be amiss, as I suppose, as well to term him a foolish painter, as to judge the thing indiscreetly painted; wherefore as well to see the head as the leg, and to hear the father as the children, I have faithfully drawn out of Scripture, and not according to my fancy fashioned, the death and testament of Jacob, that blessed and right happy father, added to this ancient monument of the children; therefore, to recompense my pains, read them diligently; neither read only, but be content to follow; for the imitation of good and godly men, is the direct way and course to godliness. So may we account of Jacob's blessing; so may we thoroughly challenge to be his children, children I mean, not by flesh, but Spirit.

(*To be continued.*)

R. G.

"NATURE OF MIRACLES."

TO THE EDITOR OF THE STAR OF GOMER.

SIR,—Inasmuch as your Publication is a free one, and ready to provide space to rebuttals on any public topic, while nothing personal is dealt with, I feel a desire in me at present to make some observations on the article of your correspondent from Talywain, in the most recent *Star*, with respect to the "Nature of Miracles." He is a man who has distinguished himself lately by his treatises on the Influences of Fallen Spirits, &c., and if no effort is made to pull down somewhat this little piece of his, perhaps some will consider him to be irrefutable.

Dewi begins his article like a faithful Christian, the kind that Christ always loved. He says that he "himself does not see the need of the working of miracles in our days, for the purpose of proving the truthfulness of the Christian Religion; for he believes without doubting, according to the witness of the New Testament, without seeing one miracle." Paul of old enjoyed getting hold of men like this, instead of those who did not believe through his preaching, but who would ask for a *sign* and wisdom. But we shall not be too quick

to praise our correspondent, for he doubts in the following lines, whether it might not be necessary, since there are so many branches of Christianity in our days, to have a miracle to prove which one of them is founded on the witness of Christ, the evangelists, and the apostles. It appears that Dewi has gotten into a bit of a dilemma here. After giving assurance previously that he believes the religion of the New Testament, without his seeing a single miracle, he finds himself surrounded by numerous religions, each one professing to have the New Testament religion. Byron says—*Some millions must be wrong*. We ourselves say, and our correspondent will probably not agree with us either—*But one must be right*. But, although one is right, Dewi, since so many are erroneous, sees the need for a sign to prove that the right one is right. The Latter-day Saints offer to the world now that which Christ offered formerly,—“If any man will do his [God’s] will, he *shall know of the doctrine*, whether it be of God, or whether I speak of myself” (John vii, 17). No one from the other denominations can offer such a thing. Arguing is the only way they have to come to a knowledge of the truth. Paul was asked for a sign to prove the truth of his message; thus the Latter-day Saints are requested now: but the majority of the denominations in this age are believed to be true, even though they are so different from one another, without any requests for a sign. If they were preaching the same gospel as the apostles preached, is it likely the world would be satisfied without receiving a sign? Since the Saints are the only religion from which a sign is asked to prove that their religion is of God, it is highly appropriate to conclude that their religion is the one most similar to be that of the apostles. Mr. Gwilym ab Dewi, I suppose, sees that; and he is heard at the beginning of his article asking for a sign. He wants one to be given by some of the “*prophets*” of the Saints, when visiting his neighborhood, “if they are thinking of” working a miracle by feeding five thousand, besides women and children, with five loaves and two fishes (at his own expense), and leave twelve baskets of fragments afterwards. If that were to be done, the one who does not “see the need of the working of miracles in our days, for the purpose of proving the truthfulness of the Christian religions,” would *think* that it would be “obvious that they were built on the foundation of the prophets and the apostles.” But, on the other hand, says our correspondent, if they cannot get the Power of the Almighty

to work through them to perform the miracle, they can be categorized under the character of false Christs and false teachers. This is a fair offer, is it not? But let us ask the question this way:—I wonder, if Mr. Gwilym ab Dewi had been a contemporary of Christ, and if he had asked for a sign like this, would he have received his wish? Did the devil get a sign from him in the desert? Did he prophesy who was cuffing him, to prove that he was of God? Did he come down from the cross to prove himself the Son of God? Did he say that a wicked and adulterous generation seeks after a sign, and they would not have one? There is no need to answer these things, for they are known to all. Despite all that, Dewi is determined, that if they fail to work the miracle, “they can be categorized, on fair and reasonable ground, as possessing the character of false Christs and false teachers.” On the same ground the apostles can be categorized, when they failed to cast out that deaf and dumb spirit, as false Christs, &c. (Mark ix.) Power was given to Paul to heal; yet, he counsels Timothy to “use a little wine for his often infirmities;” and he leaves Trophimus sick at Miletum. We see from this that God imparts his spiritual gifts, as he wishes, and according to the faith of his children; but he did not authorize his children to satisfy sign seekers, and their Leader has not given one example of that. With respect to *false* Christs and false teachers, it is true that Christ and his apostles foretold of them, but it is just as true, that false Christs cannot confess the Christ of the New Testament, unless they explain themselves. The Saints believe in the same Christ as does Gwilym ab Dewi: it is not they, then, who are the false Christs. When Christ declared that deceivers like this would show signs and wonders, “insomuch that, if it were possible, they shall deceive the very elect;” he also said that signs would follow his believers; and in connection with that he warns them to be on their guard against false signs. There is no need for the denominations of this age to keep the counsels of our Lord about false signs, since they say there are no signs of any kind; and consequently, if some are done, there is no way they can be deceived. The task that religionists of this age have is very small in comparison to that of the religionists in primitive times. They had the challenge of “proving false apostles (Rev. ii, 2), false prophets, spirits,” &c.; but now, there is no opportunity for those people to appear similar to anyone, for no apostles or prophets are

supposed to be in the church. Evil spirits can now appear in whatever way they wish; it is very easy to recognize them, for no one receives any kind of good spirit. The people in primitive times also had the task of being careful not to receive any other doctrine except that which was given them by the apostles; but one can choose whatever doctrine he wishes now, and although they are in contradiction one to another, they are all according to the teaching of Christ, and certain to lead to eternal life! In light of the foregoing observations, it is clearly apparent that the Latter-day Saints are either of God, or they are deceivers; and that the various sects of this age are neither of God, nor are they deceivers. They are like those whom the Apostle portrays as “having a form of godliness, but denying his power,” and “heaping to themselves teachers, but without ever coming to a knowledge.” The early believers *knew* that their religion was true, and that none other could be right; the Saints now know the same; but the various sects of the age can only “*believe* conscientiously.”

(*To be continued.*)

LETTER OF CAPT. D. JONES TO ELDERS W. PHILLIPS AND J. DAVIS.

Salt Lake City, September 10, 1850.

DEAR BROTHERS W. PHILLIPS AND J. DAVIS,—Until now, for the life of me, I have not had a chance to greet you, in spite of my desire, since I wrote before; and now, short words are my song, for I am about to *leave again* from here further away to settle, that is, to the valley of *Sand Pete*, and that according to the counsel of President Young to me, and as many other Welsh brethren as can come. I know not yet who will come. This place is splendid country to settle in with an abundance of water and wood close by. It lies about 130 miles from here. We went through it last year as we search for the Madocians, and I shall be as much as that on my way to fulfill that venture yet, which thing, if God wills, I shall do before I rest. I do not have time to say hardly anything about this place or its happenings, but I shall send to you the “Deseret News” which is published here to do its part of that for me.

I had received only one small letter from you since I left Wales, nothing from anyone else, until the mail came in very recently; and yesterday I received the TRUMPET for last year. I cannot describe my feelings as I took

hold of a book which came from the hands of my dear brothers in the dear country which I left; a host of things which have gone by came to my recollection! but when I cut its pages and my eyes rushed across its pages, I saw the names of a number of the brethren whom I love so greatly singing through it like *diamonds* amid the pebbles along the seashore,—proving they were yet diligent in the field, faithful in the vineyard of their Lord, which vineyard is of my own planting. The bonds of my heart are nearly bursting with longing to see them, to shake their hands once again; yes, for their company eternally. I cannot be completely happy without all of them, those whom I loved so much; and yet, instead of returning to feast in their company and to battle together shoulder to shoulder with you in the army of Jesus there, he sees best now to send me even further! Well, I am content; His will be done, says my soul, so be it.

Yet, O dear brethren in the priesthood, what shall I say to you one and all to comfort you? This you know, that you are servants, as am I, of great Jesus, and that He is expecting all of us to fill the circle into which we have been placed; and He shall call us together sometime to give our account. Well, dear brethren and children in Christ, be sure to appear there happy. Remember that which I told you when I was there and do it; and thus God our Father will bless you forever and ever. I was about to say kiss my dear co-workers there: what else shall I say to them to show my love for them? Yet, that would be nothing. I have not time nor space to even name them, as they are too numerous. Go forward, dear Saints; the crowns are ahead of you, and eternal life to clothe you. I dreamed lately that I was in the middle of a room full of you in council, and it was exquisitely sweet! Oh, such heaven it was to me, but it was but a dream! Oh, teach the dear Saints tenderly in love the way to keep the counsel of God. Thanks to my Father for answering my prayers in your regard. Remember me to dear Howells and his family lovingly; that the Lord be with him and his family is my constant prayer. Remember me to all of the Saints. My wife and little Claudia are well, together with the rest of the Welsh. Remember me and my family kindly to my brothers, John and Edward, and my relatives. Oh, that they were here; I shall pray for them all to be faithful Saints, anyway. I heard that A. Evans is not coming here this year, but that he is staying in Council Bluffs. * * *

The roads here are still white from the wagonfuls of immigrants. They are like doves coming to their windows from the four corners of the world. The sickness which gathered on my lungs through hard work there, has not gotten much better yet. Dear Saints, remember your humble servant and pray for him, he who served you almost to the death; and for him be faithful

and diligent in the work of God. We had an excellent conference here last week, and everything here is successful and wonderfully organized, for there is an able leader at the helm and an abundance of assistants. I cannot get a chance now to write an account of my journey to the south last winter; you shall have that as soon as I can write it. You shall have an account of the Council Bluffs Welsh from Brother W. Morgans. They are welcome to dwell on the land I bought for them. At last, I must close. Brethren, here are for you your triads of my love and my heart forever and ever. Amen.

D. JONES.

STATISTICAL REPORT FOR THE CONFERENCES IN THE BRITISH ISLES,
FOR THE HALF YEAR ENDING DECEMBER 1850.

<i>Conferences</i>	<i>Br.</i>	<i>A</i>	<i>Sev.</i>	<i>Eld.</i>	<i>Pr.</i>	<i>Tea.</i>	<i>Dea.</i>	<i>Cut.</i>	<i>Died.</i>	<i>Emi.</i>	<i>Bap.</i>	<i>Tot.</i>
London.....	52	0	0	123	142	96	64	108	5	10	753	2990
Manchester.....	20	0	2	96	162	86	35	106	16	36	248	2875
Birmingham.....	18	2	0	90	96	70	36	61	11	13	360	2213
Sheffield.....	34	2	0	69	111	71	41	97	9	33	382	2162
South Conference...	25	0	0	35	90	44	36	48	5	5	257	1135
Herefordshire.....	27	1	0	79	65	52	22	19	2	23	123	1010
Liverpool.....	8	0	0	44	57	23	20	32	10	27	203	946
Bedfordshire.....	26	2	0	45	59	27	24	27	7	65	128	908
Warwickshire.....	22	3	0	57	53	41	21	25	2	19	140	879
Cheltenham.....	21	1	0	49	37	33	18	31	4	14	104	820
Bradford.....	19	0	0	47	67	34	15	19	7	9	87	800
Norwich.....	15	0	0	41	50	28	15	29	2	0	94	624
Staffordshire.....	14	0	2	48	47	26	15	44	2	4	54	587
Newcastle-on-Tyne	13	0	1	45	34	15	13	12	2	8	37	463
Lincolnshire.....	13	1	0	20	32	26	7	17	1	55	122	457
Derbyshire.....	13	1	0	36	24	22	16	23	0	0	56	452
Preston.....	6	1	1	37	28	17	1	2	3	0	12	450
Southampton.....	10	0	0	15	18	11	5	15	0	1	114	444
Worcestershire.....	11	0	0	25	24	9	9	5	3	3	25	343
Clitheroe.....	10	0	1	23	29	18	12	21	3	0	15	348
Hull.....	6	0	0	18	17	9	7	17	2	13	53	321
Dorsetshire.....	5	0	1	7	10	11	9	12	5	19	23	283
Leicestershire.....	5	2	0	11	18	7	5	21	3	0	16	276
Shropshire.....	10	1	0	10	13	5	8					182
Carlisle.....	5	1	0	20	8	8	6	1	3	1	5	152
East Glamorgan....	24	0	3	170	92	123	63	64	10	24	222	2285
Monmouthshire.....	14	0	0	77	30	41	28	34	7	15	210	667
Carmarthenshire....	16	0	0	72	28	26	17	18	2	27	34	609
West Glamorgan....	17	0	1	67	37	30	21	29			77	541
Pembrokeshire.....	11	0	0	20	7	10	6	10	0	4	41	197
Denbighshire.....	6	0	0	11	17	8	5	4	1	0	29	154
Flintshire.....	8	0	0	16	14	5	0	3	0	0	26	121
Cardiganshire.....	6	0	0	12	8	2	0	2	1	10	20	114
Anglesey.....	6	0	0	14	9	6	2	2	0	8	49	109
Merionethshire.....	6	0	0	18	2	1	2	6	0	2	10	71
Breconshire.....	7	0	0	12	6	3	5	0	0	0	7	69
Glasgow.....	29	2	0	110	79	101	41	116	7	47	325	2063
Edinburgh.....	15	1	1	34	35	46	16	102	4	22	65	818
Dundee.....	5	1	0	8	10	17	6	38	2	7	59	376
Channel Islands.....	5	0	0	6	9	11	5	12	2	0	27	255
Isle of Man.....	2	0	0	10	8	4	3	5	1	0	16	106
Ireland.....	8	0	0	15	8	3	2	3	0	0	25	90
Total.....	602	22	12	1761	1590	1226	682	1240	144	524	4653	30747

NAMES OF THE PRESIDENTS.—Thomas Margetts, London; William Gibson, Manchester; James H. Flanigan, Birmingham; J. W. Cummings, Sheffield; George Halliday, South Conference; C. H. Wheelock, Herefordshire; Glaud Rodger, Liverpool; John Spiers, Bedfordshire; Eli B. Kelsey, Warwickshire; William Booth, Cheltenham; James Marsden, Bradford; Thomas Smith, Norwich; J. D. Ross, Staffordshire; J. S. Higbee, Newcastle-on-Tyne; Lorin Babbitt, Lincolnshire; Lewis Robbins, Derbyshire; George D. Watt, Preston; W. C. Dunbar, Southampton; John Lyon, Worcestershire; William Moss, Clithero; Hugh Findlay, Hull; George Kendall, Dorsetshire; Lewis Robbins, Leicestershire; Joseph W. Young, Shropshire; A. M. Harmon, Carlisle; Williams Phillips, East Glamorgan; Thomas Giles, Monmouthshire; David John, Carmarthenshire; Evan Williams, West Glamorgan; John Price, Pembrokeshire; John Parry, Denbighshire; William Parry, Flintshire; John Evans, Cardiganshire; Thomas Morgan, Anglesey; William Evans, Merionethshire; John Jones, Breconshire; J. Clements, Glasgow; C. Dunn, Edinburgh; William Burton, Dundee; James M'Naughtan, Channel Islands; John Kelly, Isle of Man.

 For an explanation about the new Districts, and changes in Branches, see Account of the General Conference, in Trumpet, November and December, 1850.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

MARRIED,—On the 30th of December, 1850, in the parish church, Merthyr Tydfil, by the Rev. James C. Campbell, John Davis, printer, Georgetown, and Elizabeth Phillips, from Cwmbach.

DOC. AND THE COV.—We are glad that more subscribers have been obtained, and that it is likely to come out for a penny and a half per segment. Strive yet a little more.

VERSE.

To Zion, lovely land, our Father, O take
Us, thy fortunate saints, from the land of the scowl;
That we there may have, over a thousand years of splendor,
Reigning with the Lamb, without pain or grief. I. R.

PAYMENTS FROM DECEMBER 22 TO JAN. 9.—Denbighshire, £2 10s; Pontytypidd, £3 2s 6c; Llanfabon, £1 8s 11½c; Cwmbach, £1 9s 0½s; Pendeulwyn, 6s 1½c; Twynyrodyn, 11s 4½c; Gog, 8s 0½c; Cardiff, £1; Aberdare, £2 2s 6c; Dowlais, £2 12s; Hirwaun, £1 13s; Rhymney, £1 18s 9c; Cwmnedd, 10s; Georgetown, £1; Merthyr, £2 16s 8c; Pendaren, 10s; Cefn, £1 5s 6½c.

 We see no need for publishing the conference minutes from now on, unless something unusual happens in them; but we request the accounts from everywhere as usual.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil*; but nothing is to be sent about anything else.

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 2.]

JANUARY 25, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

MINUTES OF THE GENERAL CONFERENCE OF THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-DAY SAINTS, HELD AT GREAT SALT LAKE CITY, STATE OF DESERET.

President BRIGHAM YOUNG, Presiding.

Friday, September 6, 1850.—Present, the First Presidency, Brigham Young, Heber C. Kimball, Willard Richards.

Patriarchs—John Smith, Isaac Morley.

Of the Twelve Apostles—Orson Hyde, P. P. Pratt, G. A. Smith, E. T. Benson.

Presidency of the Seventies—Levi W. Hancock, Zera Pulsipher, Henry Herriman, A. P. Rockwood.

Presidency of the *Stake*—Dan. Spencer, W. Snow.

High Priests' Quorum—John Young, R. Cahoon.

Presiding Bishop—Newel K. Whitney.

The High Council of the *Stake*.

Thos. Bullock—Clerk of the Conference.

The Conference was called to order by Elder G. A. Smith. The choir sang a hymn. Prayer by P. P. Pratt. Singing.

President Young then stated to the congregation that the morning would be occupied by exhortation and teaching, and preaching and instructions after that. The business before the conference will be concerning the different quorums and

authorities of the church—the propriety of strengthening the San Pete settlement, and a call for volunteers to return with Father Morley—a delegation of elders to Germany, and the various states in that country; that he purposed once more to lay the law of tithing before the people; praying that he might have the spirit to communicate, that the people might understand; and that on Saturday afternoon, Elder Hyde would deliver a lecture on education, to the Chancellor and Regents of the University.

Isaac Morley then expressed his thankfulness for this opportunity to meet the Saints; my heart is full of blessings for the people. I want a good company of good men and women to go to San Pete, and I do say, that no man shall dwell in that valley, who is in the habit of taking the name of God in vain.

President Young said—I have it in my heart to ask the congregation, if Father Morley shall have the right and privilege to select such men as he wishes to go there?

Moved that he have the privilege; carried.

Moved that he select one hundred men, with or without families; carried.

President Young said—It is as good a valley as you ever saw: the goodness of the soil cannot be beat; there is only one practicable road into it, and that is up Salt Creek; the inhabitants there are “No. 1;” and when I was in that valley I prayed to God that he never would suffer an unrighteous man to live there. I am going to bring before the people the necessity of keeping up the fund for the emigration of the poor. I declare openly and boldly, there is no necessity for any man of this community to go to the gold mines, to replenish the fund; we have more property and wealth than we are capable of taking care of. If a man is not capable of improving one talent, what is the use of his getting more? He is like the foolish child, that could hold but one apple in both his hands, and in reaching for more, he lost what he had. If men only knew how to control what they have, and were satisfied, they would do much better.

I will commence at the north and go to the south settlements, and pick out 25 of our inhabitants as they average; and another man may take 50 of the gold diggers, and they cannot buy out the

25 who have tarried at home. Before I had been one year in this place, the wealthiest man who came from the mines, Father Rhodes, with 17,000 dollars, could not buy the possessions I had made in one year! It will not begin to do it; and I will take 25 men in the United States, who have stayed at home and paid attention to their own business, and they will weigh down fifty others from the same place, who went to the gold regions; and again, look at the widows that have been made, and see the bones that lie bleaching and scattered over the *prairies*.

Brother Joseph suffered himself to be dragged about the country by a mob, and was dragged into something like forty-six or forty-eight law suits, yet he triumphed over all of them, and then they murdered him in cold blood, in Carthage jail, without any shadow of crime attached to him. I then swore that I would never see a lawyer again; and we don't owe one dime, but that we are able to pay at any moment. If I can keep my credit good with the Almighty, I care not whether men speak evil of me or not.

Singing by the choir, and benediction by G. A. Smith.

Friday, two in the afternoon.—Conference called to order by Daniel Spencer; singing by G. A. Smith, and singing.

P. P. Pratt made some remarks on the mountains and valleys south of the Utah. If we carry out the instructions that we continually receive, we shall be the happiest people on the earth; whoever is governed by the kingdom of God, is a happy man; but who realizes it? It always was the man that was *ready*, that the Lord would work by; the only thing that should concern us, is, have we the principles of the kingdom of God in our hearts, and is it our desire to fulfill them?

Orson Hyde then pleaded in behalf of the Perpetual Emigrating Poor Fund, and those who remain in Pottawatomie county. "I am glad that ways and means have been devised to deposit horses, oxen, wheat, &c., and give checks on the States, where the money can be appropriated to bring on the poor to this place. The operation is a good one, and it will operate not only in the United States, but in England, and other countries also. I feel when I get back to Iowa, that I can relieve the Saints, as I have both seen and tasted of the fruits of the Valley.

President Young said—I am much gratified to see the warmth of feeling for the poor by Elder Hyde, and I think the best way to relieve ourselves of all our spare horses and cattle is, to put them into the Poor Fund. We shall not cease our exertions until Zion is redeemed, and all Israel is gathered. From the days of Joseph to the present moment, the prophecies were never fulfilled faster, and that too upon natural principles. They are miracles and remarkable phenomena to us so long as we do not understand them.

H. C. Kimball moved that there be a committee of three appointed, to take care of and transact the business of the Poor Fund; carried. And, on motion, Willard Snow, Edward Hunter, and Daniel Spencer, were voted said committee.

President Young said—There is one question I wish to ask, it is this: will this people back that committee up to the last farthing? If they will, in the end, great joy will be yours; if you will covenant to do it, please signify it by raising the right hand. (All hands up.) Gentlemen, that's the "*terror among the nations!*" you *cannot* get a contrary vote! *that's the terror*—THE UNION OF THIS PEOPLE.

I think our next move will be to have this committee organized into a company, and chartered by the State, to sue and be sued, collect and be collected, and dispose of, and do all business as a company, and then will be the budding and blossoming of one of the greatest operations in all the world.

We do not want to detain this meeting any longer; but at intermission, come forward and enter your names, and what amount you put in, Brother Bullock will enter to your names.

Singing by the choir, and benediction by Ezra T. Benson.

Saturday, September 7, ten in the morning.—Elder G. A. Smith rose to speak on the first principles of the gospel of Jesus Christ. He said, to preach the word of life to man is a very high and holy calling, and an important trust committed to any people; and chose for his text 1 Thes. i, 5; and divided his text into, firstly, the word of the gospel; secondly, the power of the gospel; thirdly, the power of the Holy Ghost; and fourthly, its assurance. As the gospel is the power of God unto every soul that believes, he reviewed the birth, crucifixion, death and resurrection of Jesus Christ, and then the commission he gave to

his disciples, and his instructions to them, as his witnesses, to testify to the truth, and teach all the things whatsoever he commanded them, and their commencing to preach on the day of Pentecost, in fulfillment of their commission; calling on the people to repent and be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ, with the promise of the Holy Ghost, that was to follow, through the ordinance of the laying on of hands.

Men must obey the ordinances of the first principles, or their superstructure is in vain; it is recorded, all power in heaven and on earth is given unto Jesus Christ; therefore he ordered them to go and baptize the people in the name of the Father, Son, and the Holy Ghost; and they went in the name of Jesus Christ and did act, and the Comforter proceeded from the Father, and did bring all things to their remembrance, and did teach them things to come, and when the people had obeyed, the Holy Ghost fell upon them, the promises were fulfilled, and then the people rose up and declared they knew the thing was true.

The sects of the day argue that these gifts and blessings were withdrawn from the earth, and they dared not even attend to baptism, or the laying on of hands, although the Savior positively tells us we must obey.

Did God intend that this gospel should be applicable to us in all its power and glory, gifts and blessings? Yes: they are promised even unto the end of the world; and just as long as there was a being on the earth; and Christ himself gave some apostles, some prophets, teachers, &c., for the work of the ministry, and the edification of the church.

The whole Christian world have rejected the law, lost its light, have not the power and authority and blessings; and for the want of these things, they are tossed about on every wind of doctrine, and the cunning craftiness of men.

God, in these last days, in his infinite mercy, sent Joseph Smith with the gospel, and the assurance *did follow those* that entered in by the *door*, following the Shepherd of the sheep. The world united against him, and forty times he was brought before the rulers, when no fault could be found against him; and then he was by wicked

priests and crafty men, murdered in cold blood; and his blood was shed upon the ground like water. He bore his testimony to the truth, and sealed it with his blood; and the authority is here to administer the ordinances to you and your children, and as many as the Lord our God shall call; its principles are now preached, and we invite you to come forth and receive its blessings, in all its fullness; and may God our Eternal Father bless you all, in the name of Jesus Christ. Amen.

Willard Snow presented, a subscription book as follows:—"We, the undersigned, agree to pay the committee of the Perpetual Fund for the Emigrating Poor, the amount set opposite to our names," &c., and then strongly advocated the cause of the Poor Fund, but wanted all to pay as they go.

George A. Smith—There is an item of business to present to this Conference in relation to Father Cutler. After the Presidency left Pottawatomie, there was a report that Father Cutler went to Jackson County to lay the foundation for another temple. There is an influence existing there, to draw away from the Valley, and a great mystery hangs over their doings. The Conference in Pottawatomie County withdrew fellowship from Cutler, Calkins, and others. Calkins said there was no power there to try him, as he was a bishop.

We have had a notion of asking the good people living now in Jackson County, Mo., to petition us to go back again and build a temple there, if the legislature of Missouri will pass resolutions to protect us in our rights. (Laughter.)

President Young said—There is no trial before the Church concerning the Silver Creek branch, where Father Cutler resides. During the late war he was acquainted with many Indians in New York State, who went to Green Bay, they saw him again at Winter Quarters, when they urged him to go down and build mills, and establish a school among them, as they had the privilege from government to select their own mechanics and teachers. I told him to go down, work, and get his outfit. This has been turned into an under current of lies, and has destroyed his influence.

The conference there has all the authority to act with members in that conference, and I sanction their proceedings; all is perfectly

lawful, as far as I have heard.

I wish it distinctly understood, that there is not an apostle of Jesus Christ who now lives, or ever did live, or ever will live, but that man's word is law and gospel to the people if he magnifies his calling. The apostles did right in this case; and I say the acts of the conference in Pottawatamie, Elders Hyde, G. A. Smith, and E. T. Benson are just; and if this conference think the same, signify it by the uplifted hand. (All hands up.) And further, if the conference in Pottawatamie County have cut them off, they are as much cut off as they ever can be.

When we have an apostle abroad, who has not the power to deal with a conference, we will call that man home, or send him to Texas, to join Lyman Wight, and then we will put another man in his place.

Choir sang a hymn. Benediction by Aaron Johnson.

(To be continued.)

“GIFT OF THE HOLY GHOST.”

THE Holy Ghost, is like some big, general sun, “enlightening every man who comes into the world.” This is the true light, which all receive, to some extent or another, from its rays. It is he who has been illuminating in the generations that have gone by, in every corner of the earth, and it is he who enlightens the present generation of the human race. But even though he is the true light, and illuminates every man who comes to earth; yet, he did not enlighten everyone about every truth, for the only way of life was hidden from the majority of the earth. Many truths were found, in every age and country, through this general light, which guides everyone. Men of every kindred and tongue have received benefit from it, but no one more than the famous reformers who shone brightly through past centuries. But even though every man is enlightened by the Spirit of God, not every man *receives* his Spirit; for the scriptures say, that the world cannot receive it. Every man who comes into the world is enlightened, but only those who do the will of God receive it as

a “*gift*” for themselves. The gift or the endowment of the Spirit of God is something that the world cannot receive; but as for the light, it guides everyone, although not everyone can walk unerringly in its light. Two completely separate things are to receive a portion of the Spirit, such as a gift, and to be enlightened by it. The first illuminates within us, while the other consists of rays from the light. The denominations of our country can quite easily receive the light of the Spirit of God, but doing the will of God is required to receive the “gift of the Holy Ghost,” namely the other Comforter, he who brings to remembrance that which has gone past, and expresses things yet to come, and also which guides to all truth. Not every man who comes to the world receives revelations about that which was and will be, nor is guided to all truth; but the disciples of Christ only can receive that. That is the reason that Paul, after hearing that those twelve in Ephesus were disciples, asked, Have ye received the Holy Ghost since ye believed? After finding the way to obtain it, they received it and had revelations through it. Well, everyone sees now, then, the difference between receiving the gift of the Holy Ghost, and receiving enlightenment from the Spirit of God. And if anyone wishes to receive the gift of the Holy Ghost, let him believe the words of Peter on the day of Pentecost, namely “Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ, for the remission of sins,” and it can be said to him, “And ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost; for the promise is unto you, and to your children, and to all that are afar off, even as many as the Lord our God shall call.” If there are some truths in the possession of other men, we do not want to take them from them; for imparting more to everyone is our task. When others have some truth to give to us, we will be ready to accept it, for our creed is to believe all truth. The meaning of Mormonism is, more good, and not more deceit as others assert. Our religion embraces all truth, wherever it may come from, and it exhorts all to receive the “gift of the Holy Ghost.”

May that lovely time dawn in which the Lord pours out his Spirit on every flesh, so that every man who comes to the world, will not only be enlightened, but will be warmed also.

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMELY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[Continued from page 14.]

TESTAMENT OF JACOB.

Which he made at his death to the twelve sons of the Patriarch, with respect to that which happened in his final days; which was gathered from Genesis xlviii, and added to this Book.

JACOB the son Isaac, born of Rebekah, in the year of the world 2108, his father being threescore years of age, was a perfect man and righteous, dwelling in tents. Jacob was not given to the pleasures of hunting, as his elder brother, elder by nature, not by grace, for the elder shall serve the younger, saith the Lord; why? not for that Jacob had so deserved, but God had so appointed; wherefore when he thus by the determinate will of God, and heavenly disposition, which ordereth all things whatsoever, had got his brother's birthright, and his father's blessing; his parents' considering that the slippery days of carnal copulation did approach, and warily fearing his brother Esau, for that he conceived murder in his heart, and instituted a birthday for his devilish purpose, sent him from Beersheba to Mesopotamia to Laban his mother's brother, there honestly to take a wife, and quietly to live, for matrimony without consent of parents, and due consideration of either party contracted, as it breedeth their disquietness, so it provoketh God's displeasure; Jacob therefore after long travel, having gone to Laban, and serving him fourteen years in labor and pain, albeit he was the child of promise, the blessed of the Lord, born of a free woman, and that which is more, his uncle's bone and flesh, and lord of Canaan; not arguing with himself as the worldly children of this earth, saying, Shall I which am a free and wealthy man's son be made a servant in my uncle's house, being sent to marry and not to serve? Laban gave to him his two daughters as wives for his good service, by which God blessed that little that Laban had before, he gave him his two daughters, Leah first, then Rachel, with their two handmaids, Bilhah and Zilpah, of whom, according to the promise made to him in Rabel, that his seed should be multiplied; he begat twelve sons, twelve godly fathers of the earth: Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Dan, Naphtali, Gad, Asher, Issachar, Zebulon, Joseph, Benjamin.

Thus he being blessed of the Lord, as well in children as in substance, returned again to his native country, he and his children there to live and there to die; but behold the divine providence of God; after three and thirty years expired, he was removed from

Canaan to Goshen in Egypt, by means of his son Joseph, chief steward of the land of Egypt, whom his brethren had sold; where when he had lived seventeen years, and seen his family increased, to his great joy and comfort no doubt; especially all the other countries about being plagued with a great famine, and he by God's mercy not greatly feeling the same; perceiving also his troublesome pilgrimage drawing to an end, called his son Joseph unto him and said, If I have found grace in thy sight, oh put thy hand under my thigh, (for in this order they took an oath in Jacob's time) deal mercifully with me and truly, bury me not in Egypt, but let me sleep with my fathers; where his sure faith in the promise of God made to his fathers, willed him to look for Canaan his hoped inheritance and not to trust in Pharaoh's land; to which request when Joseph his loving son obediently did condescend, Jacob taking a little more strength unto him, and sitting up, desirous also to show forth the great goodness of the Lord in preserving him and his, said, God Almighty appeared unto me at Luz, in the land of Canaan, and blessed me saying, Behold I will make thee fruitful, and cause thee to multiply, and will make a great number of people of thee, and will give this land unto thy seed for an everlasting possession. Thy sons, Manasseh and Ephraim, I take as mine own, their own brethren shall be called after their name. As I came from Mesopotamia, Rachel died in the land of Canaan, and was buried by the way to Ephrata, the same is Bethlehem.

Then Jacob, albeit somewhat dim for age, beholding Joseph's two sons, answered, They are my sons which God hath given me. O bring them to me, saith Jacob, and let me bless them; I had not thought to have seen thy face, Joseph; yet lo God hath showed me thy seed.

God in whose sight my fathers Abraham and Isaac did walk, God which hath fed me all my life long unto this day, and the angel which hath delivered me from all evil bless these lads, and let my name be named on them, and the name of my fathers, Abraham and Isaac, and that they may grow into a multitude in the midst of the earth.

Then as Joseph lifted his father's hand from Ephraim to Manasseh the elder, Jacob said, Let it be, I know well my son, he shall also be a great people; but his younger brother shall be greater: In thee let Israel bless and say, God make thee as Ephraim and Manasseh. After this he fainting said, Behold, Joseph, I die: God shall be with you, and bring you again to the land of your fathers; moreover, I give unto thee a portion of land above thy brethren, which I conquered by sword and bow, of the Amorites. And come you hither also, O my children; that I may tell you what shall come on you in the last days; gather ye together and hear ye sons of Jacob, hearken to Israel your father.

REUBEN, My firstborn, my might, my strength, excellent in

dignity and power, unstable as water, thou shalt not excel, because thou didst defile my couch.

SIMEON AND LEVI, Brethren in evil, who in your wrath slew a man, and in your self-will digged down a wall. Cursed be your wrath, for it was shameless, and your fierceness was cruel; I will divide you in Jacob, and scatter you in Israel.

JUDAH, Thy hand shall be on the neck of thine enemies, thy brethren shall stoop unto thee, as a lion's whelp shalt thou come up from the spoil, thou shalt couch as a lion, and as a lioness, who shall stir thee up? Second, the scepter shall not depart from thee, nor a lawgiver from between thy feet, until SHILO come, and all nations shall seek after him. Third, Thou shalt bind thy foal to the vine, and the ass's colt to the best vine: thou shalt wash thy garment in wine, and thy cloak in the blood of grapes; thy eyes shall be red with wine, and thy teeth white with milk.

ZEBULON, Thou shalt dwell by the seaside, and thou shalt be an haven for ships; thy border shall be unto Zidon.

ISSACHAR, Thou shalt be a strong ass, couching down between two burdens; and thou shalt see that rest is good, and that the land is pleasant, and shalt bow thy shoulder to bear, and shalt be subject unto tribute.

DAN, Thou shalt judge the people as one of the tribes of Israel: Thou shalt be a serpent by the way, an adder by the path biting the horse heels, so that his rider shall fall backward.

Then, Jacob foreseeing in his mind the great calamity that should betide his posterity, comforting himself, and resting in God's promise, cried out with heart and mind, *O Lord, I have waited for thy salvation.*

GAD, An host of men shall overcome thee, but thou shalt overcome at the last.

And what shall I say to ASHER? His bread shall be fat, and he shall have pleasures for a king.

NAPHTALI is a hind let loose, and sent for a present, giving goodly words.

JOSEPH is a flourishing bough by a wellside, and the small boughs shall run upon the wall; the archers shot against him and, and hated him, but his bow was made strong, and his arms strengthened by the hands of the mighty God of Jacob. Out of him shall come an herdman, a stone in Israel. All these things shall come from my father's God, which hath helped thee, and blessed thee with blessings of the heaven, with blessings of the breast and womb. The blessings of thy father are stronger than all the blessings I had of mine Elders, until the end of the everlasting hills they shall be on the head of Joseph, and on the crown of the head of him that was separate from his brethren.

BENJAMIN shall ravin as a wolf, in the morning he shall devour the prey, and at night he shall divide the spoil.

And when he had made an end of blessing them, then he charged them, saying, Now when I shall be gathered to my people, bury me with my fathers, in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Hittite, in the cave that is in the field of Machpelah, which is before Mamre, in the land of Canaan, which Abraham bought with the field of Ephron the Hittite, for a possession to bury in, where were buried Abraham and Sarah his wife, and Isaac and Rebeckah; and there I buried Leah. The field, and the cave that is therein, was bought of the children of Heth.

When Jacob had made an end of commanding all that he would unto his sons, having lived one hundred forty and seven years, he plucked up his feet into the bed, and quickly died. Then Joseph falling upon his father's face, and kissing him with tears, caused him to be embalmed by physicians to the space of forty days; and mourned for him threescore and ten days, who departing from Egypt into Canaan, with noble men of the land in chariots, and horsemen, buried him in the place which Jacob had appointed.

(To be continued.)

“NATURE OF MIRACLES.”

(CONTINUED FROM PAGE 17.)

NEXT, we have our correspondent, after giving thanks for common sense, and a Bible, to prove that the spirits (namely the three unclean spirits John saw coming out of the mouth of a dragon, the beast, and the false prophet, which are the principles of Paganism, Papism, Mohammedism, says he), go to show what is the nature of miracles. He deals with this very clearly, and I see no way to oppose it.

After explaining the nature of miracles, he says that no one but God can perform them, and that he did not perform them except under very special circumstances. He says also that his purpose in performing miracles through men, “was always, either for the purpose of the unity of the doctrine they preached, or the message they had in mind.” Now, we shall show to our correspondent that it was not for either of the above purposes that God performed miracles. The passing of Israel through the Red Sea proves that it was to deliver them from the hand of the Egyptians, that he did that. So it was with the three young men in the fiery furnace, and Daniel in the lions’

den, and scores of other examples that could be named, which show clearly that it was merciful purposes, but not any of the things that Dewi notes, that God had in mind in all the miracles he performed. "Now," says he again, "if the Latter-day Saints can perform miracles, let them raise a few from the dead—let them give eyes to some blind men—ears to some deaf—speech to some mutes—and hold back the *Atlantic Ocean*, so that they could go through on dry ground to their new Jerusalem; or let them cause the sun to stand at its zenith," &c. He is here again very anxious to have a sign; and a huge sign is one he would like to have, but entirely pointless, namely to hold back the Atlantic Ocean, and walk on dry ground to America. It would be much wiser than that to take some ships to go across; for it would be very tiresome to walk such a long way.

Our correspondent next proves that it is not possible for angels to perform miracles, without the authority from God. This is what the Latter-day Saints believe also. But no one can determine whether or not they have authority; if they do, they can act only in obedience to God.

With regard to the power of evil angels to perform miracles, there are examples in the scriptures in which they perform great things. Satan, having had Job in his hand, was able to do great works. But it is obvious that he does not always receive permission, or else what would become of us? He is ready, and able, to harm everyone, if he gets his wish. He was ready to sift Simon "like wheat;" but Christ prayed that his faith would not fail him. Satan can appear as an "angel of light." If the leader is able to do things like this, it is logical that all his host, to a greater or lesser degree, are also able to do so.

That wicked men are deprived of the power to perform miracles, is a topic that is of no consequence at present for us to know; but it can be noted that they cannot do anything through God, except that which they can do through evil spirits. It is obvious that the man who was possessed with a legion of devils was able to perform through them things out of the ordinary, and no one could bind him even with chains and fetters, for he would break them in pieces (Mark v). Mention is made in the scriptures also of a damsel possessed with a spirit, who was able to practice witchcraft; for when the unclean

spirit was rebuked, her power ceased (Acts xvi, 16—19). John in Rev. xiii, 13, saw a beast doing “great wonders, so that he maketh fire come down from heaven on the earth in the sight of men.”

Mr. G. ab Dewi, toward the end of his article, laments that men give heed to “seducing spirits,” such as Joseph Smith and Mohammed, and to “doctrines of devils;” which things, says he, Paul, in 1 Tim. iv, 1, completely rejects. But, if our correspondent reads the two following verses, he will learn that those who “give heed to seducing spirits, and to doctrines of devils,” were also “forbidding to marry, and commanding to abstain from meats.” Everyone knows that the Latter-day Saints do not forbid to marry, nor do they command to abstain from meats; and, consequently, it is clear that it is not they whom Paul was describing.

The last thing we note in his article is the observations at the end. “The Saints say,” says he, “that they can cast out devils: if they could do this (which they *certainly* cannot), the world would not be benefited, since then they would be *free*; therefore, they could go to others.” It is obvious from the account of the legion, when they ask Christ, “Art thou come hither to torment us before the *time*,” together with other places, that the devils are not to be bound now, but only to be cast out; and it is not likely that they will be bound before their leader is bound, namely at the beginning of the thousand years. Christ permitted the legion to enter into the swine; and in no other place is there mention made of him or of his disciples, when they rebuked them, that they were bound. The verses in Math. xii, 43—45, show the freedom that an unclean spirit has after being cast out of a man. He is described as “*walking* through dry places.” Dewi says the Saints should catch them and show them; but Christ only gave a commandment for them to be cast out, and there is no account in the scriptures that they are visible either. If our correspondent could have, as he mentions, such an opportunity as to see a bound spirit in the hands of the Saints, and could ask in the words of Isaiah, “How art thou fallen from heaven?” the spirit could answer him in words just as scriptural, namely, when I fought against Michael and his angels (see Rev. xii, 7—9). In his last sentence Dewi says that the people are asking for signs; they can know that a devil once asked the same thing to Christ, and that the

Saints want to have them through the "foolishness of preaching."

Yours, sir, humbly,

Glan Teifi.

I. M.

[Since only a few of the Saints have seen the foregoing article of ours in the *Star of Gomer*, we thought that its publication in the *Trumpet* would be useful.—ED.]

GREAT GOD OF THE SECTARIANS.

The Sectarians' God up in the third heaven,
And here on the earth, fills every spot and place;
He fills hell below, and the sun and the moon on high,
And does so every second, though 'tis a great surprise to me!

There is no picture or image that can be made to this being,
He has no head nor eyes, nor hand, nor leg, nor foot;
He is a God of no substance, and Father of the substances of the world,
Author and Keeper of all the great *chaos*!

He is bigger in size than the earth, and all the great seas,
Sun, moon, stars, and the planets, were they all put together;
Neither has he boundaries—his center is in the heavens,
And his center is here also—a very strange being is he!

Good and bad are indifferent, making tremendous nonsense,
And worlds without number, all in his huge belly!
A variety of elements, and a myriad of beings without number,
Dwelling in their emptiness, which is a great surprise to me!!

Where does God dwell? Oh, in the third heaven,
We are there also, if we are in his belly;
If so it is to believe, hideous foolishness for a people,
To say that the family of death goes to him.

If the worlds are in him, we are there in them,
And thus in him as well, and what more do we need?
'Tis foolishness to talk of heavens, on high far away,
Or any blessed places,—there is no need for anything better.

Everyone is in God already, according to their creed,
'Tis great foolishness to preach of Christ and his fatal wound;
Despite this we need preachers, paying them a big wage,
And we need to bow our heads, and kneel down to them.

And also they pray, each one beneath his burden,
"Oh, Lord God of hosts, reveal thy arm;"
"And come here thyself to fully bless us;"
"We are poor, thou hast plenty."

'Tis foolishness to say "*reveal*" that which has never existed,
 And invite an object to them that *more than fills the house*;
 And who can be *poor*, and *dwell in him*
 When he is *all wealthy*, and in the third heaven!

Oh, Lord God of hosts, everyone, white and black,
 Will soon come to recognize thee by way of the blessed atonement;
 Lest in the end they suffer his terrible wrath,
 When the day comes to judge and prove us each one.

Craig ddu.

JOHN RICHARDS.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

"LET'S you and I write a book," said some young student to the old Dr. Parr. "All right," replied the doctor; "put in everything that I know, and everything that you do not know, and we will have a large book."

Since no one took any notice of Diogenes while he lectured about virtue, he began to sing, and a great crowd gathered around him to listen;—"O God," said he, "so many respect foolishness before wisdom."

THE FIRST of all virtues is innocence, the next modesty. If we exile modesty from the world, it will take with it half the virtues that are in it.

THE EASIEST way to become rich, is to restrict our wishes, and not to enlarge our possessions.

PAYMENTS FROM JAN. 9 TO JAN. 23.—Monmouthshire £6 9s 9c; Carmarthenshire, £9; Tongwyrdilas, £2; Dowlais, 7s 9½c ; Georgetown, £1; Merthyr, 17s; Pendaren, 9s 6c.

 The more often we receive payments the better, and the more those who are weak pay the better. We fear that the behavior of some will push them from the church: some are nearly ripe for that already.

VISIT OF J. TAYLOR.—We are sorry that we did not have space to give an account of the visit of Apostle Taylor to us in Merthyr, and to the Saints in the Tredegar District. We received valuable teaching from him in the two places, and his presence will be long remembered.

"J. M."—Send to the county distributor, and not here.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil*; and do not send anything else.

JOHN DAVIS, PRINTER, MERTHYR TYDFIL.

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 3.]

FEBRUARY 8, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

MINUTES OF THE GENERAL CONFERENCE OF THE
CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-DAY
SAINTS, HELD AT GREAT SALT LAKE CITY,
STATE OF DESERET.

[CONTINUED FROM PAGE 27.]

Saturday, two in the afternoon.—Conference called to order by W. Snow; singing, prayer by W. Snow, and then singing again.

Elder O. Hyde delivered a lecture to the Honorable Chancellor and Board of Regents of the University of the State of Deseret, in presence of the conference, on education.

Education is not confined to letters only, but to the excluding of all darkness, and when a man has ascended to the summit, he can then bask in the light, having nothing to obscure his vision. Every person is under a responsibility to impart the intelligence that he enjoys, unto others. The child that is born into this world, is like a blank sheet of paper, susceptible to any impression, and we have cause to be thankful for the place of our birth; that it has been in a country where intelligence has burst from the heavens through the administration of an angel.

Great honor has been conferred on parents to mould and fashion that mind, which is put into the tabernacle by the Almighty himself, that it may be qualified to fill the station it is destined to fill. Here is the honor of rearing up children to the glory of our

Father in heaven, and we have an opportunity of rearing them, to offer them to our Father and our God, from whom we received these pledges.

Man originates ideas by external circumstances, and there must be some vehicle to convey his ideas to others, or they are comparatively useless. How pleasing it is when a man gets hold of a brilliant idea, to be able to convey it to others. We can conceive ideas as splendid as the heavens, as brilliant as the orbs that roll above us; but when we want to convey our ideas, our language is imperfect. There was a time when God talked with Father Adam in the garden of Eden, in a language as perfect and pure as the water that flows in rills around. Afterwards, God confounded the language all over the world. Yet an imperfect language is better than none at all. If you could bring all the best authors now living, together, they will express their ideas in different words, and they will all admit, that our language is imperfect, yet we have to use that which we have, in order to accomplish the object which is before us, and fulfill the obligations we are under, one to the other, by using the instruments already in our midst.

A certain portion of your property ought to be devoted to the education of your children, in order to qualify them to be good representatives. Let them be full of light and intelligence and then they are able to give an answer to anything. The schoolmaster occupies an exalted sphere in the field of labor. My feelings are, endow your teachers with a liberal compensation, and then they will spare no pains to educate your children. If you sustain the teachers, they will bless you in return; and that people that pays the schoolmaster well, is destined to prosper; and may you increase in knowledge until ignorance is burned up in celestial fire; may God grant it. Amen.

President Young said, we have been highly entertained by Elder Hyde; he has dealt out the food I like. I feel it my duty to speak in behalf of the Perpetual Emigrating fund for the poor. Last year we did wonders—we accomplished a good thing in raising over 5,000 dollars, which was sent back to the States for the poor. Benediction

by Elder P. P. Pratt.

Sunday, September 8, ten o'clock.—The conference was called to order by President Young, stating it was the duty of the bishops and their counselors to attend to their respective wards, and the officers of State and County to keep perfect order round the building.

The choir sang the “Prodigal Son.” Prayer by G. A. Smith. Singing.

Elder G. A. Smith said, the business that presents itself to this conference is the presentation of the different authorities of the church, to see if this conference sanctions them in the fellowship, and then presented Brigham Young, who, on motion, was sustained as First President of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints—also Prophet, Seer, and Revelator; and also H. C. Kimball as his first Counselor, and Willard Richards second Counselor, Historian, and General Church Recorder.

B. Young then presented Father John Smith, who on motion was sustained as Patriarch of the Church.

On motion, Orson Hyde was sustained as President, and P. P. Pratt, O. Pratt, W. Woodruff, J. Taylor, G. A. Smith, A. Lyman, E. T. Benson, C. C. Rich, L. Snow, E. Snow, and F. D. Richards, as members of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles. John Young was sustained as President of the High Priests Quorum; also R. Cahoon, and G. B. Wallace as his Counselors.

Joseph Young was sustained as senior president of the Seventies, also Levi W. Hancock, Henry Herriman, Zera Pulsipher, Albert P. Rockwood, Benjamin L. Clapp, and Jedediah M. Grant, as Presidents of all the Quorums of Seventies.

D. Spencer was sustained as President of this Stake of Zion, and David Fulmer and W. Snow his Counselors.

N. K. Whitney was sustained as the Presiding Bishop of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

H. G. Sherwood was sustained as President, and Eleazer Miller, John Kempton, Heman Hyde, Lewis Abbott, W. W. Major, Levi Jackman, Elisha H. Groves, Ira Eldridge, John Vance, Edwin D. Woolley, as members of the High Council, and John Parry was voted to be a member of the same, in place of Thomas Grover, who is

gone to the States.

John Nebeker was sustained as President of the Elders Quorum, also James H. Smith and Aaron Sceva his Counselors.

Joseph Parker was sustained as President of the Priests Quorum, also Simeon Howe and James A. Chesney his Counselors.

M'Gee Harris was sustained as President of the Teachers Quorum, also John Vance and Reuben Perkins his Counselors.

W. C. Smithson was sustained as President of the Deacons Quorum, also Gehiel M'Connell and Gilburd Summe his Counselors.

President Brigham Young then rose and called the attention of the conference to the direct principle of tithing. We have preached, and talked, and written about it a long while; I will try again to give my views on it, and the things that are, I will give you my knowledge so that you may all understand and be edified.

In the first place, we are in duty bound to pay our tithing, one tenth of all we possess; that is what is required of this people; but there are so many queries and doubts, and sentiments, as to leave the principle of tithing in the dark; yet it is simple and easy to be understood, and may be comprehended by the weakest of all Saints; yet there is a general confusion pertaining to the real debt we owe, called tithing. That debt we all acknowledge, and are willing to subscribe to it, and sign an obligation for it, and yet many do not understand that it is the tenth of all we have. It is as easy to be understood, as it is for the elders who are sent forth to preach the first principles of the gospel, that men may be saved. The time has been, when you and I did not understand those easy simple principles that we read over in the Bible; you can read all the ordinances in the Bible, and yet many exclaim, we know nothing about it; at least the Christian world presents it so, because there is no light in them.

For the real debt of tithing, I shall have to suppose characters to bring it to your minds. Some say they are going to pay their tithing in produce and not in labor; and some say they pay one-fifth instead of one-tenth. There is not, I say, a man that has ever lived up to the principle of tithing. I will except many, for they have given all, and

the balance have not paid even the one-fiftieth of their tithing; and in all probability not more than one in a thousand dollars, that has been due as tithing, in the kingdom of God. I have been an observer so far as to know, that as a general thing the law of tithing has not been lived up to. Those who have promptly acted as Saints of the Most High God, and as servants of the Lord, have been ready to give their all; men must come to understanding and then live to it.

I will take the whole community, and represent it as one man, and call his name Mr. A., a member of the Church: I walk up to him, and say, Mr. A., tithing is required of you, to help to build temples, feed the poor, the widow and the fatherless, and anything that the law requires; you give the one tenth of all you have for building up the Kingdom of God upon the earth, to sustain the priesthood, and for rearing up the kingdom. Mr. A. is engaged in many branches of business, merchandising, trading, farming, and raising grain and cattle; he then retires to his country seat; rides in his carriage, has plenty of spare time; then he goes to the anvil, joiner's bench, &c., &c., and fills a variety of trades, positions, and characters. Mr. A. commences with one hundred thousand dollars as capital stock. Mr. A., there is ten thousand dollars due from you, which we want this day. He pays it, and has ninety thousand dollars capital stock on hand. Every man must do something; no idler is allowed in Zion—every man must go to work—no man must wrap his talents in a napkin, but put it to usury. Mr. A. goes to speculating on cargoes of merchandise, cattle, horses, and farms are offered at auction; he puts his 90,000 dollars as purchase money, and gains perhaps 410,000 dollars, making 500,000 in one week (it is quite a supposable case)—there is then 41,000 dollars more tithing due, to pay into the storehouse of the Lord, the balance goes to his capital stock.

We next see Mr. A., his money all gone, going into the canyon after a load of wood, or to the mill for something to eat; we see him ten days toiling and working—he owes the one-tenth of his time and team: when he has worked nine days for himself, then let him take his team and work a day for public works.

We next see him as a carpenter or joiner, set him to work on the public works, and every tenth day is put down to him as credit on tithing.

We next see him a farmer, raising wheat, cattle horses, sheep, &c.; he sits down and calculates what he has raised—say 100 bushels of wheat at twenty days work, we then take ten bushels of wheat for his tithing. If he idles away 150 days of his time in riding and pleasure, he owes 15 days work to the Lord—if he idles away his own time, he has no right to idle away the time of the Lord. If he has 100 sheep, he pays the one-tenth part of them, and has an increase, he must bring in the one-tenth of his wool, and the one-tenth of his increase, or pay for them, one of the two. Again, he has some cows, and they give so much milk, where are they? we want the one-tenth of them, with the one-tenth of your butter, cheese, and the one-tenth of your calves. If Mr. A. has fifty ducks, we want the tithe of them, which is five, and the tithe of the eggs; if you think it too trifling a matter for you, let us have the whole of them—we want the tithe of your geese, and all of your increase; it may look penurious to you—if it does, hand over the whole of them.

[The remainder of the minutes have been lost or mislaid. Pres. Hyde and Company's reception is crowded out of this issue; also the Epistle. They will appear in our next.]—*Frontier Guardian*.

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMESLY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[*Continued from page 32.*]

TESTAMENT OF REUBEN.

Listen to old Reuben relating
About seven spirits given to you,
Added to another eight heretical ones,
Which entice a man to live recklessly.

The Testament of Reuben, made to his children at his death, concerning all the things which he gave in charge to his Children before he died, in the 125 year of his life, two years after the decease

of Joseph: his children and children's children, came to visit him in his sickness and he said unto them.

My children, I die, and go the way of my fathers. And seeing there his brethren, Judah, Gad, and Asher, he said unto them, Lift me up, my brethren, that I may tell you and my children the things that I have hidden in my heart; for I am henceforth drawing to my long home. Then, standing up, he said, Hearken, my brethren, and you my children, give ear to the words of your father Reuben; and mark what I give in charge to you.

Behold, I command you this day before the God of heaven, that ye walk not in ignorance of youthfulness and fornication wherein I overshot myself, and defiled the bed of my father Jacob; for I assure you that the Lord did therefore strike me with a sore plague in my ranks the space of seven months, and I had perished if my father Jacob had not prayed to the Lord for me, because he was minded to have slain me. I was thirty years old when I did this evil in the sight of the Lord, and seven months was I sick to the death, and with a free heart did I seven years penance before the Lord; I drank no wine nor strong drink, and no flesh came within my mouth, I tasted not any fine bread, but I mourned for my sin, for it was great, and there shall none such be done in Israel. And now my sons, hear me, that I may show you what I saw concerning the seven spirits of error in my repentance. Belial giveth seven spirits against a man, which are the wellsprings of youthful works; and seven spirits are given man in his creation whereby all his works are done. The first, is the *spirit of life*, wherewith is created his being. The second, is the *spirit of seeing*, wherewith cometh learning. The third, is the *spirit of smelling*, wherewith cometh delight, by drawing in of the air, and by breathing of it out again. The fourth, is the *spirit of speech*, wherewith knowledge is made. The fifth, is the *spirit of talking*, whereof comes the feeding upon things that are to be eaten and drunk, and through them is engendered strength, because the substance of strength is in meat. The sixth, is the *spirit of seed and generation*, wherewith entereth in the lust of pleasure, for which cause, the last of creation, and the first of youth, because it is full of ignorance, and ignorance leadeth the younger sort as a blind body into the ditch; or as an ox to the stall. Among all these, is the seventh *spirit, which is of sleep*, with whom is created the wasting away of nature, and the image of death. With these spirits are mingled the spirits of error, of which, the first, is the *spirit of lechery*, who lieth within the nature and senses of man. The second, is the *spirit of insatiability*, which lieth in the

belly. The third, is the *spirit of discord, or strife*, and lieth in the liver. The fourth, is the *spirit of bravery, or gallantry*, that the party may seem comely by excess. The fifth is the *spirit of pride*, which moveth a man to mind over great things, or to think well of himself. The sixth is the *spirit of vain gloriousness*, wherein a man boasts, and desires to fill his talk concerning his own kindred, and acquaintance. The seventh, is the *spirit of unrighteousness* which stirreth up the affections, that a man should perform the lustful pleasures of his heart; for unrighteousness worketh with all the other spirits, by taking guile unto him. Unto all these spirits is matched the eighth *spirit, namely, sleep and sluggishness in error and imagination*, and so the souls of young folks perish, because their minds are darkened, and hidden from the truth, and understand not the law of the Lord: neither obey the doctrine of their fathers, as befell to me in my youth.

But now, my children, love the truth, and that shall preserve you; hearken to your father Reuben, and let not your eyes run a gazing after women, neither be ye alone with a woman that is married; neither do ye seek about what women are doing, for if I had not seen Bilhah bathing herself in a secret place, I had not fallen into that wickedness; but my mind ran so upon the naked woman, till it suffered me not to sleep till I had committed that abomination; for while my father Jacob was away with his father, Isaac, in Gader, near to Ephrata, a house of Bethlehem, Bilhah fell drunken, and as she lay asleep uncovered in her chamber, I went in so, and seeing her nakedness wrought wickedness with her, and leaving her asleep went my way. But by and by an angel of God revealed my wickedness to my father Jacob, who, coming home, mourned for me, and touched not Bilhah any more. Wherefore, look not upon the beauty of women, neither muse you upon their doings, but walk with a single heart in the fear of the Lord God, busying yourselves about some work, and keeping yourselves occupied either in learning or about your flocks, until such time as God give you such wives as he listeth, lest you do suffer as I have done, for I durst not look my father in the face to his dying day, nor speak to any of my brethren for shame; and my conscience biteth me for my sin, yea, even still. But my father comforted me, and prayed for me unto the Lord, that his wrath might pass away from me, as the Lord himself showed unto me: and from that time forth I was kept from sinning any more.

And now, my children, likewise keep ye that I shall tell you, and you shall not sin; for fornication is the destruction of the soul, and maketh it to draw unto idols, because it leadeth the mind and

understanding into error, and bringeth them to their grave before their time; for whoredom hath undone many men: and although a man be ancient or noble, yet he is a laughing stock both before Belial, and the sons of men. But Joseph, because he kept himself from all women, and cleansed his thoughts from all fornication, found favor both before the Lord and men. The Egyptian woman did much to him, by using the help of witches, and by offering him poisonous sauces, but the purpose of his mind admitted no hurtful wish; for this cause the God of our fathers delivered him from all death, both seen and unseen: for if fornication overrule not your mind, neither shall Belial prevail against you.

My sons, women are hurtful things, and when they want power and strength against a man, they work guilefully to draw him to them by trickery, and whom they cannot overmatch in strength, him they overcome by deceit. For the angel of the Lord which taught me, told me of them, that they be overmastered by the spirit of fornication more than men be, and that they be ever practicing in their hearts against men; First, making their minds to err by decking of themselves; and then shedding their poison into them by sight, and finally catching them prisoners by their doings. For a woman is not able to enforce a man.

Therefore, my sons, flee fornication, and charge your wives and daughters that they trim not their heads and will them to chasten their looks; for every woman that dealeth deceitfully in these things is reserved to the punishment of the world to come; for by such means were the watchers deceived before the flood, for as soon as they saw them, they fell in love one with another, and conceived a working in their minds, and turned themselves into the shape of men, and appeared to them in their companying with their husbands; and the women by conceiving the desire of them in the imagination of their mind, brought forth giants; for the watchers appeared to them of height unto heaven.

Therefore, keep yourselves from fornication, and if ye intend to have a clear mind, keep yourselves from all women, and forbid them likewise the company of men, that they may have also clean minds; for although continual companyings do not always work wickedness, yet, breed they incurable stings to them, and to us everlasting shame before Belial; because fornication hath neither understanding nor godliness in it, and all enviousness dwelleth in the desire thereof; and for that cause shall ye envy the children of Levi, and ye shall not be able to compass it, for God will avenge them, and you shall

die a dangerous death. For unto Levi and Judah hath the Lord given the sovereignty, and unto me, Dan, and Joseph, hath he granted to be princes with them. Wherefore, I charge you to hear Levi, for he shall know the law of the Lord; and he shall deal forth judgment, and offer sacrifice for all Israel, till the full time of Christ the chief Priest, because the Lord hath spoken it.

And I charge you by the God of heaven, that every one of you do deal faithfully with his neighbor, and stick unto Levi in humbleness of heart, that ye may receive blessing at his mouth; for he shall bless Israel and Judah.

And God hath chosen Judah to be the king of all people; wherefore, worship you his seed; for he shall die for you in battles, both visible and invisible, and shall reign over you worlds without end.

Then Reuben, having given his children the aforesaid charge, and blessed them, died; and they put him in a coffin, and carried him out of Egypt, and buried him at Hebron, in the double cave where his fathers slept.

(To be continued.)

WHO PROFESSES MIRACLES?

WE answer that it is those who deny them—the sectarians! Lately we came across an example on page 64 of one of the volumes of the “Evangelist,” which was published earlier by the Independents in Llanynddyfri; we copy from it the following:—

“HEALING OF MISS FAN COURT.

“With respect to the healing of Miss Fancourt, which is considered by many as miraculous, we shall put before our readers the true story, so that no one will stumble because of it.

“Miss Fancourt is the daughter of the Rev. J. Fancourt, from London, and she was taken ill in November, 1822. She suffered from considerable weakness in all her limbs, and at times the pain was quite intense. Several doctors visited her from time to time, and numerous medications were used to alleviate the pain, but all in vain. She went to the seaside several times, but she returned still in the same condition; and finally she became so weak that she could hardly move one foot in front of the other. And despite all the efforts

to cure her, she was very sick, and in the greatest pain when she attempted to move. Wednesday evening, in October, 1830, a friend called at her home to visit her, and when her associates were leaving her room, her friend, the Rev. Mr. G., gave some excuses to remain behind. He sat beside her, and after saying a few things, he arose, and said, They are expecting me for supper; he reached out his hand to her, and after saying a few things about her illness, he added, It is a great pity to see anyone being confined in this way; she responded, It has been sent in mercy. Do you believe that, he said, and do you believe that the same mercy can restore you? she answered, I do. Do you, added Mr. G., believe that Jesus can heal now as in former times? I do. Do you believe that disbelief is preventing that? I do. At that time Mr. G. appeared to be striving with God in a sincere prayer; Then, he said, arise, and walk, and come to your family. He took her hand, and prayed for God to glorify the name of his Son Jesus. She arose in strength, and all her pains ceased, and she walked down the stairs, while Mr. G. prayed, Lord, have mercy on us; Christ have mercy on us. All her bones went back into place, and her flesh, which was sagging before, tightened as the flesh of a healthy person."

MORMON LIBRARY.

CONGRESS, in its last session, appropriated five thousand dollars for the start of a library at the service of the citizens of the Territory of Utah, and John M. Bernhisel, Esq., one of the delegates of Utah in Congress, has been appointed to purchase the books. This kind and excellent gentleman is now in this city, purchasing in auctions and other places, wherever he can put the money to the best use. He is also receiving books and other publications as gifts, from authors, publishers, and others, for the same purpose.

This is a strange and interesting venture. The misunderstood Mormons, after being driven from Illinois, have established an empire in the heart of the continent, so wide, so acceptable, that Congress has granted a territorial government to them, appointing the head of the church as governor of the territory, and have made this provision for a public library. It is likely that this United Settlement, at the present moment, is the fairest, the most organized, and the most successful in the world. In another ten years, Utah will be a wealthy and powerful State, having a form of government and

a religious establishment as remarkable as anything that has ever existed in past times. The Mormons have had their season of persecution and martyrdom—they have held faithfully to their faith. After being driven from one city, and from one temple, they have established many more. Their exile from Illinois, by oppressive and misguided men, has given them a broad land of endless wealth, and will before long, according to all signs, be listed among the most splendid.

With such character, such abundance, the guidance of such providence, and such a diligent missionary establishment, it would not be surprising, in another half century, to see the Mormon faith spread over half our continent. Stranger things have happened. No religious belief is to be scorned, and we should be careful how we disregard—much more, how we persecute the chosen faith of any people.—*The New York Picayune*, Jan. 4, 1851.

“NATURE OF MIRACLES” AGAIN.

Answer to the question of Meurig in the December STAR.

MR. GOMER—I wish permission to inform Meurig that I said, that the apostles could be counted as false Christs, &c., when they failed to perform a miracle, on the same ground that some of the “prophets” of the Latter-day Saints could be counted as false prophets, when they fail to perform a miracle. Let your correspondent read the article again. That the apostles were unable to rebuke the deaf and dumb spirit, was no proof that they could not perform miracles, any more than the failure of some of the “prophets” of the Saints to perform the miracle that Mr. Gwilym ab Dewi wished, was proof that they could not perform miracles. I understand that the Saints allege their authority to preach, baptize, cast out devils, heal the sick, &c., in the same way that the apostles of old claimed. If Meurig or Gwilym were to see some of the Saints unable to cast out devils, or unable to heal someone with medicine, would they not be ready to shout, “Deceivers,” “false teachers,” &c.? but what do they say about the inability of the apostles to rebuke the devil, and Paul’s counsel to Timothy to use medicine to be healed? Perhaps they would answer, The apostles did not have sufficient faith, and they did not fast and pray; also, Paul’s faith was weak, or the Lord did not wish to give health. But, why not grant that to the Saints, poor things? Christ said to his disciples,—“If ye have faith as a grain of mustard seed,

ye shall say unto this mountain, Remove hence to yonder place; and it shall remove; and nothing shall be impossible unto you." Now, we see that faith is the miraculous power; and that God works according to a man's faith, but also according to his own will. Consequently, Meurig and Gwilym ab Dewi have an opportunity to perform miracles, if they are true disciples of Christ, and if they exercise sufficient faith to do so; but it is not likely that God would assist them in performing miracles to satisfy sign seekers. Quite likely, if these two had sufficient faith to perform a small miracle, and if others were threatening to call them "deceivers" if they could not perform some great miracle which they desired, such as feeding five thousand with five loaves of bread and two fishes, they would probably be heard arguing like this:—"We are, you know, but common members of the body of Christ; it is not right for you to expect us to perform that which such men as the apostles performed; furthermore, we have no account of those two (namely Peter and Paul) being able to perform great miracles; furthermore, it is not right to expect them, much less us, to perform things so remarkable as the things Christ performed; and despite it all, you want us to feed five thousand miraculously, or something similar, and do so to satisfy sign seekers!" Indeed, they would be reasoning very wisely, and in harmony with all scripture, as far as I know. But it could happen that these two were not endowed with the Holy Ghost and the gift of "working miracles," but with the gift of the "word of wisdom" or "prophecy" (see 1 Cor. xii); consequently, they could not be expected to perform any kind of miracle, much less a great one. It would be vain to expect them "to heal," if they had "divers kinds of tongues; and it would be useless to expect them to "prophecy," if they had the "gift of healing." Our friends see, then, that it is foolishness to seek a sign from the Saints, if that were scriptural and normal, without first knowing what they are able to do. But from reading the aforementioned chapter, it is obvious that all those different gifts are members which pertain to the body or the church of Christ, and that they are not to be used except for the edification of the body.

But so as not to go on too long, I may make an observation on that which Meurig most particularly wishes to know from me. He asks, whether it was for lack of power or lack of faith that the apostles were unable to cast out the deaf and dumb spirit. Christ said to them, that if they had the faith of a grain of mustard seed, that nothing would be impossible to them; consequently, they were lacking in faith when they failed. Their *power* depended on their faith. Their inability was disbelief; and for disbelieving they were rebuked by Christ. Despite that, Christ showed them that that kind of devil would not go out, unless the disciples had strong faith, and

unless they fasted and prayed. I hope this will give satisfaction to Meurig; if not, I can do nothing but try again.

Yours, sir, sincerely,

Glan Teifi.

I. M.

[The foregoing article of ours was published in the "Star of Gomer," for January, 1847.—ED.]

THE SAINTS IN LONDON.

IT APPEARS from *Star* No. 3, that the Saints in the capital city intend to accomplish a splendid work during this year. The district president, namely Eli B. Kelsey, has just sent to Liverpool for the following books:—600 Books of Mormon; 600 Doctrine and Covenants; 600 Hymn Books; 16,000 Kingdom of God, parts 1, 2, 3, and 4; 4,000 Divine Authority; 4,000 Remarkable Visions; 24,000 Divine Authenticity, Nos. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, & 6; 500 Absurdities of Immaterialism; 500 Reply to Remarks on Mormonism; 1,500 New Jerusalem; 24 Vols. of *Star*, No. 11, bound, half calf; 24 Vols. *Times and Seasons*, No. 6, bound, half calf; 3,000 *Great First Cause*; 800 *Taylor's Discussion*; 1,000 *Gibson's Discussion*. He intends to take advantage of the "world's great fair" that is happening in London this year, and also to open a shop near Paternoster Row, where books of the Saints can be obtained by any man in the country. This good man is thinking of forming some kind of clubs in the branches, and putting everyone to work together, so that he considers selling the huge numbers of books listed above but an easy task. There are 56 branches there, and after each branch does its part, he thinks he can reach his goal of selling the books in view, and pay for them monthly to the chief distributor, who is William Cook, 35, Jewin Street, City, London.

DEPARTURE OF ELDER ORSON PRATT.

ON the 22nd of January, the Saints in Liverpool held a meeting to bid farewell to Elder Orson Pratt, in the Music Hall, Boldstreet, where everything was organized in a very skillful manner. The tables were set with glasses of cold water, *confectionery*, and fruits, instead of *tea*. The party was free to the Saints, the expenses being defrayed by two gentlemen of that branch. Among the visitors were Elders Wallace, Gates, Wheelock, Phillips, Bell, and Rowan. Miss Collinson presided at the piano forte. The countenances of the Saints were loving, and their faces showed that they were partakers of the gift of the Holy Ghost. During the evening, the Liverpool branch presented to Pratt a testimonial of approval for his outstanding deeds while in

this country, to show in Salt Lake City. It was beautifully engrossed on vellum, and mounted with gilded *cornice* and roller.

On the 29th of January, the ship *Ellen Maria*, which was to emigrate President Pratt and his company, left the dock in Liverpool; but it waited until the next morning in its estuary, when brother Pratt and his family went in to the others; and then the ship sailed away without delay. The number of Welsh Saints on this ship is 66. May Almighty God keep his servant Orson Pratt, and guide him and his company safely home.

TO ALL THE SAINTS THROUGHOUT GREAT
BRITAIN AND IRELAND.

15, *Wilton Street, Liverpool, Feb. 1, 1851.*

DEAR BRETHREN,—I have contracted the American ship “Olympus,” Capt. Wilson, to sail to New Orleans on Friday, the 28th of this month. This will be the last and the only ship that will sail with Saints, until next September; therefore, all who wish to secure a place in it, should send forthwith their names, their ages, their occupations, and their deposits of £1, for every person over one year and under fourteen years of age, since the spaces are being filled quickly. The names and ages of babies, if there are some, should be sent also, even though their passage is free.

The presiding elders should announce this in the churches as soon, and as wide spread, as possible.

FRANKLIN D. RICHARDS.

THE FATHER, THE SON, AND THE DAUGHTER.

[*From the English of Apostle John Taylor, from France.*]

THE SON.

GLADLY I'd go to the west, to the lovely, good land,
To dwell with the people blessed by God;
Father, Oh, dear Father, say why
You will not come and carry us to our perfect home.
Land, land, dear, dear land,
Our Father, Oh, come with us to Zion, dear land.

THE DAUGHTER.

Why, Oh, dear Father, will you not come there to live,
For God says the Saints unto Zion shall flow;
Celestial blessings to it he'll impart,
And with the just, the upright in heart, he will dwell.
Land, land, dear, dear land,
Our Father, Oh, come with us to Zion, dear land.

THE FATHER.

Dear children, consider—the journey is long,
 And your mother is feeble, and I am not much better;
 If your old mother and your father were to die on the way,
 You would then think it were better to stay in our land.
 Land, land, dear, dear land,
 The land of our childhood—there's no place like our land.

THE SON.

But, Father, a revelation was received from God about the worry
 That is between him and Babel, where we were tenderly reared;
 That judgments will the nations o'erflow:
 To escape all these evils we wish you to flee with us.
 Land, land, dear, dear land,
 Our Father, Oh, come with us to Zion, dear land.

THE DAUGHTER.

And, Father, I'll help you all along the lonely way—
 I'll comfort and watch you by night and by day;
 And angels will guard you, and uphold you,
 And God will impart to you comfort and peace.
 Land, land, dear, dear land,
 Our Father, Oh, come with us to Zion, dear land.

THE FATHER, THE SON, AND THE DAUGHTER.

Well, then, we shall go to the land across the sea,
 For that which the Lord ordains is surely best for us;
 We'll journey together to Zion and trust in God,
 We shall partake in the righteous' reward, if we continue faithful
 Land, land, dear, dear land,
 Our Father, Oh, come with us to Zion, dear land.

*Merthyr.**Trans.* BENJAMIN DAVIES.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

REFRAIN from blaming before searching for the truth; first understand, and then chastise.

PAYMENTS FROM JAN. 23 TO FEB. 6.—Flintshire, £1 2s; Merionethshire, £1 13s; Dinas, £1 9s 6c; Cwmbach, 10s; Rhymney, 14s 11c; Georgetown, £1; Merthyr, 1s 4c.



The DOC. AND COV.—Finally coming out without delay. A small obstacle, but it is underway.



Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil*; but do not send anything else.

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 4.]

FEBRUARY 22, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

FOURTH GENERAL EPISTLE OF THE PRESIDENCY
OF THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-
DAY SAINTS, FROM THE GREAT SALT LAKE VAL-
LEY, IN THE STATE OF DESERET, TO THE SAINTS
SCATTERED THROUGHOUT THE EARTH.

GREETING:—

DEAR BRETHREN,—Another opportunity is presented, whereby we may communicate to you what great things the Lord has been doing for his people; for truly has he made the wilderness to bud and blossom like the rose, and the fruit thereof to come forth in its season, while the solitary places of the mountains of Ephraim are made vocal with the praises of Israel's God.

Since our last epistle of the 12th of April, our Heavenly Father has cheered our hearts, and strengthened our hands; and the earth has yielded an abundant harvest. On the 12th of May, peach trees, of two years' growth, were in bloom; and several trees of the same age, in various parts of the city, alternately bloomed till the twenty-ninth, when currants, peas, beans, &c., put forth their blossoms; and nature smiled with the prospect of early fruits; but on the 17th of June, the snow fell freely on the surrounding mountains, followed by a severe frost on the 18th, and a slight one on the 19th, which injured the vines and the tender plants; more particularly on the lowest lands; yet we feel confident that this valley will yet produce the choicest fruits, accustomed to the latitudes, as it now does the richest vegetables.

The peaches in brother Young's garden grew finely, until they were accidentally destroyed by the sports of the children; and the California grape is flourishing beautifully in the same garden, and other places in the city.

On the 13th of May, we located a farm, one mile by two, near Jordan bridge, for the benefit of the poor, designing to build houses for the accommodation of all such as were not able to build for themselves; but on investigation we learned there were only two persons in the Valley who were unable to provide for themselves, and the contemplated farm was converted into a pasture for the time being.

The Indians have been more quiet the present season than hitherto; though the Utes continue to steal our horses and cattle more or less, and threaten some. A band of Utes killed a small band of the Snake Indians, some time in the summer, and one white man by the name of Baker was killed by them on the 29th of May, between the Utah and San Pete valleys. Though more recently they have been on their hunts, and manifested personal hostility; yet, for the safety of the people, the drill and discipline of the Nauvoo Legion is not neglected, for we have none to depend upon for protection but God, and his people; and God helps those who try to help themselves.

Emigrants from the States, and from almost all nations, passing through the States, bound for the Gold Mines, began to arrive here on the 27th of May, and have continued to arrive till the present time, though most of them have passed a month since. Their numbers have been much larger than the previous year. Several have arrived in our city, who had been left by their companions to die by the wayside; and many companies and individuals have had contentions among themselves, not very creditable to civilized society, and which, contrary to the wishes of the magistracy of our State, they have been called upon to settle. It is the urgent wish of all the citizens of Deseret, that travelers would settle their own difficulties; or rather, that they would have no difficulties, so that our officers might pursue their daily avocations in peace. Were there no travelers in our midst, we might soon forget the name of lawsuit. As a people, we have too much

to do to attend to such matters.

Many scores, if not hundreds, of these emigrants, on arriving at the Valley, and hearing the gospel, for the first time in many instances, have been baptized for the remission of their sins, and gone no further, while others have witnessed our location, peace, union, and prosperity, and though not professing to believe the doctrine of Christ, are making their way home as fast as possible, to bring their families hither, where they can enjoy health, in a land of civil and religious liberty, where they find themselves free to do right.

On the 8th of June, a mail was received from Kanesville Post Office, per hand of Thomas S. Williams, containing the first authentic intelligence from the States this season, and on the 14th commenced the printing of the "Deseret News," the first periodical in the State of Deseret.

The Nauvoo Legion, in uniform, honored the 4th of July with a public parade, which closed with a patriotic address by the Governor of the State.

The Topographical Engineers have closed their surveys for the season, and returned to Washington, as we are informed, by way of Arkansas. Rumors having been circulated in the States, that the Engineers had been received with coldness, and the object of the expedition had been forcibly opposed by the inhabitants of the Valley. We here give extracts from a letter of Captain Stansbury (President of the corps), to the Editor of the "Deseret News," dated July 1st, 1850, concerning the matter. "How the rumor became prevalent, I am ignorant, * * I take pleasure in declaring that nothing can be further from the truth. We were received by the President and public authorities with the greatest courtesy, both officially and personally, and will remember with gratitude the many tokens of kindness and regard we have received from them and the citizens of the place.

"Every facility has been studiously afforded us for the prosecution of our duties; instruments of science frankly and gratuitously loaned, and the able and faithful assistance obtained from their commencement here, of a gentleman, well known as a fearless advocate of your doctrines, and a prominent and influential member of your community." The whole letter is in No. 4 of the "Deseret News," and a copy of the same may be found in

every newspaper in the United States, that has circulated the rumors which drew forth the letter, provided the editor thereof is an honest man.

The third anniversary of the Pioneers into the Valley, on the 24th of July, was celebrated by the public assembly, in a manner worthy of the occasion, with orations, addresses, songs of praise and thanksgiving, and music, in which the Saints and pilgrims to the mines seemed alike to participate. A synopsis of the proceedings were published in No. 7, 8, and 9 of the "News."

On the last of July, brothers Young and Kimball left home on a visit to Utah and San Pete, and returned on the 12th of August, having found a place for a good settlement, located a city at San Pete, and noticed several intermediate sites, worthy of the attention of smaller colonies, which we anticipate will be settled this fall, making a pleasant and safe communication from this to our most southern habitations. The San Pete settlement will also be strengthened, and others will spread on the north, to, and beyond Ogden, so that when the emigration of this season shall close, there will be a continued line of villages at short distances, for more than 200 miles in extent; and a company is already chartered by the General Assembly of Deseret, for the purpose of running a regular line of coaches between Ogden and San Pete, to commence as early next spring as the traveling will permit, and to be extended as fast as the settlements extend; also, from the capital to Tooele county, by way of the Great Salt Lake Bath.

The Government of the Union has been very tardy in rendering any facilities of communication between themselves and the State of Deseret, and having been left to our own resources for information, on the second of August, brother John Y. Green was dispatched to Kanesville with a mail; and on the 15th Elder O. Hyde arrived with a mail from Kane Post Office; also bringing with him the "Frontier Guardian," the only file of newspapers we are in possession of, from any part of the earth for the past year.

The weather has been more cloudy, the nights warmer, and the showers more frequent in the heat of summer, and vegetation more rapid this season, than hitherto; consequently, artificial irrigation has been less needed, which has been a great blessing; for, during the irrigation season,

there were not men enough in the Valley to water the immense fields of grain, had it been as dry as some previous seasons.

The crops have been abundant in all the settlements of Deseret this season; and we have made every exertion to have them secured for the benefit of all; and although from the best information obtained, we have reason to expect that our population will be strengthened, nearly, if not quite, fifteen thousand, this season, yet we are confident, if all will be prudent, there will be seed grain, and bread sufficient to sustain the whole, until another harvest.

The estimated population of fifteen thousand inhabitants in Deseret, the past year, having raised grain sufficient to sustain the thirty thousand for the coming year, inspires us confidently to believe, that the thirty thousand the coming year, can raise sufficient for sixty thousand the succeeding year, and to this object and end our energies will be exerted, to double our population annually, by the assistance of the Perpetual Emigrating Poor Fund, and otherwise provide for the sustenance of that population.

Viewing the gathering of Israel, which produces an increased population in the valleys of the mountains, an important part of the Gospel of Jesus Christ, and one of the most important at the present time; we shall send few or no elders abroad to preach the gospel this fall; but instruct them to raise grain and build houses, and prepare for the saints, that they may come in flocks, like doves to their windows; and we say, arise! to your wagons and your tents, O, scattered Israel! ye Saints of the Most High! rich and poor, and gather to the State of Deseret, bringing your plows and drills, your reapers and gleaners, your threshers and cleaners, of the most approved patterns, so that one man can do the labor of twenty, in the wheat field; and we will soon send the elders abroad by hundreds and thousands to a harvest of souls among all nations, and the inhabitants of the earth shall speedily hear of the salvation prepared by Israel's God for his people.

Many inhabitants of the city are leaving their good homes this fall, and taking up land in the country, preparatory for extensive farming operations; and many who are now arriving in our midst, are gathering in companies of tens, twenties, and fifties, to act in concert for mutual protection and

assistance, in opening new fields, establishing new settlements, and in preparing to feed the friends we are calling home.

Our messengers who went east, this fall, to visit the camps of the saints, emigrating hither, and report to us their situation, have discovered a new route from Green River, south of the old road, to the Pacific Springs, on which the feed and water are improved; also a new route on the north side of the Sweet Water River; which, together with the road on the entire north side of the Platte River, from its mouth westward, as located all the distance, and traveled the most of the way by our pioneers in 1847, is decidedly the best route for the Saints from the States to Deseret.

Crossing the Missouri River above the mouth of the Platte, and passing the Loup Fork, which is the only river of much consequence to cross on the north of the Platte; also, of the Sweet Water, except near its source in the mountains; and there are no natural obstructions on the route till you arrive at Green River, where a ferry may be expected at high water, and good fording is always found late in the season.

Our State House is enclosed; the walls are nearly ready for plastering; and we have no doubt but the several apartments will be ready for their several uses—the sitting of the General Assembly, High School, Printing Office, and Tithing, Post and Recording Offices, the coming winter. The Warm Spring Bath House is so near completion, the visitants are accommodated at the baths, and daily and hourly carriages are running from thence to various parts of the city.

There are several extensive storehouses completed, and near completion in our city, and goods sufficient in quantity and variety, with the exception of groceries, for the necessities of the people, till another season.

Sugar is not only a beverage, a luxury, but it is in its nature and substance, one of the component parts of our bodies; and a free use thereof is calculated to promote health; and could the Saints have a more abundant supply, they would need less meat. Should every person in Deseret consume one-third of an ounce of sugar per day, through the coming year, it would require about one hundred and twenty tons, more than has or will be brought by our merchants this season; and according to the best estimate

we can make, three hundred tons would be consumed in this State the next year, if it could be obtained.

We anticipate some relief in the sugar market next season, from the culture of the sugar beet, and its manufacture, but this can make but little impression the first year, as we are not informed of more than one or two bushels of the genuine sugar beet seed in the valley, though we know of no country where a greater quantity of saccharine matter is produced in vegetables than this.

About the middle of August, Brothers Young and Kimball, accompanied by Brother Hyde and others, visited Weber county, and located and gave the plan for the city of Ogden, near Ogden river, and between that and the Weber river.

The General Assembly has held adjourned sessions, occasionally through the summer. The sittings have been very brief, though much important business has been transacted, important to our young and flourishing State. When the constitution of Deseret was adopted, and its boundaries were established therein, the actual settlers of Deseret outnumbered Western California as five to three. Notwithstanding which, a strong exertion has been made by Congress to receive California into the Union, to the exclusion of Deseret, though our petition for admission was equally before them.

* * * * *

Kane Post Office, in Pottawattamie, is the nearest office to this place, and through which all our business has been transacted with the States and foreign countries. A United States mail arrived here on the 9th of this month, from Independence, Missouri, by which we received no news, except through the carrier, by whom we learned that a contract existed for bringing through the mail once a month, and that President Taylor was dead.

Communications to and from our friends abroad have been very uncertain in their transmission, and so far as it can be, it is desirable that valuable documents should be remitted by private conveyance.

The Perpetual Emigrating Funds have been judiciously appropriated

the past year, under the immediate application of our agent, Bishop Edward Hunter, who is near this place, on his return from Pottawattamie, with a large company of poor Saints.

Our annual fall Conference was commenced on the 6th of September, one month earlier than usual, so that the brethren who were obliged to go to the States, need not be exposed on their travels so late in the season; but circumstances, beyond our control, have cause unexpected delay, which, in the end, will result in good.

The Conference was fully attended, and much important business was transacted, as will be seen by reference to the minutes which are published, the most important items dwelt upon, were the Perpetual Emigrating Fund, Education, and a universal sustaining of the general officers of the Church, and of the different quorums thereof, except that Brother Parry was added to the High Council of this Stake of Zion, in place of Brother Grover, who is absent.

Preparations are making for the establishment of a parent school, or a school for qualifying teachers for primary and infant schools throughout the State; for enclosing the University lands, a plot of about six hundred acres, directly east of the City; and for everything else which may tend to facilitate the improvement of the old and young, in a knowledge of the arts, sciences, and general intelligence.

Several thousand dollars were subscribed to the Perpetual Fund during Conference; and several individuals subscribed one thousand each. Since that time the Perpetual Emigrating Company, of not fewer than thirteen members, consisting of a president, and assistants, has been incorporated by an Ordinance of the General Assembly of the State of Deseret, with power to choose their own officers, such as a president, secretary, treasurer, recorder, and agents; and transact all business necessary for the furtherance of emigration; in accordance with the general principles of transacting business among states and nations.

Brigham Young was unanimously elected President of the Company, who have since completed their organization by electing Willard Richards, Secretary; Newel K. Whitney, Treasurer; and Thomas Bullock, Recorder;

every Member of the Company is responsible for the acts of its officers and agents.

It is confidently reported that there is a great failure of the gold dust, the present season, in California; and many of the donations made to the Perpetual Fund, have and will be made in livestock, grain, &c.; and should a proper proportion of cash be wanting, the Company will issue their paper, for the purpose of fitting out emigrants abroad, which paper will always be good, as a sufficiency of the stock will be retained in deposit by the Company, to redeem that paper at any moment; and any person coming to this place can, with more convenience, bring the paper than flour, stock, or even gold; which will make it an object for the brethren who have the means, and travelers bound for Deseret, to secure the Company's paper, wherever they can find it; for with that paper they can get such articles as travelers most need, when money will not purchase them in this market.

The Twelve Apostles are mostly in their several fields of labor abroad. Elder Orson Hyde has been with us a few weeks on a visit, and is about to return to Kanesville, and continue his labors in the States. Elders P. P. Pratt, Geo. A. Smith, and E. T. Benson are at this place; and, with Wilford Woodruff, who is journeying hither, will spend the winter in the Valley. Orson Pratt and Franklin D. Richards are in England. John Taylor, who left for France, Lorenzo Snow, for Italy, Erastus Snow, for Sweden, last fall, have not been heard from since they arrived at their destinations. Amasa Lyman is daily expected, with a large company of the brethren from California. Charles C. Rich is expected to continue his labors in California, and commence a settlement with such of the brethren as wish to tarry there, in the southern part of the Territory. Orson Pratt is expected here, as early next spring as circumstances will permit; otherwise, the Apostles are expected to continue in their several appointments, according to previous instruction; extending their labors into other countries, as opportunity presents, and as they shall be directed by the Holy Spirit.

We received a long and cheering communication from Elder O. Pratt by Elder Hyde; and we feel to say to the Saints in England, lift up your hearts and rejoice, for the Lord hath done a great work in your midst,

and speedily a greater responsibility must rest upon your shoulders. The reason why a prophet is not without honor, save in his own country, and among his own kin, is the want of faith and confidence among his countrymen. Immense treasures of time and means have been expended by the American brethren, to extend the work in Great Britain; and the time has now come when we must begin to have a care for other nations, and leave you to prosecute the work begun in your midst, without continuing to send you Elders as heretofore: God is no respecter of persons, and he is just as ready and willing to qualify your own Elders to preach and preside over Conferences, as to qualify men from abroad; and he will do it if you will give them your faith and prayers, and honor them in their calling, as you have done the foreign Elders.

We do not wish the American Elders to leave England, unless they shall particularly desire it, and that desire shall be approved by the Presidency at Liverpool; and we suggest to that Presidency the propriety of electing presiding Elders of Conferences from the native brethren, as soon as circumstances shall render it convenient; and begin to initiate them into the practical duties of their calling, leaving the few American brethren more at liberty to visit the conferences, and attend to general instructions.

Presiding Bishop Newel K. Whitney, died very suddenly on the 23rd instant; Bishop Whitney was one of the oldest members of the Church, and we have to deplore the loss of an exemplary member, and a most upright man in all his dealings; and while we mourn his absence, we are again reminded that the Church of Christ is built upon no man; and that God is able to do his own work. Bishop Partridge was the first presiding bishop in the Church in these last days, and died several years since; he was succeeded by Bishop Whitney, who is now gone to the world of spirits; and the voice to all is, be ye also ready. The health of the people in the Valley is generally good; there have been a few deaths, mostly of emigrants.

Every possible exertion will be made on our part, and that of the Emigrating Company, to extend the usefulness of the Perpetual Fund in gathering the Saints; and it is important that those who anticipate help therefrom, should understand, that the means sent forth are, and will be

designed to furnish teams of oxen, almost or quite exclusively; and even the cases in which wagons will be furnished will be rare. The poor who can live in the States with little clothing, and little or no groceries, &c., can live equally as cheap on the road; and when once here, can procure the comforts of life by their industry. Souls are the articles for the Perpetual Fund to gather home, and that too as many as possible; and other things will be attended to in their time and place.

We are under obligation by covenant, firstly to apply the Perpetual Funds gathered in this country, to bring home the poor Saints who were driven from Nauvoo; and as soon as this shall be accomplished, we shall be ready to extend our exertions to other places and countries. Let the European Saints continue to add to their Perpetual Funds, which we doubt not they have commenced according to our previous counsel; and as soon as sufficient shall be collected to remove a suitable company, we will give instructions concerning its application, and emigration will commence.

One year ago and the Perpetual Fund was not instituted. Returns have not been completed this fall; but so far as we can judge, they will not now fall much short of twenty thousand dollars in the Valley. Let the Saints abroad imitate the example of the Saints here, according to their ability, and let this work continue to go forward with the same speed it has hitherto done, and the time will be short, when all the poor and oppressed of Zion will feel its cheering influence, and the cry need not be heard, "I would go up to the House of the Lord, but I have not the means."

The Perpetual Emigrating Company consists of Brigham Young, President: Heber C. Kimball, Willard D. Richards, Orson Hyde, Geo. A. Smith, Ezra T. Benson, Jedediah M. Grant, Daniel H. Wells, Willard Snow, Edward Hunter, Daniel Spencer, Thomas Bullock, John Brown, William Crosby, Amasa Lyman, Charles C. Rich, Lorenzo Young, and P. P. Pratt, Assistants; Daniel Spencer, Treasurer, in place of N. K. Whitney, deceased. Orson Hyde and John Brown have been appointed traveling agents, and will be in the States the ensuing winter. Orson Pratt and Franklin D. Richards have been appointed traveling agents; they are located at Liverpool; and their particular field of operations, at present, will be the British Islands.

Thus, brethren, we have given you a brief history of the situation and prospects of the Church in the Wilderness, and the wishes of our Heavenly Father, as made manifest by his spirit dwelling in us, for your edification, comfort, and salvation. The signs of the times are highly portentous of a mighty and short work in these last days; and we pray God, the Eternal Father, that he will inspire your hearts with humility, faith, and patience; and that he may give you diligence in every means within your reach, to help roll that work forward, that you may speedily be found in Zion, rejoicing with us, and the Gospel be proclaimed to the ends of the earth, in the name of Jesus. Amen.

BRIGHAM YOUNG,
 HEBER C. KIMBALL,
 WILLARD RICHARDS,

Great Salt Lake City, Deseret,
 September 27, 1850.

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMELY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[*Continued from page 46.*]

TESTAMENT OF SIMEON.

Here's the advice of cruel Simeon,
 After calling together his sons,
 To command to keep away from jealousy,
 Since this destroys its owner.

COPY of Simeon's words, which he spake unto his sons at his death, in the hundredth and twentieth year of his life in the which Joseph died; for when they came to visit him upon his deathbed, and he sitting up, kissed them, saying,—

Hearken my children, hear me your father Simeon, whatsoever I have in my heart: I am my father Jacob's second son, and my mother Leah named me Simeon, because the Lord heard her prayer. I became very mighty, and I went through with my doings, and was not afraid of anything, for my heart was stout, my mind immovable, and my stomach undiscourageable; for hardiness is given of the Highest into men's souls and bodies. In those days I envied Joseph,

because my father loved him; I hardened my heart against him to kill him, because the prince of error sending forth the spirit of envy, so blinded my mind that I could not take heed to spare my father Jacob, but his God, the God of his father sending his angel, did rid him out of my hands. For while I went into Shechem to carry fare for our flocks, and Reuben into Dathan, where all of our necessities were laid up in store; our brother Judah sold him unto the Ishmaelites, and therefore when my brother was come again, he was sorry; for he intended to have conveyed him safe again to our father, but I was angry with Judah for letting him go alive, and bare him grudge five months after: howbeit God letted me, and restrained the working of my hands; for my right hand was half withered up for seven days together; then did I perceive, my sons, that that befell me for Joseph's sake; whereupon, I repented soon after, and besought the Lord to restore my hand, and I would abstain from all rancor, envy, and folly; for I knew I had conceived a wicked thought against the Lord, and against my father Jacob, for my brother Joseph's sake, whom I envied.

Now therefore, my children, keep yourselves from the spirits of error and envy; for envy overruleth the mind of every man, suffering him not to eat or drink in rest, or to do any good thing; but is egging him to slay the party whom he envieth, and pining away at his prosperity. Two years together I punished my soul with fasting in the fear of the Lord; for I knew that the way to deliver me from envy, was the fear of the Lord. If a man flee unto the Lord, the wicked spirit fleeth from him, so as his mind becometh meek, and of spiteful he becometh pitiful, bearing no grudge towards such as love him, and so his envy ceaseth. And because my father saw me sad, he asked me the cause of it, to whom I lied, saying I have a pain in my stomach: I was the sorriest of all my brothers, for that I had been the cause of Joseph's selling into Egypt; and when I came into Egypt, and was put inward by him as a spy, then perceived I that I was justly punished, and I was not sorry for it; but Joseph was a good man, and having God's spirit in him, and being full of pity and mercy, minded not to do me any harm, but loved me as well as the residue of my brethren.

Therefore, my children, keep yourselves from all spite and envy, and walk in singleness of mind, and good conscience, after the example of your father's brother; that God may give you grace, glory, and blessedness, upon your heads as you see in him; of all the days of his life, he did never cast us in the teeth with it, but loved us

as his own soul, and more than his own children, honoring us, and giving us riches and cattle abundantly.

You therefore, my children, love ye one another with a good heart, and put from you the spirit of envy, for it maketh a man's soul to grow savage, marreth his body, breedeth wrath and war in his thoughts, setteth his blood on fire, driveth him out of his wits, and suffereth no reason to bear any sway or rule; moreover, it taketh away his sleep, disquieteth his mind, and maketh his body to tremble, for even in his sleep some spice of imagined malice gnaweth him, cumbering his soul with spirits of mischief, making his body ghastly, and his mind affrighted with trouble, and appearing unto men as it were with a pernicious spirit and pouring out his poison; but Joseph was fair of face, beautiful and comely to behold, because no wicked thing dwelt in him, for he had a countenance clear from cumbrance of mind.

And now, my children, let your hearts be meek before the Lord, and walk right before man; so shall ye find favor both with God and man; and beware that ye fall not to whoredom, for whoredom is the mother of all naughtiness, separating a man from God, and sending him to Belial. For I have seen in Enoch's writings, that you and your children shall be corrupted with whoredom, and do Levi wrong by the sword, but they shall not prevail against Levi, because he shall fight the Lord's battles, and take all your tents; and very few shall be divided in Levi and Judah, for he shall be your Captain, as my father Jacob prophesied in his blessings. And now, behold I tell you all these things aforesaid, that I may be clear from the sin of your souls.

Now, if you put from you all enviousness and all stiffneckedness, all my bones shall flourish as a rose in Israel, and my flesh as a lilly in Jacob, and my savor shall be as the scent of Libanus, and my holy ones shall be multiplied as the cedars forever, and their boughs shall spread out in length forevermore; then shall the seed of Canaan perish together with all the remnant of Amalek; all the Cappadocians shall perish and all the Scythians shall likewise be destroyed. Then shall the land of Cam fail, and all the people go to wreck; then shall the earth rest from Heldrin, and all men under heaven from war. Then shall Shem be glorified, when the great Lord God of Israel appeareth upon earth as a man, to save Adam in him: then shall the spirit of error be trodden under foot, and men shall reign over hurtful and hellish angels: then shall I arise again in joy, and bless the Highest in his wonderful works; for God taking a body upon him, and eating with men, shall save men.

And now, my children, obey Levi, and you shall be delivered by Judah; and advance not yourselves above these two tribes, for of them shall the saving health spring unto us; for God shall set up Levi as the prince of priests, and from Judah the king of kings, God and man; so shall he save all the Gentiles, and the offspring of Israel. For these things I charge you to command your children to keep these things throughout all their generations.

And then Simeon, making an end of these his sayings, and commandments to his children, slept with his fathers, when as he was of the age of an hundred and twenty years; and then they laid him in a coffin of wood that rotteth not; that they might carry his bones again into Hebron, and they conveyed him privily, that the Egyptians might not know, for the Egyptians kept the bones of Joseph in the king's treasure; for their enchanters told them that whensoever Joseph's bones were carried away, there should be such a plague of mist and darkness among the Egyptians, as one brother should not know another, no not even by torchlight. And Simeon's children bewailed their father, according to the law of mourning, and continued in Egypt till the day of their departing thence under the hand of Moses.

(To be continued.)

AN EXTRAORDINARY EVENT.

DEAR BROTHER DAVIS,—I wish to tell the readers of the TRUMPET, of an event that took place in this neighborhood (Merthyr) a few days ago.

On the 26th of last December, I was in the company of the Apostle John Taylor, William Howells, Thomas Pugh, and others, crossing Aberdare Mountain, the summit of which is about a mile and a half from Merthyr; and we placed four stones down (one opposite the other) near the top of the mountain as a remembrance of our having passed by. On the 28th I returned in the company of brothers Taylor and Pugh, and we added three more stones to the others.

Now, that which happened in that place on the 1st of February is worth noting. As two brethren were going up the mountain, near the foot of the mountain, they met a man and woman running back filled with fear, who said that the mountain was boiling up, and when it had risen up several yards, they heard a sound like a cannon's roar. After hearing so much talk about the thing, I myself went in the company of two of the brethren to see the place, and that which we saw surprised us greatly. It had happened within two yards of the aforementioned stones. We saw that many hundreds of tons of earth

had been blown about 250 yards away, and had left a crater about 120 yards long, from 15 to 20 yards wide, and from one to two yards deep. Pieces of old oak in the ground had been blown away, about 6 feet long by 3 feet in diameter, and some of them so hard that they could not be broken or sawed, and the others were black and soft. There are varying opinions about the happening; some say that it was an earthquake, others that sulfur caused it, and others that it was water. The place was mushy and soft, no matter what caused it. But my opinion is, that the whole thing was one of the signs of the latter days, and that many similar things will yet come to pass, to testify that God is taking his work forward.

Yours in the truth,

Merthyr, Feb. 11, 1851.

WILLIAM PHILLIPS.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

HE who deserves nothing, should be content with something.

NO ONE enjoys success, if he has not met with failure.

GOOD NEWS.—President F. D. Richards—"May all the presiding Elders of the Districts imitate the spirit of the First Presidency [in their Epistle], and teach the Saints not to slacken their diligence with regard to this matter [namely the Perpetual Emigrating Fund] this coming summer, and we will dare to prophesy, that we can begin, early in 1852, to send away the poor Saints, by the hundreds, yea, by the shipload or the shiploads, by means of the Perpetual Emigrating Fund, which will cause great joy throughout all the churches."

TO THE BRANCHES.—We wish to notify the Branches that one issue of every twenty can be given as profit for selling the TRUMPET this year, because of the lowering of its price. One number of every ten of the "Doctrine and Covenants" will be given as profit. Of course, profit will be granted to the District distributors also.

DOC. AND COV.—No. 1 is out now; and if the body of the Saints wish, it will be published every week, instead of every fortnight, for a penny and a half each; let us know.

PAYMENTS FROM FEB. 6 TO FEB. 20.—Monmouthshire, £1; Cardiganshire, £1 9s; West Glamorgan, £7 13s 9c; Cardiff, £1 1s; Aberdare, £1 10s 6c; Georgetown, £1; Merthyr £1; Cefn, 10s 10½c.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 5.]

MARCH 8, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

TO THE CHRISTIANS OF WALES.

DEAR COMPATRIOTS,—It has been about six or seven years since the Latter-day Saints, or the Mormons, appeared in your country; and from then until now, you have heard a lot about us as a denomination; you have read our writings, and have heard our preaching, and through that you have come to know quite a lot about us. What would you say, if we were now to ask you a few questions? First, then, why would you not believe the testimony that we have testified to you continually? Have we not said to you, as Christ said to Nicodemus, “Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God?” and also, “If any man will do the will of God, he may know of the doctrine,” namely the teaching that we have given you in the name of Jesus Christ? Remember that it was not to the kingdom of God the thief on the cross went, rather to “paradise;” for the kingdom of God was nearer than paradise, for it was among the Jews in the land of Canaan.

Second, we ask you, since you profess to believe the scriptures, why would you not “prove all things, and hold fast that which is good?” You know that you have not proven our doctrine as you have been requested; you are more fearful of angering your neighbors, than you are of angering God. If you ever go to hear

the Saints, you are more fearful that your fellow members will see you, than you are for the Almighty to see you. Is this not true for many of you?

Third, why will you not receive your light from us? Do you not know that you are in darkness? If you were in the light, many of you would not say, "Let them be; if the Saints are of God, they will succeed." That was the speech of the children of the darkness in the former days also. All who are in the light see, and walk in the right path; while the children of the darkness boast of being on the paths of blind leaders, who profess to lead them toward some "river of death," where they can, after crossing it, know where they are.

Fourth, why would you not enjoy having certainty about religion, instead of living continually in hope and belief, while sure knowledge is available? Remember that it is not only in word that the gospel comes to us, rather "in great strength and certainty, and in the Holy Ghost." "Whoever becomes my disciple," says Jesus Christ, and we also, "he will know of the doctrine."

Fifth, why not take hold of the root of the matter, or the substance, after praying so much about it? You are at present living in the shadow of what you have seen in the New Testament. Your forebears, like the dog in the story, were so foolish once as to let go of the substance, in order to have the shadow, and by so doing they lost the substance; and after that, people have gone after the shadow. Instead of the substantive gift of the Holy Ghost, which is the root of the matter, many now choose only its shadow; they prefer a spirit without substance, mute, and incomprehensible, than that Spirit that gives "manifestation" and comfort, filling the temples of the Saints, so they may know that they are children of God.

Sixth, why would you not want to have the spiritual gifts, which are divided severally as God wills? Are you too wise to receive the word of wisdom and knowledge, together with faith; or too healthy, to receive the gift of healing; too almighty, to be in need of miracles; or too aware to be in need of prophecy or discernment of spirits; or too learned, to be in need of divers kinds of tongues and the interpretation of tongues? Now, God wishes to impart all these gifts to you, and you are so foolish as to refuse them, because you are dreaming that "that which is in part" has ended, and that "that

which is perfect” has come. Remember that perfection is not to come, “until we ALL come in the unity of the faith.”

Seventh, why do you not believe that there is as much need for apostles and prophets in the church presently, and there is need for teachers and deacons in it? What did the apostles and prophets of old do, that there is not so much need for them to do the same work now? Teachers and deacons, by themselves, are not capable of “perfecting the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ;” no, apostles and prophets were also given to assist them and instruct them, until the church becomes a “perfect man.” See Eph. iv, 11—13. It is a pity that the sectarians do not wish to have apostles, so that all could know them; for each sect would need twelve, or all sects could have twelve among them! and where one would serve two or three of the sects, he should possess two or three beliefs!

Eighth, why do you cling to “a form of godliness, and deny its power?” It would be better for you to receive the gospel in its power, than to receive something similar to it. You need to have food for yourselves, instead of looking at a portrayal of others in the scriptures eating in former times; that will never satisfy your hunger. The body of Christ is to be constantly increasing; and before it can increase, it must constantly have food.

Ninth, and last, why are you ever learning, and never coming to a knowledge of the truth? Your preachers have been learning throughout their lives, and are yet as far as ever from getting hold of that truth that the illiterate fishermen of Galilee got without learning anything. They received the truth like a child, and better for your teachers and for you to receive it in the same way. The truth is to be had from the servants of God, in the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints; and if you believe their witness, by receiving baptism for the remission of sins, you shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost, which jointly testifies with your spirit that you are children of God.

Now, dear fellow countrymen, ask yourselves, and ponder on the foregoing things. The Lord will remove all darkness from your minds, at once when he sees that you are desirous of possessing the truth.

COUNSELS TO THE PRESIDENTS OF DISTRICTS AND BRANCHES.

14, *Castle street, Merthyr Tydfil*, Feb. 26, 1851.

DEAR BRETHREN,—Be desirous of teaching to the churches all the counsel that comes out (for it will be to your blessing), and be sure to see that all counsel is carried to each branch, to every district, and to every member; and whosoever obeys the counsels that come out will be enlightened by the Holy Ghost; and whosoever disregards or neglects such counsels, will be disregarded in return by God, and they will lose the Spirit and go out of the church as false witnesses. May you be unshakeable men, in carrying out your calling, and then will your election be made sure: and you will learn to respect the priesthood in these latter days; and the respect that is requested, is voluntary obedience. Do not allow one elder or priest to go out to preach, unless he possesses the Holy Ghost; for no one can preach the gospel without having the Holy Ghost; and if someone has not the Spirit, the religious world has as good a gospel as does he: Take care that no one hold office in this church, unless the Holy Ghost is in his possession. If you discover a branch president, or his counselors, or even a district president, who are destitute of the above gift, change them, and put men in their place who are full of the Spirit; for a teacher or deacon is more appropriate to lead than a withered elder: a bad president is a curse to the position. It is a strange thing to some, perhaps, why some old officers and Saints, are worse than the young ones. The reason they are worse, is that they have lost the Spirit. They are like two kinds of mice, small and large, who can do great damage in houses and neighborhoods when there are no cats nearby. You know that the oldest and biggest are those which do the most damage; but whenever some cat comes near, there are the two kinds in their holes in fright; and the large ones are more afraid than the small ones, because their knowledge is greater. Sometimes, quivering, a large one says to a small one, “Go to the mouth of the hole and look around to see where the cats are;” and thus many of the small ones are caught, and occasionally one of the large ones, when he happens to come out to plunder. Dear brethren, pray for the guidance of the Spirit to clarify this parable to you.

I counsel you to put the Perpetual Emigrating Fund in force in every branch, and to send here the amount that is collected in each branch, together with the name of the treasurer of each branch, and also the treasurer of the district, every quarter, namely on the 24th of March, the 24th of June, the 24th of September, and the 24th of December; and I expect this counsel to be observed, so that I can send the total amount to Liverpool by the appointed time; and when you send the money and the accounting here, do not send anything else mixed in. Also, from now on, send the reports of your districts to me, and everything else, except that which pertains to the Welsh books; and I would love to hear from you more frequently. May the God of heaven bless you to fulfill these counsels, because for that purpose has God given to you the priesthood; and receive this small epistle from

Your obedient servant,

WILLIAM PHILLIPS.

[The reason that some errors about money have been made, is, because things have been sent in a mixed manner. President Phillips and I live a little distance from each other, and it would require an errand boy or two to carry the mixed letters from one to the other; therefore, please send them to us separately.—ED.]

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMELY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[*Continued from page 67.*]

TESTAMENT OF LEVI.

Made to his children at his death, concerning Priesthood.

Here clearly is Levi's testimony,
Giving an account of his calling;
He was the first priest,
He shows who is the last.

THE copy of Levi's words, namely which he spake to his children, concerning all the things which they should do, and which would happen unto them until the day of judgment; he was in health when he called them unto him, for he knew before when he should die; so when they were come together he said unto them,

I, Levi, was bred and born in Caran, and afterwards came with my father into Shechem; I was at that time but about twenty years

old, when I helped my brother Simeon to revenge our sister Dinah against Hamor.

And now, as we were feeding our flocks in Abelmuel, the spirit of the understanding of the Lord came upon me, and I saw all men undermining their own ways, and how unrighteousness had builded herself a fortress, and wickedness sat upon the throne thereof. And I was sorry for mankind, and besought the Lord to save them: then there fell a sleep upon me and I saw a very high mountain, namely the mountain of Aspys in Abelmuel; and behold the heavens opened, and the angel of God said unto me, Levi, come hither; and I went from the first heaven to the second, and there saw the water hanging between the one and the other; and I saw the third heaven, much brighter than them both, for the height thereof was infinite; and I said to the angel, What meaneth this? And the angel answered me, Marvel not at these things, for thou shalt see four heavens yet brighter, and without comparison, when thou cometh up to them; for thou shalt stand by the Lord, and be his minister, and utter his secrets unto men, and preach of the Deliverer of Israel, which is to come; by thee and by Judah the Lord will appear to men to save all mankind in them, and thy life shall depend upon the Lord; by him shalt thou have thy fields, vineyards, fruits, gold, and silver. Therefore, hearken as touching the seven heavens.

The lowest is most impure, because it is nearest to all the unrighteousness of men.

The second hath fire, snow, and ice, prepared by the Lord's appointment against the day of God's rightful judgment; in it are all the spirits of vengeance for the punishing of the wicked.

In the third are the power of hosts, ordained against the day of judgment, to take vengeance upon the spirits of error and Belial.

In the fourth above these, are the saints; for in the higher places dwelleth great Glory in the holy of all holies above all holiness.

In the next unto this are the angels, that do serve in God's presence, and seek his favor in all the ignorance of the righteous; they offer to the Lord the sweet savor of a reasonable service, and sacrifice without blood.

In the other, that is under this, are the angels that bring answers from the angels in God's presence.

In that which is above it are the thrones and potentates, wherein is continual offering up of hymns unto God.

Therefore, whensoever the Lord looketh upon us, all are moved; yea, and heaven, earth, and the bottomless deep are moved at the sight of his greatness; but the children of men being witless shall sin and provoke the highest unto wrath: now, therefore, understand that the Lord will execute judgment upon the children of men; because that men will still continue in unbelief and unrighteousness, even when

the stones shall cleave asunder, the sun be darkened, the waters dried up, the fire quake, and all creatures be troubled at the fainting of the invisible spirit, and the spoiling of hell in the passion of the Highest; therefore, shall they be condemned to punishment. Then the Highest hath heard thy prayer to separate thee from unrighteousness, and to make thee his son and servant, and a minister in his presence, a lantern of knowledge to lighten Jacob, and thoroughly, to be as a day sun among the children of Israel; and unto thee and thy seed shall the power of blessing be given, till God sift all nations in the bowels of the mercy of his Son forever. Nevertheless, thy sons shall lay their hands upon him, to crucify him, and for this cause is wisdom and understanding given unto thee, to give thy children knowledge of him, because, that if they bless him, they shall be blessed, and they that curse him shall perish in his sight.

And the angel opened me the gates of heaven, and I saw the holy temple, and the Highest sitting on the throne of glory, and he said unto me, Levi, I have given thee the blessings of the priesthood, till I come myself to dwell in the midst of Israel.

Then the angel brought me down to the earth, and gave me a shield and a sword, saying, Execute vengeance in Shechem for Dinah, and I will be with thee, for God hath sent me; and at the time I slew the sons of Hamor, as it is written in the tables of heaven: and I said unto him, I pray thee tell me thy name, that I may call upon thee in the time of my trouble. And he answered, I am the angel which excuseth Israel, that he might be not be stricken forever; because all wicked spirits lie in wait for him.

And afterward being waked as it were out of sleep, I blessed the Most High, and the angel that excuseth the offspring of Israel, and all righteous men. And when I came to my father, I found an asp of brass, whereupon the hill took the name of Aspis, which is near by Gebar, on the right side of Abila: and I laid up these sayings in my heart, and I counseled my father, and my brother Reuben, to persuade the sons of Hamor to be circumcised, because I was zealously grieved for the abomination which they had wrought in Israel, and first of all I killed Shechem, and then Simeon killed Hamor; after this came our brethren, who smote the city with the edge of the sword; and when my father heard of it, he was angry, because they had received circumcision, and were killed afterward; and therefore he dealt otherwise with us in his blessing, for we sinned in doing it against his will, and he fell sick the same day; but I knew then the Lord intended evil to the Shechemites, because they had purposed to have done the like unto Sarah, as they did unto our sister Dinah, but God letted them; they persecuted our father Abraham (as a stranger) and carried away his cattle; and furthermore, they did beat Joblao very sore, who was born in his house; and after the same

manner dealt they with all other strangers, taking away their wives from them by force, and driving the men themselves out of their country; for which cause the wrath of the Lord came upon them in the end. And I said to my father, Sir, be not offended, for God will bring the Canaanites to nothing before thee, and give their land unto thee and unto thy holy seed after thee: for from henceforth Shechem shall be called the city of fools, because that as men do scorn fools, so have we scorned them for their working of folly in Israel, in taking away our sister for to defile her.

Then came we unto Bethel, and there when I had sacrificed threescore and ten days together, I saw the thing again as I had seen it before. And I saw seven men in white raiment, saying unto me, Up, and put on the robe of the priesthood, the crown of righteousness, the reason of understanding, the robe of truth, the breastplate of faith, the mitre of holiness, and the ephod of prophecy. And thus, every one of them bringing something with him, did put them upon me; saying, Be thou henceforth the Lord's priest, thou, and thy seed forevermore.

The first of them anointed me with holy oil, and gave me the sceptre of judgment.

The second washed me with clean water, and fed me with bread and wine, that is, to wit, with the most holy of holies, and clothed me with a glorious robe down to the ground.

The third did put upon me a silken garment, like to an Ephod.

The fourth girded me with a girdle, like to purple.

The fifth gave unto me an olive bough, full of fatness.

The sixth did set the mitre of the priesthood upon my head.

The seventh filled my hands with incense, to the intent I should execute the office of a priest unto the Lord.

And he said unto me, Levi, unto three principal things is thy seed appointed of God, namely, to be a sign of the glorious Lord that is to come; and he that believeth shall be the first, and the great lot shall not fall upon him; the second shall be in priesthood; and the third shall have a new name; a king shall rise up in Judah, and renew my priesthood according unto the figure of the Gentiles, among all nations; but the coming of him is unutterable, namely, Who shall be the prophet of the Highest, born of our father Abraham? "All the pleasant things of Israel shall be given unto thee, and to thy seed, and you shall eat all that is fair to see to; and thy seed shall distribute the Lord's table, and of them shall be high priests, judges, and scribes; for in their mouth shall the holy things be kept."

And when I awoke, I perceived that this vision was like the other, and I laid it up in mine heart, and showed it not unto any man living upon the earth.

The first two days, I and Judah went to our grandfather Isaac,

and he blessed me according to all the sayings of the visions that I had seen. But he would not go with us unto Bethel.

But when we came to Bethel, my father Jacob saw in a vision concerning me, that I should be their priest before the Lord; and he arose in the morning, and tithed all things he possessed to the Lord by me.

Then came we to Hebron to dwell there, and by and by, Isaac called me to expound the law of the Lord, according as God's angel had showed it to me, and he taught me the law of priesthood, sacrifices, burnt offerings, firstlings, freewill offerings and offerings for health; Every day he taught me understanding, and called upon me continually before the Lord, saying My son, give no ear to the spirit of fornication, for he will follow thee and defile the holy things by thy seed; therefore, take thee a wife in thy youth, such an one that hath not any blemish nor uncleanness, nor is of the kindred of the Egyptians, or the Gentiles; and before thou enter into the holies, wash, and likewise ere thou sacrificeth, and also when thou sacrificeth unto the Lord, and also when thou hast done, offer unto the Lord, the fruits of the twelve trees that are ever green, as my father Abraham taught me to do; and the fruit of all clean beasts, and of clean fowl, offer thou in sacrifice; likewise offer up thy first born of all things, and the first fruits of thy wine, and sprinkle thy sacrifices with salt.

Now, therefore, my sons, keep ye all the things that I command you; for whatsoever I have heard of my fathers, that have I told unto you, and I am clean from all the sin, which you shall commit to the end of the world. Ye shall work wickedness against the Savior of the world; and ye shall seduce Israel, stirring up much evil against him from the Lord; by dealing wickedly with him, so that Jerusalem shall not continue, by reason of your naughtiness; the veil of the temple shall be rent in sunder, to discover your foulness; and ye shall be scattered as prisoners amongst the Gentiles; and ye shall be scorned, cursed, and trodden under foot: despite all this, the house which the Lord shall choose, shall be called Jerusalem, as the book of Enoch the righteousness containeth.

Therefore, when I was 28 years old, I took a wife, whose name was Melcha, and she conceived and bare me a son and called his name Gershon, because we were but strangers in our land; for Gershon signifieth banishment: now I knew of him, that he should not be of the chief degree.

The second was Cohath, who was born in the five and thirtieth year of my life: and I saw a vision eastward, how all the congregation stood up aloft; and therefore I called his name Cohath, which signifieth the beginning of greatness and learning.

The third was Merari, who was born in the five and fiftieth year

of my life; and because his mother was hardly delivered of him, she called him Merari, which is as much as to say, my bitterness.

And in the threescore and fourth year of my life, was my daughter Jochebed born in Egypt; and so was I honorable among my brethren.

And there my son Gershon took him a wife, which bare him Lybni and Schimi. The sons of Cohath were Amram, Ishar, Hebron, and Uziel. And the sons of Merai were Mahali, and Mushi.

In the fourscore and fourteenth year of my life, Amram took unto owife my daughter Jochebed, because that he and she were born on the same day.

I was eight years old when I entered into the land of Canaan. And eighteen years old when I entered into the office of the priesthood. At eight and twenty years I took a wife. And at forty years old I entered into Egypt: and behold ye be now my children's children in the third generation. Joseph died in the hundredth and tenth year of his life.

And now, my children, I warn you to fear the Lord your God with all your heart; and walk plainly in all things according to his law. Moreover, bring up your children in learning, that they may have understanding by reading the law of God without ceasing all their life long; for whosoever knoweth God's law, shall be honored; and go wheresoever he will, he shall be no stranger; and he shall have more friends than his forefathers had; and many shall be glad to serve him, and to hear the law at his mouth.

My sons, deal rightfully upon earth, that you may find heaven; and sow good things in your minds, that you may find them in your life; for if ye sow evil things, ye shall reap trouble, and all manner of cumbrance. Get ye wisdom in the fear of God, for if captivity come, and cities and countries be destroyed, gold, and silver, and possessions perish, but none can take away the wise man's wisdom, save only the blindness of ungodliness and sin: for wisdom shall become a shield to him among his enemies, and make a strange country to be as his own home, and cause him to find friendship in the midst of his foes; if he teach, and doeth such things, he shall sit with kings, as did our brother Joseph.

And truly, I know by the writings of Enoch, that in the end ye shall do wickedly, laying your hands most spitefully upon the Lord, and through you, your brethren shall be confounded, and made a laughing stock to all nations: howbeit, Israel is clean from the wickedness of the high priests, which shall lay hands upon the Savior of the world; yes, the heaven above the earth is clean, and you be the lights of the heathen, as the sun and the moon; what shall all the heathen do, if you be overdarkened with wickedness, and bring cursedness upon your country folk, for whose sakes the light

of the world is put into you, to enlighten all men withal: this light of the world shall you most willfully kill, and teach commandments contrary to the righteousness of God.

Ye shall purloin the Lord's offering, and filch away pieces of it.

Before you do your sacrifices unto the Lord, ye shall steal away the choicest things, and eat them disdainfully with harlots and whores, teaching commandments of covetousness.

Ye shall defile married women, and enforce maidens in Jerusalem.

You shall match yourselves with whores and harlots.

And you shall take the daughters of the heathen unto wife, purifying them with unrighteous purifying; and your mingling shall be like unto Sodom and Gomorrah.

And ye shall be swallowed with wickedness in the priesthood, insomuch that you shall most disdainfully and spitefully laugh the holy things to scorn; not only haunting and boasting yourselves against men, but also being puffed and swollen up with pride against the commandments of God.

For this cause, shall the temple which the Lord shall have chosen, be undoubtedly left desolate in uncleanness; and you yourselves become captives to all nations, and be loathed among them, and receive endless shame and reproach through God's rightful judgment: and all that see you shall spurn you. And were it not for Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, there should not one of my seed be left upon earth.

Furthermore I know by the book of Enoch, that ye shall go astray by the space of threescore and ten weeks, and defile the priesthood, and stain the sacrifices, destroy the law, and scorn the sayings of the prophets; and forwardly persecute righteous folk, hate the godly, abhor the sayings of soothfast men; and call him heretic that goeth about to renew the law by the power of the Highest, and in the end ye shall kill him out of hand, not knowing that he shall rise again; and so shall ye receive his innocent blood willfully upon your own heads; for his sake shall your holy places be left desolate, which you shall have defiled even by utter forswearing, and your dwelling shall not be clean, but you shall be accursed among the heathen and despair shall tire you, till he visit you again, and mercifully receive you through faith and water.

And forasmuch as ye have heard of the threescore and ten weeks, hear ye also of the priesthood; for in every Jubilee, joyful emancipation, shall be priesthood.

In the first Jubilee, the first anointed into the priesthood shall be great, and talk to God as to his father; and his priesthood shall be full of the fear of the Lord, and in the day of his gladness, he shall rise up unto the salvation of the world.

In the second Jubilee, the anointed shall be conceived in the heaviness of the beloved sort, and his priesthood shall be honorable,

and he shall be honorable, and he shall be glorified as amongst all men.

The third priest shall be taken up in sorrow.

And the fourth shall be in grief, because the multitude of iniquities shall be laid upon him, and throughout all Israel every man shall hate his neighbor.

The fifth shall be held fast in darkness; and likewise the sixth and the seventh.

And in the seventh shall be such abomination both before God and man, as I am not able to express; howbeit, that the doers thereof shall not be known: for this cause shall they be in captivity and corruption, and their land and substance shall be destroyed.

But in the fifth week, they shall return into their desolate country, and renew the Lord's house.

And in the seventh week shall come idolatrous priests, covetous warriors, unrighteous scribes, and filthy abusers of men, children, and beasts.

After that the Lord hath sent vengeance upon them in the priesthood, then will God raise up a new Priest, unto whom all the Lord's word shall be opened: and he shall execute true judgment upon earth, many days: and his star shall arise in heaven.

As a king he shall shed forth the light of knowledge in the clear shining, like the sun of the day; and he shall be magnified over all the world, and be received; he shall shine as a sun upon the earth; in his days the heavens shall rejoice, the earth shall be glad, the clouds shall be merry, the knowledge of the Lord shall be poured out upon the earth as the waters of the seas; and the angels of glory, that are in the Lord's presence, shall rejoice in him, and the heavens shall be opened, and out of the temple of glory shall sanctification come upon him, with the father's voice (as from Abraham, the father of Isaac), and the glory of the Highest shall be spread out upon him, and the spirit of understanding and sanctification shall rest upon him, whereof he shall give abundantly and mightily to his children in truth forevermore; and there shall none succeed him from generation to generation, until the end of the world. In his priesthood all sin shall come to an end, and the unrighteous shall cease from their naughtiness, but the righteous shall rest in him, and he shall open the gates of Paradise, and he shall stay the threatening sword against Adam; and feed the lambs with the fruit of life, and the spirit of holiness shall be in them; he shall bind up Belial, and give his own children power to tread down hurtful spirits; and the Lord shall rejoice in his children, and accept them as his beloved forevermore. Then Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob be glad, and then shall I and all Saints rejoice.

Now, my children, ye have heard all: therefore, choose you either

light or darkness, either the law of the Lord, or the works of Belial.

And they answered their father, saying, We will walk before the Lord according to his law.

Then Levi said, the Lord is witness, and his angels and I are witnesses, and you yourselves are witnesses of the words of my mouth.

And when they had answered, they said, We will be witnesses.

Having given this charge to his children, Levi rested, and stretched out his feet, and was put to his fathers, when he had lived 137 years; and they laid him in a coffin, and buried him afterward in Hebron, beside Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

(*To be continued.*)

CONVERSATION BETWEEN WESLEY AND A SAINT.

WESLEY.

WHAT is the reason—O say the truth,
For you to leave the *Wesleys*, godly men on earth,
And go to the lying graceless *Saints*,—
Everyone persecutes them, and hates them.

SAINT.

The truth, sir, I shall answer, the reason why,
I was not willing for the Bible to be wronged;
And that is the reason for my going to the *Saints*,—
You would be blessed were you to choose the honor!

WESLEY.

The honor you said? oh, fie, don't be a fool,
There has been no need for miracles since the days of St. Paul;
Therefore, why do you claim that you enjoy
The true gifts of the Spirit, which are false.

SAINT.

Go slowly a little, your assertion is bare,
I have *knowledge* of the church of our God;
I know that his gifts continue on the same;
All who come to it, can themselves know.

WESLEY.

Jesus did not mean for them to continue,
But quite the contrary, say the Rabbis of our age;
I shall not believe otherwise as long as I am in the world,
Despite constant offers to prove their existence.

SAINT.

Do you remember that serpent who was
 In Eden perverting the true words of our God?
 I suppose that you are similar to him;
 Keep in mind finally, that the judgment is yet to come;

Therefore, put aside listening to each one
 Who denies the scripture of the great God himself;
 And come without delay into the church of the Son of
 God,
 You shall receive knowledge—it is all truth.

Garnddiffaeth.

ISAAC REES.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

SILLINESS.—The following is a quotation from a treatise on Papism and the Bible, by the Rev. E. Davies, Newmarket (Independent):—"And worse, or lower than the Papists are the Mormons—they choose to call themselves 'Latter-day Saints.' I understand that hundreds of Welsh, have chosen Mormonism, to their mortal and eternal destruction! Joe Smith, America, its founder—the 'Mormon book,' visions and imaginations, instead of the word of God—fake miracles and fables to charm and deceive the country—they say that God the Father has a body like a creature—they are Idol worshipers, of the worst and ugliest kind! The most worthless men—too lazy to work, the most unlearned, bold and impudent, go across the country, and by telling lies, promising to work miracles, and they claim that if men will be immersed, they will be born again after coming out of the water, and receive visions from heaven, &c. * * * Papism is a thousand times better than Mormonism."

LAYING ON OF HANDS.—Hear what is being said in the biography of the Rev. W. R. Davies, Dowlais, in the "Star of Gomer" for Feb., 1851, page 57:—"That which is called 'placement,' or 'laying on of hands,' was in high regard in Dowlais when he went there—it was an important aspect in the views of their faith; but he did not think much of the practice, and he succeeded in *praying* it out of the church. When he placed his hands on the head of the baptized, he prayed as follows:—'Lord, bless this brother (or this sister), and forgive us for doing things like this in order *to please ourselves*, knowing that we are acting completely contrary to the rule of thy word, for Jesus Christ. Amen.'"

A SPLENDID skill is for man to know that he is good; and splendid bravery is for him to know the way to humility.

MOVED.—Our letters and our press have been moved to the State House, where we wish for our printers to remain undisturbed, and *no one is to come in*. All business can be transacted, regarding the paper and the printing, with Thomas Bullock in the Post Office, or with the Editor in his room, the first door to the southwest of the State House.—*Deseret News*, August 31, 1850.

REWARDING DRUNKENNESS.—“Please give me a little pipe for my father,” said some tattered lad to a tavern keeper. “We cannot give you one, and we don’t even know him,” said he. “Well, he gets drunk here every Saturday night,” responded the lad. “Oh, does he, my boy?” said the tavern keeper; “well, here’s a fine, long pipe for him, my boy, and a bit of wax for its head.”

WOMEN OF FEW WORDS.—A woman was asked in the gold mines, how long she had been mining there, and how much she was paid per day? The answer was, “Three weeks and one ounce.” Another time, a girl was returning from market, and a gentleman asked her what was the depth of the river, and how much she received for the butter? “Up to the knee and nine pence,” said she.—Reader, if you want a wife, get one like that, as did the gentleman of that girl, with whom he lived happily.

REMEMBER not to talk about yourself except as infrequently as possible. If you praise yourself, it is but pride; if you blame yourself, it is but foolishness.

CHAPEL OPENING—The chapel of the Tabernacle, in Hirwaun, was opened for the services of the Latter-day Saints, Sunday, the second of this month, where Elder Phillips, Davis, Jones, and others, preached to a large congregation. A good influence was left behind in the place, and we hope that a great work will be accomplished. Chapels are more easily obtained by us now, than were rooms when we began.

J. H. FLANIGAN.—We report the death of the faithful Elder Flanigan, who was president of the Birmingham district, on the 29th of last January, of smallpox. He was honorably buried on the 31st.

WISDOM, virtue, and courage, are possessed of a natural right to govern; only he who has the most wisdom to know what is just, the most virtue to adhere to, and the most courage to put them into operation, should command others.

CAUGHT IN THE MIDDLE.—If I perform one of the ordinances of the church (at the request of a brother or sister), within the presidency of a branch to which I do not belong, and without permission, I am breaking the rule; and if I do not do so, the person will be angry with me; but despite that, I prefer to please God by keeping the rule, than to please men by breaking it.—T. H.

GOOD WORD.—A good word is like a fire after it is lit,—you can easily keep it going; but once you let it go out, you cannot easily light it again; at least it will be a long time before you can get it as bright as it was before.

EPITAPH OF AN ENEMY OF THE SAINTS.

I told great lies, over long years,
Of the Mormon religion, but my work was in vain;
I proclaimed, yes, its burial,—of its grave I drew a picture,
And after digging it, I fell right into it myself! T. H.

CONFERENCES.—A Conference will be held in Merthyr on the 6th of April, and a tea party the following afternoon; in Tredegar, Monmouthshire, on the 13th; in Swansea, on the 20th; in Llanelli, Carmarthenshire, on the 27th; and in Cardiganshire, on the 4th of May.

“H. E—s.”—Your subscribing to six of every number of the “Doctrine and Covenants,” for yourself, shows considerable goodness on your part. It would be good for all who intend to emigrate soon, if they can, to buy some extra copies, and bind them, so they can sell them, for a good price, to the Welsh in America.

“E. D.”—You should get the man’s own testimony, and not say something second hand.

 We would like information soon as to whether or not you wish for us to publish the “Doctrine and Covenants” each week. The majority of the branches have already indicated their willingness to do so. We still await an answer from the others, before deciding anything. The sooner it is finished the better. Where poverty is feared, God requires no contribution.—Payment for this book, is the same as for other books, which some fail to understand.

 We received a letter from Elder Wm. Howells, from Liverpool, reporting that he intends to emigrate on the 3rd of March, on the ship Olympus, containing 225 English Saints, which were presented to his care. Brother Henshaw went away on the same ship.

 We intend to publish the treatise of O. Pratt, on the “Great First Cause,” in Welsh, without delay, price 2c.

PAYMENTS FROM FEB. 20 TO MARCH 6.—Pontytypridd, £1 7s; Cwmbach, £1 2s; Dowlais, 6s 4c; Cwmnedd, 2s 6c; Georgetown, £1; Cefn, 5s 9c.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to “*John Davis, Printer, John’s Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*”

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 6.]

MARCH 22, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

CONDITION OF THE SAINTS ON THE CONTINENT.

THE work of God on the continent is going forward quite well. Elders J. Taylor and Lorenzo Snow are on a visit to Liverpool at present, and through them much news from the continent is being received. Elder Taylor was thinking of returning to the Valley this season; but he could not be satisfied with going home, without first seeing the Book of Mormon published also in German, as well as in French, together with seeing the Church established in some corner of that country, namely Germany. An additional number have been baptized in France, with good prospects for yet more. Erastus Snow writes from Copenhagen (Denmark), dated February 19, that half the Book of Mormon is in print, and he believes that the other half will be around May; he says that the elders there are meeting with plenty of opposition to keep things lively, and that about two hundred have been baptized, among which there were two brothers from Iceland, who were about to take the gospel to the land of their birth.

Elder Lorenzo Snow has succeeded in publishing two pamphlets in Piedmont, Italy, which are being diligently distributed by Elder Woodard in that community, and by Elder Stenhouse in Switzerland. In Piedmont, on the 24th of February, brother Woodard baptized two young men, and the next morning he baptized ten others, who are all strong in the faith, and send their greetings to the British Saints. Their greetings are as follows:—"1.

Let us meet together when the earth is renewed. 2. Pray for a young sister who desires to grow in grace. 3. Absent in the body, but one in the spirit. 4. Hallelujah, the Lord remembered his people. 5. If we do not meet in these bodies, let us embrace one another in the resurrection. [An old brother 62 years old.] 6. In the midst of weakness, I hope for strength. 7. Pray for a poor brother. 8. May we be crowned with glory when the world is judged." The other brothers and sisters send the following:—"We thank our heavenly Father that we have begun to walk on the way to a new and endless life."

The spirit of inquiry is continually on the increase. Many thought that the labor spent in that country would be in vain; but that is not how it went. Brother Snow is determined to establish the Church of Christ in those countries on a solid foundation, namely the rock of revelation. He is about to begin to translate and publish the Book of Mormon in the Italian language, and he intends to finish it without delay. After this book is once published in the Danish, Italian, French, and German languages, and the Church is established among these various countries, the people who inhabit the western side of this eastern continent will be informed of the doctrines of the gospel, as was explained by the Prophet Joseph, in their own languages.

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMELY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[*Continued from page 81.*]

TESTAMENT OF JUDAH,

*Made to his children at his death, concerning Valiantness, Covetousness,
and Fornication.*

Brave, remarkable Judah's advice,
Is to keep away from avarice,
Drunkenness, wantonness, and prostitution,
Because this kills the strongest.

THE COPY of all the sayings of Judah, which he spake unto his children at the time of his death; when they were come together before him he said unto them, I was my father's fourth son, and my mother called me Judah, saying, I thank the Lord for that he hath

given me a fourth son.

I was swift of foot and diligent in my youth, and obeyed my father in all things, and blessed my mother and my mother and her sisters: and when I came unto man's estate, my father Jacob prayed over me, saying, Thou shalt be a king and prosperous in all things. Behold, God gave me grace in all my works both abroad, and at home.

Upon a time I saw a hind, and ran after her, and caught her and made good meat of her for my father.

Also I outran the roes, and overtook all things in the fields, insomuch that I caught a wild mare, and tamed her.

I plucked a kid out of the mouth of a bear, and taking him by the paw, overthrew him.

I rent asunder all wild beasts that turned upon me, as if I had been a dog.

I encountered with a wild boar, and overrunning him, tare him in pieces.

And in Hebron, a lion leapt upon a dog, and I catching him by the tail, flung him away by and by, and he broke asunder.

In the borders of Gath, a wild bull was feeding in the fields, and I took him up by the horns and swunged him about, and finally killed him.

There came two kings of the Canaanites armed upon our flock, and much people with them; and I alone, running unto the flock, stepped to king Sur, and striking up his legs, overthrew him, and so slew him.

Also I killed another king named Thapes, sitting on his horse, and so scattered all their people.

I overtook king Achor, the giant, on horseback shooting forward and backward, and throwing a stone of twoscore pound weight upon his horse, I overthrew him and killed him; and fighting two hours with Achor, at length I clave his shield and maimed his feet and finally slew him; as I was pulling off his breastplate, behold eight of his friends assailed me; whereupon, I filled my hands with stones and flinging them at them with a sling, slew four of them, and put the other four to flight.

Also our father Jacob slew the giant Beelisa king of all the kings, who was mighty and huge, of the stature of twelve cubits: by reason whereof fear fell upon them, and they left their fighting against us.

For this cause, my father was careful of me when I was in battle with my brethren: he saw in a vision concerning me; that the angel of strength followed me everywhere to the intent I should not be overcome.

The second handsel was a greater battle to us than that which

we had at Shechem; insomuch that in fighting valiantly with my brethren I chased a thousand men, and slew of them two hundred persons and four of their kings, and following after them, scaled the walls of their city, and there slew two kings more; and so we delivered Hebron, and led them all away as prisoners.

Then the next day we went to a strong, walled, unapproachable city, called Areca, which threatened to kill us, but I and Gad went to the east side of the city, and Reuben and Levi unto the west and south side, and they that stood upon the walls, supposing there had been no more but Gad and me, did set fire upon us, while in the meantime my brother, that lay secretly in wait, brake out upon the other two sides of them, and scaling the walls with ladders, we won the city from our enemies, and thus we won it by the sword, and set fire upon the tower, and burnt it up with such as were fled into it.

As we returned, the men of Thaffie lay in wait for our prey, and took it with our children, but we followed them to Thaffie and slew them, and burned their city, spoiling all that was in it.

And while I was at the waters of Gureba, we fell upon the men of Jobel, that came against us in battle, and slew and spoiled both them, and also their accomplices, that came to their aid from Selon, so as we gave them no respite to return again upon us.

The fifth day after there came men from Machir to fetch away our prisoners, whom we met in battle, notwithstanding that they were a mighty host, and slew them before they could get up to the place that they came from; and when we came to their city, their women tumbled down stones upon us from the top of the hill, whereon their city stood, but I and Simeon coasting to the back side of the town, got unto the higher places and destroyed the whole city.

The next day it was told us that two kings and their entire cities, came against us, with a huge host; I therefore and Dan feigning ourselves to be Amortheans, and fellows with them, went into their city, and taking the entrances in the dead time of the night, did set the gates wide open to our brethren that came after us, by means whereof we destroyed them and all that they had; and when we had sacked the city, we did cast down the three walls thereof.

Then went we to Thamus, which was the refuge of all the kings for their wars; where being angry for a hurt that I took, I charged upon those that stood above me, but they threw down stones out of slings upon me, and shot arrows at me, and had killed me but that my brother Dan rescued me; therefore, we came running upon them in a rage, and put them all to flight, and they passing by another way went to my father, and humbly sued for peace, and he made a covenant with them, so as we did them not any more harm; but we received

them into league with us, and delivered them all their prisoners. I then builded Chamma, and my father builded Rambahel.

Twenty years old was I when this war was made; and the Canaanites were afraid of me, and my brethren.

And I had much cattle; and my chief herdsman was Yran of Ocellam, in whose company I saw Bersa king of Odelam, who made us a feast, and with much intreatance, gave me his daughter Berthusa to wife, which brought me forth Er, Onan, and Selah; but two of these three God slew childless; and Selah lived, of whom some of you be the children.

But my father and we made eighteen years of peace with his brother Esau and his children. And when the eighteen years were past, after our coming out of Mesopotamia, in the fortieth year of my life, Esau our father's brother came upon us with a great, strong host, but he was slain by the bow of Jacob, and conveyed away dead unto mount Seir; we also followed upon the children of Esau, but his city was very strong with high walls, and gates of Iron and brass so as we could not enter into it; howbeit we did shut them up within it, and besieged it. Now when they showed not themselves abroad in twenty days together, I put my helmet upon my head and in the sight of them all set up a ladder, and scaling the walls, slew four of their noble men with a stone of the weight of three talents; the next day Reuben and Gad went and slew threescore others; then they offered peace, and we by our father's advice, received them into tribute, and they gave us two hundred quarters of corn, five hundred vats of oil, and a thousand and five hundred measures of wine; until we went down into Egypt.

After this my son Er married Tamar, of Mesopotamia, the daughter of Aram; but Er was a very wicked imp, and doubted much of Tamar, because she was not of the land of Canaan: therefore, the angel of the Lord slew him the third night after his marriage, when he had not yet accompanied with her, by reason of his mother's subtlety, and so died in his naughtiness, for he was loathe that he should have had any children by her.

But when Onan was marriageable, I gave Tamar unto him; and he likewise of a spite accompanied not with her, notwithstanding he lived two full years with her, and when I threatened him, then he companied with her; but yet by his mother's commandment he let his seed fall upon the ground, and so also he died in his wickedness.

I minded to have given her unto Selah also, but my wife Bethusa would not suffer me, for she spited Tamar, because she was not of the daughters of Canaan as herself was.

Now I knew the offspring of Canaan was mischievous; but yet

did youthful fancy blind my heart, and as I beheld her pouring out wine, I was deceived with drunkenness, and fell in love with her.

Upon a time while I was away, she married Selah to a woman of Canaan: which her deed when I understood, I cursed her in the bitterness of my soul, and so she died in the wickedness of her sons.

At two years after these things, as I went to shear my sheep, Tamar decking herself like a bride, set her down at the gate of the city; for it was the custom of the Amorites, that their brides do set themselves forth at the gates of their cities, by the space of 7 days together, to be abused by fornication; I therefore being drunken with the waters of Horeb, knew her not, by reason of wine, insomuch that her beauty together with the attire in decking of herself deceived me, and thereupon, turning aside unto her, I said, Shall I come in unto thee? And she answered, What wilt thou give me? And I gave her my staff, and my girdle, and the crown of my kingdom; upon my company with her, she conceived: afterward, I not knowing myself to have been the doer thereof, would have put her to death for it, but she having kept my pledges in store, shamed me with them; and when I had heard my own words of her in secret, which I had spoken to her when I lay with her in my drunkenness, I could not put her to death, because it was of the Lord's doing; but I touched her not any more to my dying day; for when I had done this abomination in Israel, lest she might work wiles with me, I said I would fetch my pledges again of her; but when I enquired for her, the townsmen said there was no bride in the city, because she came from another place, and had sat there but a little while, and she deemed that no man knew of my going in unto her.

Afterward we came into Egypt to Joseph, because of the dearth: I was six and forty years old when I came hither, and threescore and thirteen years have I lived here.

And now, my sons, hear me your father in all things that I charge you withal, and keep you all my sayings, in doing all manner of righteousness before the Lord, and in obeying the commandments of the Lord God, and walk not after your own lusts, nor after conceits of your own minds, in the pride of your hearts; neither glory in the works of the strength of your youth, because it is sinful in the sight of the Lord.

For inasmuch as I gloried in my battles, and upbraided my brother Reuben with Bilhahh, my father's wife, because no face of any beautiful woman had yet deceived me; therefore, the spirit of fondness and fornication fell upon me, so that I was overtaken both in Bethsue, the Canaanite, and in Tamar, the wife of my own son's.

And I said unto my father-in-law, I have made my father privy to

the matter, and therefore I will take thy daughter to my wife.

Hereupon he showed me an infinite mass of gold in his daughter's behalf; for he was a king; and decking her with gold, and pearls, willed her to pour out wine to us at the supper.

The beauty of the woman, and the wine together, dazzled mine eyes, and voluptuousness did so darken mine understanding, that I fell in love with her, and brake the commandment of the God of my fathers, and took her to wife, according to the intent of my heart. But the Lord paid me home for that: for I had no joy of the children that I had by her.

Now, therefore, my children, be not drunken with wine, for wine turneth a man's understanding away from the truth, and kindleth in him the fire of lust, leading his eyes into error; inasmuch as wine is a servant of the spirit of lechery, to further the feeding of the mind with voluptuousness, and so these twain bereave a man of all power: for if a man drink wine till he be drunken, he traineth his mind unto the filthy thoughts of lechery, and kindleth the body to carnal copulation; and if desired occasion is obtained, sin is wrought without shame: such a thing is wine, my sons, for a drunken man is ashamed of nothing.

Behold, it made both me and Tamar do amiss, so as I blushed not at the multitude in the city, but went aside unto her in the sight of all men, and committed a great sin in discovering the unclean privities of my own sons.

Through drinking wine I was not ashamed to break God's commandment, in taking a woman of Canaan to wife.

Wherefore, my sons, he that drinketh wine had need of discretion, and the discretion that every man ought to use in drinking of wine is that he be ashamed to overdrink himself; for if he pass that bound, he forgetteth his understanding, and cleaveth to the spirit of error which causeth the drunken man to talk filthily, and to do wickedly and not to be ashamed, but to boast of his lewdness, thinking it to be good.

He that committeth whoredom, is bereft of his liberty, and becometh a bonds slave of lechery, and cannot get out of it again, after the same manner that I was made naked: for I gave over my staff, that is to say, the mainstay of my tribe; and my girdle, that is, my power; and my crown, that is, the glory of my kingdom. Howbeit repenting these things, I forbore all wine and flesh unto mine old age, and was utterly unacquainted with all mirth.

And the angel of God showed me, that women should from time to time overmaster all men, as well kings as captives, and bereave great men of their glory; for the poverty of a poor man is a greater

fence to him than is the strength of a mighty man.

Therefore, my children, keep measure in drinking, for there are in it four poison spirits, that is to wit, of Concupiscence, of Heartburning, of Lechery, and Filthy gain.

If ye drink wine merrily, in the fear of the Lord, with shamefastness, ye shall live: but if ye drink without regard of shame and fear of God, then ye turneth it to drunkenness, and dishonestly stealeth in.

And if ye drink none at all, then shall ye not sin, neither in slanderous words, nor in quarrelling, nor in railing, nor in breach of God's commandments, neither shall ye perish before your time: for wine discloseth the secrets of God and man unto strangers, like as I revealed the secrets of God and of my father Jacob to Bethsue the Canaanite, which God hath forbidden to be disclosed. Also wine is a cause of war and sedition.

Moreover, my sons, I charge you love not money, nor look upon the beauty of women; for money and womanly beauty made me to overshoot myself in Bethsue the Canaanite. And I am sure that these two things shall corrupt mine offspring, and mar the wise men of my lineage, and hurt the kingdom of Judah, which God hath given me for obeying my father; for I never repined at my father Jacob's commandments, but did whatsoever he willed me.

And Abraham, the father of my fathers, blessed me to fight for Israel and so he did bless me likewise: and I know that the kingdom shall stand by me.

But I read in the book of Enoch the righteous, that ye shall work wickedness in the latter days.

Therefore, my children, keep yourselves from lechery and covetousness and give ear unto your father Judah; for those things withdraw men from God's law, and blind the understanding of their minds, and teach them a pride; neither suffer they any man to show mercy to his neighbor: they bereave his soul of all good things, and hold it down in pains and sorrows; also they disappoint him of his rest and sleep and consume his flesh: finally, they hinder God's sacrifices, neglect his blessings; disobey the speaking of the prophets, and are offended at the word of godliness; for these two passions are contrary to the commandments of God; and he that serveth them, cannot obey God, because they dazzle men's minds, and walk abroad as well at nights as of days.

My children, covetousness leadeth men to idolatry. For through doting upon money, he calleth them gods, which are not, and compelleth the infected to grow most vilely out of kind money's sake I lost my children, and had it not been for the penance of the

flesh, and the humiliation of my body and my soul, and had not the prayers of my father been, I had died as now without children. But the God of my fathers, being merciful, and full of pity and compassion, knew that I sinned through ignorance, for the prince of error had blinded me, and I overshot myself, as a fleshly man, and being corrupted with sin, knew not mine own infirmity, but thought myself to be invincible.

Know ye therefore my sons, that two spirits do wait upon a man, that is to wit, the spirit of truth, and the spirit of error; and in the midst between them is set the spirit of understanding of the mind, whose property is to incline which way it listeth. The things that belong both to truth and untruth are written in the breast of man, and God knoweth every whit of it, and none of all men's works can be hidden at any time from him, because all the privities and secrets of men's hearts are written before the Lord, and the spirit of truth beareth witness of all things; and accuseth all, and he that sineth hath a burning in his heart, and cannot lift up his face to his Judge.

And now my children, love ye Levi, that ye may abide, and exalt not yourselves above him, lest ye perish. The Lord hath given unto me the kingdom, and unto Levi the priesthood, and hath put the kingdom under the priesthood. Unto me he hath given the things that are upon the earth, and unto him the things that are in heaven. As far as the heaven surmounteth the earth, so far doth the priesthood surmount the kingdom that is upon the earth. For the Lord hath chosen him above me, to approach unto him, and to eat of his table, and to take the firstlings of the children of Israel, and thou shalt be as a sea to him; for like as in the sea both the righteous and unrighteous are in danger, and the one sort are caught prisoners, and the other sort are enriched: even so shall all kind of men be hazarded in thee, some sinking in misery, and some others floating in prosperity. For in thee shall reign great whales, which shall swallow up men as fishes, and bring free men's sons and daughters into bondage; they shall take away men's houses, lands, cattle, and money by force, and they shall feed ravens and other greedy fowls, and many from the flesh of the flock wrongfully; and they shall prosper and flourish in naughtiness, and be exalted through covetousness; and there shall be false prophets like storms, which shall persecute all righteous men; but the Lord shall set them together by the ears among themselves, and there shall be continual wars in Israel, and my kingdom shall be knit up in strangers, till the Savior of Israel come, even till the coming of the God of righteousness, that Jacob and all nations, may rest in peace, and he shall maintain my kingdom in peace forever. For the Lord hath sworn to me, that the kingdom of me, and of my seed, shall never fail worlds without end.

But I am very sorry, my children, for the filthiness, and treachery, and idolatry, which ye shall work against the kingdom, by following witches and conjurers, by bowing your daughters to deceitful devils, by making them enchanters, charmers, and strumpets, and by intermeddling yourselves with the abominations of the heathen, for the which things the Lord shall bring upon you a famine, and pestilence, death and the sword, wrathful besiegement and devouring dogs, reproach of friends and foes, loss and pain of eyes, slaughter of your children, ravishings of wives, spoil of your goods, the burning of your temple, the desolation of your country, and the captivity of yourselves among all Nations which shall geld some of you to make eunuchs for their wives. But if ye return to the Lord with hearty repentance, and humility, and walk in all the commandments of God, he will visit you with mercy, and lovingly deliver you from the bondage of your enemies.

After this shall rise among you a Star out of Jacob, and a Man shall spring, out of my seed; which shall walk as the Sun of righteousness among the children of men, in peace and meekness, and righteousness, and no sin shall be found in him. The heavens shall open upon him, to pour out the spirit of blessedness upon him, from the Father; and he shall shed out the spirit of grace upon you, and you shall be his children in truth, walking in his first and last commandments. This is the offspring of the most high God, and the wellspring of life to all flesh.

Then, shall the sceptre of my kingdom shine bright, and out of your root shall spring the vessel of planting, in whom shall grow up the rod of righteousness unto the Gentiles, to judge, and save all such as call upon him.

After this, shall Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob rise up again to life, and I and the princes, my brethren, shall be your sceptre in Israel: Levi first, I next, Joseph the third, Benjamin the fourth, Simeon the fifth, Issachar the sixth, and so all the rest. And the Lord hath blessed us, saying Levi shall be the messenger of my presence; Simeon, the power of my glory; Reuben, heaven; Issachar, the earth; Zebulon, the sea; Joseph, the mountains; Benjamin, the tabernacle; Dan, the lights; Naphtali, the dainties; Gad, the day sun; and Asher, an olive tree, and there shall be one people of the Lord.

And there shall be no more the false spirit of Belial, because he shall be cast into endless fire.

They that are buried in sorrow, shall rise in joy.

And they that were poor, for the Lord's sake, shall be made rich.

They that suffered penury, shall have plenty.

And they that were weak, shall be made strong.

They that died for the Lord's sake, shall wake up unto life, and run in Jacob; yea, they shall run skipping and leaping, and they shall fly as eagles for joy.

But the ungodly shall be sorrowful, and the sinners shall mourn; and all people shall glorify the Lord forever.

Therefore, my children, keep all the law of the Lord; for there is hope for all such as walk aright.

A hundred and nineteen years old is my age, and behold I die in your sight.

Let none of you bury me in costly clothes, nor rip my belly, for so will rulers do; but carry me back into Hebron with you.

With these words, Judah died; and his children doing in all things as he commanded them, buried him with his fathers in Hebron.

(To be continued.)

QUOTATION FROM THE "GREAT FIRST CAUSE, OR
THE SELF-MOVING FORCES OF THE UNIVERSE,"
BY ORSON PRATT, A. C.

1.—That there must be an endless duration and a boundless space are necessary truths which cannot possibly be conceived to be otherwise than they are. These are necessary truths, whether any being exist to conceive them as such or not. Indeed, if there were no being in existence, the same unalterable and unchangeable necessity would characterize these truths. Endless space and duration cannot be created nor annihilated by any being, but their continuance has been and must be eternal. These truths do not admit of being proved, for that which has no beginning cannot be preceded by a cause, and where no cause exists, there cannot possibly be any foundation for reasoning. There can be no reason why space and duration are as they are, and yet we perceive a necessity for them to be as they are.

2.—That things exist in space, is a truth, though we cannot conceive it to be a necessary truth: for we can conceive of unoccupied space; indeed, we know, because of the phenomena of motion among things, that there must be space not occupied; otherwise, there would be no room for motion among bodies, and space would be filled with a boundless solid, and incapable of any change of place among its parts. The motion, therefore, of things proves that a part of space is unoccupied. If we conceive a part of space to be unoccupied by substance, we can as easily conceive of all space to be empty and void: therefore the existence of things in space, though a truth, is not a necessary truth. We can conceive of

space as containing either nothing or something: we can conceive it, either as containing one thing or an infinity of things: we can conceive it as empty, or partially occupied, or wholly filled. There is an infinite number of quantities of substance between nothing and an infinite boundless solid; and we can conceive either of these quantities as occupying space. We cannot conceive any necessity why one of these quantities should exist rather than another. We perceive that we ourselves exist, and that things exist external to ourselves, but we perceive no necessity for our own existence, or for the existence of anything else. Therefore, the existence of things in space, and the quantity of things in space, are not conceived to be what they are by any irresistible necessity such as characterizes our conceptions of space and duration. No one can conceive of the non-existence of space and duration, but everyone can conceive of the non-existence of things in space, or of the existence of any supposed quantity from nothing to infinity. The first are truths of necessity, the second are truths perceived to be what they are without perceiving any necessity for their being as they are: these may be termed *contingent* truths.

3.—Admitting the contingent truth, that something now exists in space, as nothing cannot produce something, therefore, it follows, as a necessary truth, that something must have always existed in space. Each part of this eternal something must occupy a finite space, having length, breadth, thickness, and figure. To occupy space, it must be solid, but solidity is only another name for matter; therefore, this eternal something must be matter. That which has no extension, nor parts, no relation to space and duration, is called *immateriality*, which is the negative of all existence, or merely another name for nothing.*

4.—Having proved, from the fact, that something now exists; that something must have always existed, let us next enquire, Have *all* substances *eternally* existed? Upon this subject, mankind are divided. One class assumes that part of the substances in space were created out of nothing by the other part which they are irresistibly compelled to believe is eternal. The other class believe all substances to be eternal. We shall now proceed to show that the creation of one part of substance from nothing by another part, cannot be established by any necessity, experience, reason, analogy, or divine revelation.

First: The creation of a part of matter is not a *necessary* truth, for we can conceive of the eternal existence of *all* matter, as easily

*For further information upon this subject, see the treatise of the author on the "Absurdities of Immaterialism."

as we can conceive of the eternal existence of a *part* of matter. All the ancient schools of philosophy conceived every substance to be eternal; and it was not until modern times, that men conjectured otherwise. As has been already stated, we can conceive of space entirely devoid of matter, which shows that the existence of all things in space, though a truth, is not a necessary truth. If the very existence of all substances be not a necessary, but only a *contingent* truth, surely, the beginning of existence or creation of any one substance cannot be conceived as a necessary truth.

Secondly: The creation of one part of substance by another; is not an *experimental* truth. No man has ever perceived any one substance created from nothing by another. In all the varied operations of nature, we perceive no creations nor annihilations: we only perceive changes wrought upon that which already exists. Therefore, no man can know from *experience*, that the creation of something from nothing is a truth.

Thirdly: Creation from nothing is not a truth derived from reason. All deductive reasoning is founded upon certain fundamental or first truths, called axioms or definitions; but there are no such first truths or axioms in relation to a creation from nothing; therefore, there can be no foundation or starting point from which we can commence a process of deductive reasoning to establish any such event. All inductive reasoning is that process by which we ascend from particular truths to those of a higher order and of a more general nature. Now, there is nothing in the particular truths of nature which indicates the creation of any of her substances from nothing; hence, no such event can be established or inferred from induction. Therefore, creation from nothing is not a truth derived from reason.

Fourthly: The creation for substance from nothing is not a truth founded on *analogy*. Analogical reasoning is that process by which we infer that one event or thing *may* be true, because some other similar event or thing is known to be true. Now, we know of no event or thing to be true which resembles, in the least, the creation of substance from nothing, therefore, there is no analogy for such an event.

Fifthly: The creation of something from nothing is not a truth founded on *divine revelation*. We learn from the revealed truths, which God has been pleased to give to man, that the sun, moon, stars, heavens, earth, and all things were created by him, but we nowhere learn in those sacred oracles that any one of these things were created from nothing. The original words rendered in our language create and make are synonymous terms, signifying, as we have every reason

to believe, the formation of things out of the original elements; at least, we are nowhere informed in revelation, that these words had any other meaning. It has been said that as God created *all things*, and as elements are *things*, therefore he must have created them also. But if all the elements be included among the things created, then the Deity must have created the elements, or parts of which he himself consists, which would be the very height of absurdity, for it would suppose him to exist and not to exist at the same time, hence the phrase "all things" cannot mean the elements, but only the "all things" that are created of the elements. Therefore, the creation of something from nothing is not a truth founded on divine revelation. If, therefore, the creation of one part of substance from nothing cannot be established by *necessity, experience, reason, analogy*, nor *divine revelation*, it cannot be a truth, or at least, we have no means left by which we can determine, or even infer that it is a truth, and it should be treated as a wild speculation, or vague conjecture, without the least shadow of foundation.

5.—As there is no evidence whatever in favor of the creation of any substance, we are justified in believing that the elements of every substance existed eternally. We can trace back the history of the earth for about six thousand years, or to the period of its formation. During this time countless millions of organizations, both vegetable and animal, have been constantly taking place. But in every case which has come under observation, the beings, organized, have been made out of pre-existing elements. In the mineral kingdom, a vast variety of new compounds have been formed, but in every instance that has come under the inspection of man, these compounds have been made from something, and not from nothing. All the miracles since the creation, that have been wrought by the power of God, have been operations upon materials already existing. God has not, since the history of man, created any new elements, and exhibited them as a testimony that such an event is possible. When our Lord made wine at the wedding feast, it was not necessary to create it from nothing; he required the vessels first to be filled with water, after which he created or made the wine, which he could easily do by miraculously combining other ingredients or elements that already existed in great abundance. When he fed the multitudes with bread and fish, it was not necessary to make these compounds from nothing; when every element which enters into their constitution, existed plentifully all around him.

[The above treatise in its entirety will be available before our next issue, for two pence and a halfpenny, and not two pence, as we wrongly estimated in our last issue.—ED.]

LONGING FOR ZION.

TUNE—"Sweet home."

O ZION, O Zion, I sing in joy,
 When will I see thy splendor and glory
 With thy crystal waters running so pure,
 And the beautiful green herbs, scenting through thy land.
 Home, home, dear, dear home,
 When shall I see thee, O Zion, my home?

Sweet sounds of the pleasant birds sounds through thy skies,
 Singing together to praise our Head;
 I imagine hearing their melodious sound,
 And the trees, and the green grass, joining in praise.
 Home, home, dear, dear home,
 Here I long for Zion, dear home.

Far away in the west, I shall dwell,
 There is true love, and unity, 'tis true;
 And lovely valleys are like the garden of Eden,
 Replete with all riches,—their sight will be glorious.
 Home, home, dear home,
 When shall I go to Zion, dear home?

O, blessed Zion, I truly love thee,
 When may I walk your bounteous, dear land,
 With the prophets, and the sentinels in throngs?
 O, delightful Zion, thou art my country.
 Home, home, dear, dear home,
 Twil be lovely to dwell in Zion, dear home.

When shall I rest, without oppressed, or tyranny,
 In the land of promise? O, that is my quest;
 And with the living prophets, and patriarchs,
 In the land of my dear fathers, who were courageous for God?
 Home, home, dear, dear home,
 When shall I see thee, O Zion, my home?

How long shall I stay, O, *say*, with no place,
 In the land of captivity, far from my dear home?
 I await my turn to go to Joseph and his seed,
 And there with loud voice, shall I praise my Father!
 Home, home, dear, dear home,
 O, my prayer is to go to Zion, dear home.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

SIFTING.—Lately, near Merthyr, some persecuting Baptist was maligning some of the Saints, because of their religion; and finally, clutching his bag of food, and swinging it around his head, he said, "I shall sift you." In response, the oldest of the Saints observed, "Behold, Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat; but I have prayed for you, that your faith faileth not."

DRUNKENNESS—Drunkenness is a sin which even the sober pagans are ashamed of. The Spartans taught their children to despise it, by showing them a drunkard, on whom they gazed as if he were a monster. Even Epicurus himself, he who believed that happiness is contained in pleasure, was yet a temperate man, as Cicero testified of him.

THINKING well is no better than dreaming well,—acting well is what perfects behavior; for as virtue is the glory of action, so acting is the life of virtue.

IT IS SAID that there is pleasure in madness, which is known to all but the mad; certainly there is shame in idleness, which perhaps no one comprehends besides the idle.

A BIG man will not trample a worm, nor will he hide from a king.

 The translation of the "Great First Cause," by O. Pratt, has swollen to a price of two-and-a-half pence, and will be ready within about a week.

 "Dream," by President Phillips, will appear in our next issue.

 We wish for the Districts and the Branches to do their best with regard to paying us, since it is impossible for us to carry forth our work without payment. More than half the money for the last quarter is still unpaid, and another quarter will come due in the next TRUMPET. Indeed, since the last quarter, our payments to others have nearly doubled the payments of others to us, and that is not counting the profit that must yet be paid to the Church. This wearies our spirit in the midst of hard labor to supply the country with words of eternal life.

PAYMENTS FROM MARCH 7 TO MARCH 20.—Caernarvon, £1 13s; Pontytypidd, 14s 6c; Llantrisant, 11½c; Aberdare, £2 3s; Georgetown, £1; Merthyr, £1 12s.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 7.]

APRIL 5, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

“WHO IS THE GREATEST?”

OF EVERY question we have ever heard, the foregoing question is the most dangerous to ask, and the most disappointing in its answer, especially in the kingdom of heaven. Pride and conceit in one's heart are what most often give birth to this question. It was most probably pride that caused Lucifer to ask such a question in heaven, when he fell from there to the extremes of degradation. Questions such as this one have destroyed hundreds. Jesus Christ was merely instructing his disciples on one occasion, when “there arose a reasoning among them, which of them should be greatest.” They received the following answer from their Lord.—“Whosoever shall receive this child in my name receiveth me; and whosoever shall receive me, receiveth him that sent me; for he that is least among you all, the same shall be great” (Luke ix, 48). That is the best answer that can be given to such who happen to ask the foregoing question; and the best way to proceed, is to do as the apostles did, namely humbling themselves to be the least, and not to follow Lucifer, who rebelled.

The father of the foregoing question is the devil himself; it was he who asked it first, and it was he who suffered first because of it. There were too much pride and conceit in him to accept the answer given to the apostles; and that was the cause of his fall. From then

to the present time, the work of the devil has been to encourage everyone to ask, "Who is the greatest?" In heaven he succeeded in drawing a third of the angels to follow after him, and to support him in his rebellion; and doubtless he has pulled thousands after him across the earth, not only in the early ages, and during the time of Jesus Christ, but in the latter days as well. What took place following the martyrdom of the prophet Joseph Smith? We answer, something as similar as possible to that which happened among the apostles of Christ in the early days, when it was suggested that the Lord was to be "delivered to the hands of men." Yes, we say, a reasoning arose at that time around Nauvoo, among the apostles of the latter days, Who would be the greatest in the kingdom of God, after the departure of Joseph Smith? And some of them, disregarding the teachings of Jesus, swelled in pride and conceit, supposing that they were to be the greatest; but it was from among the least that God chose the leaders of his church, to whom he presented the keys of the kingdom, in place of Joseph. The fate of those who desired to be the greatest, was excommunication from the church, and enlisting in the ranks of the enemy!

It is the duty of all, then, in the Church of Jesus Christ, to be on their guard with respect to "Who is the greatest?" All should avoid supporting every man who wants to be great. Refrain from listening to him testifying that he believes the doctrine of the Saints, for even the demons believe, and also tremble. There is not one true child of God who rebels, for not being elevated to some office; the conceited and the proud are the ones who do so. Upon understanding that he will not be the next president of some branch, district, or nation, the one who desires to be great begins to be angry at the new president and the old one, and at all else who did not strive to have him chosen. Then soon he begins to rebel in secret, hating the brethren who preside over him; but yet, he deceives the Saints into thinking that he is a good man, by testifying in favor of the doctrine. "He that saith he is in the light, and hateth his brother, is in darkness even until now" (1 John ii, 9). He who follows Christ's teachings, loves all the brethren, and respects all the proceedings of the church, always being satisfied with God's choice, and not with his own choice.

Those who choose themselves go to darkness, and to destruction, and sometimes they succeed in pulling others with them. Despite that, like their devil father, they still continue to say that Christ is the Son of the living God, and that the doctrine of the Saints is truth. Sidney Rigdon, and others who were excommunicated from the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, still continue to say that; the greatest thing they disbelieve is that Brigham Young and his counselors are the head of the church. Those who were once in the light, know more about the doctrine of the Saints, than those who have always been in darkness; and although the former have been thrust into greater darkness, so that they see nothing more, yet they can remember that which they saw in the light earlier.—and that is what those blind ones know.

Now, let all the Saints strive to recognize those who desire to be the greatest, and beware of them; and if the love and humility of Christ are not in them, do not receive them into your home, and do not speak of God freely with them; otherwise, you will be associated with their evil deeds. It does not matter how much good someone did previously, if he becomes evil, his evil will be worse and more harmful. Therefore, it would behoove all to watch, that they not accept a man who disrespects or rebels against the present government of God, for such a man does not love the brethren nor does he love God. The best way for everyone to become great, is to be quite small—never think about “Who is the GREATEST.”

WHEAT SOWING.

[From the “Deseret News,” for Nov. 2, 1850.]

THE time for sowing fall wheat is rapidly passing, for this season, and it is a duty of the first magnitude for everyone, to put all the seed in the earth they possibly can. Suppose there are thirty thousand in the valleys of the mountains, a very reasonable calculation, and every individual wants ten bushels of wheat annually (which probably might be a little more than would be consumed, provided other grains, vegetables, meat, and groceries, were plenty; yet, the calculation

is safe for a little wastage, by the outbreaking of cattle, and other causes of destruction); and it will require three hundred thousand bushels of wheat, to supply the people now in the mountains, during the current year. Add to this a double population by next harvest, and six hundred thousand bushels must be gathered, or the people come to want; then add to this a few thousand bushels to feed to the Indians, and certainly it would be cheaper feeding the Indians than fighting them, if it shall prove to be the wisest; and a few thousand bushels more for the mountaineers; and many thousand bushels more, to satisfy the calls of the traveler; and we easily find a bill of one million bushels of wheat which will be wanted at our next harvest, to supply the immediate demands of the people, up to the following harvest, making no calculation for the future, should the succeeding crop fail. Let every man in Deseret raise two hundred bushels of wheat, and as much other grain as possible, against the next harvest, and the prices will still remain good, and the market be open for more; and in order that mechanics may attend to their several callings, every man engaged at farming should raise at least three hundred bushels of wheat, and a proportionate quantity of other grains; therefore, put in the wheat! PUT IN THE WHEAT!!

Don't be afraid that you cannot harvest it: somebody will come to help you, as they did at the last harvest. Don't be afraid you cannot thresh it; there is one threshing machine in operation, doing good business, and there will be more still in operation next year, which will save an immense amount of hard labor at threshing, and give the farmer more time to sow; and thousands of bushels of grain must be had to feed the horses and mules that drive the threshing machines; therefore, put in the wheat and spare not. Soon we shall again see the people flocking to Deseret by thousands and tens of thousands, passing the canyons without a morsel of bread, as many have done this year, and the farmers of Deseret must feed them; therefore, put in the wheat.

What is wanting to build up the kingdom of God in the mountains? WHEAT! What is wanting to enable the elders to go forth by hundreds to proclaim the Gospel to the nations? WHEAT!! What is wanting, that all Israel may not come home at once? WHEAT!!!

What is wanting that we cannot have ten thousand men engaged in building a Temple to the Most High God, where the ordinances of life and salvation can be administered to the Saints when they arrive here? WHEAT. What can be done by the Saints in the mountains, when they shall have wheat in abundance? every thing that needs to be done. Bread and water, sure, is what the Lord has promised to his people through their faithfulness. Water is plenty now, and wheat will be when the brethren shall have used the means to obtain it in abundance, then they will have nothing to do but labor, and by their labor they can produce, sermons, temples, and feasts, and every thing God wants of them. Brethren, will you lay the foundation of the great work of God committed to your charge by putting the wheat in the earth? Will you relax your exertions while a bushel can be sown?

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS,
NAMESLY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[*Continued from page 95.*]

TESTAMENT OF ISSACHAR,

Made to his children at his death, about the Simplicity of heart.

Issachar called clearly,
All his children together as he died;
He speaks of keeping a single heart,
A pure life, and lowly lifetimes.

THE COPY of Issachar's words; he, calling his children about him, said unto them,

Ye children of Issachar, hear your father, and hearken to the words of the beloved of the Lord: I am Jacob's fifth son, in the reward of Mandrake. For Reuben brought mandrakes out of the field, and Rachel meeting him took them of him; thereat Reuben wept, and at his noise, my mother Leah came out (now the mandrakes were sweet-scented apples, which the land of Aram bringeth forth in high countries, by the water valleys), and Rachel said, I will not give thee these apples, for they shall help me to children; now there were two of these apples.

Then, Leah said, Doth it not suffice thee that thou hath gotten away the husband of my virginity, but that thou wilt have this also?

She answered, Let Jacob lie with thee tonight for thy son's mandrakes.

Leah said unto her, Do not boast nor brag, for Jacob is mine, and I am the wife of his youth.

And Rachel answered, How so? was he not first handfasted unto me? and served he not our father fourteen years for me? what shall I do to thee? for many are the wiles and policies of men, and guile goers forward upon the earth; if it had been otherwise, thou shouldst not have seen Jacob in the face at this day; for thou art not his wife, but wert guilefully put to him in my stead, for my father deceived me, and conveying me away that night suffered me not to see him, for had I been there, this had not come to pass: wherefore, take the one mandrake, and in lieu of the other I grant thee him for one night.

And Jacob knew Leah, who conceiving, bare me, and called my name Issachar, because of the hire.

Then, an angel of the Lord appeared unto Jacob, and said that Rachel should bear but two sons, because she had forsaken the company of her husband, and chosen continency; and if my mother Leah had not given the two apples for his company, she should have born eight children, whereas by reason of that, she bare but six, Rachel two, and because God visited her in the mandrakes: for he knew that she greatly desired to company with Jacob, for issue's sake, and not for lust of pleasure; for she laid up the mandrake, and delivered it unto Jacob the next day, and therefore God heard Rachel in the mandrakes, because that although she had a mind to them, yet she ate them not, but offered them to the priest of the Most High, which was in those days, and laid them up in the Lord's house.

Therefore, my children, when I came unto man's state, I walked with an upright heart, and became bailiff of husbandry unto my fathers, and brought them the fruits of their lands in their due seasons; and my father blessed me, when he saw how I walked plainly and simply; I was no busybody in my doings; I was not hurtful nor spiteful to my neighbor; I railed not upon any man, neither dispraised I the life of any that walked in singleness of mind.

And when I was thirty years old, I took a wife, because labor had consumed my strength. I never knew the pleasures of a woman through wantonness, but my labor made me to sleep soundly; and my father did always rejoice of my simplicity; for whatsoever pains I took, first of all, I offered all the first fruits of the first engendered cattle unto the Lord by the priest, and then gave my father the rest, and the Lord doubled his benefits in my hands; yea, and Jacob himself perceived well, that God wrought with me and my plain

dealing; for unto every poor man, and to every man in adversity, gave I of the fruits of the earth with a single heart.

And now, my children, hearken unto me, and walk in singleness of heart and mind, for I know that the Lord is very well pleased with it, for the single-hearted man coveteth not gold, undermineth not his neighbor, lusteth not after diversity of meats, desireth not shift of apparel, nor heightneth himself long time, but only hath an eye to God's will; and the spirits of error can do nothing against him, for he cannot skill to entertain a fair woman, lest he should defile his own mind, and wrath overmastereth not his wit, and envy melteth not his soul; neither doth his mind run covetously upon gain, for he leadeth an upright life, and beholdeth all things with a single eye, excluding all hurtfulness of worldly error, lest he should oversee any of the commandments of God.

Therefore, my children, keep God's law, and hold fast plainness, and walk on in innocency, and be not too inquisitive into God's secrets, or of your neighbors' doings, pity the poor and the weak, love God and your neighbor, bow down your back to Husbandry, and be diligent in tilling the earth, in all manner of Husbandry, offering presents to the Lord with thanksgiving, who blessed the earth with increase, and a new spring of fruits, as he blessed all holy men from Abel, to this day; for there is none other portion given thee, than of the fatness of the earth, whose fruits come by painstaking; for our father Jacob blessed me with the benefits of the earth, and the firstlings of fruits.

Levi and Judah are glorified of the Lord among the children of Jacob; for God hath planted himself in them, giving to the one the priesthood, and to the other the kingdom; therefore, obey ye them, and walk plainly as our father Jacob did; for unto Gad it is given to destroy the temptations of Israel.

My children, I know that in the last days your children shall forsake plainness, and cleave to covetousness.

Let go innocency, and follow lewdness.

Leave God's commandments, and stick unto Belial.

Give over Husbandry, and gad after wicked devices.

And therefore shall they be scattered amongst the heathen, and become bond slaves to their enemies.

Wherefore, warn your children of it, that if they sin, they may return to the Lord, for he is merciful, and will deliver them, and bring them home again into their own land.

Behold, I am now an hundred and two and twenty years old, and I know not any deadly sin upon me.

And I have not known any woman but my wife, neither have I committed whoredom in the lust of my eyes.

I have not drunk wine unto druneness, neither have I coveted any pleasant things of my neighbors.

There hath been no guile in my heart, neither hath there any lying gone out of my lips.

I have been sorry with every man that was in heaviness, and given my bread to the poor.

I have not eaten my meat alone, nor removed the bounds and borders of lands.

I have been pitiful in the days of my life, and dealt truly in all cases.

I have loved the Lord with all my strength, and all men as my own children.

My children, if you also do the like, all the spirits of Belial will fly from you; and nothing that mischievous men can do against you shall have power over you: and you shall bring all wild beasts into subjection to you, because ye have the Lord of heaven with you, if ye walk with him in singleness of heart.

Then he willed them to carry his body into Hebron, and to bury him there in the cave with his fathers; thus he stretched out his feet, and died in a good age, having all his limbs strong and sound, and kept the sleep of all the world.

(To be continued.)

A DREAM.

MR. EDITOR,—I wish to set the following before the public through the means of your melodious TRUMPET.

On the 17th of this month, about 3:00 o'clock in the afternoon, when I was sitting in my house, after speaking much throughout the day, the spirit of sleep came over me, in which I discovered myself being taken away by the Spirit to a secret room; and after going in, I saw six ministers pertaining to the Baptists, and I was led to understand that they were holding a council there, and by permission of the Spirit, I stayed there to listen until their departure; and when I awoke I remembered the topics that had received their attention; then I wrote them without delay, which are as follows:—

First, asked one, "What is your opinion of the 'Latter-day Saints?' Their testimonies and especially their books have caused my mind to be troubled, because after I carefully searched the Holy

Bible, and the doctrine of the Saints, I have found them to be totally consistent in every point of doctrine. So, O dear brethren, what shall we do? our religion is finished! it looked bad before, but indeed, it looks much worse now; the majority of our members have had their eyes opened: they ask frequently in the society such questions as: 'Are there to be no apostles and prophets in the Church now?' 'No,' is our answer to them. 'Is there knowledge to be had now?' 'No,' we say. 'Are there none of those spiritual gifts to be enjoyed now, such as speaking in tongues, interpreting, prophesying, miracles, gifts of healing and singing with the spirit, &c.?' We say, 'they have all ceased,' while at the same time remembering that Paul had used an oath saying, 'And these truly has God placed in His Church.' And we, brethren, profess that heaven and earth will pass away before one jot of the word of great God fails; and in the face of such things, how are we going to show our faces to our fellow men? yea, and something that is infinitely more important than that, is how are we going to be able to stand before the judgment bar to give an accounting of our words and deeds!! O! brethren, let us consider these things seriously, lest we find ourselves fighting against God!!"

Then, all who were in the council shed tears as they thought about the great day of judgment! Another arose, and said, "O brethren! I have a guilty conscience, for I have preached so much, when in fact I know that I was not ever sent by God; and the words that trouble me most are those in Heb. v, 4. 'And no man taketh this honor unto himself, but he that is called of God as was Aaron.' And that part of the divine word has caused me to decide that I shall not preach further, until I have a satisfactory explanation on the subject."

After that, another famous man rose to his feet, and said, "My biggest worry is that I have prophesied diligently throughout the country for eight years, that the Saints would melt into oblivion before the end of nine months; and now, many nine-month periods have gone by, and everyone sees that all my prophecies are false!! And, O brethren, how can I show my face?"

Another said the following:—"There is one thing that causes pain to my mind, and that is the words that Paul wrote, 1 Thes. i, 5.

‘For our gospel came not unto you in word only, but also in power, and in the Holy Ghost, and in much assurance.’ We say that we have the same gospel as Paul had; but truly, brethren, there is as much difference here as there is between the gospel of the sprinklers and that of Paul. And if something cannot be decided, I am determined to join the Saints.”

Another one rose to his feet and said, “I must confess, that my mind is also troubled when I read those scriptures in Acts ii, 38, 39. ‘Then Peter said unto them, Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost. For the promise is unto you, and to your children, and to all that are afar off, even as many as the Lord our God shall call.’ And we have cut off scores, for believing the above verses! and truly, dear brethren, there is cause for concern that there is too much truth in the testimony of the Saints, namely, that we ‘believe the Bible when it is closed,’ but when it is open, we ‘deny it.’ Remember that ‘that which fails in one respect is guilty of failing in all.’”

Another one said the following: “We have been speaking during the last year, about the Jews; and we have gathered hundreds of pounds from among the poor, for the purpose of sending missionaries to the Jews; and now, we see our foolishness: there is no promise that the Jews will believe, until the Lord stands on his feet on the Mount of Olives, as prophesied in Zechariah xiv, 4, 8: ‘And his feet shall stand in that day upon the mount of Olives, which is before Jerusalem on the east, and the mount of Olives shall cleave in the midst thereof toward the east and toward the west, and there shall be a very great valley: and half of the mountain shall remove toward the north, and half of it toward the south. And it shall be in that day, that living waters shall go out from Jerusalem; half of them toward the former sea, and half of them toward the hinder sea: in summer and in winter shall it be.’ Zechariah xii, 10—14: ‘And I will pour upon the house of David, and upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the spirit of grace and of supplications; and they shall look upon me whom they have pierced, and they shall mourn for him, as one mourneth for his only son, and shall be in bitterness for him as one that is in bitterness for his firstborn, &c.’ Furthermore,

chapter xiii, 1. 'In that day there shall be a fountain opened to the house of David, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem for sin and for uncleanness.' We see, brethren, that they must be baptized for the remission of sins; and we see also the kind of darkness that we have been spending our time in, and also that we are bound to confess that the Saints have light: they are the ones who have enlightened us in these things, and if I had not persecuted them so much, I would have joined with them. Now, get to the point: are we going to go to the Saints like men, or are we going to try to get a fulfillment of the promises ourselves? If you do not answer, I shall go out and I shall be baptized by them now."

The first rose again and said, "Slow down a bit, let us be calm; I think that if we go like ministers unto the Lord, he will give us the honor of receiving the gift of the Holy Ghost." "What good does it do us to pray now," says the other, "since the scriptures testify that in the Church there are Priests and Elders; we deny such, and consequently we do not have authority." "Do not get upset," says another, "as the purpose of this council is to put ourselves on the way to being believers from now on. What if we were to join the Saints and get to be ministers?" "We cannot," says the other, "for we must be members first, and wait as such until we are called through revelation as was Aaron." "And shall we know then that we are sent by God?" "We shall," says the other. "Well! well! if we could get knowledge like that, I would preach in such a way as to cause the earth to shake! truly I would, for it would be heaven on earth then, in comparison to the situation in which we find ourselves at present."

"But before stirring up our churches," says one of them, "would it not be better for us to seek after this authority for ourselves?" "No doubt that it would be," says the other. They agreed to go to pray for the ministering of an angel together with the gift of the Holy Ghost. It was decided that one would pray, and the other five would say "Amen." Then all went on their knees, and the following prayer was uttered:—"O Lord God Almighty, behold us lowly and ignorant creatures, work of thy hands, drawing near to thy breast; we would suppose tonight, O Lord, that we are true believers (which we have never been before); we have denied thy holy word, and we have testified that all the promised blessings have come to an end;

when thy word is 'yes, and Amen.' O Lord, forgive us, and come to our council here tonight, or send one of thy angels to our meeting to ordain us priests and elders. Since thou hast sent an angel to Joseph Smith, O send one to us, good Lord, and forgive us for having persecuted the 'Latter-day Saints' in the name of the Man who was crucified on the cross. We shall join them if thou dost not see fit to give us the gift of the Holy Ghost; and all our members are of the same mind as we, except for an occasional old rascal who is rooted in the traditions of the fathers. Since we have a beautiful chapel and many churches, we would like to keep them until we die. And for these worthy reasons, O Lord, keep this council secret, from everyone else; for we have had a bounteous harvest, but it is about to end if thou dost not see fit to hear us and give us the divine gifts which thy dear Son promised to the believers. Forgive us all our sins, O Lord, and receive our service with thy approval in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen and Amen."

They failed to receive anything in this meeting, and it was decided that another month would be spent at the task! I testify in the name of and by the authority of Jesus Christ, that the Priesthood cannot be had except in the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. May our gracious God bless all the honest in heart in this principality.

Merthyr.

WM. PHILLIPS.

JOURNEY FROM THE BLUFFS TO THE VALLEY.

IN response to those who ask us about the journey from Council Bluffs to the Valley, we quote the following from the "Frontier Guardian" for Feb. 7, 1851:—

"But here we give some general items. Two good yoke of oxen will haul a ton upon a good wagon from this point to the Salt Lake City. It would be better, however, to have one yoke of cows between the two yoke of oxen, before the same wagon. These will give milk for children on the way, and are more easily driven in the team than out of it, and they will help very much, also. Now, to every ton of freight, you need one such team and wagon. You can take on board this wagon some two, three, four or six children or grown

persons, because they can walk up hills and over bad places. It will be necessary for large families to have a tent to sleep in. Four persons may generally sleep in a good-sized emigration wagon, or more if they are not grown up. Families should not start from here short of three months' provisions. Say, one hundred pounds of flour, or good and wholesome bread stuffs of some kind, to the person, old or young. As much bacon or pork as you may think you will need. Sugar, coffee, rice, dried fruit, dried beef,—a little tea, and every other necessary according to the wishes and abilities of the parties concerned. No family ought to cross the plains without cows to afford milk; for milk and butter are most useful and necessary on the road. After you have taken a hundred pounds of flour to the person, you ought to take a few bushels of corn meal for bread and *mush*. Some few family medicines, it would be well to have along. Take all the clothing you can procure. Ox teams are generally the best and most reliable; and after they have hauled you through, you may fatten and kill them for food. It is well, however, to have some horses along, or mules to hunt cattle, and to herd them. Horse or mule teams are very good, and some prefer them. Persons must act their own judgment in the selection of teams."

LAMENTS OF THE SAINTS.

My little muse, revive, ascend thy voice above,
 Reveal my lament to my Father in heaven;
 I'm far from home, in desert, among a host of enemies;
 Who can sympathize with my circumstances?

O Babylon, O Babylon, thy oppression is great,
 But the end of thy rule is nearing now.

In a world of oppressive tribulation I live,
 How hard for me to keep thy laws, O God;
 The friend that once was mine, is an enemy many times,
 How hard it is to travel through the midst of such a world.

O Babylon, &c.

When my desire and strength is to do that which is good,
 Evil knots in wrath against me; what shall I do?

This is an enemy to me, O Father, hear thou my cry,
Give me strength to do thy will, by overcoming it.

O Babylon, &c.

The world where I dwell is under oppressive captive burden,
There is but unrighteousness governing it now;
I am in its midst, some way trying to live,
Under torment of sweat and tears, and O how hard it is.

O Babylon, &c.

The world is turning against me, I'm growing gray and feeble,
My pouch is empty, and also my pantry is short of food;
And the decorations of poverty are on my clothes now,
They shun my company, and fail to know me.

O Babylon, &c.

The holy prophets of old, were heroes through faith
Against unrighteousness,—although they lost the day;
But in the present age the righteous seek their part,
And injustice will be buried from sight before long.

O Babylon, &c.

Clynmil.

JOHN WILKINS.

HEALING.

MR. EDITOR,—Because your publication is small, I shall write but little; and I wish for you to publish the extraordinary, following account.

A short time ago, I was called upon together with brother Pugh to administer the ordinance of anointing with oil, as the apostle James mentions, on a sister by the name of Rebecca Flowers. Her illness was the *paralytic stroke*; one side of her was completely paralyzed. I have never felt anything more dead, than was her leg. We anointed her with oil in the name of the Lord; and before we came out of the place, she was able to walk about the house. Whoever desires more information, call at my house, 36, Tredegar Road, Cardiff.

JAMES ELLIS.

N. B.—“We testify that the foregoing witness is true.

“JOHN FLOWERS,

“REBECCA FLOWERS.

“Charlotte Road, Cardiff.”

THE CALL HOME.

TUNE—"Men of Harlech."

HOMEWARD, homeward, Saints of the Lord,
A call will come without warning,
Lest the great destruction and chaos
Overcome us.

Homeward, faithful saints,
Let us flee from the midst of our enemies;
Babylon is, from day to day,
Giving signs of its fall.
Afar is Zion gaining strength;
Thousands of saints are flocking to it,
As doves to their windows,
From the dark adversity.

Zion, Zion, is our refuge,
What better are we for staying here?
Let us go to the place where there is rest—
Yes, peace aplenty.
Zion is the dwelling place
Of the saints of Jehovah;
There the faithful ones,
Always feast well.
O, let us awake from our slumber,
And give ear to the words of the Lord;
Babylon will soon fall,
As a rock into the sea!

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

MIRACLES.—One of the Methodists was belittling one of the Saints, because of their belief in "miracles." "What," said the Saint, "did not the Methodists perform 'miracles' in the olden days?" "Be still, boy," said he, "the Methodists performing 'miracles!' no, never." "Are you certain, sir?" said the Saint. "Yes, yes, quite sure." "Well, well!" said the dear Saint, slowly, "were not Christ and his apostles Methodists?" The son of Calvin was struck dumb!—T. H.

BUSTS (PICTURES) OF JOSEPH AND HYRUM.—President W. Phillips has received recently a plentiful supply of these pictures, from brother J. Taylor, and they are to be sold by him as follows:—The best material, for 9s. per pair; regular material for 5s. per pair. We have purchased the first pair, and we can say that nothing will decorate a home better. It is best for the poor to save up to obtain them: they are indeed worth acquiring. By having Joseph and Hyrum in our homes, we will also greatly facilitate the work of the Lord among the French. Come, and purchase.

APPOINTMENT.—The Presidency here has appointed Elder Thomas Pugh, for the present time, to preside over the West Glamorgan District, without counselors, and brother Evan Williams to be a traveling elder, under his presidency.

BOOK DEBTS SINCE FROM THE DISTRICTS, BRANCHES AND OTHERS, FOR THE QUARTER ENDING APRIL 5, 1851.

DISTRICTS.—Monmouthshire £17 3s 0½c; Breconshire, £3 8s 7c; Cardiganshire, £2 17s 8c; Carmarthenshire, £14 16s 10½c; West Glamorgan, £33 7s 1½c; Flintshire, £6 9s 8½c; Caernarvonshire, £13 2s 5½c; Merionethshire, £7 6s 5c; Denbighshire, £7 15s 5c; Pembrokeshire, £3 2s 2c.—*Branches*—Dinas, £1, 1s 9s; Llantrisant, £3 5s 3½c; Pontypridd, £6 12s 10c; Llanfabon, £1 5s 4c; Cwmbach, £1 12s 7c; Pendulwyn, 10s 4c; Twynyrodyn, 15s; Llandaff, £1 7s 9c; Gog, 14s 1c; Cardiff, £7 10s 10c; Aberdare, £7 16s 3c; Dowlais, £4 3s 2½c; Hirwaun, £6 8s 6½c; Rhymney, £2 13s 10c; Cwmnedd, £1 16s 3c; Georgetown, £7 8s 7c; Merthyr, £1 8s 8c; Pendaren, £3 4s 4c; Pontfaen, 7s 3c; Cefn, £1 11s 1c; Ynysgau, 2s 5c.—*Persons*—David Davies, formerly from Clynmil, 3s 4c; Jonathan Thomas, Trecastell, £1 4s 8½c; David John, 9s 6c; Joseph Rogers, 3s 6c; Rees Thomas, 4s 6c; Robert Roberts, 5s; James Jones, 6s; Dd. Edwards, 6s 5.—Total, £173 17s 7c.

 Remember that nearly half the foregoing total is old debt, and does not pertain to this quarter. If the various presidents possess sufficient will and determination, they can clear it all forthwith—it all depends on them. Wherever there is an energetic and determined president, his Saints will never be behind in their payment—that is part of their religion.

PAYMENTS FROM MARCH 21 TO APRIL 1.—Cardiganshire, 7s; Denbighshire, 10s; Llantrisant, 1s; Pontypridd, 16s 6c; Llanfabon, 16s 10c; Cwmbach, £1; Georgetown, 10s; Merthyr, £2; Pendaren, 14s; Ynysgau, 1s 8c.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 8.]

APRIL 19, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

THE CHURCH IS TWENTY-ONE YEARS OLD

MAY the Saints of the Almighty God sing the songs of Zion on the earth, and raise their hearts to the firmament of heaven to join in praise with their brethren on high, where there are also thousands of angels ready to sound a vibrant anthem. Let the poor and afflicted rejoice; let them forget their adversity for a season. The oppressed in Babylon, do not forget where you dwell; the day of rejoicing has come to gladden your hearts. The persecuted, do not fear your enemies; it is time for you also to rejoice. All are called upon to be happy, and to delight together; for God's smiles have shone on his Daughter ZION. Hear what the TRUMPET sounds along the length and breadth of the land. "*The Church is twenty-one years old!*" The long awaited day has dawned—the sixth day of the fourth month that is called April, 1851, namely the year of the exhibition of the world. Let everyone who has a tongue sing thanks to the Most High, for the daughter of Zion has come of age. The Lord has kept her head high through every persecution she has met, and has brought her safely to a high mountain, where today she is beautiful to behold, and twenty-one years old; she is dressing and preparing herself for the coming of the Bridegroom. From there she will send messengers to the ends of the earth, to gather guests for the marriage feast of the Lamb.

Let the sons and daughters of men give thanks that the Church is twenty-one years old; For God is now more zealous for her glory than ever before. From now on, her Father, claims her, and he claims her in the presence of many nations; and he embraces her with his arm, and he keeps her safe from all harm; and on her head he will bestow blessings from heaven. Let the Latter-day Saints sing, and let them rejoice, to awaken all the inhabitants of the earth, so they may understand that the daughter of Zion, or their Church, is she who is twenty-one years old. We composed, on the beautiful morning of the aforementioned day, before turning from our bed, this new song, which is the more the fruit of rejoicing than of skill:—

Listen, you Saints of Gwalia,
 I have splendid news;
 The time of rejoicing has come,
 And giving praise to God.
 If you wish to know what's happening,
 Prepare to give forth glad praise,
 For the Church is
 Twenty-one years old!
 Twenty-one years old!
 Twenty-one years old!

Until now she was underage,
 Since she came from heaven;
 But today she is laughing loudly,
 And raising her voice.
 If you wish to know what's happening,
 Prepare to give forth glad praise,
 For the Church is
 Twenty-one years old, &c.

The Church is now claiming
 Greater blessings from God;
 She knows more from experience,
 And is wiser.
 If you wish to know what's happening,
 Prepare to give forth glad praise,
 For the Church is
 Twenty-one years old, &c.

Now the Church thinks
 Often about her state;
 Expecting to have fulfillment
 Of the true words of her Father.
 If you wish to know what's happening,
 Prepare to give forth glad praise,
 For the Church is
 Twenty-one years old, &c.

The Church now is assiduous
 In attracting the love of the Son of God;
 Shortly the wedding day will come,
 And the glorious, royal wedding feast.
 If you wish to know what's happening,
 Prepare to give forth glad praise,
 For the Church is
 Twenty-one years old, &c.

Therefore, beloved brethren,
 Lift up your heads;
 The talk about your Church
 Is spreading everywhere.
 If you wish to know what's happening,
 Prepare to give forth glad praise,
 For the Church is
 Twenty-one years old, &c.

MORMONISM.

THE *Family Herald*, for March 13, 1851, contains an article about "Mesmerism, Mormonism, and Monasticism;" in which is portrayed that which distinguishes each one of the three. And since we were satisfied with the observations made with respect to Mormonism, we quote the following from the article, so that our readers can hear the judgment of the world about us:—

"Now let us [after portraying the wonders of Mesmerism] have a short look at a very different species of Therapeutists, which produces similar and even more remarkable effects; because the

illness is worse, and the healings faster—sometimes immediate. Despite this, remember, that we take our authority out of published books; we do not possess any personal knowledge of the Mormons; but we consider ourselves duty bound, as public educators, to search out every popular subject, or every new movement that claims such things. We have long been familiar with the character and profession of the Mormon body. These Mormons are increasing remarkably fast. They compose a small nation. They form one of the United States—the State of Utah, or Deseret; and their prophet, Brigham Young, the successor to Joseph Smith, is the lawful governor recognized by Congress. They expect to soon be two States. They increase quickly by persuasion and immigration, and they have their own city and towns, and they are now establishing a university, and appointing teachers, one of which is presently on his way from England. A few years ago they were despised throughout all the States; now, when an apostle visits the capitol city, he is greeted and praised on all sides by American legislators. And one of them lately, on his way to Italy to establish a church, as he went through Washington, had his pockets filled with letters of commendation to the Italians from legislators of the Great Republic. In England they number over thirty thousand. In London, where they have been for just three years, they have already baptized three thousand believers; and they are preparing to stage an assault on the faith or beliefs of all the nations during the approaching festivities of the Great Exhibition.

“These Mormons are bold men. Now let us hear what they are doing. The Mesmerists do not like them, we know, and perhaps they mock, but yet ‘it is printed, and we read it in a book;’ and the question is, are we to believe the Mesmerist book and disbelieve the Mormon one? Generosity forbids us.

“The Mormon healings, until now, excel over everything that has been written about Mesmerism; and the publication from which we quote, tells us that the printed series is but a small percentage of the numberless numbers. We quote the words of the writer himself, namely Orson Pratt, President of the Twelve Apostles, now

on his way toward Salt Lake City, as the appointed leader of the Mormon University;—"There are now about six hundred branches of the Church of Christ in the British Isles, comprising over thirty thousand believers, and between three and four thousand Elders and Priests. Now, there is hardly a branch of the Saints (namely the Latter-day Saints) among this nation, which has not been blessed, to a greater or lesser degree, with the miraculous signs and gifts of the Holy Ghost, through which they have been sustained, and know for a certainty that this is the Church of Christ. They know that the blind see, the lame walk, the deaf hear, the dumb speak, the leper is cleansed, bones are joined together, the cholera is rebuked, and the most intense diseases depart, through faith in the name of Jesus Christ, and the power of His gospel. These are not isolated incidents that take place occasionally, or that are suspicious in their nature, or that occurred some time ago, or in a distant land; but they are taking place at the present time, and every week scores of examples are brought forth in every part of this land. Many sick persons, outside the Church, through the laying on of hands of the servants of God, have been healed. This is not something that is done in the corner, but publicly, and there are tens of thousands of eyewitnesses.'

"Complete blindness has been healed—instantaneously; deafness and dumbness of many years are healed forthwith; broken back bones rush to their place with the sound of a squeezed basket, while the ceremony of anointing and praying is being administered; a dislocated thigh bone, which had defied every medical skill, jumped immediately into its place, when commanded to do so by an Elder of the Church, while anointing the patient with oil in the name of the Lord; wounds are healed up, and their bindings are thrown away, no longer needed; a disease is rebuked, and departs at the word that commands it to leave. All this is done without Mesmerism, and yet it is done with the laying on of hands. But there is something else; there are religious and holy ceremonies and anointings. The Mesmerists look at the material attributes, and some secret power in Nature, for healing; the Mormons look directly up to God. There is something

more exalted, devotional, and elevated, but less philosophical, in the Mormon system. The Mesmerist is a philosopher; he does not mention the name of God; and the name of Jesus, he would be ashamed, perhaps, to utter. He is a skilled man, and he studies the laws of nature; he digs deep in the earth for the gold. The Mormons look for it on the surface—*sub Jove sereno* (under the blue sky).

“But are these healings truly performed? We cannot say; they are printed in a book.

“But, if such healings are genuine, must Mormonism be the true religion? Wait a little, logician! Thy conclusion is unlawful. Even the Mormon Book tells thee, that ‘miracles, taken on their own, are no proof whatsoever of anyone’s divine mission, but only when they are taken in connection with pure, holy, and infallible doctrine,’—which doctrine is not needed as evidence. The scriptures say that demons work miracles, and that there are *three different kinds* of demons sent out in the *latter days* to work them. You can see the words in Rev. xiv, 14. Therefore, do not be in too big a hurry to become a Saint, rather reason a little longer. Besides that, the doctrine is neither holy nor infallible, and consequently it cannot be that miracles are undisputed witnesses of its truthfulness. In this manner, for example, Mr. Orson Pratt says, ‘The nature of the message of the Book of Mormon is such, that, *if true*, no one can be saved, and *refuse it*; and, *if false*, no one can be saved, and *receive it*.’ From this we can determine, that a Mormon stands as little chance of being saved as anyone in the world.

“But there is another reason why you should not become a Mormon, and that is, that the monastics perform the same kind of deeds. They also work miracles. This will cause you to hesitate, and perhaps to be confused; at least, it will cause you to proceed slowly.”

This is how the Editor of the “Family Herald” writes concerning Mormonism. Had we been near him as he was writing, we would have said in his ear that the standard of the Saints to prove the divinity of their religion is *revelation*, through the Holy Ghost, which is promised to all.

WHY WERE THE PRAYERS OF THE RELIGIOUS DENOMINATIONS NOT HEARD?

MR. ED.,—It is known that all religious denominations offer prayers; but they have no assurance of being heard, as do those of the Saints. Therefore, I shall answer the question as follows:—

1. Most of them mistake the right Being to pray to, such as a being without ears to hear, or hands to impart, or feelings to have compassion for them; and thus it is difficult for such a being to hear their prayers. Others pray to Jesus Christ, instead of to his Father. Others to their fellow men, and a few to Lucifer, son of the morning. I have heard prayers to these beings myself, but they were not heard.

2. Others pray, but do not pray in the correct name. These are the brothers of the Pharisees of old, supposing that they deserve to find favor with God, because of their own good works. Therefore, their prayers are not heard.

3. Many pray also, however not through the direction of the Holy Ghost, but rather their own spirits, and other similar ones, but not the correct one. These refuse the ordinance through which one receives the Holy Ghost, and they refuse all its gracious gifts. Thus, they exclude themselves from the promise of God, and their prayers are not heard.

4. Some pray with neither faith nor belief that they will enjoy their desires, rather they doubt, and believe that it is not here they will enjoy them, but after they die, and in another world. They do not ask from the heart, rather they are as the Lord said through the prophet,—“This people draw near to me with their lips; but their hearts are far from me.” Despite this, they have the words of a prayer, a voice of sighing from the heart, as it were; but they pray “to be seen of men at best, the one to hear the other, so they receive a great name, a good word, or as the scripture says, “their reward.” For this reason their prayers are not heard.

5. Others pray also, and without caring at all whether that which they ask is according to God's will to give them, or whether receiving their request would be beneficial to them or not. They ask for things they do not comprehend, or understand; thus their prayers are not heard.

6. Others pray often in the family, and in the meetings, but they are not earnest in the task, nor determined in the work; but because the scripture says that “a godly people prays,” and that believers have a duty to do so, they pray, but they are neither earnest nor determined; thus their prayers are not heard.

7. Others pray, but not with the correct purpose, but so they can use up such things (if they receive them) for their sweet desires. These have more desire to benefit themselves, than to glorify God; everything has to do with them, and everyone and everything else is as naught. But their prayers are not heard.

8. Others mistake the time they should pray; they neglect the season of youth; but on their deathbed, they call on others to pray for them, and strive at that time to pray themselves; and if their prayers are not heard at this time, which is quite unlikely, it is because fear of death and judgment

is what compels them to pray at this time, and not love for God, because he first loved us, and gave his Son as an atonement for our sins. They will be at that time like the rich man, totally ignorant of God, or his manner of answering the prayers of his children, and for that they will be open, like the rich man, to pray to Abraham, instead of God, for a drop of water, instead of salvation! and to send one from the dead, to testify of the pains, instead of God's plan to save!

9. Many pray also without striving to keep the commandments of God, yes, without so much as obeying the form of sound doctrine, much less living according to the teaching of Christ and the apostles. Some pray for God to forgive them, when they do not forgive one another, yes, their brothers and sisters in the same church. They are not completely joined together in the same mind, or in the same opinion; rather each one has his own mind, his own opinion; the number of opinions, and of persons in the same church is quite close. They ask for their daily bread, when they have more than enough. They do not lift their hands according to the wish of the Apostle; they are in such a mist of darkness, that an occasional drunkard prays, an occasional fornicator, an occasional miser, an occasional thief, yes, in short, the wise man, the fool, and everyone; but not everyone's prayers are heard; and because of this, I have written about some of the obstacles that must first be removed, before bending the knee before God, and calling on him.

Now, old brothers and fathers, with the various religious denominations,—I urge you to consider this, so that you can remove the obstacles, and enjoy your desires after coming to the Saints, as I myself through mercy have done.

Graig-ddu.

Yours humbly,

JOHN RICHARDS

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMESLY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[*Continued from page 108.*]

TESTAMENT OF ZEBULUN,

Made to his children at his death, about Compassion and Mercy.

Zebulon said as he died,
In the presence of his children and everyone he loved,
To be Compassionate and Merciful
To every man in time of hardship.

THE CHARGE that Zebulon gave to his children in the hundred and fourteenth year of his life, two and thirty years after the decease of Joseph; he said unto them,

Hear ye me, ye sons of Zebulon, a good gift to my father and mother; for when I was begotten, my father was greatly increased in sheep and

cattle, by reason of the good luck that he had through the straked rods.

I wist not, my children, I wist not that I sinned in those days, for I considered not that I dealt wickedly through ignorance in Joseph's case; and moreover concealed it with my brothers, from my father; howbeit that I wept much for it in secret. For I was sore afraid of my brothers, because they had all conspired together to kill him with the sword that should betray that secret: nevertheless when they would have killed him, I besought them most earnestly with tears, that they would not do such wickedness; for Simeon and Gad came upon Joseph to have killed him, and Joseph falling upon his knees, said unto them, Have pity upon me, my brethren, have pity upon the bowels of our father Jacob, and lay not your hands upon me to shed innocent blood; for I have not sinned against you, and if I have done amiss, nurture me with chastisement, but lay not your hands upon me, for our father Jacob's sake. Upon his saying of these words, I being moved with compassion, came and wept, and my heart melted within me, and all the substance of my bowels were loosened upon my soul, and Joseph wept, and I with him, and my heart trembled, and the joints of my body quaked, and I was not able to stand. And when he saw me weeping with him, and them coming towards him to kill him, he fled behind me, and besought them to take pity of him. Then, Reuben stepping in, said, My brethren let us not kill him, but let us cast him into the dry pit, that our fathers digged, and found no water in it, for God suffered not any water to spring up in it, because it should be a safeguard for Joseph, and so they did, till they sold him to the Ishmaelites. Thus gave I not consent to the sin against Joseph: but Simeon and Gad, and the other of my brothers, taking money for Joseph, bought shoes with it for themselves, their wives, and their children, saying, Let us not eat it, because it is the price of our brother's blood, but let us tread and trample it under our feet, because he said he should reign over us, and we shall see what his dreams will come unto: therefore, in the sceptre of Enoch's law, it is written of him that would not raise up seed to his brother. I have loosed Joseph's shoe, for when we came out of Egypt, the young man unbuckled Joseph's shoes at the gate, and so we worshipped Joseph, as if it had been Pharaoh, and not only worshipped him, but also kneeled down before him with blushing, and so were we put to shame before the Egyptians, for afterward the Egyptians heard of all the ill that we had offered and done to Joseph.

After the laying of him in the pit, my brothers set meat upon the table to eat, but I mourning for Joseph, did taste no meat by the space of two days and two nights together; neither would Judah eat with them, but had an eye unto the pit, because he feared lest Simeon and Gad

should step thither and kill him; and when they saw I ate nothing, they set me to keep him till he was sold.

He was in the pit three days and three nights, without repast, yet he was sold.

Then, Reuben hearing that he was sold, in his absence, rent his garments, and wept, saying, How shall I look my father Jacob in the face? And therewithal taking money, he ran after the merchantmen, but he could not find them, for they had left the king's highway, and were gone away apace by by-lanes, and Reuben ate no meat that day.

Dan therefore coming unto him, said, Weep not, neither be sad for the boy, for I wot what we may say unto our father Jacob. We will kill a kid and stain Joseph's coat with the blood of it, and say unto our father, See if this be thy son's coat, or no? for when they intended to sell Joseph, they stripped him out of his father's coat and put upon him an old coat of a bondservant.

Simeon had gotten his coat, and would not deliver it us, but was minded to have cut it in pieces with his sword; and he was angry that he was yet alive, and that he had not slain him.

Then all my brethren rising up together, said unto him, Why shouldest not thou give it us, seeing that thou only art the worker of this mischief in Israel? Whereupon he gave it them and they did as Dan had counseled.

And now, my children, I warn you to keep the Lord's commandments, and be merciful to your neighbors, and have inward compassion towards all; and not only towards men, but also beasts, for in that respect the Lord blessed me, insomuch that when all my brothers were sick, I escaped without sickness; for God knoweth every man's intent.

Therefore, my children, have compassion in your bowels, because that as any man dealeth with his neighbor, so will God deal with him.

For the children of my brothers fell sick also, and died, for Joseph's sake, because their fathers pitied him not, but my children were preserved without sickness, as you know.

And while I was upon the seacoast of Canaan, I fell to fishing for my father Jacob; and whereas many others were drowned in the sea, I abode unhurt.

I was the first that made a fisherboat to float upon the sea, for God gave me understanding and wisdom therein, so that I did set up a mast in the boat, and fastened a sail in the midst of the wood; and coasting along the shore in it, I fished for my father's household, till we came into Egypt.

And for pity's sake, I gave of my fishing to every stranger that I met with, and if there were any foreign-born, or any sick body, or any aged

person, I boiled my fish and dressed it well, according to every man's need, and carried it to them, comforting them, and having compassion with them; and therefore, God made me to catch much fish in the sea. For he that give his neighbor, receiveth the things multiplied of the Lord.

Five years did I fish, giving to every man that I saw, and serving all my father's house sufficiently.

In harvest time I fished, and in winter time I fed sheep with my brothers.

Now, will I tell you what I did, when I saw a miserable man in the deep of winter, and having compassion upon him, I stole a garment privily out of my house, and gave it the naked man.

You therefore, my children, take pity indifferently of all men, and shew mercy with the things which the Lord giveth you, and deal them abroad to all men with a good heart; and have compassion on him with inward mercy: for I know that my hand was not slow to give to him that wanted, and to spend the time with him, insomuch that I have walked above seven furlongs with such a one weeping, and my heart yearned upon him for compassion.

You therefore, my children, have earnest and inward mercy towards all that are in misery, that God having pity upon you, may be merciful to you likewise. For in the last days, God will send his mercy upon the earth, and wheresoever he findeth inward and hearty mercy, there will he dwell; for look, how much mercy man sheweth to his neighbor, so much will God shew to him again.

And then, when we came down into Egypt, Joseph minded not our evil dealing with him, but when he saw us, it made his heart yearn; on whom ye look my children, learn to forget the harm that is done to you; love ye one another, and do not one of you think upon another's ill dealing, for that breaketh unity, and displeaseth all kindred, and troubleth the mind, for he that is mindful of harm past, hath not the bowels of mercy. Mark the water and see how it wasteth away the sand, when the stones and timber are removed asunder. And if a brook be drawn into many streams, the earth sucketh it up, and it cometh to nothing; and so shall you, if you be divided among yourselves; therefore, divide not yourselves into two heads, for all things that God hath created have but one head apiece; he hath given a man two shoulders, two hands, and two feet; but yet do all the members obey one head.

But I know by the writings of my fathers, that in the last days ye shall depart from the Lord, and be divided in Israel, following two kings, working all abomination, and worshipping all manner of idols, and your

enemies shall take you prisoners, and you shall sit among the Heathen in all misery, tribulation and sorrow of mind.

And afterward you shall remember the Lord, and repent, and he shall turn you again; for he is merciful and full of compassion, and thinketh not upon the lewdness of the children of men, because they be flesh, and the spirit of error beguiles them in all their doings.

After this, God himself raise up unto you the light of righteousness, and wholesomeness and mercy are in his punishments; and he shall redeem all men from the bondage of Belial, and all the spirits of error shall be trodden down, and he shall turn all nations to the following of him, and ye shall see God in the shape of man; for God hath chosen Jerusalem, and God is his name. By the wickedness of your words, you shall provoke him to wrath, and ye shall be cast off till the time of full finishing.

And now, my children, be not sad for my death, neither be ye out of heart because I leave you; for I shall rise up again among you, as a captain in the midst of my tribe, among as many as have kept the law of the Lord, and the commandments of their father Zebulun: but as for the wicked, God will bring everlasting fire upon them, and destroy them forever.

Behold, I return to my rest, as my fathers have done.

And now, fear you the Lord your God, with all your strength, all the days of your life.

And as he had spoken these words, he fell asleep to his singular benefit, and his sons laid him in a coffin, and carried him back again into Hebron, and buried him there with his fathers.

TESTAMENT OF DAN,

Made to his children at his death, concerning anger and lying.

Dan left two commandments
Amid his family which it pays to follow,
In order to reject the lies,
Anger and wrath, and greater foolishness.

THE COPY of Dan, his words, which he spake unto them in his last days, in the hundred five and twentieth year of his life; he called his tribe unto him, and said,

Ye children of Dan, hear my sayings, and give heed to the words of

your father's mouth. I liked in my heart, and shewed in my whole life the thing that is good, for truth joined with right dealing pleaseth God well. I have hated hurtful things, as lying and anger; because they teach a man all manner of naughtiness.

I confess unto you my children this day, that I was glad in my heart at the death of Joseph, that true and good man; and I rejoiced at the selling of him, because our father loved him more than us; for the spirit of spitefulness and pride said unto me, Thou art his son too, as well as he: and one of the spirits of Belial wrought with me, saying, Take this sword and slay Joseph with it, and when he is dead, thy father shall love thee: this was that spirit of spitefulness which counseled me to devour Joseph, as the leopard devoured a kid. But the God of my father Jacob did not put him into my hands, nor suffer me to find him alone, that I might dispatch two sceptres in Israel by committing that wickedness.

And now, my children, I tell you of a truth, that unless you keep yourselves from the spirit of lying and wrath, and love truth, and long sufferance, ye shall perish.

For wrath is blind, my children, and no wrathful man looketh truth in the face, because that although they were his father and mother, yet doth he hold them all his enemies.

Though he be his brother, yet he knoweth him not.

Though he be the Lord's prophet, yet obeyeth he him not.

And though he be his friend, yet he considereth it not: for the spirit of wrath besetteth him with the snares of error, blinding his natural eyes, and dimming the eyes of his mind by falsehood, and giving to him a sight of his own making.

And wherein bleareth he his eyes? In hatred of heart; for he giveth him a self-willed heart against his brother to spite him, and envy him.

Therefore, my sons, wrath is mischievous, for it becometh a soul to the soul, and subdueth the body to itself by overmastering the soul, and giveth power to the body to work all wickedness; and when the soul hath wrought, it justifieth the thing done, because it seeth not.

Therefore, he that is wrathful, if he be a man of might, hath treble power in his anger: one through the help and furtherance of his servants, another of his riches; and where through he persuadeth and overcometh his unrighteousness; and a third of the nature of his own body, which of itself worketh evil.

And though he that is angry be a poor man, yet hath he his natural power doubled: for the said spirit doth always further his wickedness, by causing his deeds to be matched with lying.

And therefore, consider the power of wrath, how vain it is: for he is in bitter speech, and walketh at Satan's right hand, that his deeds may be wrought in untruthness and lying. For Satan hath first of all stung him by speech, and when he hath once pricked him forward, he strengtheneth him by deeds, and troubleth his understanding with bitter nips and losses, and so provoketh his mind to excessive wrath.

Therefore when any man speaketh against you, be not moved to anger; or if he praise you as good men, be not puffed up, nor changed into voluptuousness, or fierceness of countenance; for when a man heareth a thing that is hateful to him, first it tickleth him, and stingeth his mind, so that he thinks he hath just cause to be angry.

Now therefore, my children, if ye fall into any loss, or hinderance, be not out of patience, for the spirit of impatience maketh men to lust for the thing that is foregone, and to be angry for the want of it. Therefore, bear your losses willingly and be not out of quiet for it, for unquietness engendereth anger and untruth, and it is evil to have a double face; anger and untruth talk one to another, to trouble the understanding: and when the mind is cumbered with disdain, the Lord departeth from it, and Belial getteth the dominion of it.

Therefore, my children, keep the Lord's commandments and laws, eschew untruth and hate it, that the Lord may dwell in you, and Belial flee from you; speak every one of you the truth to his neighbor, that he fall not willingly into encumbrance, and so shall ye be in quiet, and ye shall have the God of peace, and war shall not prevail against you: love the Lord all your life long, and love ye one another with a true heart.

For I am sure that in the latter days ye shall depart from the Lord, and walk in naughtiness, working abominations by the working of deceitful spirits in you; for I have read in Enoch, that Satan is your prince; and that all the spirits of fornication and pride shall ply themselves in laying snares for the children of Dan, to make them sin before the Lord.

But my children, stick ye unto Levi, and look upon him in all things.

The children of Judah shall snatch away other men's goods, like lions through covetousness; for this cause shall ye be led away with them into captivity, and there receive all the plagues of Egypt, and all the malice of the Heathen.

Whereupon, ye shall return to the Lord, and obtain mercy, and he

shall bring you into his holy place, and proclaim peace to you.

And saving health shall spring up unto you out of the tribes of Judah and Levi; he shall make war against Belial, and give our young men the victory in revengement; he shall deliver the imprisoned souls of the Saints from Belial, and turn your unbelieving hearts to the Lord, and give everlasting peace to such as call upon him.

The Saints shall rest in him, and the righteous shall rejoice in the new Jerusalem, which shall glorify God forever.

And Jerusalem shall no more be wasted, nor Israel led into captivity, because the Lord shall be constant among men in the midst of it, and the holy one of Israel shall reign over you in lowliness and poverty, and he that believeth in him shall certainly reign in heaven.

And now, my children, fear the Lord, and beware of Satan and his spirits, and draw near to God, and to the Angel that excuseth Israel, for he is the Mediator between God and man, to set peace in Israel; he shall stand up against the kingdom of the enemy, and therefore will the enemy labor to overthrow all that call upon the Lord; for he knoweth that whensoever Israel decayeth, then shall his enemies' kingdom come to an end: but the said Angel shall strengthen Israel, that he come not to an evil end.

At that time shall Israel depart from iniquity, and the Lord shall visit such as do his will in all places of Israel, yea, among the Heathen; and his name shall be The Savior.

Therefore, my children, keep yourselves from all noisome dealing, and put from you wrath, and all untruth. Love truth and mildness, and look what you have heard of your fathers, deliver it over to your children, that the Father of Nations may receive you: for he was true, longsuffering, meek, lowly, and a teacher of God's law, by his own works.

Therefore, depart from all unrighteousness, that ye may stick to the righteousness of the Lord's law, and bury ye me by my fathers.

In saying these things, he comforted them, and kept the sleep of the whole world, and his sons buried him, laying his bones by Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

And like as Dan had prophesied to them, that they should one day neglect God's law, and estrange themselves from their offspring, and native country of Israel, so came it to pass.

(To be continued.)

ACROSTIC.

Among my harsh enemies I live,
 There is none to please me but the saints of my God;
 I am often afflicted, unhappy in my aim,
 In the midst of Babylon's tribulation I stay.
 Dear Saints of Jesus, we will not long be captive;
 Here is a Fund—escape has come:
 Some thousands will praise and laud their Father,—
 He organized the path, we will be set free.
 Patience is needed for Saints (that are
 In the midst of tribulation), to become free;
 The failing and poor, the faithful, full of faith,
 Will enjoy the promise surely some day.
 The obedient of Jesus, we will be blessed, I know,
 By aiding this good plan;
 From Babylon let us hasten, following the Father's advice,
 Joy is ever in Zion, dear land.

Merthyr.

JOHN ARGUST.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

TIME.—A minute of time is a part of life, which cannot be called back; and the memory of it will be a fountain of joy or of sadness.

No man was ever the loser in doing good, because although he may not be rewarded soon, yet, after a time, perhaps some crisis will happen to convince him that virtuous men are dear to Providence.

“W. M.”—It would be foolish for us to attempt to give directions as to how to act in a dream; we have enough work to instruct men who act when awake. Perhaps our brother will receive his own information in his next dream.

PAYMENTS FROM APRIL 2 TO APRIL 16.—Cardiganshire, 8s 6c; Denbighshire, £1 13s; Pembrokeshire, 10s; Llantrisant, 6s 6c; Pontypridd, £1 12s 6c; Llanfabon, 16s; Cwmbach, £1; Twynyrodyn, 15s; Gog, 8s; Hirwaun, £3 8s; Rhymney, £2 8s 6c; Cwmnedd, 4s; Georgetown, £2 11s 7c; Cefn, 17s 1½c; Total, £25 14s 1c.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 10.]

MAY 17, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.]

HENRY WILKINS AGAIN.—LETTER FROM HIM TO
PRESIDENT WILLIAM PHILLIPS.

St. Louis, April 12, 1851.

DEAR BROTHER PHILLIPS,—I have taken the opportunity to write these few lines to you, hoping that they find you in good health, as they leave me at present, thanks be to God.

We received your letter on the 8th day of April, and we were happy to hear from you. I read the letter myself; and with respect to the thing you wished to know about me, namely concerning the letter I sent to my father, it is quite true that I sent the letter to him, and that I called Pratt and you, and many others, deceivers: there is no use in my denying that, rather to confess it. Dear Brother Phillips, the reason for my writing, and calling you and others deceivers was, that I wrote it in my anger, and because I gave heed to all the old tales that I was hearing in this place, which I have proven completely false. It is true that through many tribulations one learns about life. It is true that I was without work or money for a little while at first, and from the time I left home I experienced many *ups and downs*, which were very difficult for me at first, but now I consider it all joy to be called on to suffer for the cause of Christ. I have taken my place in the church since I have

been here, and I know that this is the gospel of Jesus Christ; and my determination now is greater than ever to go forward in the work of the Lord, and to build the kingdom of his dear Son on the earth in the latter days. I never intend to turn my back on this religion, which has brought comfort and happiness to me a hundred times, although the spirits of darkness and their influences frequently endeavor to restrain me; but thanks to God, according to the promise to those who keep his commandments, there is strength according to the day, and assistance according to the cause. I am very sorry that I have been a stumbling block to anyone for my having written about you to my father; but it was too late to repent after sending it; I would like to have been wiser. I beg you that you might be able to forgive me; and here is this letter at your disposal. I am sending a letter to my father concurrent with this one, to repair and extinguish the damage of the letter I sent to him. This in hopes that the Lord will forgive me for the letter I sent to him, and grant me more of his Spirit than ever before, and greater wisdom and determination than ever before. May Gracious God forgive me for my having been a stumbling block to anyone, and I hope that you also will forgive me, that is my prayer. Dear Brother Phillips, I am going to the Valley of the Great Salt Lake this *spring* as a *driver* for an elderly sister from Cardiff by the name of Mrs. George. Her sons refuse to come along with her to the Valley, and they have become quite bad indeed. I wish to see the Valley, so that I can gain a greater knowledge of the law, and receive my endowment; so that I can yet be great in his kingdom, in a future time. I hope that you can overlook the mistakes that are in this letter, since I am not as used to writing in Welsh as I am in English. Please give my regards to David Morgan and his wife, and my relatives, and all the Saints. This in haste from,

Your brother in the gospel,

HENRY WILKINS.

[The foregoing is an accurate copy of the letter; and if anyone doubts, he can see the original by calling at our office. President

Phillips is exhorting the Rev. James Wilkins to publish the other letter in the *Baptist*, if he deems it well, so that the country can have further information concerning the "Mormon Disappointment." We have another letter before us, that President Phillips received the same day, from Morgan Jones (originally from Mynydd, Merthyr), from the same place, dated April 10, 1851, written by the hand of Henry Wilkins himself, which letter can also be seen in our office. The following is a quote from it:—]

"Henry Wilkins is going to the valley of the mountains this spring with an elderly woman from Cardiff, by the name of Mrs. George. Thomas Lewis, Howell Williams, and Henry Wilkins, and myself, are working together, and living together. I can say this much about Henry Wilkins, that he has not been without food, or without a shilling in his pocket, ever since he has been with me, since Christmas. He has been a good brother ever since he arrived here, but it was just in his anger that he sent a letter to his father."

COUNSELS TO DISTRICT PRESIDENTS, TRAVELING ELDERS, AND THE CHURCH IN GENERAL.

DEAR BRETHREN,—Your primary task when you visit the branches, is to look into their books, to see if things are being recorded properly, namely, baptisms, confirmations and ordinations to various offices. Also, make sure that children of the Saints, if they are under the age of eight, are being blessed by the elders, on Sunday in the meetings of the Saints, and not at any other time, except in case of special circumstances, such as illness, poverty, &c.; and make sure that the ages of the children to be blessed, and their names, and the names of their parents, together with the names of the elders who blessed them, are being recorded in an orderly fashion in the Book of the Church, and also the day of the month the ordinance is administered. Then, look into everything such as payments for books, &c., not allowing the branches to go into debt. Then, feel free to teach and to preach as directed by the Holy Spirit; and see to it that these things are being carried forth in an orderly fashion.—Some consider these to be very small things, but I say in the name

of the Lord, that they are the biggest things; and it is a great loss for you to neglect your duty in these things. And let all secretaries who have been appointed, remember to record all numbers correctly, because the angels of heaven are watching you always; remember that you will be lifted up in the kingdom of God if you keep all these things in order; do not seek to preach, except as circumstances allow; rather let your concentration be on the books; put down the deeds of everyone correctly; for the day will come, when the books that are in heaven, and on earth will be opened! And O! brethren, obey the counsel of God, and then you will be blessed greatly by him.

Let the elders teach the Saints to baptize their children, when they reach the age of eight; for God calls them accountable at that age. Some ask, "What purpose does that baptism serve?" and I answer that baptism is for the remission of sins. Have you heard anything about God's having revealed two kinds of baptism? No, never. Well, let all vain talk cease; and if someone fails to understand, let him pray to God to receive enlightenment on the matter. Someone says to a mother that her child is nine years old, but she is afraid that her child will bring shame on the cause if he were baptized because he plays so much and he is so bad; otherwise, he would have been baptized. I say, the sooner he is baptized, the better; no one ever became good except through baptism; and let your children play a little after they are baptized; that is better than for them to be sick in bed; but remember to teach them the purpose of baptism. With respect to the ordinance of the Lord's supper, no one is worthy to partake except those who have been baptized. It has been a practice in this country to give the bread and the wine to children, or babies, but this is not right. One purpose of the practice is, that forgiveness of sins is given to all who partake of it honestly; but little children have no sins; for that reason, let parents of children strive to refrain from giving it except to those who have been baptized. It has also been a practice in this principality, for teachers and priests to preside over meetings when there have been elders present. But from now on the highest priesthood is to preside, in all meetings; and let the teachers and deacons always visit the Saints, and teach them in their homes. See "Doctrine and Covenants," p. 65, section 8.

Instruct the members to read the following books:—Book of Mormon, Doctrine and Covenants, Zion's Trumpet, *Star*, and all the other pamphlets, if they can, or at least strive to do so. Refrain from too much laughter in the homes, tales, and all vain talk; there is an excess of harmful singing. I visit many branches throughout the country, and the first thing that happens after a meeting is over, is singing. I am prevented from saying a word for an hour, when the true need is to give counsel to various persons. I have to listen to the singing, and by the time it is over it is time to go to bed. I enjoy hearing singing as much as anyone in the country; but there is a time for everything, and in the meetings there is a time to sing, or in singing practice, and on other occasions when circumstances allow. Instruct all to go to bed early, for their good health, and to receive wisdom, which is a commandment of the Lord to everyone. The priests and teachers are frequently prevented from officiating in their callings, because of singing when they visit the homes of the members, when everyone should be quiet at their entrance; for they come in the name of the Lord to officiate in their callings. May gracious God bless you together with all the Saints is my prayer in the name of Jesus Christ. Amen.

WM. PHILLIPS.

TO THE EDITOR OF "ZION'S TRUMPET."

MR. ED.—I ask your permission for the few following words to have the honor of appearing in your excellent TRUMPET, which is a virtuous publication, if proper use is made of it:—

I have spent several years in mental turmoil, and that in relation to religious principles, striving in the first place, to discover proof of the existence of the excellent Being whom the scriptures speak of, namely God. Next, what kind of God he is, together with what is his will toward men, or mankind in general; but, through extensive reasoning with myself, and receiving strength and consistency of the logic of others, together with the beautiful and elegant appearance of the creation, I have become persuaded to believe the propriety of

the existence of a God, who is above all in power, in knowledge, in justice, in sanctity, more generous and warm in his love, and more abundant in his mercy than anyone else; consequently, this exalted subject is worthy of the recognition of all by their submission to him, by worshiping him in spirit and in truth; by listening to him, and keeping his commandments—giving consideration to his laws—embracing his ordinances, and their honoring of all through giving perfect obedience to them, and rejoicing in the opportunity they have of doing so. Having journeyed to this point with glimpses of the divine person, together with his attributes, I received encouragement from several persons, who were of religious characters, to search carefully the holy book called the Bible, or the Old and the New Testaments, since that book spoke of holy men, motivated and guided by the wisdom of the Spirit of God; and it contained his will for men in general in their various stations, and also revealed the duty of every man and women, parents and children, toward him, as their Creator and their Keeper, and toward their fellow men, and toward themselves, and that all that God asks from men, or commands that they do, is written and explained in that book. By this time, I was very desirous of searching the book, so that through it I could achieve abundant knowledge of the nature of the divine person, in whose existence I had just begun to believe. In this decision, to know the will of God, I took the book, and after opening it I began to read it and search diligently in order to carry out my objective in its regard; but as I read the book, I saw clearly that the holy authors portrayed this divine Being, with such excellent characteristics, that I judged immediately that he was a highly worthy object of my attention. They said that he is a God who is Almighty, able to work according to his own will, even when the obstacles were as strong as is possible,—he is stronger than the armed strong man, and it is not possible for any enemy who comes against him to ever succeed to the extent of keeping him from doing his will; because he is the Supreme Leader and Lord over everything, and through his dominion he has authority to do as he wishes with every man, with every creature, and with everything: for the work of his hands is everything that

is seen and unseen, in the heaven and on the earth, the heavenly bodies in their orbits and their conjunctions—the contents of the seas—and the things under the earth,—all belongs to the Lord God; as is said by the prophet Isaiah, “I am the Lord that maketh all things, that stretcheth forth the heavens alone, that spreadeth abroad the earth by myself; that frustrateth the tokens of the liars, and maketh diviners mad; that turneth wise men backward, and maketh their knowledge foolish;” as the Psalmist said—“The earth is the Lord’s, and the fullness thereof;” therefore, since everything is the work of his hands, he can do with everyone and with everything as he wishes, and his wisdom clarifies all his deeds; again, although he is all powerful, he is just, and wishes to deal justly with every man: “the Lord will not deal unjustly with a man in his business,” for the Lord is righteous in all his ways, and holy in all his works,” say the scriptures. Furthermore, not only is God all powerful and just, but he is also merciful, and full of compassion for every man,—extending his mercy from day to day, to fulfill the needs of all his creations; this calls loudly to every man to be persuaded to believe in the existence of a God, and to give true worship to him according to his will, considering that his supremacy enables him to teach men to worship him according to his will.

After coming in this manner to believe the necessity of being a servant of God, to be accepted by him, I felt the tendency in myself to be a believing man, thinking that true religion is worthy of service to God. In light of this tendency, I proceeded to search the scriptures further, for commandments in them for men to fulfill in order to be pleasing before God, and glorify his name; and as I searched, I discovered that the following commandments are directed to men in general, namely that they must believe in Christ, repent of their sins, be baptized with water and with the Holy Ghost; love God with all their heart, soul, might, and mind: that a man must also love his neighbor as himself, do good to everyone, especially to the family of the faith; love his enemy, be merciful, conciliatory, thirsting after justice; peaceful with all men; refrain from being in debt to anyone for anything; refrain from loving in word and tongue only, but in

deed, and in truth; and to do unto others as he would have them do to him; overcome evil with goodness; refrain from killing or stealing, or swearing an oath, or committing adultery, or blaspheming, or drunkenness, or anything similar, rather living soberly, justly, godly, always telling the truth, and hating all lies, refraining from bringing false witness against a neighbor or a stranger; refraining from being vengeful, or giving place to anger; holding his tongue from speaking guile; adding to faith virtue, to virtue knowledge, to knowledge temperance, and to temperance patience, and to patience godliness, and to godliness kindness, and to kindness brotherly love; informing also that he must leave aside malice, and all deceit and hypocrisy, and listening to the commandment of Christ, which is as follows—“Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.” According to the scriptures, no one is content with the will of God, except those who obey the aforementioned commandments.

Now, Mr. Editor, will you be so kind as to let me know, through your TRUMPET, whether the foregoing commandments, which are seen in the scriptures, have to do with men in this age and generation? If so, I wish for you to explain a little about them, to guide me as to what I should do to fulfill them. And if there is some denomination of men on the face of the earth which conforms to the aforementioned commandments, be so kind as to let me know, so that I can forthwith, so great is my desire to be a religious man, offer myself as a regular member of their virtuous and godly society. I also wish to be informed where Babylon is located? and who are the Babylonians? and where is Zion, where you say that deliverance can be had from the plagues that are to come on the earth, together with the way of going there.

T. J.

[We agree with the wish of our correspondent, and answer him that the commandments named pertain as much to this generation as to the generation to which they were given. The way to believe in Jesus Christ, is to believe that everything he spoke is constant truth; and the way to repent, is to make a decision to obey God from now on, and not think of weeping and making many contortions—all that is necessary can be done in a matter of minutes. The way to receive

the proper baptism, is to receive our guidance from an authorized servant in the kingdom of God, namely one who will bear witness to that, and at the same time will promise the gift of the Holy Ghost to confirm his words. Such a one cannot continue to deceive for long, for his words can be proved: therefore, take him at his word; and if he proved a deceiver, you can look for the authentic servant until you find him. But deceivers do not dare promise this gift; they choose to say that it is not necessary, in order to refrain from being caught in deceit. Then, the next thing after receiving baptism is to obey all the commandments noted in your correspondence, refraining from all things that are evil, and holding fast to all things that are good. All men, most often, are inclined to some sin that surrounds them; while one is prone to drink, another is prone to adultery—while one is prone to steal, another is prone to idleness—while one is prone to be fickle and unstable in his thoughts, the other is prone to be dishonest, not paying his debt and working justice. As such every man has some things he has to overcome; and to the extent that he overcomes them, to that extent he will be perfecting himself. Every man can overcome all things he comes up against; otherwise he could not be condemned for not overcoming them. Members of the church of God are children in school, where they can learn all things; and after they have all become a “perfect man,” that is when it can be shown which denomination of people have fulfilled all the commandments of God. If our correspondent wishes to join such a denomination, he must join it while in his imperfection, and while he is striving to fulfill the perfect commandments which have been given to him. Such a denomination is the Latter-day Saints; and in their church only must a man work out his own salvation, before he can be saved. For further information about the foregoing things, we direct our correspondent to the various pamphlets we have published.—Next, we shall strive to say *where is Babylon*. The place of Babylon is as broad as the government of the Mother of harlots and abominations of the Earth, which is portrayed in Rev. xvii, as “the great whore that sitteth upon many waters” (verse 1), “which are peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues” (verse 15). The woman or the whore in question, is the great city (namely Babylon, or confusion) which reigneth over the kings of the earth (see verse 18). Until now, it appears that the reign of the woman is spiritual, the same as the kingdom of Zion; but soon it will have some splendid city adopted by the woman, when its government will become more visible than the monarchs of the earth. We consider that Babylon will be the greatest merchandising city on the earth, we say that its *place* will be on the seacoast; for the scripture says, “And every shipmaster, and all the company in ships, and sailors, and as many as trade by sea, stood

afar off, and cried when they saw the smoke of her burning, saying, What city is like unto this great city?" It is clear that the Babylonians are those who are governed by the great whore, who will be drunken with the blood of the saints; and to flee from Babylon, is to flee from her governmental borders, as well as from the city herself.—Next, our friend asks, *where is Zion?* Where the "pure of heart" have gone; and the place where they have gone, is the "high mountain" in the sides of the north. Zion, according to Isaiah xl, 9, will get herself up into the high mountain; and she does that at present, by emigrating to Great Salt Lake City, where "the city has been brought down into a low place." This city will not be the New Jerusalem, or the city of Zion, rather one of her extensions, where the daughters of Zion at present have gone to build a house in the name of the Lord, and to preach the gospel to the ends of the earth. In Zion there will be deliverance, when the wrath of the Almighty will be poured out on the earth. Therefore, hasten everyone to go there; for "We would have healed Babylon, but she is not healed; forsake her, and let us go every one into his own country: for her judgment reacheth unto heaven, and is lifted up even to the skies" (Jer. li, 9). The way to go, is by the direction of the servants of God; and "where there is a will, there is a way."—ED.]

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMESLY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[Continued from page 141.]

TESTAMENT OF GAD,

Made to his children at his death, concerning Hatred.

Listen to Gad, and beware of strife,
Do not allow angry malice into your bosom;
Tolerate wrongs, do not bear a grudge,
God himself will punish the hateful act

THE copy of Gad's testament, and of the things that he spake to his children, in the hundred and seventh year of his life, saying,

I was Jacob's seventh son, and skilful and strong in keeping of sheep; I kept the flocks by night, and when there came any lion, leopard, wolf, bear, or other wild beast, upon our cattle, I ran to it, and killed it.

Joseph also did feed sheep with us about thirty days, who being tender, fell sick by reason of overmuch heat, and went home to Hebron, to our father, whom he ledged by himself, because he loved him.

And Joseph told our father that the sons of Bilhah wasted his goods at Zilpha, and made havoc of them without the knowledge of Judah and Reuben; for he knew that I had rescued a lamb out of a bear's mouth, and killed the bear, and that because the lamb could not live (which thing grieved me) we killed it also, and ate it, and he told our father of it; and our brothers were greatly discontented with his doing, even to the day that he was sold into Egypt. And the spirit of hatred was in me, insomuch as I could not find in my heart to hear Joseph speak, or to see him, because he had rebuked us openly for eating the lamb, without Judah; to be short, he made our father believe whatsoever he told him.

But now I acknowledge my sin, my children, that I was often in mind to have killed him; for I hated him from my heart, and I was utterly without compassion towards him, and the cause of this my great hatred towards him, was his dreams; therefore, I would have devoured him, as an ox eateth up grass from the earth; and for that cause I and Judah sold him to the Ishmaelites, for thirty pieces of gold, which is six pounds, of the which, we kept away ten privily, and showed the other twenty to our brethren: and so covetousness persuaded me to wish his death. But the God of our fathers delivered him out of my hands, to the intent I should not do such wickedness in Israel.

And now, my children, give ear to the words of truth, that ye may live righteously, and keep the law of the Highest, and not go astray through hatred, for that is evil in all men's doings. Whatsoever another man doth, that doth the hater dislike and abhor. And if one keep the law of the Lord, he praiseth it not: and if one fear the Lord, and deal righteously, him he loveth not, but dispraiseth the truth, and he envieth him that ordereth his ways aright, he embraceth backbiting, he loveth scornfulness. And because that hatred hath blinded his mind, he doth to his neighbor, as we did to Joseph.

Therefore, my children, keep yourselves from hatred, because it committeth wickedness, even against the Lord, for it will not hear the words of God's commandment concerning the loving of a man's neighbor, but sinneth spitefully against the Lord. And if a brother offend, by and by it blazeth him abroad, and is hasty to have him condemned and killed, or punished for his offence; and if the offender be a servant, or bondman, it accuseth him to his master, and deviseth all means that may be to persecute him, and to put him to death, if it be possible; for hatred worketh with spitefulness, and is sorry to hear or see men go forward, or prosper in well doing. For like as love beareth good will even to the dead, and wisheth them alive, and would, if it were possible, stay them from death which are condemned to die; so hatred seeketh to slay the living,

and deemeth them unworthy of life for the lightest transgression: for the spirit of hatred doth, through stubbornness of heart, which works jointly with Satan in all things, even to the death and destruction of men.

But the spirit of love doth, through long sufferance, work with God's law to the welfare of men.

Hatred is evil, because it abideth with lying, speaking continually against the truth, making a great ado of small matters, overshadowing the light with darkness, counting sweet to be sour, teaching slanderousness, war, oppression, and abundance of all mischief, and finally filling the heart with devilish poison.

My children I speak these things upon experience, to the intent you should eschew hatred, and stick to godly love; righteousness driveth out hatred, and lowliness killeth it; for a righteous and a lowly person is ashamed to do wrong, not for fear of rebuke, but for conscience sake, because the Lord seeth his intent; he backbiteth no man, because the fear of the Highest overcometh hatred; for he who feareth the Lord offendeth not, neither will do any man wrong, no not even in thought.

And at length I came to the knowledge of these things, when I had repented me of my dealings with Joseph, for the true repentance that is according to God's will, mortifieth the evil things, and brings a man to obedience, chaseth away darkness, enlighteneth the eyes, giveth knowledge to the mind, and leadeth the soul to salvation. And whatsoever men know not of themselves, that doth repentance teach them. For it brought upon me the pain of the heart: and if my father Jacob's prayers had not been, surely I had died out of hand; for look wherein a man sinneth, by the same he is punished; forasmuch therefore as my heart was merciless toward Joseph, I suffered God's rigorous justice in my heart by the space of eleven months, that the time of my punishment might fall out even with the time that I urged the selling of Joseph.

Now, therefore, my children, each of you love your brothers, and put away hatred from your hearts, loving one another in deed, word, and thought of mind. For before my father's face I spake mildly of Joseph, but behind his back, the spirit of hatred darkened my understanding, and tempted my mind to kill him.

Wherefore love ye one another heartily, and if any of you offend the other, tell him of it gently, driving out the poison of hatred, and fostering no deceit in heart; and if the offender confess it, and be sorry, forgive it him: and if he deny it, strive not with him, lest he fall to swearing and so sin double.

Let no stranger hear you uttering one another's secrets in variance; lest he turn to be your ill willer, and work some great mischief against you; for he will talk guilefully with thee, and undermine thee to do thee a shrewd turn, taking his poison at thine own hand. Therefore, if he deny it, and be ashamed of it, and hold his peace when he is rebuked, draw him not out, for in denying he repenteth him, so as he will no more offend thee, but honor thee, and fear thee, and be in quiet: but if he be unshamefaced, and abide by his naughtiness, then refer the revengement of it to God with all thy heart.

If another man prosper more than thou, be not grieved at it, but pray for him that he may have perfect prosperity; for peradventure, it may be to your own benefit; and if he be exalted more and more, envy him not, but remember that all flesh shall die; and praise God for it, who giveth good and profitable things to all men. Seek the Lord's judgments, and so thy mind shall let him alone, and be in quiet.

Now if a man be enriched by evil means (as Esau, my father's brother was) envy him not; for in so doing ye control the Lord, who either taketh away his benefits from the wicked, or leaveth them still to the repentant, or else reserveth them in the unrepentant, to their endless punishment. For the poor man having sufficient of all things, giveth thanks unto the Lord, and is enriched of all men, because men wish him no harm.

Therefore, my children, away with hatred out of your hearts, and love one another with a right meaning mind: also will you your children to honor Levi and Judah, for out of them shall the Lord make the Savior of Israel to come. For I know that in the end your children shall depart from them, and walk in all manner of mischief, naughtiness, and corruption, before the Lord.

And after a little pausing, he said again, My sons, hear me your father; bury me by my fathers.

And so, plucking up his feet he slept in peace; and after five years, they carried him thence, and laid him with his fathers in Hebron.

(To be continued.)

ADMONISHMENT TO DISTRICT PRESIDENTS AND THEIR SCRIBES.

THE Presidents and Scribes of all the Districts and Branches in Wales, are admonished to send in their semi-annual reports, to President Phillips, by the 7th of next June. Tally the numbers on the

1st of June. We request the number of branches, the high priests, the seventies, the elders, the priests, teachers, and the deacons; the excommunicated, those who died, emigrated, were baptized, the current number of members (and in every circumstance the number of members should include the number of officers and the scattered members as well), and the names of the President and the Scribe. We hope the Presidents will see that the numbers will be sent in a timely fashion, that is, by the 7th day of June, so that we will not be forced to wait for them as usual.

THE VOICE OF "ZION'S TRUMPET."

COME, come to the escape,
 Flee to the refuge, hasten quickly
 From the ugly oppression of Babylonia,
 The day of its destruction is drawing nigh.
 See! thou canst be delivered from thine enemies,
 Stand bravely in thy part;
 Yonder on the lovely mount Zion
 Thou canst rejoice in a while.

O little flock, do not fear,
 Obstacles will cease, burst out in song,
 Thy God will be thy protector
 In the water and in the fire.
 Despite suffering long trials,
 Among enemies on the earth,
 Yonder on lovely mount Zion
 Thou shalt have thy great inheritance.

Stop, traveler, leave thy fears,
 Cease thy grieving, cease thy pain,
 Lift up thine eyes, dry thy tears,
 See thy home with the Lamb;
 Listen to the voice of the Prince of life,
 See thy crown in thy hand,
 Thou shalt be adorned with every blessing,
 And wear immortality there.

Sing, thy struggle is nearly finished,
 Thou shalt have victory as thy part,
 On thy lament comes a purpose,
 Possessing freedom ere long;
 If the captivity of cruel Babel,
 Overwhelmed thee many times,
 Away on lovely mount Zion
 Thou wilt have joy at JOURNEY'S END !

Aberamman.

DEWI ELFED JONES.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

WARNING TO EMIGRANTS.—We quote the following from the letter of Daniel Evans (earlier from Hirwaun), who is presently in St. Louis, as a warning to the Saints who emigrate:—"On your arrival in New Orleans, you must purchase food, and thus exchange your money. Get American money in its place; therefore, you must understand the money system before coming here, so that you will not be cheated; but there are many difficulties in understanding the money system. Money of various countries and kingdoms is used here. But the exchange for American money is as follows:—The dollar is 4s. 2c., a half dollar is 2s 1c., a quarter dollar is 1s. 0½c., a dime is 5c., a half dime is 2½c., a bit is about 6c., one cent is ½c. In exchanging 6c., you will lose 1c.; in exchanging a shilling you will lose 2c.; in exchanging half a crown, you will lose 5c.; thus, do not take silver coin with you. In exchanging a sovereign, you will gain 2c.; but with silver coin, you lose. Also, gold and bills are used extensively." This counsel can be beneficial.

BINDING BOOKS.—We wish to give a little counsel about binding books. Do not be eager to bind too much together; for thick books break much sooner, and need a second binding. One volume of the TRUMPET is plenty big for a book; otherwise, we would not make yearly volumes. When several volumes are bound into one, the wear on such is much more than on volumes bound separately, which can be used one at a time. It is better to bind the pamphlets together, in one book, than mixing them with the Trumpet, the Treasury, &c. No one is better off in the long run, by binding many together. Nevertheless, we bind everyone's books as they choose; for it makes no difference to us, or to any other binder, whether the books we bind are thick or thin: that is up to the owners.

THE LATEST WELSH EMIGRANTS.—We have seen letters from David Jones (Monmouth), William Beddoe (Merthyr), and J. Davies (Pendaren), informing us that they began their journey on the 1st of February, and arrived in New Orleans safely on the 6th of April. Out of a company of 374 only four died, three of which were infants who were sickly before being taken on the ship. A daughter of brother Pratt was one of the infants, and she was embalmed to be buried in New Orleans. Among the Welsh, Edward Williams, from Llanelli, Carmarthenshire, was married to Ann Morgan from Cwmbach. Giving extensive accounts of voyages is becoming too common; despite that, there are many things in brother Beddoe's letter that we would like to publish if we had the space.

HE who waits for the opportunity to do much at once, may breathe out his last breath in useless wishes, and will grieve in his final hours over his useless intentions and his fruitless zeal.

THE HUMAN LIFE.—The human life is constantly plundered by invaders; one steals an hour, and the other a day; one hides the theft by driving us with too much haste to our tasks, and the other by lulling us with pleasures and amusement; but the waste continues on, until we have lost everything.

TIME.—Time is that for which we have the greatest need, but time is also that of which we make the poorest use; this without considering that we will have to give an accounting for our time when time has run out.

PAYMENTS FROM MAY 1 TO MAY 15.—Carmarthenshire, £12; Caernarvon, £2 10s; Merionethshire, £1 9s; Denbighshire, £1; Dinas, 8s; Pontytypridd, £1; Pendeulwyn, 10s 4c; Georgetown, 7s 6c.; Pendaren, 10s 6c; Cefn, 14s; Pendeulwyn, 2s 2c; Merthyr, £1 10s; Total, £22 2s 6c.

 Newly published, price one penny, or 7s. 6c. per hundred, Treatise on MIRACLES, describing what they are, their purpose, and when they are performed, and their use as a standard for proving the divinity of a religion: by J. Davis, Merthyr.

 The letter of President F. D. Richards to the Presidents and Distributors will appear in our next issue, as it is in the Star for May 15, 1851, which is sent to us beforehand every fortnight.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 11.]

MAY 31, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

TO THE PRESIDING ELDERS AND GENERAL BOOK
AGENTS OF THE CONFERENCES OF THE CHURCH
IN THE UNITED KINGDOM OF GREAT BRITAIN
AND IRELAND, TOGETHER WITH THOSE OF THE
ISLE OF MAN AND CHANNEL ISLANDS.

(From the "Millennial Star.")

DEAR BRETHREN AND FELLOW SERVANTS,—Your attention is particularly requested to the subject of this article, namely, the financial condition of your Conferences, as connected with that of this office. It is a fact worthy of gratitude and congratulation before God, and that the circulation of the printed word, in most of the Conferences, has been vastly increased during the last two quarters, yes, beyond that of any previous period since the organization of the church. In this we greatly rejoice, and pray that the same noble and godly spirit of enterprise may increase and abound, until every Conference and Branch shall be aroused and stimulated to worthily emulate the examples of such as have gone forward in this glorious undertaking. Experience is daily proving to us, to the Saints, and to the world, that wherein his people seek to spread abroad the knowledge, of the glorious Gospel to their fellow creatures, in love, humility, and with much prayer, the Lord owns their humble efforts, and crowns them with success, often to an unexpected extent. As an instance, a single person has received not less than ten shillings, in voluntary donations, from persons, not members of the Church, to aid in purchasing tracts for circulation, in one week, while engaged in her errands of distribution to the houses in her portion of the town. The time

that has already elapsed since the more general organization of Tract Societies, and Book Clubs among the churches, has begun to tell with surprising effect generally, where these means have been adopted, by the greatly increased additions of members to the Church, causing a spirit of inquiry after truth, both in the church and out of it, among whom we have observed editors and publishers; and in several instances, where the work had acquired a state of apathy and langor, it has been, by these means, aroused to a state of life, energy, and vigor; in fact, wherever the plans for circulating the books and tracts have been adopted, they have furnished the most demonstrable evidence of their utility, and adaptation to the wants of the people, upon the subjects of revealed religion; and it is earnestly hoped, that those Conferences and Branches which have not made that degree of advancement in the knowledge of God, and acquisition to their numbers, which appears desirable to them in order to keep pace with their sister churches, may be induced to find a remedy through these means, now so generally employed.

Your special attention is requested to the fact, that the amount of debts due for Books, Stars, &c., by the several Conferences, and others, for the quarter ending March 15, and published in No. 7, for April 1, of the present year, is nearly double the amount published in No. 1, due for the previous quarter; and the accumulation of the debt during the last quarter, over the amount accumulated the previous quarter is considerably more than doubled; this, we conceive, augurs much in favor of the growing increase of our Redeemer's kingdom in the future, as well as indicates mightily and truly its present progress, for it must enlarge, and as it enlarges, our plans and arrangements must enlarge commensurably with it, until its triumph. The greatly increased demand for books during the last quarter has quite exhausted the eighth edition of our Hymn Book. The Book of Mormon, and the Doctrine and Covenants are also nearly out of print. As an index to our views of enlargement, we will state that, in 1847, an edition of four thousand Hymn Books was considered ample for the promised demand. In 1849, the eighth edition of ten thousand was published, and the ninth edition, now in press, consists of twenty-five thousand, which will soon be ready for sale. In view, then, of our enlarged plans for publishing the various works of the Church, and the greatly enlarged amounts due from the Conferences, it becomes our duty to call upon you at this time to cooperate with us more effectually, by causing all funds arising from the sale of any and all the publications of the Church, which may be in your hands, to be remitted to us with the least proper delay. We cannot balance our sheets with the Printer and the Distributors, by doing as did the Quaker, when he lost his account book, namely,

by saying "*let brotherly love continue.*" Nothing less than the Pounds, Shillings and Pence, will answer their purpose; and nothing less than the same, can answer ours; nor can anything short of a prompt and faithful attention to the business transactions of the Church, enable us to carry on the work of God which is entrusted to us, either in the Office, or in the Conferences; and if any man is not faithful over the unrighteous mammon, how shall he be found worthy to be entrusted with the true riches!

Since the autumn of 1846, it has been the established usage of the Conferences to appoint agents by vote, through which they became responsible for them in Pounds, Shillings, and Pence, in case of defalcation. If this has been lost sight of by any of the conferences, let them not fail to take such action at their next quarterly meeting, and report the same to this office. It will be seen then, that no general agent is directly responsible to this Office, for his management in the duties of his agency, but to the Conference which he serves; and the Conference alone is responsible to this office, for the payment of all debts contracted by their agent for them. It is the duty of the presiding elders, to render themselves fully acquainted with the state of their agent's accounts, and to know verily, as often as once per quarter, that the amount of debts due from the sub-agents, together with the books, tracts, Stars, &c., in their hands, shall be fully equal to the amount of debt due this office; and as the branch agents are instructed not to sell the works of the church on credit to individuals, but for cash only, then if these instructions are faithfully and unitedly carried out, it will not be inconvenient to balance your accounts quarterly.

Brethren, let no shyness or false modesty deter you from a prompt and faithful performance of this duty; it is not enough that you issue your instructions to the effect merely, but it is required of you to see that such instructions are executed. If your agents are upright and faithful in their duties, it will afford them special pleasure to submit their conduct and accounts, for your supervision and wholesome counsel; and should there be any reluctance manifest on their part, to presenting the subject fairly and faithfully to the light—that alone is sufficient reason, for the vigilance and promptitude, herein urged, on your part.

All agents, whose accounts with us amount to £5 per quarter, should make their remittances monthly, and those whose amounts are less, should remit at the middle and close of each quarter, taking care to make their last remittance in time that it may be placed to their credit before the list of debts is published for that quarter.

The vast amount of good which it is in the power of the Book and Star agents to accomplish, is a consideration which

should lead to the selection of enterprising and just men—men of FAITH, who study the extension, increase, and upbuilding of the Kingdom of God—men who seek first the Kingdom of God and His righteousness, and who will not sacrifice its interest for personal convenience or profit, whether his own or anyone's else, however near, dear, or confidential they may be; as, for instance, Neighbor Self knowing there is Church money in the agent's hands, wishes to get the loan of a small amount for a few days, to accomplish an important object. The agent feeling very desirous to oblige, and withal being well acquainted with brother Self, and having great confidence in him, obliges him with the use of a few pounds, fully believing that when it is wanted he will be quite prepared to pay; soon unexpected misfortune cuts off the hope of his gain from some quarter, and he is unable to restore the money to the good brother Agent. Agent kindly conceals brother Self's misfortune, until he is required to produce a balance sheet of his accounts, when lo, and behold, the amount stands to the debit of the Agent's account, cash lent to Self. The agent now, unable to make full payment, or if able, perhaps unwilling, to pay what brother Self would have restored, if he had not been unfortunate, is found defaulter; and both he and brother Self have lost the confidence of the Saints, jeopardized their standing in the Church of God; and the Conference must now meet the demand.

Now, we specially request, that when sufficient funds are in hands to admit of any appropriation whatever, that the same be appropriated to the benefit of their real owner—the Church, by forwarding the same to the address of the *Star* office. The Church has not yet become sufficiently wealthy to open loan, or exchange offices, in various parts of the kingdom; and desires earnestly to avoid the necessity of borrowing, which it is thought may be effected, provided the agents pass over their quick turned pennies to her constant aid. It must be apparent to every considerate person, that with so rapidly an increasing amount of stock outstanding in the Conferences, that unless there is also as rapidly increasing attention paid to making quick returns, our ability to extend the publishing department, must be very much impaired; and also that our inability will be increased according to the number of such as do not remit for eight or ten months at a time, and such, as without increasing their orders for publications, suffer their debts to increase quarter after quarter. We are pleased to state that such instances are *few*, but we earnestly hope they may soon be *less*.

It is not wisdom for the presiding elders to encumber themselves with the duties of a general agency, as it will limit the extent of

their more valuable labors, in the Church; and it will limit them in devising ways and means for the spread of both the printed and preached word in places where the Gospel is not yet known; besides that, if you should make a few pence on a parcel of books, although it might not be enough to pay you for your trouble, its tendency is to close up the benevolent feelings of the people towards you—lead them to forget that you are sent to preach the Gospel without purse or scrip, by inflating them with an idea that you are making a living from the sale of books.

It is better that other men be appointed agents, and treasurers of the Perpetual Emigration Fund; and that you, in the spirit of your callings, preside and teach officers and members their duties in all things, both temporal and spiritual. It is the duty of the various treasurers of the Perpetual Emigration Fund to remit *the full amount donated at the close of each quarter*; and the Presiding Elders will see to it that not one farthing donated to that fund is appropriated to any other object. Should any misappropriations of the Perpetual Emigration Fund occur, the person thus offending, unless he shall repent and speedily restore every farthing, will be displaced, and one who has feelings of compassion for the poor, and who will handle their funds with clean hands will take his office.

In conclusion, you are requested to examine an article upon these subjects, contained in the *Star*, No. 19, of last volume; and the two articles together will enable you to understand clearly our views, as to the best method of cooperating with us in the business affairs of your conferences with this office; and we shall be enabled, by your attention thereto, not only to issue the new-revised and enlarged edition of the Hymn Book, but also a new edition of the Book of Mormon, and the Doctrine and Covenants, by the opening of next emigration season.

May the spirit of the living God enable you to go out and in before His people in meekness, purity, and faithfulness, that you may minister unto them successfully eternal life, and have great joy in your labors.

F. D. RICHARDS.

REMARKABLE HEALING.

DEAR BROTHER DAVIS,—I am sending the following to you, hoping that you will sound it through your TRUMPET.

Monday, the 18th of this month (May), as I was returning home

from my work, a messenger came to request that I administer the ordinance of anointing with oil, on a young brother about twelve years of age, by the name of William Phillips, in Aberaman. Soon after washing, I went there, and there were present two elders and a number of Saints. In the presence of them all, together with one of the world, the doctor was asked if the boy had broken his leg, and he answered that he had; then after setting the leg, and putting a splint on it, the doctor went away. After the meeting in the evening, another elder and I anointed the boy with oil in the name of the Lord, and I felt the bones come together during our prayer for him. He testified that his pain had vanished, and that the splint was no longer necessary. We saw him walk out on the 22nd, namely in three days.

Aberaman.

JOHN EDMONDS.

N. B.—We testify that this account is true.

DANIEL BIRCH,
SAMUEL DAVIES.

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMELY THE SONS OF JACOB.

[*Continued from page 161.*]

TESTAMENT OF ASHER,

*Made to his children at his death, concerning two faces, one of vice,
and the other of virtue.*

Asher said to his sons,
That there are two ways to the human race;
And two things to lead you amongst them,
Never keep two faces towards them.

THE copy of the testament of Asher, of the things that he spake to his children, in the one hundred and tenth year of his life, being still in health he said unto them,

Ye, children of Asher, hearken unto your father, and I will shew you all things that are right before the Lord.

God hath given two ways unto the sons of men, two minds, two doings, two places, and two ends; therefore, all ways may be one, yea, though they be contraries, as are the ways of good and evil: also there are two minds in our breasts, which do move us either to honesty, or dishonesty.

Therefore, if a man be led to goodness, all his doings are occupied about righteousness, and if that he do anything amiss, by and by he

repenteth him; inasmuch as his mind is bent unto righteousness, he putteth away naughtiness, and out of hand amendeth his misdeeds, and correcteth the corruptions of his mind.

But if his mind incline unto evil, all his doings rend unto naughtiness, insomuch that he thrusteth away the good, and taketh unto him the bad, because he is under the dominion of Belial: and if he do any good thing, he turneth the same unto evil, for if he begin to do any good, he bringeth the end of his doing to an evil work, because the treasure of his heart is infected with the venom of a devilish and mischievous spirit; and therefore the evil overmastereth the good that is in his mind, and bringeth the end of the thing to naughtiness.

Some man sheweth compassion upon him that serveth his turn in naughtiness, that man hath two faces, and that deed of his is stark lewdness.

Another man loveth ungraciousness, and he is lewd likewise: and although he could find in his heart to die for the compassing of his evil, yet it is manifest that he is double-faced, and his doing is altogether stark naught; for his love being but lewdness, doth as it were cloak his evil with a good name, whereas the drift of his doings tendeth unto a wicked end.

Another is miserly and doth open wrong, pilleth, and polleth, is covetous and pitieth not the poor; he also hath a double face, and all this is stark naught; for in being niggardly towards his neighbor, he provoketh God's wrath, and denieth the Highest in not pitying the poor; he despiseth and spiteth the Lord, which is the commander of the law, he suffereth not the poor to rest; he defileth his own soul to make his body gay, he killeth many and pitieth few. This is the part of a double-faced person.

Another committeth whoredom and fornication, or vexeth many men pitiously with his power and riches, and yet abstaineth from meats, his fast is naught for he doth the commandments with an evil conscience, and that is a double-faced dealing, which is altogether naught. Such manner of folks are right swine and hares; for they seem to be half clean; but in very deed they be utterly unclean.

You therefore, become not like them, neither bear ye in one hood two faces, the one of goodness, and the other of naughtiness, but stick all only unto goodness; for in goodness doth God rest, and men like well of it. Shun naughtiness, and kill the devil in your good works. For they that are double-faced serve not God, but their own lusts, because they seek to please Belial, and such as are like themselves.

Now, though plain dealing men, and such as pretend but one face, are taken for offenders at the hands of such as bear two faces; yet are they righteous before God; for many in killing wicked persons do two

works at once, namely good by evil; but indeed the whole work is good, because that he which hath rooted out the evil, hath destroyed it.

Some man, hating his neighbor, unmercifully blameth him for his theft, for such a one is the whole work good, because he followeth the Lord's example, not respecting what seemeth good when it is evil indeed.

Another will not make merry with rioters, lest he should be stained by them, and defile his own soul: this man also is double-faced, but yet is all his doings good; and he is like a roe or a stag, which in a common wild herd seem to be unclean, and yet are altogether clean, because he walketh in the zeal of the Lord, shunning and hating those whom God willeth to be shunned in his commandments; and so killeth the evil with well doing.

See therefore, how there are two in all things, one against the other, and the one hidden under the other: death succeedeth to life, shame to glory, night to day, and darkness unto light. All righteous things are under life and light; therefore doth eternal life overmaster death. It is not to be said that truth is untruth, righteousness unrighteousness, or right wrong, because that as all things are under God, so all truth is under light.

I have practiced all these things in my life, and not strayed from the truth of the Lord, but sought out the commandments of the Highest, to the uttermost of my power, and walketh with one face in goodness.

Take heed therefore, to the Lord's commandments, and follow the truth with one single face. For they that are doubled-faced, shall be double punished: the spirit of error hateth the man that fighteth against it.

Keep the law of the Lord, and regard not evil that seemeth good, but have an eye to the thing that is good indeed, and keep the same; returning to the Lord in all his commandments, and resting upon him; for the ends whereat men do aim, do them their righteousness, and know the angels of the Lord from the angels of Satan.

For if you cleave to wicked spirits, your souls shall be tormented of those wicked spirits, whom ye serve in wicked lusts and works. But if ye quietly and cheerfully acquaint yourselves with the Angel of peace, he shall comfort you in your life time.

My children, become not like the Sodomites, which knew not the Angel, and perished forever. For I am sure that you shall sin, and be delivered into the hands of your enemies, your land shall be laid waste, and yourselves shall be scattered into the four corners of the earth, and be despised as unprofitable water in your dispersing abroad, until the Highest do visit the earth, eating and drinking as a man, with men, and

breaking the serpent's head in pieces without noise; he shall save Israel and all the heathen by water, being God hidden in man.

Therefore, tell your children these things, that they neglect not God's law, which is written in the tables of heaven. For the time will come, that they shall give no credit to the law of the Lord, and you falling into naughtiness, shall deal wickedly against God, giving no heed to his law, but unto men's commandments.

For this cause shall ye be scattered abroad, as my brothers Gad and Dan, which were not acquainted with their own country, tribe, and tongue.

Nevertheless, the Lord shall gather you together again in faith, for the hope of his mercy, for Abraham. Isaac, and Jacob's sake.

When he had so said, he commanded them to bury him in Hebron; and he died, sleeping a good sleep. And afterward, his sons doing as he had willed them, carried him back, and buried him with his fathers.

TESTAMENT OF JOSEPH,

Made to his children at his death, concerning chastity.

Gentle, civilized Joseph, shining with praise,
 Gifted, with remarkable talents;
 He suffered – there is good to come,
 For the holy at the end of the race.

MY sons and my brethren, hear ye Joseph the well-beloved of Israel. My children, hear your father; I have known in my life envy and death, with the which my brethren would have destroyed me, for they hated me, and the Lord loved me. They would have killed me, but the God of my fathers kept me alive: they put me into a pit, and the Most High brought me out again: I was sold as a bondman, and the Lord made me free, and his strong hand helped me: I was kept in hunger, and the Lord himself nourished me: I was sick and the Lord visited me: I was in prison, and the Savior made me glad: I was fastened in chains, and the Lord unbound me: he pleaded my cause in the accusations of the Egyptians; and not only delivered me from envy and deceit, but also exalted me; insomuch that Potiphar, chief Steward of Pharaoh's house did lend me lodging, where I was in jeopardy of my life, by reason of a shameless woman, which enticed me to do naughtiness with her, through the flame of voluptuousness, burning about her breast. I was cast in prison for her: I was beaten and mocked for her, yet the Lord caused the keeper of the prison to be moved with mercy towards me.

He forsaketh not them that fear him in darkness, neither in bonds,

neither in tribulations or necessities.

God is not ashamed as men, neither dreadeth he as men; neither speaketh or shrinketh he for fear, as earthly men; he is present in all places; and in their most grievous sorrows he comforteth his: he goeth away for a season, to try the thoughts of their mind: he found me trusty in ten temptations, and in every one I was constant, and he preserved me. For sufferance is a great medicine, and causeth much goodness.

How often did the Egyptian threaten my death? And how often was I punished? and yet the woman called me again. How often did she threaten me to die, because I would not have to do with her!

She said unto me, Thou shalt have governance of me, and all that be mine, if thou wilt give thyself unto me, and obey my desire, and thou shalt be lord over us.

But I remembered the words of my father Jacob, and entering into my chamber, made my prayer to the Lord, and fasted seven days; yet I appeared unto the Egyptian in the self-same estate of body, as if I had lived in pleasures and delights: for they that fast for God, receive beauty of face.

When I had wine given unto me, I drank none; and fasting three days, I took my meat daily and gave it to the sick and needy, and early I awaked unto the Lord, and wept for Memphitica the Egyptian, because she was evermore troubling of me.

She came unto me in the night, as though she would have visited me: and first, truly, because she had never a son, until which time she feigned to take me as her son, and I prayed to God to send her a son, until which time she embraced me, as though I had been her son, and I perceived not the cause.

And for a conclusion, she drew me to have done fornication with her; and I, remembering myself, was sorrowful to the death.

And when she was gone out, I came to myself, and I sorrowed many days; for I perceived her deceit and error. And I spake unto her the words of the most high God, if peradventure she might be turned away from her pernicious concupiscence.

Many times, as to a holy man, she spake flattering words to me, not without deceit, lauding my chastity and my honesty before her husband, which would utterly have destroyed me.

Both manifestly and secretly she said unto me, Fear not my husband; for he is persuaded of thy chastity; for if it so be that any man showed him of thee and me, he would not believe it.

For because of this thing, I covered me with sackcloth, and laid

me flat upon the earth, and prayed unto Almighty God, that he would deliver me from this woman of Egypt.

When she could do nothing this way, she came unto me again armed with other reasons, that is to say, that she would fain learn the word of God of me, and began to speak after this manner: If thou wilt have me to forsake mine idols, follow my desire, and I will persuade my husband, the Egyptian, to go from his idolatry, and we shall walk in the law of thy God.

I made answer to these things, God will have none to worship him with uncleanness, neither hath he any pleasure in adulterers, and she held her peace, desiring to fulfill her concupiscence. And I fasted and prayed, that God might deliver me from her.

And again at another time, she said unto me: If thou wilt not do adultery with me, I will kill my prince, and so by the law, I shall take thee to my husband.

When I heard that, I rent my garment, and said, Woman, I pray thee, be ashamed of these things before God, and do thou not such an abominable thing, neither despair utterly, that thou drown not thyself in thine own evil. For if thou go about, I shall utter and declare the thoughts of thine iniquity.

She fearing these things, prayed me that I would not bewray her naughtiness, and so departed.

Yea again, she went about to beguile me with gifts, sending unto me all things that men have need of; and she sent me meat stewed about with enchantment: and as the Eunuch brought it in, I beheld and saw a terrible fellow giving me a sword with the dish, and I perceived that she went about to deceive me, and when he was gone, I wept, and touched not that meat, nor any other of her sending, for a good while after.

A day after that she came to me, and said: What is the matter that thou hast not eaten of the meat? and I said unto her, Because thou hast poisoned it, therefore thou shalt know, that I will not come unto idols, but only unto God. Now understand, therefore, that the God of my father, by his angel, hath showed thy mischief unto me, and I have kept the meat to thy shame; if perchance thou mightest repent, or learn that the malice of wicked doers prevaieth not against them that worship the Lord in chastity and honesty. And I took and did eat before her, saying, The God of my fathers, and the angel of Abraham shall be with me; and then she fell down at my feet, and wept. Then lifting her up, I exhorted her in many ways; and she promised unto me, that she would never do such iniquity after that day.

Yet, because her heart was mourning, and did burn towards me in adultery, with sighs coming from the depth of her heart, she cast down her countenance. The Egyptian her husband perceiving her, said, Wherefore holdest thou down thy face?' she answered, I am even sorrowful at the heart; and he comforted her, that was not sick:

Yet again she entered in to me, her husband being without, and said, I am strangled or choked; either I will break my neck, or else drown myself, without thou wilt obey me.

And perceiving that the spirit of Belial troubled and vexed her, I prayed unto the Lord my God, and said thus, Wherefore art thou vexed and troubled, all blind in sin? Remember thyself, for if thou do kill thyself, the concubine of thy husband (who was called *Secon*) envying thee, shall beat thy children, and destroy the memory of thee from off the earth.

And she said unto me: Have done, have done; I perceive that yet thou hast some care for me, I have even enough that thou defendest my life and my childrens', I have good hope in time to come, that I shall obtain my wished desire: and she perceived not, that for the love of my God I said so, and not for her sake.

Whatsoever he be that followeth the concupiscence of his most filthy and pernicious desire, is made servant unto the same, as this woman was: and if he hear any good thing in the passion, wherein he is overcome, he draweth the same to his pernicious or filthy desire.

I say unto you, my sons, that it was about six of the clock when she went from me, and I fell upon my knees, praying to God all that day, with the night following; and about the break of the day, I rose weeping, that I might once be delivered from this Egyptian woman.

Finally, she caught me fast by the garment, drawing me to have gone to bed with her; then perceiving that she waxed mad, and that violently, and with her whole strength she held my clothes, I let my clothes slip from me, and fled away.

Then she complained to her husband of me, which put me in prison in the king's house; the day following after I was sore beaten and cast in prison; and when I lay bound in fetters, this Egyptian woman waxed sick for sorrow, and hearkened how I lauded God, being in a house of darkness, for I rejoicing, with a glad voice, glorified my God only with my cry, that by such occasion, I was delivered from the Egyptian woman.

Yet, she left not to stand hearkening, and said, Have done, and take the offer which I put unto thee, and fulfill my desire, and I will deliver thee from thy bond, and bring thee out from the darkness: but all that

could persuade me nothing, insomuch that in thought I was not inclined to any desire of her; for God loveth him better which fasteth in chastity, being in a prison of darkness, than him which taketh his pleasure with voluptuousness, in a chamber of honor and riches.

For if a man live in chastity, and desire glory, if God perceive it to be expedient for him, he giveth it unto him as he hath done unto me.

Many times, as though she had been sick, she descended unto me unlooked for; and she heard the voice of my praying, and stood the more still; but when I heard her sigh, I held my peace, for in her house she stripped herself naked, breasts, legs and arms, whereby she might have kindled me into the love of her; for she was very fair, and gloriously adorned to have deceived me, but God kept me from her works. Therefore, my sons, behold what sufferance with prayer and fasting doth.

And therefore, if you love soberness and chastity in sufferance and humility of the heart, the Lord shall dwell in you; for he loveth sobriety: and when the Most High doth dwell in a man, although he chance to fall into envy or into bondage, or slander, the Lord which dwelleth in him, will for his chastity not only deliver him, but also exalt him, and glorify him, as he hath done me; for he is always with him, in word, in deed, and thought.

My children, ye know well, how my father did love me, and yet I was never the prouder thereof, in my heart. For though I was a child, I had ever the fear of God in my mind. When I grew unto age, I moderated myself, and honored my brethren, whom I feared. I held my peace when I was sold, because I would not have the Ishmaelites to know my stock and kindred, how I was the son of Jacob, a man of great strength and power.

Therefore, have you in your deeds the fear of God, and honor your brethren; for all men that observe the law of God, are loved of him.

Then I came with the Ishmaelites to a certain place called Indoclep, and they demanded of me what I was; and I said (because I would not reprove my brethren), that I was one of their household slaves. Then said the chief of them, Thou art no slave; for thy countenance doth show thee what thou art; and he threatened me unto the death: yet for all that, I said again, I was their slave.

But when we came into Egypt, they began to strive who should have me for money that was paid, and they agreed that I should abide in Egypt with a merchant, until such time as they had made their merchandise and returned again; and God gave me grace in the sight of the merchant,

that he gave me the charge of his house. And the Lord blessed him by my hand, for the Lord gave him plenty of gold and silver; and I was with him three months and five days.

In this time passed by Memphitica, the wife of Potiphar, in great glory, and she cast her eyes upon me, for the eunuchs had showed her of me, and she showed her husband of the merchant which was made rich by the hand of a young man being an Hebrew, and she said, They had stolen him out of the land of Canaan; therefore, do now judgment upon him, and take the young man to be your steward, and the God of the Hebrews shall bless you; for grace from heaven is in him.

Then Potiphar, her husband, persuaded with these words, caused the merchant to be sent for, and said unto him, What do I hear of thee, that stealest souls out of the land of the Hebrews, in selling of children? And the merchant fell down upon his knees, and prayed him, saying, I beseech thee, Lord, show me, for I know not what thou sayest. He asked again, Where gatest thou this Hebrew child? And he said, The Ishmaelites left him with me, until they came this way again.

When he had said so, Potiphar said, Bring the young man hither. And I being brought in, did reverence to the prince of the eunuchs; for he was the third man in dignity with Pharoah, and prince of all the eunuchs, and he had wife, children and concubines.

And when he had taken me apart, he said, Art thou bond, or art thou free? I answered, Bond. And he said unto me, Whose bond-man art thou? I answered him, The Ishmaelites. And he said again unto me, How came it to pass that thou wast made their bond-man? and I said, for they bought me in the land of Canaan. Yet he did not believe me, saying, Truly thou liest, and commanded me to be beaten.

And his wife spied me beaten at a window, and sent unto her husband, saying, Thy judgment is unjust, for thou dost punish wrongfully the young man that is stolen. But because I changed not my word, yet again was I beaten, and commanded to be kept at his commandment, till such time as my masters came, and his wife said unto him, Wherefore do ye keep in captivity this noble child? it were more alms to let him go, and to beat you. She would fain have spied me in desire of sin, and I knew nothing of this.

He said again to his wife, It is not honest among the Egyptians, to take away another man's goods, before he show him of it. He said that of the merchant, and of me.

And after I was imprisoned, After twenty-four days, the Ishmaelites came, and they hearing that Jacob my father was heavy for me, said unto

me, Wherefore is it that thou saidst thou was a bondman? and now, we know that thou art the son of a great man in the land of Canaan, and thy father sorroweth for thee in sackcloth?

Then I would fain have wept, yet I restrained myself for shaming of my brethren: and said, I know it not; for I am a bond-man.

Then they took council amongst themselves, whether, or to whom they might sell me, lest I should be found in their hands; for they feared my father Jacob lest he should be revenged on them; for they had heard that he was mighty, both to God and man.

Then said the merchant to them, Redeem him now from the judgment of Potiphar: they hearing this, went and asked for me, saying, that they had bought me for money; and he delivered me.

Memphitica spoke unto her husband to buy me, for she said, I hear say they would sell him.

And they sent an eunuch to the Ishmaelites, and desired to buy me, and when he could not bargain with them, he returned and showed his lady that they asked a great price for the child.

She sent again another eunuch, saying, Although they ask two basences of gold, see that thou spare not for money, but buy the child and bring him to me.

He paid eighty golden crowns for me, and said to his lady that he paid one hundred. And I perceiving this, held my peace, lest the eunuch should have been searched.

Now behold, my sons, what I have sustained, love one of you another, and with continuance, cast out from among you deceitful minds, for God delighteth in the concord of brethren, and hath pleasure also in the love and choice of a proved heart.

For when my brothers came out of Egypt, and knew me, I gave unto them their money; and never gave reproach unto them, but comforted them; and after the death of Jacob I loved them more abundantly, and all that ever he commanded me, I did very gladly, and they marveled because I suffered not them to be troubled for a small cause, for all that was in my power I gave them. Their children were reputed to me as mine own, and mine own children as their servants: their life was my life, and their sorrow was my sorrow, and all their infirmity, or disease, was mine: my land was their land, my council was the council of them, and I never exalted myself above them in pride, for mine own worldly glory, but was amongst them as one of the least.

(To be continued.)

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

LOVING EVIL.—Men love evil in themselves, yet there is not one man who loves it in another; and although it may be that a man loves sin, there is no one who loves the sinner.

PRAYER.

O, listen, O good Lord,
 To the earnest prayers of thy children,
 Giving thy smile, and turning thy wrath
 And every evil away.
 Cast down thy heavenly fire,
 To boldly lead us on,
 That in peace we may enjoy
 The manna from above.
 Brighten the look of every Saint's face,
 The dearest children of heaven,
 Benevolent Father, and extend thy hand
 To deliver us to yonder home. P. HUGHES.

 The Old Hymn Book is ready, unbound.

 All who begin to receive the DOC. AND COV. in some Branch, should determine a way to receive all the segments in the same place, whether they move from there or not, so that it will cause no further loss or confusion. Keep the odd segments at hand until we finish the publication, and then perhaps they can be put together in volumes.

 The Branches that commit at the beginning of the year to take a certain number of the TRUMPET, disappoint the Church in its arrangements, when later they send for fewer. If all were to do this, nothing could be published. The TRUMPET is very cheap, and it should be supported. To learn how to sell more, read "Address to the Saints," in No. 22, for 1850.

 We hope to finish the "Testament" in our next issue, and then we will have more space for other things.

 We advise the sons of freedom to put aside composing in strict meter, especially those who cannot.

PAYMENTS FROM MAY 16 TO MAY 28,—Cardiganshire, £1; Flintshire, 15s; Pontytypidd, 17s 5c; Llanfabon, 13s 8½c; Cwmnedd, 6s; Georgetown, £1 1s; Merthyr, £1 10s; Newchurch, 1s. Total, £6 4s 1½c..

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to "*John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*"

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 12.]

JUNE 14, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

ADDRESS OF ORSON HYDE AT A CONFERENCE IN KANESVILLE, IOWA, APRIL 6, 1851.

[From the "Frontier Guardian," for May 2, 1851.]

It is necessary for us to know our present condition. You all know what our condition was five years ago, the wide-spreading *prairie* lay before us, and the sons of the forest as Lords of the same, were our neighbors. We came here under very peculiar circumstances; we were driven out from our homes in Illinois at the instigation of an infuriated and bloodthirsty mob, to find shelter among the savages of the great west. We, like our father Abraham, came out from among the people, to seek a country we knew not of; and inasmuch as we are like him in faithfulness to our God, we are Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise; and the apostle, while speaking of his seed, does not limit their dominion to this world, but says, "All things are yours, and ye are Christ's, and Christ is God's." If all things are given to the Saints, then don't you see what I said before; that the salvation of God is extended to all the children of men. "Strait is the gate and narrow is the way that leadeth to life," &c. From these and the following remarks, many have gathered the idea, that few shall be saved. "Depart from me, ye cursed, into everlasting fire," &c. Now this is the stronghold of many who disbelieve the doctrine that I

have brought under observation. Noah prepared an ark for his own salvation, and that of his family, so that the old world could see him working according to his faith, and thus his faith was made manifest by his works.

The Book of Doctrine and Covenants says, of those who objected his warning, that the Lord prepared a prison for them. This prison is represented in the scriptures to be an everlasting prison, but the sacred volume does not advance the idea that its inmates were to remain there everlastingly, without release or change. For illustration look at our State prison; the prison is there always for the transgressors of the law to be confined in, according to the aggravation of their crimes, but whenever the period arrives that justice is satisfied, and they have answered the end of the law, and suffered its just penalty as transgressors, they are then released, and suffered to go at large among the people, having their freedom,—despite that the prison remains there still. [The Bishop whispered, “How long will they have to continue in prison, those who have not paid their tithing?” Let the delinquents answer.] I will illustrate Love and Fear; it is written in the Bible that God’s mercy, or love endureth forever; but his wrath is but for a moment. For example; you read of the man who fell among thieves which shews the goodness of God extended, that love, or attachment might be generated in the creature towards him. The genius of the governments of the world is, “The more I can, I shall draw nearest to the fountain of mercy.” When a good boy receives a dollar from his father, and makes wise use of it, then by and by the father delivers everything he has to the hands of the son; and thus the words of the scripture are fulfilled, “Thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things. Enter thou into the joy of thy Lord.”

I would here ask, what has preserved us as a people, amid our fluctuations and changes, which have been rather adverse

sometimes? Our union and fidelity in one common cause, and the moral influence used.

Have I injured any of you, in dollars and cents since I have been your presiding officer? If any individuals have been injured, or wronged in this respect by me, answer, Jew or Gentile! [A dead silence ensued for several minutes, and no reply.] I appeal to high Heaven (with hat off and right hand stretched upward) that inasmuch as I have wronged any, it has been through ignorance, and not design.

Some say that I am as kind to the Gentiles, as to the Jews or those in the Church. There is a principle in my breast that I cherish, that is righteousness. I view things ahead with a prophetic eye, and see them all in the Church; for our heavenly Father maketh his sun to rise on the evil and on the good, and sendeth rain on the just and on the unjust. If we only love them that love us, what reward have we? The publicans do the same. Principle, aside from sympathy, should be the character of a counselor, and so long as a man conducts himself aright, whether he is in the Church, or out of the Church, he will be protected in his rights as long as I am your presiding officer. The Church is this day twenty-one years old, and some would have us believe that at that period she was to declare her independence, but all the independence I have to declare is that which I have declared in your ears this day. Independence of character upon principle, aside from cobweb sympathy, or mock friendship. Let no gossip go away and say that Br. Hyde said that we were independent of the United States Government; if any do, they shall be damned.

I believe somewhat like David Crocket, "know that you are right, and then go ahead."

[We omit the last of the address, since it serves no purpose to anyone here to read it.—EDITOR.]

“THE LATTER-DAY SAINTS IN ABERDARE,”

Or Two Baptist Ministers in the Gwawr Chapel, near Aberaman, Aberdare, together with a host of the members who have, and who continue to become Saints, in a Review of the letter of T. Price, Baptist minister of Penypound, Aberdare, in the “Times.”

TO THE EDITOR OF THE “TIMES.”

MR. EDITOR,—In your May 28 edition, there is a piece which tries to refute the “profession of someone (I know not who he is) giving an account of Ministers and the Baptist Church in Aberdare, having become Latter-day Saints.” I consider that T. Price wants to deny this, and throw the truth of the circumstance somewhere about two miles away from Aberdare, in order to fool some people into believing that there is neither a chapel nor Baptists in Aberdare, except for those of his great self and his flock.

Let it be known about Gwawr Chapel (which is now, together with the two ministers and a host of the members, in the possession of the Latter-day Saints) that Aberaman is not “about two miles from Aberdare,” even though it is not in the location nor at the point where the Dare discharges. This is the truth and nothing but the truth; if it be the opposite, let T. Price show otherwise, if he can. It is also true that T. Price, because of this, is incandescent with rage, frothing at the mouth, and spouting curses against the Saints, until his reverend corpus is about to break and fall to shreds. No doubt his vessel will soon be so full of malice for the Saints, that he will explode, and his loathsome parts become as tiny fragments. Well, the sooner the better, then! his murderous blast will have no more effect on the Saints, than the barking of a dog at the moon. The truth of the Latter-day Saints is firm,

“And its position will never be shifted,
While with God it stands its ground.”

I understand that T. Price’s intentions in writing his piece were,

1. To aim to obscure the truth that I, Dewi Elfed Jones, and another ordained minister who assists me, by the name of David Rees, together with many other Baptists, “have turned away from the Baptists,” and joined the Latter-day Saints.

2. To blacken my character, and to bestow upon me his own character.

3. To falsely claim membership of “a host of members of Gwawr Chapel,” who would prefer a million times over never to have any religious name, than to join under the ministry of T. P. or J. W., Cwmbach.

4. To pour forth the profane reservoir of his heart upon the Saints, thereby demonstrating his fondness for and familiarity with the language and secret works of his father, and that he always, as one of the latter’s chief agents, receives of his diabolical influences; and yet, in his hands, all his efforts against the Saints spill by the ladleful upon himself before he attains his ends.

In the context of the above, I ask T. Price the following:—

1. You say that I, “the Dafydd,” am a preacher second to none in sermonizing people from the chapels, and that I have done so two or three times. Is it not the very, very great Thou and his reverence, that “sell-no-talent-at-all for four pounds a month” in Cwmbach, together with your deacons and a host of your members—who came upon us and tried to despoil us of our rights—whom you mean by “people from the chapels”? If so, “*right* enough.” You remember, no doubt,—yes, you do, and you will remember for a good while too, I warrant you—the time my truths pressed so much on your breath and your conscience, that you all had to flee shamefully and fearfully under the weight of the incontrovertible testimonies which overwhelmed you into limpness and servility!

2. How far is it from Gwawr Chapel to your chapel in Penypound? Is it more than a mile?

3. You say that “Dafydd possesses the ability to scatter.” *Right* enough again, for I have scattered you and your kind many times, not just twice or thrice. I am a scatterer, and you shall experience that again, when another host of your members are scattered to join the Latter-day Saints.

4. You say that there is no relationship between “Dafydd and his four followers” (it should be said many foursomes) and the Baptists, and that it is a transgression against the Baptist denomination to link us with them. *Right enough* again. It is perfectly true there is no relationship, and we rejoice greatly in that; but, alas, there was a link between us; and how many score above a hundred were we when we were all “expelled” contrary to the rules of the county Baptist association, in the meeting at Penypound Aberdare?

5. What were the “accusations” brought against us, in addition to the Saintism of opinion, &c., on my part of which you spoke? Specify the accusations to which I admitted, so that the public

may recognize the reverendish tricks in that outrageous quarterly conference meeting of the county Baptist association. Oh, oh, such a disgrace to humanity! Was I or any of the Baptists with me there, allowed to say one word on our own behalves? Why had the accusations not been published in the same way the expulsion was? I entreat all the Baptist ministers of Glamorgan to answer. There is some *sly trick* in the business.

6. Where are the "greatest number," as you claim, who abandoned me? They did not join you, T. P., nor Cwmbach. Did not a host join the Saints?

7. Did I, "the Dafydd," not provide good reason for my closing the chapel door while you and that other little Rev., in conjunction with your brothers, broke the lock of the chapel door without having any authority to do so? That little trick is still remembered, T. P. Has that dreadful combustible urge not left you that took such a savage hold of you while, in the presence of hundreds in the chapel, I painted such an accurate picture of you reverends as hirelings who care more for the wool than for the life of the flock?

8. Are you and your church of the same opinion and practices as Penypound church was six years ago? Your church testifies differently. Was it not in such matters as the laying on of hands upon the newly baptized, &c., which you drummed out of the church, that your chief quarrel with me lay?

A prompt reply to the above will afford a fair opportunity and a natural occasion for the circumstances of all sides to be set out justly and publicly so that everyone may judge for themselves.

In replying, try to be as much of a *good boy* as you can and do not curse yourself out of breath as you have done previously; then I can assure you of every fair play, that your *Matchlessness* may not, as is usually the case, become confused in the effort.

As you are almost as familiar with swearing as breathing, set your twelve profane seals as confirmation of your answers, and put the name of your father as usual in devilish letters on the last great seal, and cast the whole thing after the Saints if you so wish; and everything will be *right* with them, for no one on earth can extinguish all the fiery spears of the devil, except the Latter-day Saints. For goodness' sake, hurry to answer me.

"Do not hold back, and don't be late,
Behold a battlefield, and I await."

Aberaman.

DEWI ELFED JONES.

TESTAMENTS OF THE TWELVE PATRIARCHS, NAMESLY THE SONS OF JACOB.

TESTAMENT OF JOSEPH,

[*Continued from page 179.*]

Therefore, my sons, if ye walk in the commandments of the Lord, the Lord shall exalt you, and bless you in riches perpetual. And if any man will do evil to you, with meekness look that ye pray for him, and God shall deliver you from all evil.

For behold, and see, that for my long sufferance, the daughter of my lord was given me to wife, and there was given to me with her an hundred talents of gold; for God made them to serve me, and gave me beauty, that I should be as a flower above them that were fair in Israel; and he kept me unto mine age both in strength and beauty, because I was like to Jacob in all things.

And what dreams I have seen, my children now hear; there were twelve harts feeding, and nine were divided abroad in the earth; also I saw how that of Judah was a virgin born, having a white silken robe, and of her came forth an immaculate Lamb; and on the left hand of the said Lamb, was as it were a lion, and all beasts made against him; and the Lamb overcame them, and trod them under his feet, and in him joyed the angels, the men, and all the earth.

These things shall come to pass in their time, that is to say, in the latter days. Therefore, my sons, keep the commandment of the Lord, and honor Judah and Levi: for of them to you shall spring the Lamb of God, which by his grace shall preserve all Gentiles and Israel; the kingdom of him is a kingdom eternal, which shall never pass, for my kingdom shall be ended in you, as the keeping of an orchard; for after the harvest, it shall appear no more.

I know right well, that after my death, the Egyptians, shall trouble you, but God shall revenge you, and bring you to the promised land, which he sware to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

But carry my bones with you; for in so doing the Lord shall be in the light with you, against the Egyptians, and Belial shall be in darkness with the Egyptians.

Also carry with you your mother Zilpah, and nigh unto the valley, near unto Rachel, bury her.

When he had said these words, he stretched forth his feet, and slept the sleep of all the world. Then they embalmed him with spices, putting him in a chest in Egypt.

After he had lived a hundred and ten years, he saw Ephraim's children unto the third generation. For unto Machir the son of Manasseh were children born on Joseph's knees.

After this, all they of Israel bewailed him, and all the Egyptians with a great mourning; for he had compassion of Egypt, as of his own proper members; assisting them both with his labor and counsel, and did them good at all times and seasons.

TESTAMENT OF BENJAMIN,

Made to his children at his death, concerning a clean mind.

Benjamin is a happy tune,
Imposing a fitting task to his sons
To maintain through a pure expression while they live,
The beneficial good of a righteous mind.

THE copy of Benjamin's words, which he uttered to his children, being of the age of one hundred and twenty years: he kissed them, and said,

As Isaac was born in the hundredth year of Abraham, so was I in the hundredth year of Jacob: and because Rachel died at my birth, I sucked her bond-woman Bilhah. For after that Rachel had borne Joseph, she was barren twelve years; and when she had prayed to the Lord in those twelve years, she conceived and bare me; for my father loved Rachel exceedingly, and wished to see two sons by her; and therefore I was called Benjamin, that is to say, the son of my days, or the son of my sorrow, because my mother died in the birth of me.

When I came first into Egypt, and that my brother Joseph knew me, he said to me, What said they to my father, when they had sold me?

I answered, They stained thy coat with blood, and bringing it to him said, See if this be thy son's coat or no.

And my brother also said unto me; Truly when they sold me to the Ishmaelites, one of them stripping me out of my coat, gave me a thin shirt to put on, and lashing me with a whip, bade me run. And as he went aside to hide my garment, a lion met him, and slew him; and his partners being afraid, sold me to their fellows.

You therefore, my children, love the God of heaven, and obey his commandments, following that good and holy man Joseph; and let your mind be set upon goodness, as you know that mine hath been. He that hath a good mind looketh rightly.

Above all things fear God, and love your neighbors; and then, although the spirit of Belial tempt you to all naughtiness, to trouble you, yet shall it not get the uppermost hand of you, no more than it did of my brother Joseph; how many folk would have killed him, and yet still God defended him.

For he that feareth God, and loveth his neighbors, cannot be wounded of the airy spirit Belial; and he that is shielded with the fear of the Lord, is safe from harm both of man and beast, and cannot be overcome, because he is helped by the love of God, which he hath towards his neighbor.

For Joseph besought our father Jacob to pray for my brethren to the Lord, that he would not lay unto their charges, the mischief that they had devised against him.

Whereat Jacob cried out, O, my son Joseph, thou hast overcome my heart. And therewithal embracing and kissing him, he said, In thee shall the prophesy of heaven be resembled to the full, concerning the Lamb of God, and Savior of the world, that the unspotted shall be delivered from the wicked doers; and he that is without sin shall die for sinners in the blood of his Testament, to the salvation both of the Gentiles and of Israel, and he shall dash Belial and all his servants.

My children, look upon the end of that good man, and follow his mercifulness, with a good mind, that you also may have a crown of glory upon your heads.

A good man hath not a dark eye; for he is merciful and pitiful to all men: yea, though they be sinners, and have devised mischief against him.

And he that doth good, overcometh evil, by the defense of goodness, and loveth the righteous as his own soul.

If another man be honored he envieth it not.

If a man be enriched, it grieveth him not.

If a man be strong, or valiant, he praiseth him, and believing him also to be chaste.

He defendeth him that hath the fear of God; he worketh together with him that loveth God, and he loves him.

And if a man forsake the Almighty, he warneth him to return again.

Whosoever hath the grace of the good Spirit, him doth he love as his own life.

He pitieth the poor, succoreth the weak, and praiseth and honoureth God.

My children, if ye have a good mind, evil men shall stand in awe of you, and unthrifths shall for very shame be converted to goodness. And thus, covetous men shall not only depart from their niggardliness, but also give of their abundance to the needy.

If ye be good doers, both unclean spirits shall flee from you, and shrewd beasts shall shun for fear of you; for where the regard of good works is in the mind, there darkness flieth away; for if he do wrong to

any holy man, he is sorry for it: and if a holy man receive wrong, he pitieth the doer, and putteth it up with silence. And if any man betray a righteous soul, and the righteous pray for his betrayer, the betrayer is not a little disgraced, and the righteous becometh much more notable afterward, as did my brother Joseph.

The guileful spirit of Belial hath no power over a good man's mind; for the Angel of peace guideth his soul.

He looketh not affectionately upon corruptable things, nor raketh together riches in the desire of voluptuousness.

He is not delighted with pleasures.

He grieveth not his neighbor.

He stuffeth not himself with meat, neither wandereth he in the pride of his eyes; for the Lord is his portion.

He taketh no glory, for giving good counsel.

He passeth not how men dishonor him, neither can he skill in any fraud or guile, untruth, strife, or slanderousness; for the Lord dwelleth in him, and enlighteneth his mind, and he rejoiceth before all men in a good time.

A good mind hath not two tongues, one to bless with, and another to curse with; one to slander with, and another to honor with; one of sorrow, and another of joy; one of quietness, and another of trouble; one of dissimulation, and another of truth; one of poverty, and another of riches: but it hath one only disposition pure and uncorrupt towards all. It hath no double sight or double hearing; for in all things that he doeth, he knoweth that the Lord beholdeth his heart, that he may not be found faulty before God and man.

But all the works of Belial are double, and utterly void of simplicity.

Wherefore, my children, shun the naughtiness of Belial; for at the first he delighteth those that obey him, but in the end he is a sword, and the father of seven mischiefs. For when the mind hath once conceived by Belial, it bringeth forth first envy, secondly desperateness, thirdly sorrow, fourthly bondage, fifthly neediness, sixthly troublesomeness, seventhly desolation; and for that cause was Cain tormented with seven punishments by God; for in seven years together, God brought every year a new plague upon Cain, two hundred years he suffered, and in the nine hundredth year, the earth was made desolate with the flood for his righteous brother Abel's sake. In seven hundred years is Cain judged, and Lamech in seventy times seven; for they that are like Cain in spitefulness and hatred towards their brethren, shall be punished with the same punishment for ever, as he was.

You therefore, my children, eschew malice, envy, and hatred towards your brethren, and cleave to goodness, and lovingness: he that hath a

mind clean in love, looketh not upon a woman in way of lechery, for he hath no defiling in his heart, because the Spirit of the Lord resteth in him: for as the sun is not defiled by shining upon a puddle or a dunghill, but doth rather dry up, and drive away the stink: even so, a pure mind striveth against the uncleanness of the earth, and overcometh it, but is not denied itself.

And I perceived by the sayings of the righteous Enoch, that there shall be evil deeds among you, for you shall defile yourselves with the fornication of Sodom, and perish all, save a few, and multiply inordinate lusts in woman; and the reign of the Lord shall take it away suddenly.

Nevertheless the Lord's temple shall be made in our portion, and it shall be glorious among you.

For the Lord himself shall take the kingdom upon him, and the twelve tribes shall be gathered together there, and all Nations shall resort thither, until the Most High send his salvation in the visitation of his only Begotten.

And he shall enter into the first temple, and there the Lord shall suffer wrong and be despised, and be lifted up unto a piece of timber. And the veil of the temple shall be rent asunder, and the spirit of the Lord shall come down upon the Gentiles, poured out as fire; and rising up from the grave, he shall ascend from earth to heaven; he shall remember how base he hath been upon earth, and how glorious he is in heaven.

When Joseph was in Egypt, I longed to see his person, and the form of his countenance, and through the prayers of my father Jacob, I saw him awake in the day of his full and perfect shape.

Now therefore, my children, know you that I shall die: wherefore deal every of you rightfully with his neighbor; work ye justly and faithfully, and keep ye the law and commandment of the Lord; for that do I teach you instead of all inheritance; and give you the same to your children for an everlasting possession.

For so did Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, they gave us all these things for an inheritance, saying, Keep the Lord's commandments till he reveal his saving Health unto all nations. Then shall ye see Enoch, Noah, Shem, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, sitting at his right hand with joyfulness.

Then shall we rise also every of us to his own sceptre, worshipping the King of heaven, which appeared on earth in the base shape of man.

As many as believe in him, shall rejoice with him at that time, and all these shall rise again to glory, and the residue unto shame.

And the Lord shall first of all judge Israel for the unrighteousness committed against him, because they believed not in God, that came in the flesh to deliver.

Then shall he judge all nations, as many as believed not in him when he appeared upon earth. He shall reprove Israel among the chosen of the Gentiles, as he reprov'd Esau in the Midianites, that seduced his brethren by fornication and idolatry, who were estranged from God, and fell away from the inheritance of the children, because they feared not God.

But if you walk in holiness before the Lord, ye shall dwell in hope again in me, and all Israel shall be gathered to the Lord, and I shall no more be called a ravening wolf, for your robberies' sakes, but I shall be called the Lord's workman, which giveth food unto such as do his will.

And in my seed shall be raised up the Beloved of the Lord, whose voice shall be heard upon the earth, and he shall give new knowledge, and enlighten all nations with light of understanding, and shall come up to save Israel.

He shall take from them their synagogue and give it to the Gentiles, and continue in the synagogue of the Gentiles, to the world's end.

He shall be among their princes as musical melody in the mouths of all men, and his doings and sayings shall be written in holy books.

And as concerning him, my father Jacob taught me, saying, He shall amend the defaults of thy tribe.

He shall be the Lord's darling for evermore.

And when he had ended these sayings, he commanded his children to carry his bones out of Egypt, and to bury them in Hebron by his fathers. So Benjamin died an hundred five and twenty years old, in a good age; and they put him in a coffin, and in the four-score and eleventh year before the departure of the Israelites out of Egypt, they and their brethren conveyed their father's bones privily again into the Land of Canaan, and buried him in Hebron, at the feet of his fathers; and returned again out of the land of Canaan, and dwelt in Egypt till the day of their departure thence altogether.

EPISTLE OF PAUL THE APOSTLE TO THE LAODICEANS.

1 PAUL, an Apostle not of men, nor by man, but by Jesus Christ.

2 Unto the brethren that are at Laodicea: grace be unto you and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 I give thanks unto Christ in all my prayers, that ye continue in him, and persevere in all his works, looking for the promise at the day of judgment.

4 ¶ Neither do the vain talkings of some overset you, which creep in, that they may turn you away from the truth of the Gospel which is preached by me.

5 And now shall God cause that they that are of me shall continue ministering unto the increase of the truth of the Gospel and accomplishing goodness, and the work of salvation, even eternal life.

6 ¶ And now are my bonds seen of all men, which I suffer in Christ.

7 Wherein I rejoice and am glad, and unto me this is for everlasting salvation.

8 Which also is brought about by your prayers, and the ministry of the Holy Ghost, whether by life or by death.

9 For I have a great wish and joy to die in Christ, and unto him shall he work his mercy in you that ye may have the same love, and be of one mind.

10 ¶ Therefore, dearly beloved, as ye have heard in my presence, so hold fast and work in the fear of God, and it shall be unto you for life eternal; for it is God that worketh in you and is perfected in you without delay.

11 ¶ And for the rest, dearly beloved, rejoice in Christ, and beware of them that lust after filthy lucre.

12 Let all your petitions be made openly before God, and be ye steadfast in the mind of Christ.

13 And do ye what things are sound and true, just and sober, and what ye have heard and received, keep fast in your heart, so that ye may have praise.

14 The grace of God, and of our Lord Jesus Christ, be with your spirits all. Amen.

¶ Cause this Epistle to be read unto the Colossians, and read ye the Epistle that was written to the Colossians. Co. 4, 16.

[The Epistle of Paul to the Laodiceans which was obtained in the oldest Bible and which was translated at Worms, Germany.]

TO THE CHURCHES.

DEAR BROTHER DAVIS,—Announce through the TRUMPET that the East Glamorgan Conference will be held, in Merthyr, on the 6th of July; Monmouthshire, in Tredegar, on the 13th; West Glamorgan,

in Swansea, on the 20th; Carmarthenshire, in Carmarthen, on the 27th; and Cardiganshire, on the 3rd of August.

Dear Brethren,—Those who intend to emigrate next September, send your deposits here to us in a timely fashion, together with your addresses, your skills, and your names, so that I can send information to you in time, concerning the time for you to be in Liverpool, or in Swansea. It is not wise for those who intend to go straight to the Valley, to leave in September, rather in January; because they will need to stay for a few months in St. Louis, because of the ice on the rivers.

Money for the Emigrating Fund is to be turned in by the 24th of this month, and let everyone take care to send it, together with the name of the Treasurer of each Branch and his director, by the above time.

14, *Castle St., Merthyr Tydfil.*

WM. PHILLIPS.

CONDITION OF THE CHURCH IN MONMOUTHSHIRE.

Tredegar, June 6, 1851.

DEAR BROTHER PHILLIPS,—In joy I am writing to you, hoping that you have returned in good health, having enjoyed more of a fullness of joy and rejoicing in your journey among the elect of God than ever before.

I hereby give a brief account of this Conference. There is here general unity, and good signs that many will obey the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ. Lately we have opened three Halls in convenient places, and there are hosts of people gathering to hear what we have to say about our religion. One of them was opened on the 25th of September in Blackwood, and four were baptized as a result of that; and on the same day there were three public baptisms, one in Nantyglo, one in Blaina, and one in Kendle; these provided the opportunity of preaching to hundreds of people. The following Sunday the Hall of the Belle Vue Inn, between Victoria and Penycae, was opened, where Elders Dewi Elfed Jones and David Rees had an opportunity to give their testimony to hundreds of people. The Hall was overflowing with listeners in the morning, and many were unable to get in. At two, it was decided to preach at the window,

so that those inside as well as those outside could hear; there were between a thousand and fifteen hundred listening, and many more at six. Sermons were given during the day in Welsh and English, and we had an attentive audience; and the testimonies of Elders Jones and Rees have caused a stir among the people, and several were baptized as a result. We intend to open a Chapel and two Halls in the near future. We intend to open one of them on the 15th of this month, when I, and the Saints, and several of the Baptists, wish to see Dewi Elfed there if possible. I am, your humble brother,

THOMAS GILES.

NEW SONG.

TUNE—"Fair Bird."

WHEN all the Saints come home together,
 To beautiful mount Zion,
 And come in praise of God our Master,
 With no one sad of heart;
 All the faithful Saints will be,
 Without any contention in their midst;
 They will live there without worry,
 Without anyone to mock them ever again,
 But praising boldly, their dear Creator
 In song, without a single lament.

I yearn for the privilege,
 To go to the Saints in Zion,
 Where no sadness is in their midst,
 Nor any kind of strife;
 The voice of the families is heard
 Singing sweetly in the evening and morning;
 They sing praise in a new land,
 With no shame of the Savior;
 Blessed I would be to swiftly
 Join the happy throng.

I know that my Redeemer comes,
 To Zion to reign,
 Among the patriarchal host,
 Where thousands will praise them;
 Oh how cheerful the Saints will there,
 Be wearing beautiful crowns,
 With not a single enemy there to frighten,
 All awake throughout the Valley;
 And, Oh the joy each Saint will have,
 Those privileged children of the King.

Aberaman.

THOS. PHILLIP.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

LONDON CONFERENCE.—We found it a job to be present in the London conference, on the 1st of this month, where four of the Apostles, together with hosts of elders from far and near, were gathered. The day was spent very interestingly, and it would not be easy to spend it any better. Monday, about 1200 gathered at the Freemasons Hall, to partake of a feast, similar to those that are held in the Valley. Perhaps I shall have occasion to furnish greater details in our next issue. Suffice it to say at present that we and our brothers Phillips and Pugh felt delighted, while watching, listening, and speaking, in the company of the Saints who were gathered in London, in the days of the “world’s fair.”

CEFN BRANCH.—Last Sunday, a building was opened to the service of the Saints in Cefncoedycymmer, when good meetings were held throughout the day. The place is called “The Branch,” which was built by one of the brethren, and capable of holding about 200 listeners.

THE GREAT EXHIBITION.—If you wish to see the wonders of the world without traveling it, walk about fifteen miles within the Crystal Palace. It was appropriate to make it of glass, for it is the mirror of the world, in which are seen the industry and skill of the world’s nations.

THERE are but few men who know the way to be idle and also good; for by doing nothing we learn to do evil.

AS MANY days as we spend doing nothing which is good, are the same number of those days that are completely lost.

WHATEVER I desire, I always obtain, for I desire nothing I cannot get.

“E. M.”—With respect to the wording of the sacrament prayers, it is best to follow the latest translation. Let the Doc. and Cov. Be the standard for all. We thank E. M. for noticing; but the spirit is more important than the words.

“G. WATKIN.”—It is better for you to write to Aberaman, to the men themselves, and send a stamp in your letter.

PAYMENTS FROM MAY 29 TO JUNE 12.—West Glamorgan, £3 9s 3c; Pembrokeshire, £1; Cwmbach, £2 14s; Cardiff, £3 1s 8c; Hirwaun, 7s; Georgetown, £2 6s; Pendaren, £1 4s 6c; Merthyr, £1 6s; Cefn, 19s; Total, £16 7s 5c.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr Tydfil.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 13.]

JUNE 28, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

ACCOUNT OF A JOURNEY FROM GREAT SALT LAKE CITY, FOUR HUNDRED AND FIFTY MILES TO THE SOUTH [FROM CAPT. D. JONES].

San Pete, March, 1851.

DEAR BROTHER DAVIS,—Perhaps it would be interesting, and useful, to give the following account to the Welsh Saints, who are no doubt desirous of every bit of information concerning these parts of the world, from whence they derive their love; at least, that is how I felt when I was there, and I still do. And even though I am far from them now, my desire to entertain and benefit them is not one ounce less than ever before; on the contrary, the more I perceive of advantages to benefit them temporally or spiritually, the more my desire grows for them, more than for anyone else, to receive these advantages; and I continue to think, like Paul of old, that my joy will not be perfect, without being in the company of all of you. But, on with the account.

The week that I arrived in Great Salt Lake City from Wales, our respected President B. Young told me privately, of his intention, and his plans with respect to settling the valleys of the mountains, &c., and reported to me interesting evidence which he had received from travelers about that branch cut off from the race of Gomer who are called the Madocians; and he also counseled me to go with the company which he intended to send to the south soon, all of which brought great joy to my heart. Another purpose of this journey, was to search out as far as we

could how far up we could navigate the Colorado River, together with determining the quality of the valleys and rivers, &c., of these everlasting hills.

November 22, 1849.—According to the previous arrangements, the majority of the company departed from the city to gather, and to organize the regiment 12 miles to the south, but I was prevented from departing until the 24th, since I was settling the various Welsh families on the other side of the Jordan River, and apportioning to them their inheritances according to their needs. Great was the weeping and the sorrow at my leaving. I had already established them as Welsh branches before that, and had designated presidents over them; and almost all of them had renewed their covenants through baptism, &c., and in the Welsh meetings there was more unity and more of the Spirit of God than I have seen amongst us since I left Wales.

The first day, I came to the place where I expected to meet the company, but all of them except for myself had gone from there two days before. I stayed the night there, and the next day I began alone after them. It had snowed during the night, and continued to snow when I began, so that the trail was totally invisible, except that I could see the sprigs of grass on either side, and nothing on the road; there were no inhabitants or houses, or any hope of seeing a traveler along my way, for over sixty miles. It was so foggy that I could hardly see anything around me; and although others had tried to get me to refrain from venturing forth, I was not to be discouraged in spite of that; forward I went on horseback, and one other I was leading, which carried my clothes, bed, &c. I went along with hardly a pause for about 15 miles, when I discovered an unexpected crossroads; I ventured along the middle of the three, which before long deceived me by disappearing from sight. I turned back to try one of the others, and I followed the south road, which after a while, led me over a steep bank, and to bogs and mud, where the horses sank to their thighs; but I struggled forward through water mixed with mud, and snow, until the path dipped precipitously over the bank of a large and deep river, which I saw just in time to save myself from a ducking. I took the hint now that that was not the right path either, and I went back as best I could, at times the horses, at times myself lower. The horses, poor things, performed their part well to come out alive from such bogs, when neither they nor I could see ten

yards around us. My lonely and deserted situation was not enviable now; for, if I lost much time here while the camp traveled forth, I could see that my bed that night would be in the cold snow, without a fire or anything to light one; and if so, although I was safe from the barbarous inhabitants who wandered across the country, the company would not be so pleasant of the snarling wolves, who were already howling to each other to assemble their armies together in sufficient number as to take the wanderer captive. Now I called on my Father to guide me or my animals to the right path; who, as usual, praise be to his name, answered my plea; for the latter, when given their rein, took me to the bottom of a steep and rough hill; they quickly climbed to its top, and then down over it from rock to rock.

At the bottom of the hill ran a small river which was difficult to cross, but after following its banks for a while I found a safe spot, and before long I found myself on the highland again, without ever a road, or a compass, or anything except the heavens above to go by. I shouted again more loudly than before, "O Father, cause a breeze from somewhere to disperse the clouds and the snow;" at the calling the breeze came, and the snow ceased, and I heard the neighing of a horse not far from me; as I pondered what it could be, whether a horse as lost as I was, whether it had a rider, or whether it was an angel from heaven bringing salvation: over and over the whinny, and it was answered back by my horses and myself as loudly as we could, and taking heart my horses pranced to meet it. A gust of wind came which blew the clouds away; then we saw three horsemen on their mounts before us! These were travelers toward Utah; I traveled with them until I caught up with my own company, and great was the joy of the meeting, for they were waiting for me at the Willows River. With gladness I was welcomed to the camp, and we started from there to climb a steep hill which divides the Great Salt Lake Valley from the Utah Valley. From the highest point we took the last look on Salt Lake City and its inhabitants in the distance. We descended gradually along an excellent road of the south side and camped along the Dry River in Utah Valley.—Our camp contains twelve wagons drawn by oxen, and a carriage for me and P. P. Pratt, which was drawn by four horses; we had also about twenty horses and fifteen riding mules, and 47 brave and armed men, one brass cannon on wheels, seven fat animals for slaughter as the need arose, and food for four months.

On one of the wagons there was an odometer, which was turned by the wheel, a barometer and astronomical instruments, &c.

—26.—We traveled along the side of this beautiful valley; Utah Lake was to the south of us, about 30 miles long and about 10 miles wide, of fresh, clear water and an abundance of fish. We crossed several rivers more or less today, on the banks of which trees are scarce, but the land is rich and abundant, and suitable for farming.

—28.—About mid-day we crossed the Provo river, which is about 103 feet wide and two feet deep, emptying from the eastern hills to the lake in the west. On the southern bank are settled from three to four hundred Saints: they built a square fort of log cabins, about twenty on each side, and two wide gates; the enclosure contained about two acres of land. They cultivated about 600 acres in one enclosure, and are doing very well up to now, and they had abundant crops. Distance from Salt Lake City, 46 miles. We camped on Spring Creek, 12 miles to the south: the snow has almost vanished. On the bank of the next river, namely Hobble Creek, in beautiful and fruitful country, we met a tribe of Indians, who are called Utahs, and who stole from us a fat ox, and escaped stealthily. They made their cabins out of willows or *sage*; and since they wandered from place to place, according to the hunting, they did not build their cabins to stay in them for long. Their clothing is of buffalo skins, which they get from the southern natives, or blankets which they get from the Mormons, &c. There is not much desirable in them, poor things, except that they possess eternal souls, and are the descendants of a strong nation, to which great promises were given earlier; behold here in them the fulfillment of many prophecies without doubt; for much was said that the seed of Ephraim was brought to bow down to the dust, and they were brought low to the ground—that their “speech should whisper out of the dust,” &c. Not one unbiased man can doubt the truth of the Book of Mormon, after understanding the true character and history of these remnants, I dare say.

—29.—We crossed a river about 10 yards wide, and a foot deep, which runs along the dividing strip of land between the southern corner of the Utah Valley and the northern corner of Juab Valley. A considerable number of trees good for firewood line the banks of this river; and there is a broad view from here to the north over the entire Utah Valley, and to the south for scores of miles in its length, and from about 10 to 15 miles in width, is a valley which would be

difficult to surpass in beauty, or in the nature and lay of the land, except the scarcity of its trees lessens its worth.

About 15 minutes before reaching the southern corner of this valley the road leads to San Pete, which runs through a canyon between high mountains for about 18 minutes, from where runs a small river with cold and crystalline water. In this canyon there is a mountain of hardened salt of a reddish color, and it comes from a cave which runs under the mountain of salt; near the cave there is a spring bubbling its salt water to the surface, which when it sits in the sun produces a layer of tasty and good white salt. Here we gathered sufficient for our use.

—30.—We reached the corner of the San Pete Valley, which is far more abundant than the valleys already mentioned. Now, in front of us to the south can be seen a luxuriant and grassy meadow, for 50 minutes; it looks very similar to some meadows which I have seen in the old country of my fathers, before the hay harvest, but more abundant. Several rivers and streams run through it, from which the biggest part of it can be irrigated; the largest of these is called the San Pete river, which runs from the northern corner, meandering along the length of the valley, where the valley stretches its foot several miles beyond the high point of cedars on our left; it stretches its other foot to the northwest corner just as far; around it, it is enclosed by a range of high mountains, beyond which nothing can be seen except for the blue sky, without a cloud “as big as the palm of a man’s hand” to darken its lovely countenance. This valley is 20 minutes wide at times, and then it narrows toward the south, where its head slopes up from its shoulders, toward the southwest again on the bosom of some majestic mountains, which give to this valley the appearance of a small world by itself, and where timeless calm reigns herein on its throne; except for an occasional savage native or wolf which wander after their prey—the fish in its rivers, or an occasional rabbit, as white as the snow, which jumps from its refuge in fright, gazing at our faces, as if to ask, Who are these strange intruders, and what do they want? This is how this valley was, like many other valleys, sheltered in the chambers of these everlasting mountains, until a few days ago, when an encampment of Saints arrived here, to settle in its southern corner, whose welcome association we reached on December 3; we stayed with them here until the 5th, and we received every kindness they could give us. It is Isaac Morley who

presides here, and there are about 50 families with him. They have not had time to build, but there is an excellent rock quarry to use for building nearby, with a river running through their intended city, and they are surrounded, except in the east, where there are mountains, by many thousands of acres of fertile land; there is an abundance of trees for firewood readily available at the foot of the hills, and plenty of timber for building, &c., in the nearby canyons, which are a blessing generally hard to come by in these valleys. We received an additional three men in our camp here. The distance of this place from the Great Salt Lake is 130½ miles.

(*To be continued.*)

BAPTISM FOR THE DEAD.

DEAR BROTHER DAVIS,—On the 31st of last May, I had the privilege of hearing a few observations on the subject of baptism for the dead, and also to see that being done, by one of the respected ministers of the Methodists (namely the Rev. Wm. Evans, Tonyrefail), on the occasion of the burial of the wife of one Thomas Jenkins, Dinas, and the baptism of her baby, which was performed in the chapel, while the body lay on the bier off to the side. The Rev. Mr. Evans spoke as follows:—"I am now going to baptize for the dead. We find in the scriptures that Paul mentions baptizing for the dead; we ourselves are going to do that here today. Many of the godly persons of old were martyred, and when they were killed some others came forward and said, Take me in their place, and in this manner were they baptized for those dead. And we ourselves here see that the arrow has gone to the heart of the mother, and has taken her to the other world; and here we are taking her little baby, and baptizing him for this deceased, so that he may come to stand in the gap in her place," splashing water from his hand three times to his face, "in the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Ghost. Amen."

Dinas.

THOMAS DAVIES.

[We wish for our correspondent to let us know when the above baby receives baptism for *himself*, for the baptism he received was only for his *mother*.—ED.]

HEALING OF A BURN.

DEAR BROTHER DAVIS,—I, Morgan Williams, take this opportunity to write to you, to let you know of that which happened to me in these days; and if you see that it is useful to be printed in your praiseworthy TRUMPET, it is at your service. I was working in the coal mine at the Ton-ddu ironworks, the morning of the 15th of May, 1851. At about eight o'clock, I was burned by the *damp*, across my entire face, and my left arm from my elbow down to about the middle of my fingers. I came out of the mine, and my fellow workers with me; and they wanted to apply the oil which is in the works on my face and arm, but I kept them from doing so. I went home as soon as I could, and according to the teaching of the Apostle James, I sent for the elders of the church, and Thomas Llewellyn, who was at home at the time, came to me, and he anointed me with the consecrated oil in the name of Jesus Christ, and he laid his hands on me, rebuking the fire out of my face and my arm; and I received the blessing, and I returned to the works directly, and I put in my day's work, as well as the following days, as I always did. This has caused a big stir around here. Some said that I am a fool, and that I am without feeling, because I came back to my work, and there were many other thoughts in their midst; but we glorify God for his blessing.

Yours in the truth,

MORGAN WILLIAMS.

Witnesses—

THOMAS LLEWELLYN,

SAMUEL DAVIES.

Although I am not one of the Saints, yet I testify of the truth. I am aware of the burns, but I have never before seen such a thing, and I believe that God has answered their prayers.

JENKIN WILLIAMS.

A NEW WAY TO ZION.

THROUGH the kindness of brother Alfred Woods, we have received the "Missouri Republican" for May 27, which contains an abridgment of the Fifth General Epistle from the First Presidency in the Salt Lake

Valley. We do not know how they obtained the Epistle before the "Frontier Guardian," but it appears that they did so. It is quite likely that we will have the whole epistle in time for the next TRUMPET. For the time being we can but quote what is said in the words of the Epistle, about the new way to Zion:—

"It is wisdom for the English Saints to cease emigration by the usual route through the States, and up the Missouri river, and remain where they are till they shall hear from us again; as it is our design to open up a way across the interior of the continent, by Panama, Tehuantepec, or some of the interior routes, and land them at San Diego, and thus save three thousand miles of inland navigation through a most sickly climate and country. The Presidency in Liverpool will open every desirable correspondence in relation to the various routes, and rates, and conveniences, from Liverpool to San Diego, and make an early report, so, if possible, the necessary preparations may be made for next fall's emigration."

We could give additional news, but since we will yet need to publish the entire epistle, we think it best to let our readers take pleasure at the above, together with the letter of Capt. Jones to President Phillips and ourselves.

ACCOUNT OF THE WAR BETWEEN THE ROMANS AND THE JEWS, IN WHICH JERUSALEM WAS TAKEN AND COMPLETELY DESTROYED.

IN the year 67 A. D. the war with the Romans began, which did not come to an end until the destruction of Jerusalem, and the overthrow of the Jewish nation. In the beginning they were winning at times, one battle after another, and in the various battlefields, thousands from both sides were killed: and at the same time frightful contentions arose among the Jews, and the Christians fled to Pella beyond the Jordan, and they were safe, and some others went out of the city, suspecting what would be the consequences of the anger of the Romans.

In the year 68 Vespasian came to Galilee with a powerful army; one city after another fell through the anger of the Romans; and they either put the people to the sword, or they made them slaves. Amid the next-to-the-last city was Josephus, the Jewish historian, who afterwards went with Titus, the son of Vespasian, to the siege of Jerusalem, and he gave an account of their wars.

The nation was now divided in two opposing factions, one was for bowing to the Romans, and have peace, and the other declared that it would be the highest of insults to God to bow to a worldly government, especially of the Gentiles. Under the name of godliness these zealots worked the most shocking cruelty; they began by killing all those in the land round about them who opposed them; they went to Jerusalem, but they met with strong resistance from the other faction, who were armed to defend themselves against their frightful cruelty. The zealots gained the upper hand, and 12,000 of the great men of the city, in the flower of their age, fell as a sacrifice to their cruelty. Putting these to death was not enough of a punishment in their opinion, rather they took pleasure in inflicting the greatest pain they could imagine on these servants. Next they began to kill the common folk, who had to flee Jerusalem and seek protection from the Romans, although the zealots had set watchmen along the roads, who were sure to kill the unfortunate people who came to them. Vespasian stayed at Cesarea, knowing that the Jews were wasting their strength, and making themselves more vulnerable to the Romans.

When the zealots, under John the son of Levi, who until then had kept himself from the siege of Gischala, had destroyed, or driven out the opposing faction, these terrible people turned on each other. The Idumeans (who were on John's side) lamented the number that were put to death, but John, because of his oppression, caused them to rebel and turn their weapons against him.

There was one Simeon also, who was in Massada, who had formed a faction, and in his turn had killed, spoiled, burned, and destroyed nearly all before him. Out of fear that because of the fury of John and his followers (the strongest place for whom was in the temple) they would set the other gates of the city on fire, its gates were opened to Simeon and his followers. There was also another faction that rose up in the city, under Eleazar; but this lasted but a short time; the various factions were distributed between the two, under John and Simeon.

In the year 72 the Romans began their march toward the capital city of Judea, destroying the country and its inhabitants along the way, and in the year 73 they sat before the walls of Jerusalem. Their warrior Titus offered, several times, through Nicanor, Josephus, and himself, terms of peace to this rash people, but they were refused with contempt; and Titus had to begin a siege. Through enormous work of the Romans, trees were cut, houses were pulled down, rocks were split, valleys were filled, towers and walls were built, and battering rams and other destructive things were set against the city.

From within, the factions of John and Simeon were destroying each other; but they were united in their assaults against the

Romans; and when again inside the gates, they were with the same fury turning their arms against each other, in those parts of the city which John had destroyed: while those who were taken by the Romans were crucified within sight of the town.

After several engagements, and great effort, the Romans breach the walls, and have a way in; the Jews leave that place and go to the next; through huge amounts of work they close the walls behind them; the Jews retreat, and are still safe.

At the same time famine and pestilence reign within the city; the rage of the factions increases with their adversity; they were breaking into the houses of the inhabitants to search for food, and if there was something in them, they would kill the people for not letting them know they had it; if there was nothing, they would torture them, suspecting that they were hiding something from them. The zealots were never completely without, but they had the terrible satisfaction of starving those whom they called useless people, and by so doing keeping themselves alive.

The warrior, knowing of their pitiful condition, and wishing to spare them, gave them four days to lose their zeal; and at the same time he passed out food to his army in their view, while they were gathering at the walls to see them. He extended an offer of peace to them once again, but received only a bitter answer. From the offers of Titus, which they count as cowardice, and because of the cruelty of the zealots, several are persuaded to go secretly to the Romans, while others go more obstinately and stubbornly, and meet with their end even in the camp of the Romans; because of some suspicion the Soldiers had that they had swallowed gold, 2000 of them were opened with the sword the same night, to get at the hidden wealth. When Titus found out about it, he was ready to condemn the bloody murderers, but they proved to be so numerous that he was forced to drop his intention, and content himself with making it known throughout the camp, that from then on whoever was thought guilty of such cruelty, would be put to death; but that was not sufficient; several were killed after that, under the same wanton assumption.

The adversity of the Jews continued to increase.—From without, the Romans build a wall nearly five miles around in three days, by which they make it impossible for them to escape.—From within, mounds of dead bodies are rotting on the face of the land, the zealots are joking at the adversity and the deathly groans of their brothers, and sometimes killing them, with their swords, under the excuse of checking to see if they were sharp.

Josephus says, I take upon myself an impossible task to report all the cruelty of these men; it will suffice to say, that I do not think that any city in creation has ever suffered such terrible affliction.

When I perceived that the zealots could no longer by their

cruelty or their watchfulness forestall the defection of the people, or their fleeing to the Romans, they tried another deceptive trick:—Some wretches pretended to prophesy, and were hired to go about the city, shouting that prompt and wondrous salvation was at hand; and this for a moment gave a little hope to the rest of the people, when something happened in Jerusalem that filled the inhabitants with surprise and madness, and the besiegers with anger and dread. An unfortunate mother driven to extreme need, killed her child and ate its body.

When the news was spread about this unnatural deed in the city, the pitiful inhabitants began to think they had been completely abandoned by divine Providence, and to expect the most cruel effects of his anger. And when Titus heard, in horror, the terrible story, in his anger he decided to completely destroy the nation. He said, since they have so frequently refused my offers of peace, and have chosen war instead of peace, rebellion instead of obedience, and famine instead of abundance,—I have decided to bury this accursed capital city in destruction; so that the sun will never warm with its rays a city where mothers eat the flesh of their children, and their fathers are no less guilty than they, in driving them to such an extreme instead of laying down their arms.

Titus, despite giving this ultimatum, still wished to be merciful to that people; and while the one faction after the other was defeated by the powerful attacks of the Roman army, Titus and Josephus were counseling them to surrender: he really wanted to save the temple; observing with great sorrow the daily offering not made, and blaming the zealots for their negligence in worship; but this pitiful people were damaging the temple which they considered to be a safe refuge from the Roman nation, and which they had convinced themselves was too holy ever to fall to the hands of the gentiles, although they themselves were drunk with the wine that had been prepared as an offering.

Now, the destruction of the war is throughout Jerusalem; one place after another is being set on fire by those being besieged, and by the besiegers, and in the tumult, large numbers are being killed on either side. The temple was yet intact; but there was no stopping the fury of the Romans any longer; one of their soldiers went on the shoulders of another, and threw torches at the temple through the window, which soon set the structure ablaze; on the same day of the month that Nebuchadnezzar had burned it before.

Titus, who was sleeping, awoke to the confusion, and he ran immediately to cause the fire to be extinguished, but it was in vain; he shouted, begged, threatened, and also caned his men; but they were too busy killing the Jews, or fanning the flames, to pay attention to the command of their Field Marshal.

Amid the flames, parts of the building were falling, and the sword of the Romans, which killed everything before it, whether man or woman, whether a gray-haired man or a tender child, vanquished a large number, and among these, more than 6000 were charmed by false prophets, which had promised wondrous salvation to them that day. Some of them were five days on the walls, and after that had thrown themselves on the mercy of the Field Marshal; but the answer was that they had waited beyond their time, and they were led to their death.

Scenes identical to this havoc were in the temple and around it, from where the zealots by a powerful rush made their way to the city, but the roads leading out were guarded so they could not leave it. With this they strengthened themselves as much as they were able on the south side of the city, from where John and Simeon wish to have a meeting with the Field Marshal; they receive their answer that, although they have caused so much loss of blood, their lives will be spared if they lay down their arms. They answer that they are bound by oaths never to give up, and therefore they earnestly plead for permission to go with their wives and their children to the mountains. Titus was very angry at this response, and he had them notified to stand and defend themselves, saying that not one of them would be spared since they refused his last offers of peace.

The Daughters of Zion, or the lower city, is now brought down to the madness of the soldiers, who spoil, burn, and kill with the greatest fury. The zealots afterwards escaped to the royal palace, in the higher city, which is called the City of David, on mount Zion. Here 8,000 of the Jews who had taken refuge in it were killed.

Nearly twenty days are spent by the Romans preparing themselves to make a powerful attack on the higher city. The machines of war are operating with great fury: the besieged are in a frenzy running like people out of their mind, and thinking of attacking the surrounding wall as a way of escaping from the city; but being opposed, they are running to the safe places of the city to hide, such as the water ditches, &c., which when the Romans catch them, they kill them, and the city is set on fire. John, who was squeezed with hunger, comes out and begs for his life, which is given to him, but he is cast into prison for life. Since Simeon's safe place was more well stocked, he is able to hold out longer. Simeon and John are spared along with 700 of the most handsome Jews, to decorate the celebration vehicle. After this, Simeon is pulled along the roads with a rope around his neck, scourged, and after that put to death; and John is driven to his prison. There were three fortresses that were not taken, Herodian, Macheron, and Massada; the first two negotiated for peace, but Massada held out. The place was strong by nature and design, and was Defended by some of

the zealots under Eleazar. Although he used all his war machines against him, the Field Marshal could not conquer him; therefore, he built a high wall around them, and set the gates on fire; Eleazer having no hope persuaded his people to first kill their women and their children, and after that to choose ten men to kill the rest; and lastly one of those to kill them and himself, after setting fire to the place before so doing. This was done; and the next day the Romans after getting to the top of the walls, were surprised not to see or hear anything moving, and they gave a great shout, at which two women who had hidden themselves came and showed them the terrible slaughter that had taken place on the besieged.

The number of Jews that died in this war is estimated to be more than 1,406,000, without counting many who died in the trees, the caves, the desert, &c., of which no count could be taken. From the prisoners who numbered 97,000 (besides 11,000 who perished from the cold by neglect or who died from great grief) a few were kept to adorn the glory of the victor, and a number were sent to several cities of Syria to show them in the common theaters, or to be devoured by ravenous beasts according to the custom of the times.

Despite this terrible damage of their city and their government, the Jews are scattered across the face of the earth; and despite so much persecution they receive from the uncircumcised in all the ages of Christianity, they continue to increase. In a remarkable way they distinguish themselves by their diligent commerce, and there are some places of commerce that are permeated by them. In antiquity there was a "separation set between the Egyptians and Israel," and until the present day it is lamentable that the superstition of the Jews and Gentiles keep them separate.

R. G.

LAMENTATION OF JEREMIAH.

WHY art thou sad,—Dear friend, &c.,
 And lonely through the day,—Dear friend?
 Hast thou lost thy friends,
 And their pleasant associations,
 The foremost of thy privileges?—Come listen, &c.
 Thou shalt hear from me why,—Before long, &c.
 Continually very soon,—Before long;
 I have lost my friends,
 The best ones my heart loved,
 And their dear, happy society,—Yes indeed, &c.
 Where are they now?—Wretched man, &c.,
 How pitiful is thy dawn,—By thyself.
 Today they have gone
 Each one to his direction;
 They have left me destitute;—O how wearisome, &c.

Have they gone far?—Heavy blow, &c.;
 Is there hope they will be better?—O, I know not.
 Some became Methodists,
 And others became Unitarians,
 Many became Independents;—Faint hope, &c.
 Some went away overseas,—Sad am I, &c.,
 Losing all from the choir,—Sad am I:
 Some went to the Baptists,
 The fanatical Ranters and the Shakers,
 They are all religionists,—But me, &c.
 Lastly came the arrow,—Quite heavy, &c.,
 I was wounded by it—Beneath my breast,
 Losing Edward Davis,
 Amusing, wise and gifted,
 With all his sweet association—Was so happy, &c.
 Where did he go with his support?—Thou knowest, &c.;
 He went to the Mormon* men,—Say boldly;
 He went through ordinances
 To the pure Church of the Saints,
 Under divine authorities;—This is true, &c.
 Is there any hope now?—Not even weak, &c.,
 Will a religion full of praise come—To thee?
 I am at last determined,
 To be wiser now,
 I shall become a more proper religionist—Than ever, &c.
 Listen to me as thou goest,—Before thy farewell,
 Which Church is thy friend,—Dear friend?
 Well, the Latter-day Saints,
 Who are full of the most divine gift,
 I offer thee through the power of my God;—Go, farewell, &c.

* More good.

T. JEREMIAH.

FEAST OF THE SAINTS IN LONDON.

IN this feast, all had taken their seats in the Hall at half past two, and though the place was overflowing, there would have been present that many more had there been space for them. The tickets were a shilling each, and for that each one received cakes, biscuits, oranges, raisins, and clear water, besides taking part in the pleasure of the day. After getting order, a procession came into the Hall, having 12 branch presidents, with staffs; 24 young women dressed in white, muslin *visites*, and blue ribbons in their hair; and 24 young men with blue scarves. The objective of the presidents was to keep order, and the girls and boys were to be waiters. After walking around once, and taking their seats, another procession entered, having the twelve

fathers in Israel, namely greyhaired elderly men, with their staffs; twelve young boys, with large blue scarves, carrying a Bible in one hand, and a Book of Mormon in the other; and twelve young women, dressed in white muslin, with large blue scarves, with wreathes of flowers about their heads. They walked around once, and before taking their seats they all sang. Then the chaplain read the 6th chapter of Nephi, in the Book of Mormon, and the 10th chapter of John, in the New Testament, and then he prayed. After that the congregation was addressed by one of the elderly men, one of the young boys, and one of the young women, and by the four apostles, and others sang, all in a very effective manner, until all were satisfied.

STATISTICAL REPORT FOR THE CONFERENCES IN THE BRITISH ISLES,
FOR THE HALF YEAR ENDING JUNE 1, 1851.

<i>Conferences</i>	<i>Br.</i>	<i>Sev.</i>	<i>H.P.</i>	<i>Eld.</i>	<i>Pr.</i>	<i>Tea.</i>	<i>Dea.</i>	<i>Cut.</i>	<i>Died.</i>	<i>Emi.</i>	<i>Bap.</i>	<i>Tot.</i>
London.....	60	1	0	183	161	142	75	155	13	112	714	3267
Manchester.....	30	1	0	111	163	103	45	175	21	62	332	2934
Birmingham.....	15	2	0	87	95	75	43	68	17	40	237	2283
Sheffield.....	33	2	0	68	139	80	44	143	16	116	310	2168
South Conference...	27	0	0	42	80	47	43	48	10	18	155	1190
Liverpool.....	10	0	0	48	57	25	23	30	5	32	190	1098
Bedfordshire.....	28	2	0	51	62	35	28	30	1	38	153	962
Cheltenham.....	20	0	0	52	44	35	24	24	6	22	103	861
Herefordshire.....	29	1	0	81	67	42	22	25	3	18	83	855
Bradford.....	18	0	0	56	66	39	14	46	4	9	75	813
Preston.....	16	0	1	66	51	41	12	33	6	39	85	787
Warwickshire.....	25	1	0	63	60	33	18	25	5	85	78	760
Norwich.....	16	1	0	54	53	32	17	26	5	8	134	746
Worcestershire.....	15	0	0	40	37	15	17	14	5	30	69	666
Staffordshire.....	16	0	2	52	46	27	17	52	3	10	25	566
Newcastle-on-Tyne	14	0	1	52	47	18	19	5	1	2	28	548
Southampton.....	15	0	0	14	25	17	19	18	1	32	112	499
Lincolnshire.....	16	0	1	30	39	26	9	28	5	45	164	477
Derbyshire.....	13	0	0	29	27	19	8	18	0	27	83	395
Leicestershire.....	5	1	0	20	22	12	10	14	2	20	95	378
Hull.....	6	0	0	17	17	12	3	14	0	7	43	318
Dorsetshire.....	5	0	0	8	10	11	10	18	0	0	7	273
Shropshire.....	11	1	0	15	18	4	9	12	0	1	33	245
Carlisle.....	5	1	0	23	6	8	5	16	1	1	10	146
East Glamorgan.....	26	0	2	188	124	126	96	97	12	31	325	2489
Monmouthshire.....	19	0	0	85	33	43	35	22	4	18	147	740
West Glamorgan.....	16	1	1	66	38	36	24	27	6	0	53	543
Carmarthenshire.....	15	0	0	72	32	26	25	43	3	8	42	530
Pembrokeshire.....	12	0	0	25	10	13	12	18	1	5	52	215
Denbighshire.....	6	0	0	18	15	10	5	11	0	0	31	177
Cardiganshire.....	8	0	0	18	11	3	0	5	1	0	26	126
Flintshire.....	6	0	0	18	11	6	1	1	0	0	20	121
Anglesey.....	6	0	0	17	7	6	2	9	0	0	19	113
Breconshire.....	7	0	0	15	5	3	5	2	0	0	16	79
Merionethshire.....	6	0	0	16	2	3	1	6	0	0	13	71
Glasgow.....	30	1	0	111	97	106	29	95	6	43	191	2094
Edinburgh.....	15	1	0	30	40	46	14	44	3	25	58	797
Dundee.....	7	0	0	10	10	16	5	11	2	9	37	392
Belfast.....	5	0	0	7	8	2	1	4	1	0	12	76
Ireland.....	3	0	0	8	1	0	1	2	0	3	23	38
Channel Islands.....	5	0	0	10	8	9	5	17	2	9	30	270
Isle of Man.....	2	0	0	13	7	3	3	2	1	0	17	120
Total	642	17	8	1998	1851	1355	789	1463	172	925	4439	32226

NAMES OF THE PRESIDENTS.—Eli B. Kelsey, London; C. H. Wheelock, Manchester; I. C. Haight, Birmingham; Lewis Robbins, Sheffield; George Halliday, South Conference, Glaud Rodger, Liverpool; John Spiers, Bedfordshire; J. D. Ross, Cheltenham; H. W. Church, Herefordshire; R. C. Menzies, Bradford; J. W. Johnson, Preston; J. W. Crosby, Warwickshire; C. V. Spencer, Norwich; John Lyon, Worcestershire; James F. Bell, Staffordshire; J. S. Higbee, Newcastle-on-Tyne; C. W. Dunbar, Southampton; Moses Clawson, Lincolnshire; Jacob Gates, Derbyshire; Jacob Gates, Leicestershire; Hugh Findlay, Hull; George Kendall, Dorset; Joseph W. Young, Shropshire; A. M. Harmon, Carlisle; William Phillips, East Glamorgan; Thomas Giles, Monmouthshire; Thomas Pugh, West Glamorgan; David John, Carmarthenshire; John Price, Pembrokeshire; John Parry, Denbighshire; John Evans, Cardiganshire; William Parry, Flintshire; Thomas Morgan, Anglesey; John Jones, Breconshire; William Evans, Merionethshire; J. Clements, Glasgow; James Marsden, Edinburgh; James Marsden, Dundee; Gilbert Clements, Belfast; ———, Ireland; Elias Cave, Channel Islands; James Hewley, Isle of Man.

BOOK DEBTS FROM THE DISTRICTS, BRANCHES, AND OTHERS, FOR THE QUARTER ENDING JUNE 26, 1851.

Districts.—Monmouthshire, £20 14s 10½c; Breconshire, £3 15s 10½c; Cardiganshire, £3 14s 2c; Carmarthenshire, £14 15s 2c; West Glamorgan, £36 10s 8½c; Flintshire, £10 5s 1c; Caernarvonshire, £12 15s 11½c; Merionethshire, £8 1s 2c; Denbighshire, £15 11s 7½c.—*Branches*—Dinas, £2 4s 0½c; Llantrisant, £3 14s 5c; Pontytypridd, £5 3s 4c; Llanfabon, £2 9s 3½c; Cwmbach, £2 18s 10c; Pendaulwyn, 9s 10½c; Twynyrodyn, 15s 4½c; Llandaff, £1 17s 9c; Gog, £1; Cardiff, £4 5s 3½c; Aberdare, £11 7s 7c; Dowlais, £3 16s 8c; Hirwaun, £5 9s 8½c; Rhymney, £2 15s 9c; Cwmnedd, £1 6s 7c; Georgetown, £7 10s 1c; Merthyr, 8s 5½c; Pendaren, £3 6s 6c; Pontfaen, 18s; Cefn, £2 12s 10c; Ysyngau, 11s 6c; Liverpool, £1 2s 9c.—*Persons.*—David Davies, Clynmil (formerly), 3s 4c; Joseph Rogers, 3s 6c; Rees Thomas, Twynyrodyn, 4s 6c; David Edwards, formerly of Tongwyrddlas, 6s 5c; David John, Carmarthenshire, 9s 6c; Jonathan Thomas, £1 19s 8½c; Eglwysnewydd, 4s.—Total, £197 10s 10c. (Mistakes to be corrected.)

Contained in the above figures is no less than £80 of debt from the previous quarter, and of that there is over £25 owing from the North alone!

PAYMENTS FROM JUNE 13 TO JUNE 26.—Monmouth, £3; Denbigh, £1 5s; Pontypridd, £2 1s 4c; Georgetown, £1 14s; Pendaren, 11s; Ynysgau, 2s; Cwmbach, 12s; Merthyr, £2 10s; Total, £11 15s 4c.

 The letter of Capt. Jones to W. Phillips will be a penny pamphlet.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 14.]

JULY 12, 1851.

[PRICE. 1C.

FIFTH GENERAL EPISTLE OF THE PRESIDENCY OF
THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-
DAY SAINTS, FROM GREAT SALT LAKE VALLEY,
STATE OF DESERET, TO THE SAINTS SCAT-
TERED THROUGHOUT THE EARTH,

GREETING:—

BELOVED BRETHREN,—Ever mindful of the Redeemer's kingdom, and of your interest therein, we gladly improve the present moment in expressing to you our watchfulness and care concerning you, and concerning those things which may tend to your present happiness, and your future exaltation. There is nothing that transpires around us, but what has its tendency to good or evil; and while we are in the world, and are surrounded by circumstances and events which have a bearing on our welfare, either for or against, it becomes us, as Saints of the Most High, to inform and be informed; and to treasure up knowledge and wisdom concerning all things that are transpiring on earth; and in the heavens, so far as it concerns us, and we are permitted to know; and in hell too, that we may be ready to shun every evil tendency, and embrace all good; and if through our pen the wisdom of God shall be made manifest for your good, comfort, consolation, and salvation, the greatest joy of our hearts will be realized.

The Church, of which you are members, was organized on the 6th of April, 1830; when consisting of six individuals, since

which time it has continued to increase, and to be persecuted and driven from town to town; from county to county; and from State to State, and out of the States; until its resting place in the wilderness and valleys of the mountains, is about three thousand miles from the place of its organization in the State of New York; and in those persecutions, prophets and apostles have been martyred for the truth's sake, and the elders have been scattered abroad on the four quarters of the earth, and the islands of the sea, preaching as they went, faith on the Lord Jesus Christ, repentance, baptism for the remission of sins, the laying on of hands for the reception of the Holy Ghost, the Lord's Supper, the gathering, the resurrection of the dead, and eternal judgment, and hundreds of thousands have believed and yielded obedience to the heavenly message, and are patiently waiting the coming of the Lord Jesus Christ; who, ere long, will set his feet again on Mount Olivet, and make himself manifest unto Israel, according to the predictions of the ancient prophets; for Israel must be gathered from all nations, and be again established in the land of their inheritance, and behold the wounds in the hands and the side of Him whom they have pierced, and acknowledge Him as their Savior, their Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel. The gathering of Israel has already commenced; Judea is receiving its ancient inhabitants, and the Holy City is rebuilding; which is one prominent sign of the near approach of the Messiah.

During the twenty-one years since the organization of the Church, the Gospel has been preached in Europe, Asia, Africa, America, the East and West Indies, and on many islands and clusters of islands in the Atlantic and Pacific; many thousands of the Saints have gathered from various parts of the earth, unto Zion—to America, the land which God has pointed out as a place of safety for his people, in these last days; and which will prove a place of refuge for kings and princes, and nobles, and honorable men of the earth of all nations, whether rich or poor, who are disposed to seek refuge therein, when the overflowing scourges of God's wrath shall destroy the nations, and depopulate the earth on account of the multiplied infidelity and abominations of the inhabitants thereof.

The unparalleled spread of the Gospel, in so short a space of time, and the rapid gathering of the Saints, is another token of Messiah's near approach.

The increasing convulsions of the nations; the multiplied wars and rumors of wars; the internal dissensions which threaten the disunion and overthrow of the best governments on the earth; the increasing plagues and sickness in new and diversified forms, baffling the skill of the ablest physicians, and causing the wisdom of their wisest to perish; the increasing divisions among professing Christian parties, and members of the same party, showing, daily, a greater and greater want of that union which must exist to secure the perpetuity of the principles of righteousness among any people, and without which God's kingdom cannot exist on earth or in the heavens; the increase of the loss of life by shipwreck and tempest, by steamboat *explosions* and burnings; the destruction of life and property by murder and incendiarism, robbery, burglary, and theft; the fearful sights, and strange signs, and knockings and noises frequently exhibited in the heavens and on the earth; the increase of seers, and wizards, and diviners, and familiar spirits, and soothsayers, and astrologers, who are charming the nations with their magic arts, lulling the foolish to sleep with their magnetic influence, deceiving priests and people by their necromancy, calling rain, snow, and fire from heaven, and scattering abroad the hoar frost, like a winter's night, in their halls of science, and the people supporting them by their faith, influence, and money, leaving the poor, the sick, the widow and the fatherless, to mourn for the comforts of life in the solitary chamber—and the too general corruptions, and abominations, and defilements, and polluted practices of all flesh, upon the face of the earth;—all, all these signs, and multitudes more of a like nature, now existing, are the fulfillment of the prophecies, not only of the ancient prophets, but more particularly of the latter-day prophet and apostle, seer, and revelator, namely Joseph Smith, who opened up the way of life and salvation to this generation by the power of the everlasting Priesthood, which was restored to earth through him, and who prophesied and bore witness that all these, and many more

like things, should come to pass in this generation, as signs of the second coming of the Son of Man, which is near at hand; and verily his testimony is true, and his testament is in force, for he has sealed it with his blood; therefore, hear it all ye ends of the earth! believe on Jesus, be baptized in his name for the remission of your sins, and do all things he shall command to you; and you shall be saved in the presence of God and the Lamb, and there is no other way by which you can be saved.

Of the day and the hour of the coming of Christ no man knoweth. It is not yet, neither is it far off; there are prophecies yet to be fulfilled before that event takes place; therefore, let no man deceive the Saints with vain philosophy and false prophecy; for false prophets will arise, and deceive the wicked, and, if possible, the good; but while the wicked fear and tremble at surrounding judgments, the Saints will watch and pray; and, waiting the final event in patience, will look calmly on the passing scenery of a corrupted world, and view transpiring events as confirmation of their faith in the holy gospel which they profess, and rejoice more and more, as multiplied signs shall confirm the approach of the millennial day.

The Saints at home are making preparations to receive the Saints from abroad, and we feel grateful to our heavenly Father that we can bear witness in truth, that the choice blessings of the God of Abraham have rested upon his people, in the valleys of the mountains, since we last wrote you. The winter has been mild, compared with most winters, and much business has been transacted which could not have been done, had the weather been severe. Several grain and *lumber* mills have been erected, in the various settlements, the past winter; many *shingles* have been made, and all that is wanting to bring them into immediate use is nails; and let the Saints coming hither, remember this in particular. Chairs and various articles of furniture are multiplying in our midst. Two or three threshing machines have been in successful operation in our valley, the past fall and winter, which have saved the labor of many hundred days, which has been appropriated to other objects of improvements; yet more machines will be wanted for threshing in this valley, the present season, and

also in the various settlements of other valleys, and there is no fear of bringing too many, or too many fanning mill irons, and the most approved drafts for manufacturing the same.

It is a subject never to be forgotten by the Saints coming hither, that the most highly improved labor saving machinery of all kinds, (ever needed by almost any community), can be employed to greater advantage in Deseret, than in any other place on the earth. Suppose a brother coming home, brings some piece of machinery, with which he can sow, reap, thresh, fan, or perform the labor of ten men at this, or any other kind of business necessary to be done; nine elders could be immediately released from their employment, and go forth to preach the Gospel, and the improvements of Deseret, and the necessary preparations for a multiplying population, suffer no material injury; while under existing circumstances, there is enough for all to do who are here, to prepare for the coming of others; consequently, it is not wisdom to send many elders on foreign missions at present.

Our Council House was so far completed, during the fall, that the several apartments have been occupied through the winter, to the great joy of this people. The Warm Spring Bath House was completed, and dedicated by prayer and festival, on the 27th of November, since which time the house has been open to the public, for health and pleasure. The Tithing store house was enclosed last fall, and so far completed that one apartment has been used for a store, another for storage of grain, others for mechanics shops, while the cellars have been filled with vegetables, and the whole in progress of finishing. Building has hitherto been retarded, at times, for lack of lumber; but the prospect is much more flattering for the future. The enclosing of the University lands by a substantial stone wall is commenced and progressing, with a prospect of being completed this season. Great loss has been sustained hitherto, by the straying of cattle; but the tithing pasture, a large tract of land on the northern border of the city, is so far enclosed by fence and ditch, that it will soon be completed, and be of great utility this season. All who can bring wire No. 9, will find it of great advantage in fencing in the valley.

The State has appropriated two thousand dollars towards opening a woolen manufactory in this valley, the present season; and any amount of raw cotton, or cotton yarn, which may be brought hither, will prove highly useful to combine in certain fabrics, with the wool which grows in the valley. Our pottery is nearly completed, and we are expecting to use chinaware of our own manufacture in a few weeks. Cutlery establishments have commenced in the city, on a small scale, but more laborers are needed.

The snow fell on the mountains surrounding this Valley, on the 10th of October, and has continued to the present time, but in the Valley there was no snow till the 1st of November, about seven inches deep; and the first severe frost was on the 5th; and again on the 1st of December about four inches of snow fell, and at other times, the snow has fallen, but seldom over four or five inches, in the Valley, during one storm. The last two nights in February, were the coldest during the winter. Most of the month of March was very pleasant, and was improved by the farmers in putting in wheat. There was not so much wheat sown in the valley last fall as there was the fall previous, but considerable has been sown this spring. The spring sowing is quite as sure a crop as the winter, and equal in quantity and quality. The last week in March and first in April have been visited with high winds, alternate from south and northwest; some slight showers and some snow squalls, of three or four inches, during nights, which would pass off during the next day; and wheat sowing continues the principal business of the day, and may be continued from four to six weeks.

Elder Amasa Lyman arrived by the northern route, from California, on the 30th of September; and Elder C. C. Rich, by the same route, arrived on the 12th of November, each accompanied by a company of thirty to fifty of the brethren, on their return from the Gold Mines, of the products of which they brought very little with them; some were compelled to borrow to get home; and many who remained at the mines, would gladly have returned home, if they could have procured means.

December 7th, Elder George A. Smith left this city with about

130 men, a few families, and a good supply of teams, seeds and tools, for the purpose of establishing a settlement at Iron county (Little Salt Lake), about 250 miles, nearly south. We learn by an express that the colony have located in a good place, excellent soil and water, plenty of wood, iron ore, and alum, with some prospect of stone coal; a field of 1600 acres, and 400 of it sown, and that they designed to sow the whole this season. And their houses, which are to constitute a fort, and their meeting house are progressing rapidly. The name of the place is Cedar City.

(To be continued.)

ACCOUNT OF A JOURNEY FROM GREAT SALT LAKE CITY, FOUR HUNDRED AND FIFTY MILES TO THE SOUTH [FROM CAPT. D. JONES].

[Continued from page 202.]

DEC. 5.— We traveled to the south, crossed the San Pete River the second time, and in the evening we camped along the Sevier River, which runs from south to northwest, and contains as much or more water than the Tovey river. There is hardly any good land on its banks here. Here we met the Utah Chief Walker and his tribe hunting, some of them sick from measles. We administered to them as we were able. Before getting under way the next morning, they assembled together in our camp, and the gospel was preached to them through our interpreter, D. B. Huntington: they were presented with a Book of Mormon, together with a brief explanation of its contents, and our intentions of coming into their midst, together with their duties, &c. They listened attentively and contentedly to the end, when their Chief, Arapin, answered that “they had heard a great deal through the traditions of their fathers about some book of the work of their ancestors,” which they expected to obtain through the hands of white men; that they understood their genealogy and their ancestors, and that they had been a white people, skillful and good formerly; but, through transgression and disobedience of their fathers to the great *Shinob*, they had come to this degeneration. He said that they promised obedience to the Mormons in everything they wanted them to do, and through so doing they expected to be civilized, so they could become a strong, skillful and blessed people,

and so they would become white and beautiful again as before. He enlarged with apparent happiness through all of them, that their forebears showed that this blessed time was at the door: that they were very happy to see the Mormons settle in their midst, &c. We left a good impression on their minds, and we had from them irrefutable proofs that what is told of them in the Book of Mormon is true. It was amusing to hear them try to follow us in our songs, prayers, &c.! That the gracious Lord hasten the time in which they will be restored to the bond of the new covenant, is our prayer.

Here some of the brethren from San Pete visited us, and brought samples of salt and coal, which was in abundance in the neighboring mountains; also, a trader by the name of Barney Ward came here with goods to barter with the Indians; he informed us that he had been 14 years among the Indians of the interior—that we could get a fairly flat route along this valley, except for a place or two, for over a hundred miles to the Little Salt Lake Valley, and from there to the Colorado river, by the source of the Mohave river, to which place, from the California strait, and he was of the opinion that that the Colorado river was navigable. Mr. Ward told us also, that he had been among a people called the Moquis; that they were white people, skilled in crafts such as agriculture, weaving, making clothes, raising animals, building, planting, &c., that they were different in their whole behavior and in their language from the Spanish, more so than any Indians around them, and that they were handsome people, and that their women were particularly beautiful and fair. He described their clothes as being very similar to the clothes of the common folk in Wales. They worked, and they raised abundant crops of wheat, Indian corn, &c., in an abundant and luxuriant valley, along the Colorado river. They chiseled their houses for the most part in neighboring rocks, for protection against the neighboring Indians, which oppressed them greatly. Mr. Ward says that they are quite peaceful and hospitable to strangers; they had supplied him and his friends with plenty of food for free,—he said that he had eaten better apples, *pears*, &c., there, than in any other place; and that there was among his friends there one Welshman from birth, who understood a few words of Welsh only, and who testified that it was Welsh these natives were speaking! I do not guarantee, of course, how much credence we should give to all the above stories, yet they are not incredible to me when I understand the character

of the storyteller. Not often can so much smoke be seen, which hides the Madocians from the attention of their fellow nation from age to age, without its originating from some fire, say I. But to return to the account of our journey:—

We traveled to the bank of the Sevier river, and the land improved until the 11th, when the mountains closed before us. In the morning P. P. Pratt and I went on horseback before the rest of the camp to look for a path between the mountains. At about sundown, as we were going through a grove of cedar trees, totally unexpectedly, we heard horses neighing, and soon several galloped toward us; we understood from this, and from the barking of many dogs that there were Indians nearby; we followed after the horses to the trees, and soon we saw the *wicciups* (houses) of the Indians; but, they were inside making preparations to defend: we called them to come out, but they did not come, until we shouted *Mormoni toowidgeweinio*; at this they came out to us unarmed and cheerful to shake hands, and welcome us; this proved that the name of Mormons among the savages of the mountains was a protection to their lives; when among “Christians,” as they were called, the same name is reproachful and proverbial, and in some places endangers the life of its bearer! Does this not prove that the time is dawning when the “envying of Ephraim shall cease?”

P. P. Pratt went ahead to the mountain, and I returned to lead the company here to make camp, where we all met on that night.

Dec. 12.— We climbed a rather steep hill through cedars; and after descending about 5 miles to the south side, we arrived in a splendid small valley along the Sevier River, with an abundance of grazing and large *pine* trees, &c. We camped.

The next morning five of us went to look at the quality of the country; we crossed the Sevier on the ice, and we called this place *Mary Vale*, 200 miles from G. S. L. C. In the evening, after traveling hard through the day, through trees, and seeing the trails of bears, panthers, wolves, &c., we reached the fork of the river, the meeting of the half of the water coming from the east, and the other half coming from the south. We saw some Indians through the day wandering here and there for game. We returned back to meet the company. The weather cold, hardly any snow in the valley. The surrounding mountains white with snow; the thermometer at times in the night below the freezing point.

Dec. 14.—It was snowing; we reached the furthest corner of the valley, where the river issued from the huge crags, impossible to follow them further. The next day a way between the mountains was searched for, but one was not found better than crossing over the huge cliffs of the Wasatch Range, which feat was considered impossible by many, especially in the middle of the winter; but bravely and unitedly, we set ourselves to the task, and the next morning, the 16th, we began to climb, and some with axes, some with shovels, others with pickaxes, &c., through the deep snow we ascended gradually to the castle of the snow god, who at the time summoned his whole snowy and frigid powers to prevent us; by night we had reached from three to four miles; at times we had to tie ropes around the oxen, and drag them through the snow drifts, and then leave them to drag others, and after that the wagons, in this manner over the cliffs, and then lowering them down by ropes. Another time we drove the horses to break the way through the snow, but they became buried in the drifts, and then because of the cold we could not get them to face the storm. Sometimes we had to clear the snow with shovels, and the entire time we were crossing this ridge, almost a week, the animals had no food except for the tips of the trees which were sticking up out of the snow.

To our great joy, we found a narrow and gradual descent between steep and high rocks on the other side; we saw hills at times which were almost covered with deer, mountain goats, &c. I killed some of them. One morning we discovered that our animals had scattered, and we were everywhere in all directions on horses through the day looking for them, and by night we had gotten them all; and some of the searchers found out also, too late, that to the south of this place we could have had an easy opening that would have saved us crossing this ridge. On our descent from here, we went at times as if through narrow gates, between high crags, of every color and shape, as if we were traveling in an old castle; the view was wondrous and majestic. At last the fissure led us to the eastern corner of the Little Salt Lake Valley, and the climate was so temperate here, that the snow had disappeared, the grass was in abundance and sprouting, and the scene had changed so completely and suddenly compared with that on top of the mountains, that we called this place "Summer Gate." Here we camped, and great was the feast our poor animals had. From here we could see a splendid valley reaching from before us to the southwest a good 30 miles, and in its middle a rather large lake of water on which the sun shone as if on glass.

Dec. 22.—We traveled along the valley through the country of the rabbits, which dotted the face of the land, so that it was hardly possible to shoot in any direction without killing some; we had our fill of this food at that time. The land improving. In the evening we camped along a small river which came from the southern mountains, and emptied within ten miles to the salt lake. Because of the weakness of the oxen, and our desire to examine the quality of this new and beautiful valley, we decided to leave all the oxen here, together with the wagons and 32 men; the other 20 of us began on the 26th to the south, with twenty horses and 12 mules to carry our supplies, &c.

After traveling 6 miles through good land, we crossed another river, bigger than the other, the shores of which for several miles, are of excellent soil. This place is an excellent location for a settlement, with an abundance of firewood, namely cedars, &c., which extend to the foot of the nearby hills. The weather continues temperate here, and at times warm during the day, but rather cold in the morning and in the evening. After traveling about 12 miles further through these luxuriant meadows, in the evening we camped on the third river in this beautiful valley, after being greatly surprised in the excellence of its size and advantages, more than we had thought at the first sight from afar.

These waters are crystalline, cold and of good taste, and the chief wonder of these rivers is that they run along the small ridge of land which is higher than almost any other place of the land, which makes it easy to irrigate all of the lands. It is thought that the greatest part of these lowlands will produce wheat, oats, &c., without irrigating, and we believe it will produce Indian corn, cotton, potatoes, &c., better, because of the climate, than any other place we have seen in the valleys of these mountains: and certainly animals can be raised here with hardly any cost. The main road to the gold country of California, runs through the middle of this valley, which will make it a good marketplace.

(To be continued.)

SPECIAL GENERAL CONFERENCE.

ON Monday, the 7th of July, the above conference was held in the Cymreigyddion Hall, Merthyr, and presided over by President W. Phillips. Present, were President Phillips, R. Campbell, J. Davis, T. Pugh, T. Giles, E. Edwards, P. Seix, J. Roberts, together with a

packed hall of various other officers.

After the President opened the meeting, and was approved to continue presiding over his district, he proceeded to instruct the officers present, telling them, that inasmuch as they had come to the source, they should drink abundantly from it, so they could carry the instruction home to the Saints. He showed how the officers, when they came among the priesthood, felt themselves to be very small, and thus it would be preferable for them to refrain from speaking than to speak. He showed clearly that this principle is of God, and that the Holy Ghost is what causes it. He told them to always be small men, and that they would become great men in the kingdom of God. Another principle that he explained, was fear of the Lord; he showed the necessity for this principle to increase in us, namely the fear of disobeying the least counsels and commandments; and he said that he had found some persons, branches, and districts, with the hand of God on them, for they had spent book money for food and clothes, instead of trusting in God. He showed that the books were very special things; and if the book money is spent, how will the office pay its debts? he also said that whoever spent or borrowed money of the Emigrating Fund for the Poor, was guilty of serious transgression, and that the hand of God would certainly be upon him. Let every president remember, that if he is borrowing money from the treasurer of the fund, he is a transgressor. He has no right to ask for funds, for that is money of the Church; and the presidents only should take care to have the treasurer for each branch send the money punctually to the district treasurer, and then he will send it to the chief treasurer for Wales.

Then brother Robert Campbell (from Salt Lake Valley) was called on, and he addressed the crowd in English, on subjects similar to those of brother Phillips. He said that many very good men were to preach, like Aaron of old, but that it was necessary to have Moses to lead Israel. If the secrets of the kingdom of God were to be revealed to us at the present time, we would likely misuse them, as a watch would be misused in the hand of a child, for we do not know how to use them; God gives to us gradually so that we can grow in knowledge in his kingdom. He taught the presidents and the traveling elders to be kind, and full of the Holy Ghost, in teaching the people, and not to be the first in complaining about poverty. The branch that has a president who is poor in spirit, will have all his members poor also. Remember that our Father is very rich, and that the poorest of the Saints will have the greatest share in carrying forth the work of the Lord.

Then President Phillips arose again, and proposed that books in Wales no longer be sold on credit, and that the assistant distributors

should sell them only for cash, and then send the money to the head distributor, so that he can then send it to the office; and then the motion carried unanimously.

After calling on brother P. Seix to give a description of the upper part of Pembrokeshire, it was decided that the branches of Fishguard, Letterston, and Simpson, be made a District, under the name of the North Pembroke District, and that Phillip Seix would preside, with David Williams and David Rees as his counselors.

Then about eighteen missionaries were sent to labor in new places in the East Glamorgan District, and other Districts in the South, to try to establish new branches.

The President arose to give counsels to the missionaries concerning their responsibilities, that they take care not to be charmed by women, and that they pray when in need, &c.

He was followed by President J. Davis, who counseled the officers to keep the counsels of God, as well as his clearly defined commandments, by making use of the Word of Wisdom, which forbids wine and strong drink, tobacco, and hot drinks, such as tea, coffee, &c.; and he exhorted them to strive not to be in debt to anyone for anything, rather to look toward working justice.

Then it was decided that John Roberts was to preside over the Breconshire District, and that the Brynmawr and Waunhelygen branches would be in that district.

It was decided that the Llandudno, Eglwysfach, and Llanddoged branches, be made into a District, under the name of the Conwy Valley District, containing part of Caernarfonshire; and that John Davies was to be the president, and Isaac Morris and Barnett Parry as his counselors.

It was decided that Eliezer Edwards be a traveling elder in the North for the First Presidency, and that he was to give counsels and teachings to them with authority from the First Presidency in Wales.

President Pugh arose, and showed clearly the calling of God, and that those who hold a lesser office may preside over those who hold a higher office, &c.

WILLIAM PHILLIPS, *President*,
RICHARD MORRIS, *Scribe*.

A LITTLE REGARDING THE DEATH OF PAUL IN ROME.

PAUL was delivered by Nero, bound, unto Longimus and Magistus, the chief officers, and Akestus, the centurion, that they should lead him without the city, and cause him to be beheaded.

Paul being full of the Holy Ghost, spake the words of eternal

life, that Nero, and all the people, should believe in Jesus Christ, who was the king of heaven and earth, and who would destroy the glory of the world with fire.

When they had led him away, Longimus, Magistus, and Acestus, began to say unto him, Oh, Paul, where is that king? And where will he appear unto you? And how will you know him? And what will he give unto you? Or what good will he bestow upon you? that you, Christians, so mightily love him, that by no means you will consent unto our religion; that you may live and enjoy the good of this life? But rather than all the pleasures, you delight, to be led to die for him, with divers torments? For this seems to us to be a great error, to hate this joyful life, and to embrace, with all your desire, punishment and death.

Paul, therefore, said, O ye wise men, and flourishing in knowledge, depart out of the darkness and error, wherein the nobility of your understanding is clouded with darkness, lest you should see the truth, which lieth hid in you; turn the eyes of your minds to the eternal God, the true light, that ye may be able first to know yourselves, and so come to the knowledge of that King with gladness, and to be saved from the fire which is to come from heaven, and to remain unhurt: for he is no respecter of persons, as you think, rather God is just and holy, and the Lord Jesus Christ, who by reason of the injustice and violence, will come as a judge, and will judge by fire. Happy is that man who will believe in him, for he shall have eternal life, and shall live an everlasting life; and most unhappy is he who despising the riches of his bounties, and his long suffering, will not return unto him, for he shall perish eternally. R. G.

A WORD OF WISDOM

A Word of Wisdom, for the benefit of the council of high priests, assembled in Kirtland, and the church; and also the saints in Zion. To be sent greeting—not by commandment or constraint, but by revelation and the word of wisdom, showing for the order and will of God in the temporal salvation of all saints in the last days. Given for a principle with promise, adapted to the capacity of the weak and the weakest of all saints, who are or can be called saints.

Behold, verily, thus saith the Lord unto you, in consequence of evils and designs which do and will exist in the hearts of conspiring

men in the last days, I have warned you, and forewarn you, by giving unto this word of wisdom by revelation, that inasmuch as any man drinketh wine or strong drink among you, behold it is not good, neither meet in the sight of your Father, only in assembling yourselves together to offer up your sacraments before him. And behold, this should be wine, yea, pure wine of the grape of the vine, of your own make. And again, strong drinks are not for the belly, but for the washing of your bodies. And again, tobacco is not for the body, neither for the belly, and is not good for man, but is an herb for bruises and all sick cattle, to be used with judgment and skill. And again, hot drinks are not for the body or belly.

And again, verily I say unto you, all wholesome herbs God hath ordained for the constitution, nature, and use of man. Every herb in the season thereof, and every fruit in the season thereof; all these to be used with prudence and thanksgiving. Yea, flesh also of beasts and of the fowls of the air, I, the Lord, have ordained for the use of man with thanksgiving; nevertheless they are to be used sparingly; and it is pleasing unto me that they should not be used, only in times of winter, or of cold, or famine. All grain is ordained for the use of man and of beasts, to be the staff of life, not only for man but for the beasts of the field, and the fowls of heaven, and all wild animals that run or creep on the earth; and these hath God made for the use of man only in times of famine and excess of hunger.

All grain is good for the food of man, as also the fruit of the vine, that which yieldeth fruit, whether in the ground or above the ground. Nevertheless, wheat for man, and corn for the ox, and oats for the horse, and rye for the fowls and for swine, and for all beasts of the field, and barley for all useful animals, and for mild drinks, as also other grain. And all saints who remember to keep and do these sayings, walking in obedience to the commandments, shall receive health in their navel and marrow to their bones, and shall find wisdom and great treasures of knowledge, even hidden treasures; and shall run and not be weary, and shall walk and not faint; and I, the Lord, give unto them a promise, that the destroying angel shall pass by them, as the children of Israel, and not slay them. Amen.

We endorse the thorough observance of the foregoing Word of Wisdom, for the Twelve, the High Priests, the Seventy, the Elders, the Bishops, the Priests, the Teachers, the Deacons, the Brothers and Sisters, of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints; and that the officers of the Church in general, put the matter before

the Church, so that they may have the opportunity, either scattered or grouped; and converse together about the principles contained in the foregoing, and decide whether they have been sent out by the wisdom of heaven, or by the foolishness of men; and if it is by wisdom, let each one who decides this, show his faith by his works, and prove to others that his faith is saving faith.

Why is not wisdom to make a general habit of drinking tea, coffee, or hot drinks of any kind? Physicians, Scientists, Elders in Israel, will you be so good as to answer?—ED. OF THE DESERET NEWS.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

“DEATHBED alms,” says Dr. Sherlock, “are too much like deathbed repentance. Men give their possessions to God and to the poor, the same way they forsake their sins, when they can no longer keep them.”

It is an excellent skill for a man to know himself well; and excellent courage to know the way to humble himself.

PAYMENTS FROM JUNE 27 TO JULY 10.—Monmouthshire, £1 10s; Breconshire, £2; West Glamorgan, £3 17s; Denbighshire, £2; Dinas, £2 0s 0½c; Llanilltyd, £1 4s; Pontytypridd, £1; Llanfabon, £1 7s; Cwmbach, 17s 7c; Pendeulwyn, 9s 10½c; Twynyrodyn, 15s 4½c; Llandaff, 10s; Cardiff, £2 8s; Aberdare, £6 8s; Dowlais, £4 6s 9c; Hirwaun, £3; Rhymney, £2 10s 6c; Cwmnedd, 11s 6c; Merthyr, 8s 5½c; Pendaren, £1 7s; Cefn, £1 14s; Ynysgau, 2s 1c; Newchurch, 4s. Total, £40 11s 9c.

ERRATA.—In the Account of the Journey of Capt. Jones, in our last issue, “second” escaped for “minute,” in several places. A minute is the 60th part of a degree, or somewhat more than a mile; and a second is the 60th part of a minute. A degree is 69 miles.

 We have received a letter from Mrs. Lewis (originally from Kidwelly), from Manti City, containing very interesting news, but we have no space for it this time.

 The Letter of Capt. Jones to President Phillips, is for sale at 14, Castle street, Merthyr. Its price is one penny, and it contains excellent news.

 We had very many things to publish in this issue, but we are forced to leave them until the next.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 15.]

JULY 26, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

FIFTH GENERAL EPISTLE OF THE PRESIDENCY OF
THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-
DAY SAINTS, FROM GREAT SALT LAKE VALLEY,
STATE OF DESERET, TO THE SAINTS SCATTERED
THROUGHOUT THE EARTH.

[Continued from page 219.]

ON the 27th of November, the quorum of Seventies, in conference assembled, agreed to erect an extensive rotunda in Great Salt Lake City, to be called the Seventies' Hall of Science; and Joseph Young, their president, was appointed trustee and superintendent of the work. The foundation of the hall is commenced on East Temple and Second South streets, and the Seventies abroad will do well to send their money for the hall, to the trustee, inasmuch as they desire to own shares, and partake of the blessings of the hall on their return. All the elders of the different quorums are permitted to take shares. The design is highly commendable to the brethren, and such a building is much needed in this place.

At a special session of the Great Salt Lake County Court, on the 3rd January, a few transient men were convicted of stealing, and sentenced to hard labor for various terms, who, after serving a portion of their time, were pardoned by the Executive, and have gone on their way to California, the place of their original

destination. This was the first jury trial there had been in the State of Deseret since its organization, and the first occasion for the empanelling of a grand jury. It is supposed that about three hundred emigrants who quartered in the valley the past winter have left for the gold mines this spring. Many emigrants on arriving at this place, heard the gospel, believed, and were baptized, and thus far proved their sincerity by their works; while some professed to believe and were baptized, but their works have made manifest their hypocrisy, and their sins remain on their own heads. Had it not been for such kind of characters, no jury would have been needed in Deseret to this day.

In the former part of January, the General Assembly of Deseret granted an act of incorporation to Great Salt Lake City; and on the 11th of the same month the Great Salt Lake City Council was organized; Jedediah M. Grant, mayor, with four aldermen, and nine counselors; and municipal law immediately began to extend its influence over the city. About the same time, charters were granted by the General Assembly, on petition to Ogden City, in Weber County; to Provo City, in Utah County; to Manti City, in Sanpete County; and to Cedar City, in Iron County. All the counties in the State were greatly strengthened by the last emigration, and since that time several new settlements have been formed, and the agricultural interest of the state has been greatly extended.

A railroad has been chartered, to extend from Temple block in this city to the stone quarry and mountain on the east, for the conveyance of building materials; the construction to commence immediately.

A small company of brethren arrived from California, by the south route, on the 27th of January, bringing the intelligence that Utah territory had been organized, and Brigham Young appointed Governor, which intelligence has recently been reiterated through the medium of the eastern mail, in a manner which leaves no room to doubt; but as yet, the official notice, reports, or papers have not all been received. We anticipate no convulsive revolutionary feeling or movement by the citizens of Deseret in the anticipated change of

governmental affairs; but an easy and quiet transition from State to Territory, like weary travelers descending a gentle hill near by their way-side home.

As a people, we know how to appreciate, most sensibly, the hand of friendship which has been extended towards our infant State, by the General Government. Coming to this place as did the citizens of Deseret, without the means of subsistence, except the labor of their hands, in a wilderness country, surrounded by savages, whose inroads have given occasion for many tedious and expensive expeditions; the relief afforded by our mother land, through the medium of the approaching territorial organization, will be duly estimated; and from henceforth, we would fondly hope the most friendly feelings may be warmly cherished between the various States and Territories of this great nation, whose constitutional charter is not to be excelled.

The First Presidency of the Quorum of Seventies have been in frequent conference, the past winter, with the presidents of their several quorums, enquiring into the situation of their officers, severing from their office all such as have been known to dishonor their high and holy calling, and filling these vacancies with worthy men; also in filling the places of those who have been known to die since the quorums were organized in Nauvoo. The High Priests Quorum, and other quorums of the Church, have held their weekly meetings in the Council House during the winter, so that the house has scarce been cold since it was so far completed as to be occupied.

In January we visited the brethren in Davis and Weber counties, and organized a stake of Zion at Ogden city, by appointing a Presidency, High Council and Bishops: Loren Farr is president of the stake. Officers were also appointed in various places in Davis county, as there was occasion.

Elders Amasa Lyman and Charles C. Rich left this place early in March, with others, the camp amounting to about one hundred and fifty wagons (some of which were to stop and locate themselves in Iron county), for the purpose of establishing a settlement in the southern part of California, at no great distance from San Diego, and near Williams' Ranch and the Cahone pass, between which

places and Iron county, we design to establish settlements as speedily as possible, which Elder Lyman will commence on his route, if practicable, so as to have a continued lie of stations and places of refreshment between this point and the Pacific Ocean, which route is passable during the winter months.

On the 19th of March, we visited the Saints in Utah, and organized a stake of Zion at Provo city, by appointing Isaac Higbee President, with his Counselors, High Council, and Bishops.—On the 24th, we visited Elders Lyman and Rich's camp, at Payson, and saw them organized ready for their departure. Elder Pace presides over the branch at Payson, which is situated on Peteetneet creek. There are settlements also at Pleasant Grove and Springville. We left Elder P. P. Pratt, accompanied by Bishop John Murdock, and Elders William J. Perkins, John S. Woodbury, Richard R. Hopkins, Philo B. Wood, Morris Minor, and Francis A. Hammond, with Elder Lyman's company, on his mission to the Pacific.

Our city is now being fenced into *blocks*, instead of wards as formerly, and many shade trees are being set on the borders of the sidewalks. School houses have been built in most of the wards in the city and out in the country, and schools have been sustained therein the past winter, and we joyfully anticipate that the time has arrived when our children may be partakers of the blessings of constantly continued schools in their several wards. The Parent School is in successful operation in the Council House, under the tuition of Chancellor O. Spencer and Regent W. W. Phelps. The design of this school is to prepare its pupils to become teachers, and for all who may desire to advance in the higher branches of education. It is designed for the parent School to be open continually.

Hitherto, California immigrants have been accustomed to leave their sick on our hands, at a heavy expense, and depart without notice; to turn their teams loose in our streets, and near our city, which has caused much destruction of crops and grass, so that if we wanted a load of hay, we have had to go from ten to twenty miles to procure

it, and drive our cattle a still greater distance to herd the succeeding winter; but since the organization of a municipality, *quarantine* has been introduced, and no animals are permitted to roam within the corporation, which extends to some six or eight miles square; and when the surrounding lands are fenced, the accommodations in our immediate vicinity, for those who travel by multitudes, will be small indeed; and we believe it will be more convenient for the great mass of travelers to the mines to go by Fort Hall, or some route north of this, saving to themselves the expense and hindrance of *quarantine*, and other inconveniences arising from a temporary location near a populous city, where cattle are not permitted to run at large.

In view of the anticipated change in our government, and to facilitate business, the General Assembly of Deseret appointed Governor Young their agent, to receive the 20,000 dollars appropriated by Congress to build a State House in Utah Territory, and cause said house to be erected without delay on Union Square, in this city, a little north-west of Temple block; and the Assembly adjourned *sine die* on Saturday last. Dr. J. M. Bernhisel has been appointed by the President to select the Utah library, for which Congress has appropriated 5,000 dollars, and, at our latest advices, he was in New York, making the selection. Dr. Bernhisel has issued a circular, soliciting editors and publishers of newspapers, magazines, pamphlets, and books, to forward a copy of their productions to Great Salt Lake City, for the benefit of Utah library. We are happy in announcing the arrival of a few papers and pamphlets already, and if the friends of science generally shall respond in like manner, we will soon have a most valuable reading room attached to the Utah library, which will cause the blessings of thousands to rest upon the heads of the liberal donors.

The best interests of the Perpetual Emigrating Fund are continually before us, and we would urge the importance of its object upon all the Saints, and desire they would add to its funds by all laudable means; for when once a line of communication is established between here and the Pacific Ocean, those funds can

be made to bear in a more effective manner than they can under existing circumstances. We are looking forward in hope that the time is not far distant, when the most speedy conveyance may be had between this and the western coast.

It is wisdom for the English Saints to cease emigration by the usual route through the States, and up the Missouri river, and remain where they are till they shall hear from us again; as it is our design to open up a way across the interior of the continent, by Panama, Tehuantepec, or some of the interior routes, and land them at San Diego, and thus save three thousand miles of inland navigation through a most sickly climate and country. The Presidency in Liverpool will open every desirable correspondence in relation to the various routes, and rates, and conveniences, from Liverpool to San Diego, and make an early report, so, if possible, the necessary preparations may be made for next fall's emigration.

We contemplate erecting a wall around the Temple block this season, preparatory to laying the foundation of a Temple the year following; and this we will be sure to do, if all the Saints shall prove themselves as ready to pay their tithing, and sacrifice and consecrate of their substance, as freely as we will; and if the Saints do not pay their tithing, we can neither build nor prepare for building; and if there shall be no Temple built, the Saints can have no endowments; and if they do not receive their endowments, they can never attain unto that salvation they are anxiously looking for. So far as the Saints in the United States and Canada desire to see the work of the Lord prosper, let them arise as one man, and come to Deseret, where they can do more for Zion in one year, than they can in many years where they are. Come on the Saints' route north of the Platte, as we stated in our last epistle, leaving the grave yards on the south of the Platte to a future resurrection. If all were agreed in this move, there need not be a Saint left in the States or Canada one year hence. This is wisdom; but if you shall continue to hold on to your farms, and improvements, and effects, for the purpose of improving the price, and making money, you may expect to want help at a future day, when it will be difficult to obtain; and the

Saints need not ever to expect a more convenient time to gather out of the States than the present.

The Indians have been troublesome in their operations the past winter, driving off cattle from remote settlements, but with less threatening of life than formerly, and more secret in their depredations.

We have received very few letters from the elders abroad since our last epistle, although there is a monthly mail between here and Independence, Mo., when not interrupted by snow, as it has been mostly the past three months. The Twelve Apostles are abroad, except Wilford Woodruff and Ezra T. Benson, who are in the valley. Their president, Orson Hyde, is located at Kanesville, Iowa, and is expected to visit the valley this summer. P. P. Pratt is on his way to the Society and Sandwich Islands, and Chile; his mission extends to all lands in, and bordering on the Pacific Ocean. At last accounts, the work was very prosperous at the Society Isles. We have not heard from the Sandwich mission since the arrival of Elder Hiram Clark and his associates. Orson Pratt is supposed to be in the States on his way to the valley, where he will be associated with the University of Deseret for a season. John Taylor was at Boulogne, in France, at our latest dates, preaching, translating, and publishing. Lorenzo Snow, having visited the Italian States, was located at Piedmont. Erastus Snow is at Copenhagen, and the work is prospering in Sweden, Denmark, Norway, Germany, and all that region. We received a letter from Brother Snow, dated Copenhagen, August 17, 1850. He is translating the Book of Mormon.—Franklin D. Richards is presiding over the church in the British Isles, and his office is in Liverpool. Amasa Lyman and Charles C. Rich are on their way to the Cahone pass. George A. Smith is presiding at Iron county. The mission of the Twelve Apostles now abroad is to all nations, kindreds, tongues, and people, upon the face of the whole earth; and whenever and wherever the Lord shall open a door for their admission, they will scatter the seed, and, if needs be, will leave wise men to gather the harvest, being guided, directed, and counseled in all their movements by the principle of revelation, and the Holy

Ghost dwelling within them; and may the God of Abraham and Joseph help them on their missions, for verily they will not have time to preach to all nations before all flesh will be seized with fear and trembling in view of those things which the Almighty is about to bring to pass, for the wickedness of man is great before Him, and the earth He will purify by fire.

There has been more sickness in the valley this spring than usual, and several deaths, though the people in the other valleys have been well generally. We know of no reason why this valley is not as healthy in its location and character as any other; but as this is the place for the first arrival of the Saints, a greater proportion of the infirm stop here, where they can more readily procure the comforts of life, while the hardier portion go forward to newer settlements; and a great portion of the sickness in our midst arises from the seeds of disease and death sown in the system while tarrying and passing through the agueish regions of the western States. Sickness here is generally of short duration, and ends speedily in health or death. The families of the elders who are on foreign missions are in usual health at this time.

The Saints in their gathering should never forget to gather and bring all choice seeds, for here is the place for them to grow and be useful; a large quantity of *osage orange*, and other seeds suitable for hedges, through which wire may be passed to make fence, are much needed at this time. Bring all the lath and *shingle* nails you can, also glass, wire no. 9, raw cotton, cotton yarn, machinery, and domestics.

Amid all the revolutions that are taking place among the nations, the elders will ever pursue an undeviating course in being subject to the government wherever they may be, and sustain the same by all their precepts to the Saints, having nothing to do with political questions which engender strife, remembering that the weapons of their warfare are not carnal, but spiritual, and that the Gospel which they preach is not of man, but from heaven; and if they persecute you beyond measure, in one city, country, or kingdom, leave the testimony which Jesus has given for a witness unto your Father in heaven, that

you are free from their blood, and flee to other cities, countries, or kingdoms where they will receive you and believe your testimony.

During the early part of the last session of the General Assembly of Deseret, the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints was incorporated into a body politic, in accordance with the general principles of incorporation, given by Christian governments, to religious societies, with power to choose a trustee-in-trust and assistant trustees to hold the property, and manage the financial affairs of the Church, for its benefit and convenience; and during the present general conference, President Brigham Young was unanimously and legally elected trustee-in-trust of the church, and Edward Hunter assistant trustee, and Presiding Bishop.

Should the way open for any of the scattered saints (except such as we have before counseled to tarry where they are) to ship direct to San Diego, in California, they will do so, and from thence they can work their passage to the settlement about to be formed by brothers Lyman and Rich in that vicinity, and from thence to this place.

May grace, mercy, peace, and prosperity, be multiplied unto all the Saints, in the name of Jesus. Amen.

BRIGHAM YOUNG,
HEBER C. KIMBALL,
WILLARD RICHARDS.

Great Salt Lake City, Deseret, April 7, 1851.

ACCOUNT OF A JOURNEY FROM GREAT SALT LAKE CITY, FOUR HUNDRED AND FIFTY MILES TO THE SOUTH [FROM CAPT. D. JONES].

[Continued from page 223.]

THE next day after traveling through this lovely country, in the afternoon we stood on the ridge from where we could see an even wider valley, which is about 15 minutes wide before us; it reaches to the south between two mountain ridges out of sight, and to the north about 20 minutes, or more, then to the west for 100 minutes, and half that in width. At our feet three strong *springs* of sparkling

water gush, which form enough water to turn mills and irrigate the meadows in their course down to the large river which runs through the middle of this valley, on the eastern banks of which there are thousands of acres of desirable land, yet not many in contrast to those which are on its western side; where we judge to be about 20 thousand acres of flat luxuriant meadows; and behind that as much, or more, of good farming land, which reaches to the foot of the western hills, which rise gradually and are covered with cedars, &c. To the west of the place I describe now, there is a rather high, jagged mountain, which we judge to be of iron ore, the richest that any of us has ever seen; besides several kinds of other ores in that neighborhood. I consider this discovery to be priceless in this place. Some in our company said that they saw coal also nearby, but I did not see any. No doubt but what this is a lovely and very commercial location for a settlement. Commercial, I say, because of the iron, &c., so convenient and abundant,—located about half way between Salt Lake City and the Pacific Ocean, or the California Strait. Lovely, because the country is open to the south, and the climate is temperate, and the lay of the land is so advantageous and beautiful. An excellent place to build a city is at the foot of these hills, where there is plenty of firewood, water, and land, and healthful air to breathe. Permit me for a minute to describe the image which I saw in my mind's eye while standing in this place! I see here a beautiful city, a branch of mount Zion, and plenty of space to stretch its boundaries where it wishes;—in its foreground, to the east, and that which it overlooks, from every corner of it, I see large fields getting white for the harvest, their glad owners smiling at this sight, without thinking of paying anyone rent or hardly any tax on any of them, rather everyone free to enjoy his fill of all the elements. Beyond these white crops, the luxuriant meadows stretch their verdant and splendid *carpets*, along which countless thousands of oxen, cattle, calves and flocks of sheep are playing, all of which fill their skins with this abundance in a short time. To satisfy their needs, the river runs slowly and sluggishly past this majestic sight, while along its pretty banks herds of horses prance with a boastful neigh, under the feeling of their independence in this western paradise. Yet, I

cannot close this picture until we see hosts of the race of Gomer, which are now in slavery and poverty, their women and children, instead of hunger and oppression, here enjoying their fill; and all of its inhabitants cheerful whom I meet along its long and beautiful roads. But, hush! we have gone far enough; my wish is this, even though perhaps it may never be realized; at least there is here now neither house nor sty, except what the Indians have, nor animals, except for those we brought here, and an occasional deer, wolf, or rabbit. Its only inhabitants are a few Indians of the *Pah Utah* tribe, which wander over the country without perceiving its worth or its excellence, much like the fox that wishes only for his prey.

From here we went up to the southern valley through fruitful meadows, and we crossed some streams which furnished it with water. The third day we crossed a small river which runs across the valley, which by now narrows to about 7 minutes in width; this river could easily be turned to run to the north, to mix with the waters of the "Great Basin," and with them to the eastern seas thousands of miles from here; but having been between two thoughts for a long time, it decides to swerve to the south, and it is soon swallowed into the bowels of the Rio Virgin river, which a little to the south bubbles out of the middle of a huge rock, swelling to the bellies of our horses as we crossed it, and it hurries to the south a bit, and then it rushes to a cave under a mountain out of our sight for about 5 minutes, and then it comes to daylight again, hurrying to meet its mother, namely the Rio Colorado, and with her to the California strait, which proves that we now have passed the highest ridge of this continent, and from where there is a descent to the Pacific Ocean.

The climate changes now almost every day and becomes more temperate; no snow or any more snowy mountains, except behind us; the leaves are breaking out on the small trees and vegetables; all of which are of a different kind, more similar to those of the *tropics*. The geography and the view have completely changed also. Now, the country with its face is looking the other way, as if it had turned backwards. It seems as if we are going quickly to the bottom of some place! The country is lumps and cliffs shattered by something, and stretching its ledges to the south, from the heads of which it jumps hundreds of feet to begin another ledge. On these varied rocks are seen pictographs of almost every kind, *hieroglyphics*, carvings, together

with monuments of the greatness and antiquity of the nation which made them. Several of them were copied; our wise men, those who can interpret them, say that they resemble those which were on the plates of the Book of Mormon. These natives, who are of the tribe of the Pah Utahs, wandering through the country without settling, building or laboring, or having rifles, or clothes except from the skins of rabbits, cannot give us an explanation of them, except that is where they first saw them.

It is obvious that it is Spring in this country, even though it is but the beginning of January for us. The whole country, not only the lowlands, but also the hills, is terribly muddy, so that it is almost impossible to travel. Everyone has to walk now because the horses are sinking; the mules, despite all their skill in trying to tread on rocks, are sinking to their bellies, and unable to rise, so that we frequently have to untie their burdens, at times a half a dozen or more at once. Now we have to keep one or more of the Indians in our camp every night as a hostage so that the others won't take our animals, &c. Like this we traveled, uncomfortable and tired, down along the banks of the Rio Virgin river, which by now, receives other rivers to its bosom, and finally we reached the place where the Santa Clara empties into it. It rushes now between high and rough crags. A fairly even distribution of trees are along it, with an occasional small and paradisiacal glade, where the Indians have planted *corn*, &c., but too narrow for a settlement.

Because of the weakness of our animals and the miry condition of the country, we had to change our intent and our course, and from here we followed the small river last named to the west. We had intended to follow along to the south, to the Colorado, to search out the Moquis, &c.; but because of that which was noted, we deemed it wisest to return. In these parts scores of the inhabitants gathered around us, and at times gnashed their teeth at us in an ugly way. The rains are frequent here while we did not have anything to shelter us from them, nor against any other possible harm except for blankets or a Buffalo skin, which we spread on the wet ground, with another one over us; and frequently during the night I woke up almost swimming in water, but the watchmen had kept the fire going in their turn, and thus they kept the large black wolves, the panthers, the *wild cats*, &c., away, which were thirsting after our blood; yet, the animals were no more bloodthirsty than the natives at times. One time we had a

host of them together, and we made conditions of peace with them, which continued at least as long as the presents they received from us. After that they invited us to their country, and said that they had heard a great deal from other Indians about the "Mormons", that they are good people, who teach them the ways and the skills of their fathers. We did not see a woman or a child in their midst at all; they said that the measles had swept them all away. Was this true or false? there are worse, but unproven tales told about them; I do not think they consider hardly anything too shameful to do. Within a few days, we reached the road which leads to California, along which we returned over the Rim of the Basin, along the valley that I mentioned before, for about 60 minutes, where we met several emigrants going toward the gold country. We saw the abundance of iron ore along the sides of the road, and at last we camped by the foot of the iron mountain mentioned before. Next day, P. P. Pratt and I went ahead of the others, and we reached our wagons in the Little Salt Lake by midnight, tired, and after having a rather hard skirmish with the snarling residents of these woods. Everyone healthy, and happy to see us; we were received with cannon thunder, rifles, *hurrahs* and *hosannas*, &c. Hardly anyone slept until the morning, rather we exchanged stories and news, and feasted.

(To be continued.)

SPECIAL GENERAL CONFERENCE.

(From the "Millennial Star.")

A SPECIAL General Conference was held, in the Saints' Chapel, Whitechapel, London, on the 3rd of June, 1851, at which there were present four of the Twelve, the counselors to the Presidency in the British Isles, Presidency and counsel in the Principality, and twenty-three Presidents of Conferences. The propriety of detaching the Channel Islands Conference from the Presidency of the conferences in the British Islands, and annexing the same to the French Mission was taken into consideration.

Being requested by President F. D. Richards to express his mind upon the subject, Elder John Taylor desired that it should be so, and expressed his sentiments as to the propriety and wisdom of such a movement, inasmuch as it would serve to strengthen the hands of the French brethren, and would be a convenient place from which to obtain and send forth Elders who were somewhat familiar with the language and manners of the French nation. He also spoke with

reference to the Book of Mormon, which would shortly appear in the French language, observing that as many Elders would no doubt be sent from this island to the continent to labor, it would be well for them generally to obtain the French translation, and diligently read it, in connection with an English copy, and thus obtain an acquaintance with the French version. This method he considered one of the best for acquiring the language. If the Elders felt to adopt this, it would materially aid in refunding a loan made for the purpose of publishing that work. Elder Taylor also stated his plan for issuing a monthly periodical in Paris, the first number of which is on sale.

After some further remarks from Elder Taylor and others, it was moved, seconded, and unanimously voted, that the Channel Island Conference be detached from the Presidency of the British Island, and attached to the Presidency of the Church in France.

Elder Edward Sutherland represented the situation and prospect of the work in Dublin, after which it was moved, seconded, and unanimously voted, that Elders Sutherland and Hayes continue to prosecute the work of the Gospel in Dublin, and call such faithful men as they may find there to aid them in the same.

The entire day was spent in a most happy and profitable manner, in imparting instruction upon various interesting, profitable, and important subjects, by the different members of the Twelve, and others who were present.

The services of a day that will long be gratefully remembered, were closed at eventide by singing "When shall we all meet again," and benediction by Elder John Taylor.

F. D. RICHARDS, *President*.

J. F. BELL, *Secretary pro tem*.

TO THE CHURCHES.

14, Castle St., Merthyr Tydfil, July 15, 1851.

MR. EDITOR,—I have a few counsels to give to the presidents in general; if you have space for them in "ZION'S TRUMPET," I shall proclaim some things that will benefit the districts, branches and all the Saints.

We held a conference here on the 6th of this month, and we sent eighteen missionaries to go to their journeys without purse or scrip; and I think that the last of them has gone out today; and may our gracious God bless them. They have been sent out to test the world, and to establish new branches in their midst, without any help from any branch, rather to get their food, their clothing, and their lodging from the world, as far as circumstances will allow. And now, Presidents of Districts and Branches, in order to legitimately prove

the world, prevent these missionaries from visiting your branches, or from receiving help in any way, except for books; if the branches are so kind as to help them with a few books, that will be fine. The reason that more branches have not been established throughout this country is, that the brethren have not gone out legitimately; they have taken money with them or they have been relying on the branches around them. These missionaries have the right to receive money from the world, and they are sure to get it through faith; for God is truthful, and promises to give food, clothing and lodging, and money also, if there is a need, together with everything that is necessary to those who faithfully keep His commandments. And the Spirit of God this very minute, through me, promises these things. There are many temptations to come to confront these brethren; but regardless of how many temptations come, God is on their side, and he will guide them.

And now, brethren, may you in your Districts have as much desire for your part as do these missionaries to save the thousands of souls who are in this land, and search out good men whose circumstances allow them to go out; send them out to the towns, villages, and the surrounding country, to establish Branches. Have no fear of priests, preachers, or any class of men; go to their congregations, and to the synagogues, and preach this Gospel to them, as a witness for the kingdom, and do it with the power of the Holy Spirit, so that you can be free from them on the day of judgment; for all will be judged according to this gospel. And now, brethren, go forward and gather up the daughter of Zion, so that she may be taken home, across the seas, to the Mountains of Ephraim, to build splendid cities and temples, and plant her vineyards, and put on her wedding garment; for her Bridegroom is coming, and galloping across the clouds of heaven, and a myriad of his Saints are with him. So be it. Amen.

I have one other counsel to give to you pertaining to those who are called Saints, or officers, and who are too lazy to work, and go around from branch to branch, singing to the women, and deceiving others for their food like this from house to house for months, and influencing some presidents to take up a collection for them by giving them a small account as to how things are going along in the North, in Cardiganshire, in Carmarthenshire, and in other counties; and how they debated with people and were victorious; and then a little ding dong on the harp afterwards; and then some innocent sister comes in and extends an invitation, "Come and have lunch with me;" "come and have tea with me," says another; "and come with me to meet with the Saints," says some president; and he will sit in the chair of the president, and will be introduced—that he is a brother from somewhere, and then the dear Saints will be ready to listen to him. Oh! how sorry I feel for my brothers and sisters, who did not beware, and refrain from giving acceptance to anyone except those who are in authority, or those who have permission in

some circumstances. Once again, I warn you, presidents of districts, branches and groups, to beware of such cunning men, and do not allow men to live idly on the backs of the Saints. Teach the Saints to give them a meal, a night's lodging, and send them on their way the next morning; do so if they possess licenses; and if they do not leave their wicked ways behind, we shall cut them off from the Church, and put their names in the TRUMPET.

I am, your humble servant,
WM. PHILLIPS.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

BEAUTY is a flower that soon dies; health worsens, and strength flees away; but innocence is immortal, and is happiness in life and in death. Perhaps the young may die very young, but it is impossible for the old to live much longer. Unripe fruits can be picked off, or shaken down; but the ripe fruits will fall on their own.

If you do not wish to be considered fools by other people, do not be wise in your own eyes; he who trusts in his own wisdom, proclaims his foolishness; the true wise man has enough wisdom to perceive his own foolishness.

IMPETUOUSNESS is a kind of fever in the mind; it always leaves us much weaker than it found us.

PAYMENTS FROM JULY 11 TO JULY 22.—Monmouthshire, £10 10s; Flintshire, £2; Caernarvonshire, £1 6s; Merionethshire, £2; Pontytypridd, £1; Cardiff, 11s 4c; Georgetown, £3 5s; Merthyr, £2 6s; Cefn, 14s 3½c. Total, £23 12s 7½c.

“W. T., A——r.”—If you see some contradictory things in the Book of Mormon and the Doctrine and Covenants, it is better for you to point them out to us, and then perhaps we can comment on them in the TRUMPET, so that others also may also be enlightened as well as yourself.

“W. W.”—We cannot say yet when the next emigration will be; we will let you know as soon as we hear.

BOOK OF MORMON.—We desire all Presidents and their Distributors to collect names for the Book of Mormon without delay. It will come out in the same manner as the “DOCTRINE AND COVENANTS,” until it is completed, for a penny halfpenny per segment. It will likely contain from 30 to 32 segments.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 16.]

AUGUST 9, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

MINUTES OF THE GENERAL CONFERENCE OF THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-DAY SAINTS,

*Held at Great Salt Lake City, in Deseret, April 6, 1851 at ten in the morning,
President Young presiding.*

[From the "Deseret News."]

PRESENT of the First Presidency—Brigham Young Heber C. Kimball, and Willard Richards. Patriarchs—John Smith and Isaac Morley. Of the Twelve Apostles—Wilford Woodruff and Ezra T. Benson. Presidency of the Seventies—Joseph Young, Levi W. Hancock, Zera Pulsipher, Henry Herriman, Albert P. Rockwood, Benjamin L. Clapp, and Jedediah M. Grant. Presidency of the Stake—Daniel Spencer, David Fullmer, and Willard Snow. High Priests Quorum—John Young and Reynolds Cahoon. The High Council of the Stake. Clerks of Conference—Thomas Bullock and William Clayton.

Conference opened, and adjourned on account of the heavy rains, and the leakage of the roof of the Bowery.

Monday, April 7, ten in the morning—Conference being called to order, was opened with singing, prayer by John Young, and singing.

President Young being detained by sickness, President Kimball stated the business of the conference, and remarked very pointedly, that it was the duty of the presidents of the different quorums, to furnish a list of their several quorums, at every conference, for the benefit of the historian and the authorities of the Church; and presented Brigham Young, as the President of

the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, throughout all the world, and also as prophet, seer and revelator; which was carried by unanimous vote.

Heber C. Kimball was then presented as first counselor to President Young, and Willard Richards as his second counselor; who were severally sustained in that office.

John Smith was sustained as the presiding patriarch to the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

Willard Richards was sustained as the Historian of the Church, and general Church Recorder.

Orson Hyde was sustained as the president; and Parley P. Pratt, Orson Pratt, Wilford Woodruff, John Taylor, George A. Smith, Amasa Lyman, Ezra T. Benson, Charles C. Rich, Lorenzo Snow, Erastus Snow, and Franklin D. Richards, were severally sustained as members of the quorum of the Twelve Apostles.

Daniel Spencer was sustained as president of this stake in Great Salt Lake Valley, and David Fulmer and Willard Snow his counselors.

H. G. Sherwood was sustained as president; and Eleazer Miller, John Kempton, Heman Hyde, Lewis Abbott, Wm. W. Major, Levi Jackman, Elisha H. Groves, Ira Eldredge, John Vance, Edwin D. Woolley, and John Parry, as members of the High Council.

John Young was sustained as president of the high priests quorum, and Reynolds Cahoon and George B. Wallace his counselors.

Joseph Young was sustained as senior president; and Levi W. Hancock, Henry Herriman, Zera Pulsipher, Albert P. Rockwood, Benjamin L. Clapp, and Jedediah M. Grant, as presidents of the quorums of Seventies.

President Kimball nominated Edward Hunter, to occupy the place vacated by the death of Newel K. Whitney, as presiding bishop in the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints; carried unanimously.

John Nebeker was sustained as president of the elders quorum, and James H. Smith and Aaron Seeva his counselors.

Joseph Harker was sustained as president of the priests quorum. (His counselors have left this stake, and he is not prepared to nominate new counselors.)

McGee Harris was sustained as president of the teachers

quorum, and John Vance and Reuben Perkins his counselors.

The presidency of the deacons quorum having been removed into other quorums, no action was taken on their officers.

Some of the bishops having removed to the southern settlements, it was moved that Nathaniel V. Jones be the bishop of the fifteenth ward; carried.

Abraham Hoagland, bishop of the fourteenth ward; Reuben Miller, Mill Creek ward; Abraham O. Smoot, Big Cottonwood ward; Ezekiel Lee, Holladay's settlement; Peter McCue, first ward; and Joseph C. Kingsbury, second ward.

President Kimball nominated Brigham Young to be trustee in trust for the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints; carried unanimously. Bishop Edward Hunter was elected assistant trustee.

The motion to build a Temple to the name of the Lord our God in Great Salt Lake City, was carried by acclamation.

A committee of one, viz., Daniel H. Wells, was appointed to superintend the building of the Temple, and the public works.

Benediction by J. M. Grant. Adjourned for one hour.

Two in the afternoon.—Conference opened according to adjournment, south side of the Bowery. Singing; prayer by E. T. Benson. Singing; President Kimball presiding.

Brigham Young was sustained as the president of the perpetual emigrating company to gather the poor, and H. C. Kimball, W. Richards, W. Woodruff, O. Hyde, G. A. Smith, E. T. Benson, J. M. Grant, D. H. Wells, W. Snow, E. Hunter, E. Spencer, T. Bullock, J. Brown, W. Crosby, A. Lyman, C. C. Rich, L. Young, P. P. Pratt, O. Pratt, and F. D. Richards were sustained as his assistants.

J. M. Grant then made a call for volunteers to go to Iron county, and requested those persons who were appointed last fall, to go and fulfill that appointment.

Anson Call gave a short review of what had been done towards settling that country.

President Kimball then called several by name, when thirty-seven persons agreed to go.

E. T. Benson said—This morning you all voted to build a Temple;

you appointed a committee to superintend the public works; you are aware that they cannot progress without your assistance; you are aware we are the Latter-day Saints, and are the bone and sinew to roll forth the work; it is required of the presidents and quorums in this Church to pay their tithing, and you know this has not been lived up to; I consider it a command on this people; there are some men and women who have done and will do all they can. This church will not become of age until we all pay our tithing, and live up to all the commandment binding on us; then we will be free indeed, for the gospel is the gospel of freedom. Many persons inquire, When shall we get any more revelations? I tell you we shall not get any more until we as a people observe those revelations which are already given; when we do that, we shall get more.

H. C. Kimball remarked—We should be glad to continue this conference three or four days; but we cannot. He called on all men to attend to their duty, and then the power of God will be with us; there will be no fear with those who do right, &c.

On motion, conference adjourned to the first Sunday, (the 7th) in September, 1851.

Dismissed with benediction by Willard Richards.

THOMAS BULLOCK, *Clerk.*

ADDENDA TO THE FIFTH GENERAL EPISTLE

Of the Presidency of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, from Great Salt Lake Valley, State of Deseret, to the Saints scattered throughout the earth, greeting:—

[From the "Deseret News."]

BELOVED BRETHREN,—Some items having escaped notice in our communication of the 7th of this month, we again resume the pen in reference particularly to the necessary supplies of sugar, molasses, and honey that are necessary for the citizens of Deseret. Some experiments have been made with beets in the manufacture of molasses and vinegar, mostly in private families, the specific results of which, in minute detail, we are not informed; but we have learned for a certainty, that with a little labor, any family who has a supply of beets can make themselves comfortable for molasses, though

the art of removing the gas and foreign matter, is not sufficiently understood to secure so perfect an article as is desirable. Vinegar has been produced from the same source, of a good quality. Let the brethren bring all the white sugar-beet seed they possibly can, for years to come.

Messrs. Beach (of St. Louis), and Blair (of Texas), have opened a general manufacturing establishment this spring, mostly too late for sugar, but progressing in making molasses and vinegar. It is expected that this establishment will continue its operations, and be prepared for more extended labors on the approach of another harvest; but it will not be possible for one factory to supply all the sweet that will be needed; and if a practical chemist and manufacturer of sugar from the beet, one who understands the business in all its bearings, or a company of individuals, who are severally versed in the various branches, could come to this place and open their sugar factories, our farmers and families would gladly surrender their domestic operations, and procure their supplies, in a more perfect form, from the factories; and it would now require several extensive establishments to supply the people. It is our wish that the presidency in England, France, and other places should search out such practical operators in the manufacture of sugar as fully understand their business, and forward them to this place, with all such apparatus as may be needed and cannot be procured here.

Several swarms of bees, that have been brought from the States, are doing well in the Valley, and it is very desirable for the brethren to bring all the bees they can; for it is believed they will flourish here; and so far as honey can be produced, it will supersede the necessity of making sugar; and if there were ever so much sugar, honey is needed as a medicine, as well as a luxury.

BRIGHAM YOUNG,
HEBER C. KIMBALL,
WILLARD RICHARDS.

Great Salt Lake City, Deseret, April 16, 1851.

OBSERVATIONS ABOUT EMIGRATING, &c.

AMONG the various interesting subjects considered in the Fifth General Epistle of the First Presidency, that of emigration, in all

likelihood, will attract more attention of the British Saints than any other topic.

We shall send out no ship load of Saints to New Orleans on the 1st of September as usual. There are, however, some American Elders whose families reside in the western states, who will be going out by way of New Orleans some time during the winter; there are also a few, whose husbands and fathers have gone before to earn means to bring their families to them in New Orleans, St. Louis, or Kanesville and vicinity, whom it may be advisable should go that way. Such cases will be represented to us by the presidents of their respective conferences, and arrangements will be made for them to go out on the same vessel. Those Saints will make their applications to the president of their conference; and should anything difficult or doubtful arise, the president will communicate with us.

The Saints will be pleased to learn that a company has been organized for the manufacture and refining of sugar from the beet, which will take out the operatives, seed, and all the machinery, apparatus, &c., necessary to establish the business in the valleys. Also a company for the manufacture of all woolen fabrics, which are in common use for either male or female wear: this company takes with it machinery of the most improved patents, and of the best quality of workmanship, together with the necessary managers and operatives, for the several departments of the concern. Their complement of laborers is already made up. Both firms are organized with a handsome capital, in the hands of thorough-bred business men; who, no doubt, by their prudential policy, will establish themselves in a business which, in that new country, will soon become the first on that continent, and not only prove a vast pecuniary advantage to the proprietors and their heirs, but to the enterprising and growing community, among whom they have determined to cast their lot.

These companies will probably go out under the auspices of one of the Twelve, who has rendered himself familiar with the entire route, by repeatedly traveling it; and whose experience will doubtless save the companies hundreds of pounds of expenses, which would otherwise incur on the various stages of that long, and in some

portions, tedious journey. They will probably proceed on their way by the present route during the approaching season of emigration.

Brethren, we know the deep anxiety that pervades your minds, to get where you can accomplish something to benefit yourselves, and the cause of God; but we say unto you, be not overly anxious; let the way be provided before you, that when you start you may be landed among your brethren, under the watchcare of such faithful men of the Twelve, as elders Amasa Lyman, and Charles C. Rich, who will teach you the purposes of God, and instruct you in the way of everlasting life. Far better is it for you to remain here, under your present beloved elders and ministers, where you can enjoy the gifts and blessings of the Gospel, than to go and give your strength to strangers, who have no interest with you in the upbuilding of the Kingdom of God, and perhaps, fall by pestilence, or apostasy. Let none think of going to the eastern states, for the voice of the Spirit is, for all Saints to flee out from those countries and the two Canadas, with all possible speed. The faithful in St. Louis, and other places on the western rivers, will hasten to the mountains as fast as their circumstances will possibly permit; and we do hope during the approaching emigration season to see the Saints leaving Liverpool by shiploads for San Diego. We have been in communication with the Presidency, and also with officers and agents of the Perpetual Emigration Fund Company, since last February upon this subject; and shall spare no pains to inform the Churches, upon the receipt of any intelligence which will be of importance to them, upon this absorbing topic. The deposit monies in our hands are held subject to the orders of those who remitted them, or may be applied on their passages at any future time. We are not prepared to state, whether emigration to San Diego, will be opened via Cape Horn, or the isthmus of Panama; neither shall we be prepared to name the price of passages, till definite arrangements are made.

Meanwhile, let every member as well as officer in the Church, be diligent to aid in some good degree, to spread abroad the knowledge of the Gospel. Now is the time for the presiding and traveling elders to enlarge their arrangements, both for preaching, and for circulating

the written word, while it is the warm season, and outdoor preaching can be done with great effect. Now is the time, while editors and publishers are spreading abroad the growing fame of the mighty Kingdom of God, which is to increase until it shall fill all the earth. Let holy boldness, with great meekness and simplicity, characterize all your testimonies; always avoid every spirit of contention, that the Spirit of the Lord be not grieved from your bosoms. Be not self-righteous, as was said by some of old, "Come not near me, for I am holier than thou;" but let us rather make ourselves of no artful reputation, and do good to all as we have opportunity, so that we may save some from the error of their ways.

F. D. RICHARDS.

SPECIAL CONFERENCE OF THE SEVENTIES.

[From the "Deseret News."]

Saturday, January 18, 1851, about half past ten, a large congregation of the Seventies had assembled in the Bowery, when President Joseph Young gave an introductory address, stating that the object of the conference was to examine into the situation of the Seventies; ascertain what vacancies exist in the quorums, and fill the same so far as it shall be wisdom; attend to ordinations,—and to devise ways and means for prosecuting the building of the Seventies Hall of Science. There were present of the first presidents of the Seventies, Joseph Young, Zera Pulzipher, A. P. Rockwood B. L. Clapp; also of the Twelve, W. Woodruff, E. T. Benson, and W. Richards. After prayer by E. T. Benson, and singing, one hundred and four elders, priests, and members were called upon, and ordained into the quorums of Seventies, under the direction of Presidents Rockwood and Clapp. The ordinations were attended to in the State House.

After an intermission of thirty minutes, and partaking of refreshments by the congregation, and arrival of President B. Young, the assembly was addressed by President Zera Pulzipher, W. Woodruff, J. M. Grant, and Joseph Young, on the importance of the Seventies attending to their several duties, of there being a reformation among the Saints, and their living so as to have a

fullness of the Holy Spirit at all times. The record of the names of the presidents of the several quorums of Seventies was read, when about eighty were found to be in the Valley. Offerings were made for the Seventies' Hall of Science, and conference adjourned to early candlelight, when the Bowery was filled.

"The morning breaks," was sung by the choir, followed with prayer by President Clapp, when the conference was severally addressed on a variety of topics by Elders A. P. Rockwood, Milo Andrus, Jesse Haven, Alexander Badlam, Joseph Young, Sylvester H. Earl, Charles Hubbard, D. D. Hunt, Reuben McBride, J. M. Grant, B. L. Clapp, and President B. Young, with great spirit and power.

Sunday, Jan. 19, 1851,—The conference was opened at 10 A.M. with prayer by Elder J. M. Grant, and singing by the choir.

Twenty-four elders came forward to receive ordination into the quorum of Seventies, who being approved, went to the State House and were lectured by Elders Herriman, Pulzipher, and Bullock, upon the responsibilities that devolved upon them, and the requirements of the Holy Priesthood, and ordained into the quorum under the hands of Elders Pulzipher and Herriman.

At the same time the Saints in the Bowery were receiving instruction and wisdom from President B. Young, Heber C. Kimball, and P. P. Pratt, on the prospects of commencing a temple in this valley, for the endowment of all who were faithful in the work of the ministry, at the same time emphatically declaring that the man who did not settle up his tithing dues, will not have the privilege of receiving his blessings therein.

The Saints were full of joy at the glorious prospect that was laid before them; and the work of reformation among many who have heretofore been lukewarm, has already manifestly commenced.

After an intermission of one hour, the assembly was addressed by elders Joseph Young, Lorenzo Young, E. T. Benson, A. Lyman, W. Woodruff, and A. P. Rockwood, on the efficacy of prayer, the Seventies' Hall of Science, &c., when T. O. Angel, chief architect to the public works, presented a perspective view of the intended rotunda; afterwards the subject of those men who had come into

our midst, and become, as the President observed "winter saints" was taken up, and on motion, George Love, Washington Loomis, Phillip George, Henry Schuck, O. H. Speed, Joseph Alvord, widow Jane M'Carthy, widow Cook, Cynthia Bevry, Charles Montrose, and Mrs. Emma Day were cut-off from the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, for conduct unbecoming the character of Saints.

[We understand "winter saints" to mean those who have been baptized just to have the privilege of serving the devil more perfectly, while they winter with the saints, or thieve their way to the mines.—Ed.]

After a discourse on the Seventies' Hall, by elder J. M. Grant, the conference was adjourned till Saturday, the 8th of February, at 10 in the morning, and were dismissed with benediction by President Young.

ACCOUNT OF A JOURNEY FROM GREAT SALT LAKE CITY, FOUR HUNDRED AND FIFTY MILES TO THE SOUTH [FROM CAPT. D. JONES].

[Continued from page 241.]

JAN. 10.—The rest of the company arrived, and they were received kindly to enjoy the excellent feast that was prepared for the occasion; surrounding the table on the grass sat about 50 of the brave sons of Zion, all in unity and love. Here the *Liberty Pole* was raised, about 50 feet in height, as a monument to the first settlement of this country. There was an abundance of trees of several kinds in the fissures of the mountains, limestone, *plaster of paris*, &c. Distance from Great Salt Lake City is 277½ minutes.

—14.—We all began toward home. The second day we left the valley over a ridge of mountains, and the snow began to fall, and continued to fall more or less, until the 20th. During this time we traveled along the road of the Immigrants, for the most part over hills and stony hollows, exhausted, at times without water, just snow, for days; only three or four small and insignificant valleys, except the *Beaver* valley, which is of considerable size and advantageous for agriculture and which perhaps will be a settlement before long. Several days we had to travel by the compass, because the snow was

so deep that it hid the road and all landmarks, and so cloudy that we could see hardly anything. The snow was by now close to a yard deep on the level ground; and none of us had ever been this way before. Some days we traveled but 5 minutes, and had to drive the horses back and forth to tramp down the snow before the oxen and the wagons, the wheels of which were at times buried in the snow. It was now clear that we could not travel like this for long, for the food for the animals was buried, except for the tips of the cedars. Furthermore, we did not have supplies for all of us to stay here until the spring; and since it was for certain that the Indians would kill our oxen, and would take our spoils, if we all left, it was agreed that twenty-one of us would start on horseback toward home, and leave all that we could of our food to the rest to remain here until the snow subsided; and so we started the next day, leaving our wagons, &c., on the Willow river.

Now our hardships in soberness began in earnest! Even though we tried hard from morning to evening, we could not travel over 8 or 10 minutes; the snow was in drifts, at times as much as 8 to 10 inches deep,—with nothing to eat except bread, which was getting scarce, and dry meat, and at night we made our bed in the snow, which by morning had covered us with a foot of it. The snow, after all, was not as bad as the weariness and the cold, besides the fact that we had close to one-hundred-and-fifty miles before any hope of seeing a house, or anyone to help us; and the road now was climbing every day higher toward the white sky over a range of jagged mountains. Yet we were not really aware of our danger until our food supply dwindled to one small biscuit per day, which in spite of that I shared with my faithful animal, who by this time was too weak to carry me, or hardly carry forth on his own. Every day there were some horses that gave out, and were left behind, to perish no doubt in the snow, and their riders discarded their saddles, clothes, and everything they could spare, proceeding on foot.

One day, before reaching the top of the mountains, we left six animals almost within sight of each other; who poor things foresaw their danger, and whinnied after us as long as they could see us, which, intermingled with the howls of the wolves, &c., was heart-rending music.

Among others, one of my own horses failed. Great was our

joy when we reached the Sevier river, but before this, I and several others had become snow blind, others had frostbitten feet, and some had frostbitten hands more or less, who were led on the horses which could carry them.

Finally we arrived within 50 minutes of the Utah settlement, and that night will be long remembered, for we ate the last of our scanty provisions; and also P. P. Pratt and others laid their hands on me, and I saw the first light of day which I had seen for days! Such joy and gratitude that caused! Next day P. P. Pratt, and another brother, started off on the two strongest horses in front of us, and to send help to us; we followed as best we could after them; and though we suffered greatly, yet our cup was sweetened by the strong hope that we would get to the end of our journey without perishing. The fourth day after that, and the morning before reaching Utah, we met two brothers bearing food from Utah to meet us. I need not say how good it was to see it, how long we took to open their bags, or how much we ate before getting up! But I shall say that we all had our fill and more for the first time in a long time; and that night we reached the settlement of Utah, and we had a hearty welcome. I slept in a bed once again! The next day we went from Utah, except those whose feet were frozen so badly that they could not travel, and the second day we arrived back at Great Salt Lake City; and I found my family and the Welsh all healthy. So this strange journey came to an end without any of us losing our lives. The rest of the company arrived here in May. I was sad that we had been unable to fulfill all of the aims of the expedition this time; but I believe they will be fulfilled before long. Time will tell how much good was done by this exploration; no amount of money would tempt me to go through it again, not to mention that it cost me about 300 dollars. By the time I returned, several of my animals had perished here because of the winter cold, which was beyond anything ever felt before or anticipated.

I received, from some of the mountain men and the Indians, several accounts of the existence of a nation of white and civilized people who had settled in the south. Their accounts agreed with respect to the locality, &c., and some assured us that it was Welsh that they spoke; yes, there are too many of such accounts, from a number of different places, persons, and times, totally unknown to

each other,—to leave any doubt in my mind about the existence of the remnants of the *Madocians*. Among others, Pres. B. Young told me that he had been totally satisfied by a man of good character since he has been here, that such a nation had settled on the banks of the Colorado. This man said that he had visited them, and gave the same description of them that was given before by Mr. Ward; and he said that he understood just enough of the Welsh language to know that it was Welsh that they spoke. He added that there were some old books in their midst, which, though they could not read them, they respected greatly and kept carefully, in the hope according to their traditions, that the time was about to dawn when someone from the country of their fathers would come and would teach them to understand them and read them again!

Perhaps the accounts which I heard are incorrect to some extent; I could not expect less, but I repeat, I cannot believe that they are all baseless imaginings, especially when I link them with the accounts which are in the chronicles of Wales of the departure of one such as Madoc ab Gwynedd from Wales, the second time to America with ten ships laden with emigrants,—the traditions which were had among the oldest natives of the states, was that “white men had landed on the shores of their nation, and had gone up the Taunton River in Massachusetts, in ten floating houses, and conquered the natives.” The accounts which I got from the “*American Antiquarian Society*,” which followed them by the ruins of their crafts, their houses, &c., along the shores of the Lakes, and from there to the “*Falls of Ohio*” in which place, says Mr. Josiah Priest, their president, a few years ago several bodies were found buried, and that they were still in such a condition of incorruption, that it was obvious that they were dressed in war-like clothing, that they imitated the Roman dress, and that on one of them there was the emblem of the mermaid playing the harp. Whether it is true that these were the markings of the Welsh before the departure of Madoc I am not sure, but I think I have read that. Besides this, I read in a publication belonging to the Wesleyans in St. Louis, “that a tribe of Indians settled along the *Iroquois* river, in the State of Illinois, which spoke Welsh,” and, that it happened that two Welshmen who were in the service of the “*American Fur Company*,” had traded with this company of Indians in Welsh. All this, besides many other later accounts in my possession, proves the same thing

to me; and the greatest desire of my soul for more than 20 years, has been to bring these Indians out into the light and to give them a knowledge of their forefathers.

Yours in the truth,

D. JONES.

DOCTRINE OF DEVILS.

THE "Star," for August 1, 1851, contains the observations of President F. D. Richards, with respect to the doctrine of devils, and we would like for all to read them, for we do not have enough space in the TRUMPET. The greatest part concerning this subject can be understood by translating the quotation which brother Richards gives, from the work of the prophet Joseph, on the same subject. The quotation is as follows:—

"Say to the brethren, H——, and to all others, that the Lord never authorized them to say that the devil, nor his angels, nor the son of perdition should ever be restored, for their state of destiny was not revealed to man—is not revealed, nor ever shall be revealed, save to those who are made partakers; consequently, those who teach this doctrine have not received it of the Spirit of the Lord. Truly brother Oliver declared it to be the doctrine of devils. We, therefore, command that this doctrine be taught no more in Zion. We sanction the decision of the bishop and his council, in relation to this doctrine being a bar of communion."—*Times and Seasons*, vol. vi, page 801.

TRIPLET TO THE SIGN-SEEKERS.

If we perform signs,
To satisfy men,
We shall have widespread praise,
And many friends.
But yet, we reason,
If we did so, whose servants would we be?
Whether the servant of dear Jesus,
Or son of the chief of hell?
Reason teaches me,
That I would not be Jesus' servant,

Rather the servant of these men
 Whom I would satisfy.
 Well, who are the constant hoards
 Who ask for signs?
 From what life, and what land,
 And who is the father of these men?
 If we search the scriptures,
 We can see this clearly,
 That their desire is that of the devil,—
 And his children are the sign-seekers.
 Their life is pitiful,
 Evil and adulterous;
 Their dwelling place, their land and their town,
 Will be hell, the painful place!
 Well, well! is that true?
 Oh, yes, true indeed;
 But if you believe that it is not true,
 Go to God's word and search.

Y Graig-ddu.

J. RICHARDS.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

PREJUDICE OF THE STAR OF GOMER.—After reading on the wrapper of the “Star of Gomer” that it publishes every kind of Notice, and that without making a distinction to anyone whoever it might be, we decided to send a series of the Welsh Books of the Saints to be published in it. We knew that the primary reason of every publisher of Notices is to publish for money, and we believed that it was no doubt thus for the publishers of the Star. Books of every sect can be seen on the wrapper of the Star without distinction, and that because they are paid. But the Star will not publish the Books of the *Saints*, despite being paid in advance. No, says the Rev. D. Ll. Isaac, in his letter to us, “it is not appropriate for us to do so.” He said that he would be glad to please us, but that it was not appropriate to publish the Books of the Saints in the *Star*. Why not, Mr. Isaac? Are you afraid for the world to see them, and afterwards see your deceit? Is there a reason for the Rev. D. Ll. Isaac, such a great scholar, to be afraid to publish a few of the books for the Saints? Does he have some “goddess” in danger, or is he rather *scorning* us? No, not *scorning*, for he says that he would like to please us, but it would not be *appropriate* to do that! The religion of Mr. Isaac must be in danger were he to publish the books of the Saints, and thus he had best not; and with that we shall leave him in peace now with regard to this matter.

LETTERS TO THE VALLEY.—We announce that the Saints can send letters to their brethren in Utah Territory, for a shilling each, if they are not over half an ounce, by prepayment or otherwise; while the postage to California State is 2s. 9c.

PAYMENTS FROM JULY 23 TO AUG. 7.—Monmouthshire £2; Breconshire, 10s; Carmarthenshire, £11 15s 2c; West Glamorgan, £6 8s 8c; Pembrokeshire, £1; Llanilltyd, 8s 9c; Ynysgau, 2s 1c; Pontypridd, £1 3s 4c; Llanfabon, 18s 1½c; Gog, 10s; Cardiff, 10s 1½c; Georgetown, 15s 3½c; Merthyr, £1 13s; Pendaren, 8s; Cefn, 15s 10c; Eglwysnewydd, 1s 4c. Total, £28 19s 6½c.

“W. T.”—We shall try to get an answer in our next issue. There are so many things from the Valley accumulating on us now, that we cannot spare space for less important things.

DUAL HYMNAL.—The two hymnals, bound together, are now for sale, for 1s. 4c. each. A penny-and-a-half each will be given to the assistant distributors.

BOOK OF MORMON.—Now is the time for the Presidents, and the Distributors, and all the Saints, to strive for the selling of the Book of Mormon throughout our nation; be as one man. We have begun to translate it, and we ask you to pray for us that we might have every necessary gift for such an important task. Let us know, *without fail*, by the 31st of August, how many will be received in each place. Do not neglect this. It is quite likely that a segment will come out each week, although we do not promise that it will be every time.

DOC. AND COV.—Within a fortnight, the Book of Doctrine and Covenants will be completely ready. If all the distributors send word to us as to how many segments they need, or which ones they have left over, perhaps we can buy some and sell others, so that we can make up as many volumes as possible.

 We have about one hundred of the Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs published as a book, price 10c. sewn.

APPOINTMENT.—Abednego Jones has been appointed to preside over the Carmarthenshire Conference, with Thomas C. Martill and Thomas Jenkins as his counselors; and John Fleyd is to be a traveling elder.

 President Thos. Pugh wishes to warn the Saints against receiving one Thomas Davies, who has left Llansawel branch, West Glamorgan conference, before he comes back to give satisfaction to the Neath council.

MARRIED on the 24th of July, in the church of the St. Helier parish, Jersey, by the Rev. Phil. Filleul, Elder Henry Evans, from Wales, to Miss A. Browse, from St. Malo, France, namely the person whom brother Howells baptized.

 We are forced to leave many things out for lack of space, which we will yet publish.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 17.]

AUGUST 23, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

“A WORD OF WISDOM.”

BY THE EDITOR OF THE “DESERET NEWS.”

WHY is it not wisdom to make a common practice of drinking tea, coffee, or HOT DRINKS of any kind?

As no physician, philosopher, or elder, has presented us with a direct answer to the foregoing question, we refer our readers to a quotation from President Brigham Young's sermon, page 186, for proof that “tea and coffee are narcotic poisons,” and this is reason sufficient why it is not wisdom to use them. An additional reason is that those who use tea and coffee, generally drink them HOT. Passing by, for the present, all the deleterious and poisonous effects of tea and coffee on the human system, we propose a few suggestions on this part of the Word of Wisdom, in its simplest literal sense,—“HOT DRINKS are not for the body or belly.”

Pure HOT WATER is the simplest hot drink with which we are acquainted; but even this, when drunk to the extent which most people take of some kind of liquid with their food, will relax, weaken, and enervate all the organs of the stomach, and prevent or hinder the digestive powers in their necessary operations, both in preparing the food to nourish, and absorbing the nourishment from the food after it is thus prepared.

The effect of hot water upon most animal substances is well known; for instance, a piece of raw hide, leather, or meat, when

immersed, or brought in contact with hot water becomes elastic, and may easily be drawn into almost any shape, and yet has no power to retain that shape, until it is cooled again, and perhaps dried.

So with the stomach and all the organs of the human system connected with the stomach, when saturated with hot water; and could we then reach them we could draw them over a saddle-tree, or make a trace chain of them, as we would of a piece of hide or leather, but they would be of no use until dried, any more than would be leather; and the organs of the stomach when relaxed with hot water, can no more perform the duties naturally assigned them in relation to food connected with the body, than a piece of wet raw hide can perform the duties of a trace; and it has been said, that a man with such a trace may attach his team to a load of wood, and drive till his family freeze before the load would start, on account of the stretching of the wet trace; so might a person take food into a stomach relaxed by hot water, and there the food may lie dormant, till putrefaction commences, before the digestive organs will become cooled and strengthened sufficient to move that food into a position prepared for nutriment.

Again, when those JUICES and FLUIDS, which are accustomed to mix with the food in the stomach, in order to assist in preparing it for nutriment, or for the action of the absorbent vessels, become FLOODED or INTERMIXED with a quantity of HOT WATER, they become weak and inefficient, and are incapable of performing the office assigned them; consequently digestion is retarded, and the food must continue to remain in the stomach waiting the operation of putrefaction; when headache, sickness at the stomach, uneasiness, oppression of the whole man, and fever, are the natural consequences, frequently ending in death.

It may reasonably be argued that abundance of cold water taken with the food, will weaken the fluids of the system as well as hot water; very true, but the cold water will not relax the absorbents and weaken the water ducts so, but they will gather up and convey away the surplus water, as the hot water will. A moderate quantity only of any kind of liquid is good to be taken with food (and none at all

is far better), and any quantity more than is necessary to produce a proper consistency of the food in the stomach, is so much too much; but, while cold water will dilute the fluids of the stomach, it will, contrary to the hot, stimulate the organs of the stomach, and cause them to act more efficiently, after the surplus water is conveyed away; therefore it is wisdom to be temperate in drinking cold water, with food particularly; as well as to refrain from drinking hot drinks to any amount while in a healthy state; or as an ancient apostle said, "be temperate in all things."

When the organs are relaxed, and the fluids thinned by hot water, the food will remain for a season inert in the stomach, and when nature has thus been imposed upon, and its laws transgressed, it will seek revenge, and strive to force that food from the stomach before it is prepared to nourish the body, and if it succeeds in its exertion vomiting ensues; if it does not succeed in its revengeful efforts in throwing the food upwards, it will force it downwards; or if any portion should be prepared for nourishing, the absorbing vessels, which are some of the most tender and sensitive of the human system, are so relaxed by the hot water that they are not capacitated to perform their office, and, consequently, not only the food and its nutriment is lost to the eater, but the stomach and all the digestive organs are irritated, and to a greater or less extent, retain their spirit of revenge towards those substances, or that food which has so unceremoniously been forced upon them and through them.

If a sponge is suspended over a body of water, with a corner of the sponge in the water, the sponge will absorb or draw up the water till it is filled, and every part of the sponge will be wet. Drown or immerse the sponge in water, and the water will be forced into every pore in an instant, and all the absorbent properties of the sponge will be destroyed; during the immersion it is drowned, dead; and if immersed in hot water, the sponge in a great degree becomes inert, losing its absorbent powers.

So it is with the absorbent vessels in the animal economy; they may be drowned, even with cold water, but if they are drowned in hot water, the heat renders them flaccid and useless, and while they

remain in that state, the body must not only remain unnourished, but it is exposed to any disease which may be presented for its reception, and hence a fruitful source of sickness.

Many people have so corrupted their appetites with hot drinks, that they possess an immoderate appetite, called thirst, and should they banish their hot drinks, they would not want to drink near as much as they now do, and this would be a great improvement, in the domestic economy, and tend greatly to health.

We have carefully avoided technical terms, wishing to be understood by all who love truth; and although volumes might be written on this subject, these few hints must suffice for the present, to show that our Heavenly Father is mindful of all his works for good, and that when he gives a word of wisdom to his children, it is founded on pure philosophic principles, and no person can transgress those principles without suffering the consequences of that transgression.

With how much faith can a Saint ask the fountain for more wisdom, while that wisdom is neglected which is already voluntarily given? Will parents continue to give gifts unto their little children, while the children are trampling those gifts under their feet, which they have previously received? or, would it be wisdom for parents to do so? if not, with what confidence can parents ask their Father to do for them what they would not do for theirs?

COUNSELS TO THE SAINTS.

DEAR BRETHREN,—I am happy to have the opportunity of informing you of the will of God by this means. During the past eight years since the Church was established in this Principality, we have been under many disadvantages; even though we have gotten very many books out which showed the first principles of the gospel, and which have been very successful, and the Church has enjoyed great happiness, &c., yet there are two specific things which are lacking, namely the Doctrine and Covenants and the Book of Mormon, in Welsh. Those are the first books which should have come out. This nation has been greatly wronged: but we are grateful that things are such, that

the beautiful time has dawned when these good books are to come out shortly; and it will not be much over half a year when they will be in our native tongue. Although English is the main language at the present time, through which God has given revelations, and is going to give again, pertaining to the Church in general; for God has chosen that language to establish his Kingdom on the earth, but he does not disregard the others; and it is the responsibility for all the Saints to learn English. It will be necessary for every nation to come to understand English, but their own languages will not be terminated because of that.

And now, brethren, strive to teach to all their responsibilities. Encourage every member to receive the above books; not only should every member receive them, but the parents should receive them for their children as well. Children will rise up against their parents, if books are not prepared for them, so that they can see the law of the Lord. Oh, fathers and mothers in Israel, remember this, for I think that there will not be time to get a second printing of them; and for that reason you who have begun to receive the Doctrine and Covenants try to complete them, and let others send for complete volumes which will be ready shortly; and try to get subscriptions for the Book of Mormon; we intend to get 2500 subscribers. You know, brethren, that the cost is great to publish a book like this, in addition to the hard work; and then call on the name of the Lord to favor us, and pray for us; truly we have a great responsibility; and with each day that passes we feel more and more the weight of this task; and may you have the same feelings and wish to see the work of God going forward rapidly in this country. Some of the enemies of the truth said that our religion would come to an end with the appearance of the Book of Mormon in Welsh. Oh, blind men, that is when it will be galloping fast, and the mouths of priests, preachers, together with every Jack will be forced shut. They have gotten a good harvest while holding this book in their right hand at the pulpits, shouting, Deceit, Deceit!! &c. Here the time is dawning when our dear nation will have this book in the Welsh language; and thousands will know that in it are the principles which show the fullness of the Gospel of Jesus Christ; and through it the lies of the

ministers will come into view; and it will be hell on earth for them, when the honest in heart come by the thousands to the Church of Jesus Christ. Woe unto you, preachers and priests, the Lord is coming to the field against you shortly; you have raised your hand against Almighty God. Let the honest in heart come from your midst; we invite you in the name of the Lord, knowing that the dreadful day is at the door. I wish to see the Doctrine and Covenants and the Book of Mormon published not only in Welsh, but I desire to see them published in every language, and so they will before too long. And I intend to get around 50 or 100 copies of the Book of Mormon in every language for Wales, not only to help to carry the work forward, but I have yet another objective in mind, namely the gathering to Zion, where we can dwell, and be taught what the rights of man are, and be prepared to be ready by the time the Lord comes: and there will be unity, peace, and love dwelling in the hearts of all the pure in heart. I believe that when the Saints enjoy this condition, that there will be there a lovely society amongst them; from city to city, and from house to house, they will enjoy comfort; and I expect that there will be many of them visiting the cities and homes of the old nation of the Welsh, and if we do not have the Book of Mormon in the various languages, such as English, French, German, Italian, &c., to set before them after lunch, the association will not be so sweet. And I think that we, according to our deeds, will be invited to visit others, such as the English, the French, and the various other nations; and if they do not have Welsh books, such as the Book of Mormon, &c., it is logical that we shall not feel as happy. Therefore, we counsel the English brethren to receive Welsh books, and the Welsh brethren to receive English books, together with every other language, as far as circumstances will permit. I shall close now, and that this letter may be a blessing to you all, is my sincere wish. Amen.

Your brother and your servant in Christ,

WM. PHILLIPS.

14, Castle St., Merthyr Tydfil, August 14, 1851.

P. S.—Thomas Morgans has been released from the Anglesey Conference, and Williams from Aberdare is to preside in his place. William Evans has been released from the Merionethshire Conference, and William Richards from Rhymney is to take the presidency in his place. Also Elder Dewi Elfed Jones is to be a traveling elder to preach the Gospel in every place in the conferences of South Wales, from conference to conference; and he is to be presided over by the presidents. He is not to preside, rather only to preach; and may God bless him, and the Saints to remember him and his family at home.

W. P.

BAPTISM.

THE NECESSITY OF IT.

To the Friends (Quakers), and the Unitarians, and all who do not believe the necessity for Baptism.

KIND FRIENDS,—You are always quiet in your meetings, until you get the stirring of the spirit; but after enjoying the stirring, you are never stirred to baptize anyone, or even mention baptism: I have read about John the Baptist, who was full of the Holy Ghost from his mother's womb, and this Spirit stirred him frequently to baptize, and to persuade men to submit to his baptism: Christ also commanded to teach and baptize all nations, and Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John were stirred to mention baptism: Peter also on the day of Pentecost, said, "Repent, and be baptized every one of you for the remission of sins,"—thus Phillip, Ananias, and also Paul, all under the stirring of the same Spirit, and all mentioned, and baptized more or less; but even though all of you have had the stirring of the Spirit on occasion, not one of you has been stirred to be baptized, or even mentioned baptism! This causes me to think, that either the Spirit has changed its teaching, or that you do not have the same spirit, that they of old had; and I can hardly believe that the Spirit has changed, for the scriptures say that God is unchanging, and thus it is of course with his Holy Spirit. Dear friends, consider this, and furthermore it is written, "Whosoever shall keep the whole law, and

yet offend in one point, he is guilty of all."

You, Unitarians, you sincerely wish for everyone to believe that there is one God, and thus says the scripture, "There is one God," "To us there is but one God." The scripture also says that there is "One baptism," but you (it appears) *stop* without getting baptized, as Saul of old, and it is high time for us to say to you, as was said to him, Rise up, and be baptized every one of you for the remission of sins. Well, someone says, the thief on the cross was saved without being baptized, and why not us? As for the salvation of the thief we must be silent, for the scripture is silent, but if it was on the cross that the thief repented, I do not think he was permitted to descend from his cross to be baptized, if he wished; and if so, it was necessary, before he could be saved, for someone else to be baptized for him, or in his place. But what do you think about the scripture that says to teach and baptize all the nations? you teach everyone (to the extent it is in you) to believe that there is one God; but I have not heard any mention of baptism from you as yet! If there is no need for baptizing as well as teaching, the scripture speaks in vain; the commandment, the testimony, and all the promises, are in the future; and thus, if there is need for the one now, why not for all of them? so, why do you teach that there is one God, and completely cease with baptism? Dear Unitarians, consider that all the book should be eaten, and not just a portion.

To persuade you to believe the necessity for baptism, I ask, do you wish to be saved? Oh, yes, says everyone. Well, God intended to immerse the world once, because of the wickedness and disobedience of its inhabitants; and before fulfilling his intention, he commanded Noah to warn them all, and to build the ark to save the obedient; and since all the earthly sphere was covered with water, every thinking man sees, that no one could be saved without going to the ark; this was God's counsel to them, humble themselves or obey him. Does everyone admit, that no one could be saved in that circumstance, without obeying God? Yes, we all do. Well, it says in the epistle of first Peter iii, 21, that, "The like figure (salvation) whereunto even baptism doth also now save us." That which makes the second similar to the first is, that not one man or woman will be saved

except they obey: no one was saved but those of old who obeyed, and so it is now; you also by not submitting to baptism *disregard* God's counsel, like the Pharisees and the lawyers of old, and that also against yourselves! If you wish to be saved, you must submit to baptism; for it is through baptism that you come to an enjoyment of salvation; thus, you see that submission to the one, brings men to the enjoyment of the other.

Now to prove the need for baptism, I shall call the witnesses before me; first, an angel of God, I know not thy name, but thou mayest speak (see Acts x, 6), "Call for Simon Peter—he shall tell thee what thou *must* do." What was this *must*, do you suppose, was it to be more devout, or more God fearing, or to give more alms to the pool, or to pray more frequently, or to believe in the ministering of angels? No; those are common practices of the believers of this age, and more; all of these things Cornelius fulfilled strictly; what! do all who fulfill all of the foregoing things, fall short of God's approval? Cornelius fell short, and if not, he would not have needed the ministering of the angel, and the angel would not have said what he *must* do; well, what was this requirement? Following his hearing of Peter, he would need to humble himself or give obedience to whatever he said; this was but to baptize him, and all who had heard the word that day in his house. *Wait*, someone says, he was not the doer in the baptism, rather the receiver; true, in the administration; but he was humbling himself or obeying, that which was requested of him, that which he did: humbling oneself, and obeying are *active verbs*.

"Whosoever denies this, take her,
And deny that the sun rises."

The second witness now, is the Son of God (see Acts ix, 6), "Go into the city, and it shall be told thee what thou *must* do." What was this *must* again? not believe or repent, for Saul asked concisely, "Lord, what wilt thou have me to do?" "Go," was the answer, "and it shall be told thee what thou must do." Not to pray, or to fast either, for he had for three days been diligently doing so; well, what was required, then? To humble himself to that which Ananias told him to do, namely, "Arise, *be baptized*, and wash away thy sins, &c." Even though

Saul had received a heavenly vision, had believed, repented, prayed, and fasted, yet he *remained* in his sins; and inasmuch as he was thus in those days, of course all are thus in these days, *remaining* in their *sins*, if they have not been baptized for forgiveness. Now, you see that the testimony of the angel and of the Son agree one with the other; yet, I bring the testimony of the Son and his *oath* to Nicodemus before proving the necessity of baptism. John iii, 7. "Marvel not that I said unto thee, Ye *must* be born again." A man *born* again through baptism! Yes, 5th verse, "Jesus answered and said unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, except a man be *born of water* and of the *spirit*, he *cannot* enter into the kingdom of God."

Is it baptism in natural water that is meant? Yes, it is a waste of language to say, with the spirit and with the spirit, an insult to our Savior, and a foolishness of the greatest kind to believe such a thing. True that the Holy Ghost is used figuratively in *living water*, rivers of living waters, &c., yet, water is not a figure of speech for the Spirit; also it is seen that this manner of figurative language is common in the scriptures. In Rev. xvii, 15, the angel of God says, "the waters thou sawest,—are peoples and multitudes;" thus also Jesus said, born of water, for baptism with, or in water; and if it is possible to enter into the kingdom of God, or into the church of God, or into heaven, without being baptized, Christ has vowed in vain, and wrongly; and if it is possible to enter by some other way, such would be, according to the scripture, but thieves and robbers: therefore, friends, Unitarians, and everyone, inquire of yourselves, whether it is better to enter into heaven as free men through baptism, or through the windows as thieves and robbers! Every man is an agent unto himself, and a judge of his own business. And now, I release myself from you, for I have explained other witnesses to you, who have stated the need for something, which need you have not yet understood, and my testimony is, that every man who wishes to save his soul for life eternal needs to believe in Christ, repent of his sins, be baptized for a remission of his sins, and then receive the gift of the Holy Ghost by the laying on of hands of God's servants now as in days of yore. I have compassion for you, because I myself was in

the same circumstance as some of you for a long time, but when I saw the light, I received it; thus, consider this as your enlightenment, and receive it willingly. Yours faithfully,

Graig Ddu.

JOHN RICHARDS.

INCONSISTENCIES OF THE DOCTRINE AND COVENANTS, THE BOOK OF MORMON, AND THE BIBLE.

TO THE EDITOR OF "ZION'S TRUMPET."

MR. ED.—Since you wish to enlighten others, and since I wish the same thing, I shall strive to show by writing to you, the places that appear to me as though they are contradicting each other in the Book of Mormon and the Doctrine and Covenants, as best I can: no one can do better than his best. According to what I have seen in the Doctrine and Covenants, pages 241 and 242 of the Welsh edition, I understand that the Lord means for all to be saved at some time, except for the sons of perdition: but, if I am able to understand that which I have read in the Book of Mormon (second European edition), page 491, there are some who are very similar to the religionists who exist in this age, since they say that the Lord no longer works through revelations or through prophecy, &c., who become like a son of perdition. Also, on page 486, we have an account that Jesus Christ said that other men who are built on the works of men, will be "cut down and cast into the fire, from which there is no return." These, I would think, are very much like the religionists in our midst, who are called by the names of John Calvin, John Wesley, &c. I understand from that which is seen on page 321, that there is no hope for anyone who does evil all the days of his life to ever have mercy. It does not say or mean, I think, the sin of blasphemy against the Holy Ghost.

Also, if true that which is seen on page 58, and page 177, of the Book of Mormon, I must believe that the serpent who deceived Eve was the devil, which is impossible for me to believe if I believe the account Moses has left for us in the first part of the book of Genesis; for he says there that God said to the serpent who deceived Eve,

“Upon thy belly shalt thou go, and dust shalt thou eat all the days of thy life;” and it is too difficult for me to believe that the devil goes on his belly, and eats the dust of the earth.

Also, I fail to understand clearly that Oliver Cowdery was innocent of the evil mentioned in the Doctrine and Covenants, page 79, namely breaking the covenant of the priesthood; if he did not do so by leaving the Church, and remaining out for about eleven years, I find that very strange. And also I find it strange that ———, one of the twelve, and Dr. ———, no doubt good men, drink tea, if God wishes for his Saints to abstain from it.

Now, since I see that the Book of Mormon and the Doctrine and Covenants contradict each other with respect to the duration of the punishment of men who are outside the Church of Jesus Christ, I wish for you, if you see that I am in darkness in this matter, to shed some light on it, together with the other things I have indicated. If you do so, I shall feel very grateful to you.

WILLIAM THOMAS.

[We have written the answers, but we cannot find the space for them this time, because of their length; they will appear in the next issue without fail.—ED.]

LETTER FROM MANTI CITY, UTAH TERRITORY, TO THE EDITOR OF “ZION’S TRUMPET.”

DEAR BROTHER IN THE GOSPEL,—My excuse for writing to you is, that I am not certain where my parents or my relatives are now living; and if they are living, you can let them know about me; also, I promised many dear friends, Saints and others, that I would write from here about the things they doubted there concerning the conditions and nature of the country, its inhabitants, and the religion that is professed; many there promised to believe my testimony from here, if I testify that Mormonism appears still to be true. Even though their delay in believing until that time was not wise; yet, I consider it my duty to fulfill my promises to them; so that with your messenger, in providing space for this in the columns of the “TRUMPET,” I can yet hope, though from afar, to help them to resolve the doubt that was in their minds.

With respect to the land in general, briefly, for space does not allow us to go into detail; this is a mountainous country, broken more or less into valleys, rich and lovely, with a series of high and rocky, wooded, snowy mountains, cold looking, which in contrast to the fertile valleys, and the summery weather which is around the foot of the mountains, forms without exception a majestic sight.

Its present inhabitants, not counting the remnants of the various Indian tribes that roam around rather inhumanly and unnoticeably along its lands and hills, are the Saints; who, like myself, have immigrated here from various parts of the world; who, with practically no help in the world, but freedom from the elements in their natural state, with hope spurring them on, can here enjoy the freedom to worship their God which they were forbidden to do in practically every other part of the world; they have come together in disarray, and already, not only are they a people independent from the world, and possessing an abundance to sustain life from the fruit of their own labor, but they also have peace and freedom which is of great worth.

Our officers, civic and church, are from among ourselves, and the laws are so the citizens can have justice. Needless to say that these inhabitants are religious, for there is nothing else *fashionable*, much less tolerable here. There are here four cities that are being built and settled, some already containing thousands, and some tens of thousands of inhabitants; and the surrounding countryside, as regards agriculture, looks similar to Wales, except that the fields are more productive, more level, and a little larger—some fields contain thousands of acres! Every vocation is prospering, with schools in every town; the houses of worship are numerous and full of Sabbath worshippers. General unity is enjoyed throughout the settlements, with peace reigning through practically all the places. But I cannot say the half that I feel or see of the rights that are enjoyed, without mentioning the religious privileges of these redeemed inhabitants.

When I observe the temporal advantages of these valleys, my thoughts frequently escape back to compare the conditions of my fellow nation in Wales; and their poor land, their heavy rents and taxes, and all that creates adversity there, and the prosperity, the abundance, and the freedom which they can enjoy here, with reasonable diligence; but when I understand about the plagues, the

cholera, and the sickness, the deaths, the robberies, and the murders that are destroying mankind there, and embittering the sweetest pleasures, I cannot help but grieve that they are not here by the thousands; and I know of nothing that would make my happiness more complete than to enjoy Welsh company here.

With respect to the religion about whose truthfulness I testified so much while there, I testify today more strongly than ever before, that this is the true gospel of Jesus Christ in its power. I constantly receive additional witnesses of this, and also the like that I could not receive there; all this has confirmed its truthfulness beyond doubt in my mind some time ago. And if my friends there could hear my testimony now, it would be stronger than ever before; and my exhortations would be much more earnest for them to receive their baptism from the servants of God. Oh, you, my dear relatives, believe this my testimony; be wise for your own benefit. You, my acquaintances, I beseeched many of you to give obedience to God's plan to save mankind—from this distance may this final inducement strengthen you to finally settle the debate, that it is best for you to obey the ordinances of heaven, than to go to the trouble to strive to live zealously according to the human traditions of the age; which, in contrast, are nothing more than shadows to the substance. Choose the good part, and be saved, is my constant prayer.

Remember me lovingly to my dear parents, my brothers, and my kind sisters, if you see them, and to the faithful Saints, hoping to see them here soon, like doves to their windows.

The Welsh who came here the same time as I did are alive, and all well and prospering, as far as I know. All of my own family and myself, thanks be to the Grantor of all blessings, are enjoying excellent health, with comforting hopes before us. The health of our dear President Capt. Jones is better than it was; but his diligence in every way, keeps him moving forward. He will likely write to you himself, and several others, from whom you may have a more detailed account than I can give to you. Capt. Jones was elected Mayor and chief Justice, for Manti City lately.

I am, your sister in the gospel of Christ,

ELIZABETH LEWIS.

REFLECTION ON ZION.

TUNE—"Men of Harlech."

WHEN my reflections are
 Away in Zion and its pleasures,
 My soul lightens its burdens
 And its weary sorrows.
 Although here in persecutions,
 Amid the opposers of truths,
 Yonder I see all virtues,
 For the happiness of man.
 I see there an abundance
 Of the beautiful fruits of gentleness,
 After all, it is true, under God's blessing,
 That delicate nature is sustained.
 Oh, that the beautiful morning would dawn,
 When I can certainly there
 Be taken to Zion, land of the Saints,
 Remarkably beautiful in its aspect.

Upon gazing on its meadows
 Beautiful and luxuriant, together with its trees.
 This is what kindles in me the desire
 To go there to live:
 There was not in holy Eden of old,
 Despite her beauty, comforting fairness,
 Anything to satisfy my little musings,
 As worthy Zion will do.
 There will be there no fear
 Of eating fruit and sinning;
 Everyone will be free there,
 To have lovely feasting;
 Where there will be no unhappiness,
 Within this, the dwelling place of peace,—
 Beneath God's protection.

Blaen Dowlais.

WILLIAM THOMAS.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

TIME.—Time is the most precious jewel we possess; but yet we take less notice of it than we do of almost anything else. A man would give much for time, when his time is ending; but he spends it in the most wasteful manner, when he is in full enjoyment of it.

THE LOVE OF GOD.—The love of God and of the world are two different things; if it is the love of the world that dwells in us, then the love of God will leave us, but we should refuse the one and receive the other. The best love deserves the best place and the warmest welcome.

“I CAN hardly believe,” said Cicero, “that that man is in his right senses, and is destitute of religion.”

GOD USUALLY punishes disobedience to parents, by allowing the children of the disobedient to behave toward them in the same manner.

If long days will be thy part, do not make that thy expectation. Do not count on long days, but consider that every day may be the last day, and live each day so that you can give an accounting.

PAYMENTS FROM AUGUST 8 TO AUGUST 21.—Cardiganshire, £2 4s 9c; ditto, from W. Jones, 6s; Denbighshire, £1 8s; Monmouthshire, £1; Dinas, 8s; Pontypridd, £1 2s 3c; Llanfabon, 18s 1½c; Cwmbach, £1 5s; Dowlais, £1 0s 11½c; Georgetown, £1 11s 4c; Merthyr, £1 10s; Pendaren, 5s 6c; Cefn, 11s 9c; Ffynnon Tydfil, 11s 5c; Total, £14 3s 1c.

“W. P.”—The Price of BOOK OF MORMON Segments has been announced twice already; but we take pleasure in announcing it again. One penny halfpenny is the price that was stated, but if over two thousand subscribers are obtained, the segments from the 20th on will be sold for a penny each. It will contain about 30 segments, of the same fold and size as the Trumpet, but containing more.

 The “Doctrine and Covenants” is completely finished at the same time as this issue; and as soon as we get it bound, we shall announce its price.

REMEMBER THE BOOK OF MORMON.—Oh, brethren, remember it. Read the letter of President Phillips in this issue in every branch, and emulate his faith; and then we shall have two-and-a-half thousand subscribers. Let every member try for one, or a dozen of the world, as subscribers with his own; with faithfulness and cooperation, it would be possible to sell easily four thousand. Offer it to your friends, neighbors, shopkeepers, &c., and you will be assured of success. The country is desirous of purchasing that which they call the “New Bible,” and therefore give them the opportunity. Also the book is so cheap, that it will be easy for even the poorest to buy it, especially in segments.—Remember to send us, without fail, by the 31st of August how many will be received in each place.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 18.]

SEPTEMBER 6, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

POUCH (*SCRIP*).

ONE correspondent asks us, what is meant by scrip, and now we are ready to answer him. Although we reported our opinion concerning this matter in one of the meetings of the Saints, yet we did not feel ready to publish our opinion in the TRUMPET without having certainty that we were right. For this purpose, we wrote to President F. D. Richards, and we received the following answer, which agrees with the opinion that we gave:—

“With regard to the word scrip (pouch), at first it signified a pouch or bag, which had been in constant use, to an extent more or less, by men and women, ever since before memory, which we can see in our day, since many men, and also young boys, place one on their shoulders, with a strap, and under one arm; or it can be, perhaps, applied also, but not so appropriately, to bags of a larger size. Use of these bags called scrips was to hold some little things which persons wished to keep with them, the same way that pockets are now used, and also to put a little food in them for sustenance if the traveler was to be out, for it should be kept in mind that in the time that our Savior and David were alive, men did not wear the clothes that they now wear. At that time they wore loose garments, together with a girdle about their loins, which were not suited for pockets, in the same way as at present; consequently a pouch or bag was more necessary and

more customary, at that time, than at present, for the purposes I mentioned. Furthermore, the word scrip (pouch) in our days is used to denote paper money, or promissory notes, or notes of exchange, or a certificate of possessions in a bank, or in the trade of some company; or, in short, any piece of paper showing a sum of money is called a scrip in some countries; consequently, going without purse or scrip, in light of the above, signifies going without money, or paper money; but we shall look at this scriptural phrase as a principle, allowing the two former meanings to be true; and what can we surmise from the two? Well, only this; refraining to prepare in advance that which someone needs. Now, the great commandment of the Lord was, to go without thinking of tomorrow, whether by taking necessities with us in the pouch to eat or to wear, or by having a purse (money), or scrip (paper money), to buy them; one like the other of these would prevent the great intention, i.e., to try the people, and to see if they had those qualifications that made them worthy of the association, teaching, and ministrations of the servants of God; for, says the Doctrine and Covenants, "by this you may know my disciples; they will feed you, and clothe you, and give you money." Now, if a man were to make advance preparations of food, clothing, and money, he could not prove his own faith to go and warn the people about God's intentions, which would show his own love for them, nor whether they, the people, were disciples and worthy of his ministrations. It must have been, no doubt, this principle, that our Savior had in mind with his two commands to the apostles of old, and those who are alive now, that they should go without purse or scrip, whatever the literal meaning of the word scrip was, whether a pouch, or a paper of worth, or both.—Be so kind as to forgive me for being so long in sending this answer, since so many reasons combined to prevent me from doing so until now. With great love and blessings, I am your fellow servant,

"F. D. RICHARDS."

Upon reading the foregoing, the reader will see that he who takes with him a pouch to hold clothes, or paper money, or a purse, makes preparations for the morrow. Certainly money and clothes

are needed by those who are sent out without them, and it is the duty of those to whom they minister to supply them. (See Doc. and Cov., section ix, part 7.) Blessed are those who receive one of these little ones, the least of the brethren of Christ, and who give food, drink, clothes, and money to him. After a servant of God gets purse and scrip or bag, from those to whom he is sent, it is reasonable that he can use them, for he is not the one who takes thought for the morrow, rather those who have received him. We can determine that the more strict observance we give to God's commandments, all the more we will be blessed when we go out to preach to the nations of the earth. When God reveals something, let us take care to do everything according to his word, and then we shall be blessed.

"INCONSISTENCIES" OF THE DOCTRINE AND COVENANTS, THE BOOK OF MORMON, AND THE BIBLE.

ANSWER TO THE QUESTIONS OF WILLIAM THOMAS.

We perceive, in reading those questions, that our correspondent is in great need of light, and we shall do our best to answer his questions, confident that they will be of general benefit, especially to those foolish virgins who are without oil in their lamps. And now, in order to answer the first question, we shall quote the various things that appear to be in contradiction to each other, and then we shall offer our observations concerning them. The first quotation is taken from the Doctrine and Covenants, page 241:—"Thus saith the Lord concerning all those who know my power, and have been made partakers thereof, and suffered themselves through the power of the devil to be overcome, and to deny the truth and defy my power—they are they who are the sons of perdition, of whom I say that it had been better for them never to have been born, for they are vessels of wrath, doomed to suffer the wrath of God, with the devil and his angels in eternity; concerning whom I have said there is no forgiveness in this world nor in the world to come, having denied the Holy Spirit after having received it, and having denied the Only Begotten Son of the Father—having crucified him unto themselves, and put him to an open shame." The next quotation

is taken from the Book of Mormon, page 491:—"Wo unto him that spurneth at the doings of the Lord; yea, who unto him that shall *deny* the Christ and his works; yea, wo unto him that shall *deny* the revelations of the Lord, and that shall say, The Lord no longer worketh by revelation, or by prophecy, or by gifts, or by tongues, or by healings, or by the power of the Holy Ghost; yea, and wo unto him that shall say at that day, to get gain, that there can be no miracle wrought by Jesus Christ; for he that doeth this shall become like unto the son of perdition, for whom there was no mercy, according to the word of Christ." Furthermore, on page 486, it says, "If it so be that the church is built upon my gospel, then will the Father show forth his own works in it; but if it be not built upon my gospel, and is built upon the works of men, or upon the works of the devil, verily I say unto you, they have joy in their works for a season, and by and by the end cometh, and they are hewn down, and cast into the fire, from whence there is no return." There should be one more quotation, but we think that our correspondent has erred in noting page 321, instead of some other place; for there are no such phrases as the ones he notes.—Now, there is nothing easier than finding agreement between the Doctrine and Covenants and the Book of Mormon, concerning the topic under scrutiny. In the two first quotations, mention is made of DENYING Jesus Christ, together with the Holy Ghost, for which there is no forgiveness in this world nor in the world to come. One cannot *deny* except that which he *knows*; consequently, the sectarians of this age cannot be likened to those who denied Christ and his works, together with his revelations and his gifts, for they only disbelieve, which does not make their sin unforgivable in the world to come. There are in this age some persons of the character noted by the Book of Mormon, but they are not sectarians, rather they are those who have denied that which they came to know through the Spirit of God. That is sufficient, we think, about that; if it is not, we can elaborate on it some other time. Next is the observation that Wesley, Calvin, &c., are the religionists who built their churches "on the works of men," who, if they do not repent, "will be hewn down, and cast into the fire, from whence there is no RETURN." This "return" is to be understood in the same way as the "return" in the words "I shall go

the way whence I shall not *return*." Job, poor man, is to return from his grave, despite this; and in the same sense one can return from the fire mentioned. If it had said there is no return ever, eternally, or forever and ever, then it could mean endless fire; but since the word is by itself, it does not mean there is no return *sometime*. The fate of the evil-doer is somewhat hidden, for wise purposes; and those who have the greatest clarity about them are they themselves.

Next, our correspondent mentions that the Book of Mormon says that the devil was the serpent that deceived Eve, and that Moses portrayed him as a natural serpent, which had to go after that on his belly, and eat the dust of the earth. It is too difficult for our correspondent to believe that the devil goes on his belly, and eats the dust of the earth; that is also difficult for us to believe. The wisest way, we think, is to believe the Book of Mormon and the Bible, without setting them to contradict each other. The Bible says in one place, namely in Revelation xii, 9, "And that great dragon was cast out, that old *serpent*, called the Devil and Satan, which deceiveth the *whole world*;" while the Book of Mormon says that he deceived Eve. It appears clearly that the Bible is describing the instrument the devil took to deceive Eve, and the Book of Mormon is describing the deceiver, who was called after that the "old serpent." If the serpent, the most subtil of all the beasts, listened to the voice of the devil, it deserved a punishment, and that is what he received, by having to go on his belly, and eat the dust of the earth. The devil was before that a son of perdition, and his punishment had been appointed him; for previously he had deceived many to follow after him. It must have been the devil, through the mouth of the serpent, that spoke to Eve; for what creature, without the devil being associated with him, would say, "For God doth know, that in the day ye eat thereof, then your eyes shall be opened, and ye shall be as gods, knowing good and evil?" There are plenty of examples in the Bible of the devil speaking through men, while the scripture portrays the men that were speaking themselves; see Luke viii, 28, and other places. We think that is enough about the old serpent.

With respect to Oliver Cowdery, there is nothing in his life that proves him guilty of the evil that is mentioned in the Doctrine and Covenants, page 79, where it says, "But whoso breaketh this covenant

after he hath received it, and *altogether* turneth therefrom, shall not have forgiveness of sins in this world nor in the world to come." Perhaps he may have broken it to a degree, but not altogether; the head of the church knows best about that, and not we, nor men outside the church. If he had broken it, he would not have been received back into the church, and he would not have been able to repent as he did.

With a look at drinking tea, the apostle has as much freedom as anyone: perhaps he wants to be similar to Paul, to eat what is set in front of him, to avoid giving offense sometimes: but we believe that he does not make a practice of that, especially after calling the attention of the twelve and everyone else to the Word of Wisdom, which was published in the Trumpet.

We hope now that our correspondent is now enlightened, and that the stumbling block has been removed.

REVIEW.

PRINCIPLES OF THE LATTER-DAY SAINTS *weighed in the Scales of Logic and the Scriptures*. By WILLIAMS JONES, Bethesda.

ONE of the brethren in the North has been kind enough to send the above booklet for us to review, which we shall do with pleasure. It contains 24 pages, and we must confess that it is somewhat more genteel than many that preceded it in discussing the Saints. It says on the title page, "Thou art weighed in the balances, and art found wanting." Indeed, perhaps it was thus; but we must examine the weights, in order to determine whether they are accurate. We feel quite satisfied with the balances, for we have weighed Mormonism in them many times before, and have found them to be accurate.

Our author begins his treatise by likening the Latter-day Saints to Papism, Muhammadism, and Puseyism. "Their doctrines," says he, "are an interwoven mixture of presumptuous and destructive heresies, if one but examines them in the simplicity of the gospel." Does he know what the simplicity of the gospel is? We hope that he does not mean the simplicity of the gospels of the sectarians, those who contradict themselves so much, so that nothing similar to

simplicity pertains to them. A little further on he says, concerning the Saints, that “the primary tenets of their belief are that they can heal the body by their anointing it with oil, and if one of their ministers immerses it in water, its soul will receive salvation.” Surprising how contrary this is to the teaching of James (chap. V., 14, 15), where he commands to anoint with oil, as well as to the teaching of Jesus Christ, who says, “He that believeth and is baptized shall be *saved*!” That must be the “divers and strange doctrines” that Paul mentions, those that will be in the last times, because they are so opposite from the scriptures! Our author should not shout “Tekel,” until others can inspect the weights: his end of the scales is the light end here at least; in any event we shall let the scales determine the matter.

“I do not think,” he says, again on the same page (namely, the 4th), “that the deceit is so hidden that all who understand the Bible cannot perceive it readily.” Who understands the Bible? We fear that the men who purchase commentaries do not. Those who pretend to understand the Bible the most, are those who know the least about the Saints; for they are the ones who seek the most diligently for miracles to prove our divinity, as we shall show before finishing. We believe that the “deceit” of the Saints is so hidden, that there are thousands who have joined with them who have failed completely to perceive it. How is it that so many preachers accepted among the sectarians have been enticed to join the Saints, we wonder?

Next, our author tells of two groups who are susceptible to being seduced by the Mormons, namely, silly, ignorant women, and the promising young people of Wales. They are to be pitied, if they believe the “primary tenets” of the Saints, namely, anointing the sick, and baptizing for salvation! “Thus, we counsel my fellow young people,” he says on page 5, “to listen to the gospel in its simplicity, as it is preached in our time, and as it was preached in the time of our fathers for salvation, instead of going to listen to baseless tales, and silly and superstitious imaginings.” Yes, listen to the gospel as it is preached in our time, and in the time of our fathers, and not as it was preached in the time of Christ and the apostles! Listen to it in its simplicity, as it was reformed by men who were excommunicated from the Papist church—as it is by the daughters of the mother!

Next, our author gives, on pages 5 and 6, some of the opinions of the Mormons, which are as follows:—

"1. They believe that the true church, or the Christian church, and the gospel of the Son of God, together with the influence of the Holy Ghost, were taken from the earth following the apostolic age—and that it is full of oppressive abodes, with no one to uphold the remembrance of the Lord for 1600 years.

"2. They believe that God sent an angel of light to reveal the gospel to one Joseph Smith, and that he was authorized to reestablish the Christian church on the earth, by preaching the gospel himself, together with authority to ordain others to the word.

"3. They claim to have the same commission that the Apostles received from Jesus Christ,—that they are to establish the church in the same way, and on the same conditions, and that they possess the same authority as the Apostles.

"4. They claim to have the same qualifications to make a Bible as did the holy Apostles and Prophets, and that they do not know how soon they shall have a commandment to do so.

"5. They believe there is to be a probationary condition after death, and that all who were in the world from the apostolic age to the time that the gospel was revealed to Joseph Smith, are subject to it,—and salvation will be offered to them, by preaching the gospel in Paradise, (or as the Pope calls the place, purgatory).

"6. They believe that the day of judgment will last for a thousand years.

"7. They believe there are *two heavens*, not counting the celestial heaven, or the starry heaven.

"8. They believe that after they go to California, Jesus Christ will come to meet them, and that they will reign with him for 1,000 years, when everyone else will be destroyed, &c.

"I shall not mention here the deceit of the Book of Mormon; its destiny for my part is the same as that of the Koran of Muhammad. May humanity blush because of it, and refuse to have anything to do with it; may it be buried in the land of its birth, and may its remembrance go to the whirlpool of perdition."

Now, before we examine the foregoing items, we inform our readers that we will have to jump from place to place in our author's book, in order to get hold of the different reasons that have a connection with some of the items under scrutiny, because his treatise is so untidy. We shall examine them in the following order:—

(1.) It is true that we believe the church was taken from the earth following the apostolic age; but we do not see this as "unworthy of

a powerful God of mercy, who wishes for every man to be saved." Since it was men who refused the gospel, God cannot be considered merciless in any way at all. Our God is merciful, and sends missionaries to preach to the spirits in prison, and to those who did not hear the gospel in the flesh; while the God of the sectarians leaves thousands of our fellow creatures to go to perdition without ever hearing a preacher; "for how shall they believe without a preacher? and how shall they preach, except they be sent?" With respect to the church's being taken from the earth, we can show that it is quite logical and scriptural, and very important. Since the sectarians of the land say that Papism is not the church of God, the church must not have existed on the earth when none of the present-day sects were in existence, except for Papism. It is from the Papist church that all the sects of our land derived, as can be proved with historical evidence. What became of all those who died when Papism filled the land, when not one of the different sects of this age had been heard of? God was quite unmerciful, if he did not give them an opportunity in the other world. The creed of the Saints concerning this matter is not only logical, but scriptural as well. "Let no man deceive you by any means," says Paul; "for that day shall not come, except there come a *falling away* first" (2 Thes. ii, 3). See also in Rev. xii, 14—17. What falling away is this, except it be a falling away from the faith? One can have further clarification of this in our treatise on "The Body of Christ, or the Church," so there is no need to elaborate on this topic here.

(2.) It is true that we believe that an angel of light appeared to Joseph Smith, and presented him with the eternal gospel, and with authority to preach it to every creature. There is nothing illogical in that, nor anything unscriptural. The work of angels in every age of the world is to minister; and since the gospel was not on the earth, there was no one more appropriate than an angel to reveal it; for John says, in Rev. xiv, 6, "And I saw another angel fly in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach unto them that dwell on the earth, and to every nation, and kindred, and tongue, and people." Another angel is to follow after that one, saying, "Babylon is fallen, is fallen, that great city." If there is an angel to proclaim the fall of Babylon, there is also an angel to restore the gospel. Next, it is amusing to read what our author says concerning this topic, namely, that "the book of God, and the Book of Mormon are contradictory; the book of God says that the kingdom of heaven belongs to little

children, and the Book of Mormon claims that the kingdom of heaven was not extended to them. The conclusion is, that all the little children who died from the time of the Apostles until the time of Joseph Smith, are lost," (page 7). Has this man ever seen the Book of Mormon? We know that it has never been read by him; for the Book of Mormon mentions more about the salvation of little children than does the Bible. Let him try to see the Book of Mormon somewhere, and let him read on pages 557 and 558 of the second English edition, where he may see that "little children are alive in Christ, even from the foundation of the world," and that they are "partakers of salvation." We could indicate many stronger phrases, but we consider that sufficient to shame our author, and to show his incorrect weights again.

(3.) The Saints do not claim to have the same commission that the apostles received from Christ, rather a new and similar commission; but they do claim that they are establishing the church in the same form, and on the same conditions, and that they have the same authority as the apostles. Were we to claim that our church is not in the same form, &c., as the primitive church, then we would be seeking to prove our church false, while claiming it to be just the opposite. Here again we are consistent with logic and scripture.

(4.) He says that the Saints claim to have the same qualifications as did the holy apostles and prophets to make a Bible. Quite true; if God and his Spirit have not changed, he can inspire apostles and prophets to write additional scriptures, for there is a great need for them, especially by the sectarians, for they do not understand half of the scripture already given.

(5.) It is true that we believe that the spirits in prison have an opportunity to hear the gospel preached, so they can be judged according to men in the flesh; and that has been proved in our treatise about "Preaching to the Spirits in Prison, and Baptism for the Dead." It is remarkable that our author would not read the books of the Saints, instead of appearing so obtuse. To say that is the same as saying that we believe in the crucifixion of Jesus Christ. Let him read in 1 Peter iii, 18—20; and iv, 6, and he shall have proof that the above doctrine is scriptural, and that no one can shout "Tekel" at it. Were not the dead preached to by Christ, so they could be judged according to men in the flesh? What difference does it make that Luther, Calvin, Wesley, Elias from Anglesey, Williams from Wern, Christmas Evans, &c., are good men? They are not too good to hear

the preaching of the fullness of the gospel in the spirit world, and to be lifted up to an even brighter glory. Those men did their best while they were on the earth, and certainly they will be rewarded for their labor, and they will have an opportunity to have the fullness of the eternal gospel. Also, there is hope for all the wicked who have not heard the gospel, to hear it in their prison in the other world, after they have paid the last farthing; for they were no worse in the flesh than were the antediluvians. Christ preached to those spirits, while others on the earth were baptized for them. The only ones that will remain in the fire forever are those who have committed the unpardonable sin; many will be cast into the *eternal* flame, without being there eternally, if they have not committed the unpardonable sin. If someone does not believe in the other world, he will be justly condemned. No writer should take occasion to publish books to oppose any sect from the sayings of "silly, ignorant women," while there is an abundance of books published by that sect. Those who do this show dishonesty. Now, the biggest part of William Jones's book has been answered previously, as he could see were he to read our books.

(6.) "They believe," he says further, "that judgment day will last for a thousand years." From which old woman did he hear that, pray tell? We have heard reverends of our country say that every sinner who dies goes directly to judgment, and that his fate is determined for all eternity. If that is so, the sectarians believe that the judgment will last for more than two thousand years.

(7.) "They believe there are two heavens," says Mr. Jones further, from the mouth of some old women, we suppose, "not counting the celestial heaven, or the starry heaven." What the Saints believe is, that "there are many mansions" in our Father's house.

(*To be continued.*)

MEN WHO HAVE LOST THEIR WAY.

I GREATLY pity men *who have lost their way*, for I have been such myself, and have seen others in this unfortunate situation. A man who has lost his way, is open to losing himself, and falls into danger of losing his life also. Since seeing how a man who has lost his way in a literal sense, is the object of pity and sympathy, how much more to see a man who has *lost his way* in a spiritual sense. We know many young

men who were raised in high situations, and were brought up under the instruction of the foremost teachers, for the purpose of training them to be able at some future time to teach others in the ways of God; and after *all* their learning, they are in doubt as to whether they have learned the *proper way*, like those the Apostle indicated, "who are ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth," since they did not become disciples of Christ, so that they could "know of the doctrine, whether it be of God," or of men; suited to be counted with the men who have *lost their way*.

Others began their spiritual career in order to have safety for their souls, by affiliating themselves with some religious denomination, not because they saw the principles of such more logical and scriptural than those of other denominations, but because their old and dear fathers and mothers had lived and died with them, and they do not desire a better religion, even if one is offered them; but when they are asked if they have found the right way, they say they fear they have not. With reason, then, I say that they have *lost their way*, because they have not received "perfect love, which casteth out *fear*."

Others in pride go to religion, casting their lot with those who respect the "gold ring," and the "splendid clothes," so they may have the highest and most honorable seats in the synagogues. But when death comes, they shudder fearfully, like the guilty when going before the judge. They cannot say as do the children of the light, "We know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens," because in the beginning of their career *they lost their way*.

Also, there are many who seek a religion in the same sense as the gentle father and mother who were convinced as follows:—John was the name of their oldest son, who, one day received permission to go for a walk in the churchyard; and since he was a thoughtful boy, he took great notice of the graves, and after returning to his parents, he said to them in a grieved voice, that "little children die." "What caused you to think of that?" said his father in astonishment. "Oh, there are graves of ones younger than I in that churchyard," said the child; and then he turned to his mother, and said, "Dear mother,

there are mothers who die also." "Are there, my dear child," said the mother with a sigh. "Yes, yes, said little John, "for I saw their graves, and there are men there also who are older than you, father," said the child. "Why do you say that?" said his father to him. Oh, I want you to remember that *you also can die*, dear father," was the answer. This had such an effect on their feelings, that they decided at once to turn to religion, regardless of where, but to go to the *society* somewhere; they were led by their neighbor (who did not know if he was on the right path or not), to some religious denomination, so they could have some comfort before dying. And since they were not convinced by the "foolishness of preaching," and they did not search for the path that leads man to obtain true comfort, they did not receive the fulfillment of God's promise through Amos, namely, "And he will turn the shadow of death into the morning;" because at the beginning they *lost their way*.

When there are diseases in the land, and death is cutting down its thousands, as in the time of the Cholera, O! how men seek religion. They do not take the time to search for the religion of the New Testament; they believe it does not matter which denomination, or which place, just to have a denomination of religion somewhere. But when the storms overcome them, and the winds begin to shake their place of refuge, it will fall apart; at this time they will see that they *have lost their way*, by not searching for the "house that is built on the rock," namely on REVELATION.

Others follow the explanations of men, refusing to accept the word as it is in Jesus; they believe that it is enough to rely on the teachings of the wise, without considering that God is going to "destroy the wisdom of their wise," and that the "understanding of their wise ones shall be hidden;" and that he has "chosen weak things" to do his work, yea, his wondrous work, and that "the excellency of the power may be of God, and not of men." Since men choose the first, disregarding the last, *they lose the way* of the light, walking in the way of the darkness, which will lead to destruction and perdition.

Our world has become confused with the different doctrines of men. Men have made their own rules and regulations, for the

purpose of bringing the human race to a reconciliation with God; they have established societies, calling them after their own names, without considering that “as many as walk according to *this rule*” (namely the rule of Jesus Christ), will be acceptable before God, and “there is none other name given among men, whereby man must be saved.” What thinking man does not see clearly that these people *have lost their way*.

The reason there is so much preaching against each other, by those who profess to be servants of Christ is, because they have “taken the honor unto themselves,” without their being “*called of God*, as was Aaron.” They do not receive the blessings of God, because they *have lost their way*.

The churches, or the religious societies, *have lost their way* so far “that they heap to themselves teachers,” and they mock us, by “walking after their own sensual lusts;” they refuse “this rule,” by “separating themselves, sensual, having not the *Spirit*,” who spoke to the churches in the days of old, and was given *clearly* to all: he “brought things gone by to remembrance, and showed things to come;” they have denied him, by saying, “It is not needed.” They are such who are in darkness, although they have a name of religion, or “a form of godliness,” but “they deny its *POWER*.” They cannot say, “Our gospel came not unto us in word *only*, but in *POWER*, and in the Holy Ghost, and in assurance;” because the Lord is not in their midst “confirming the word,” or “bearing them witness, both with signs and wonders, and with divers miracles, and gifts of the Holy Ghost.” They are destitute of the heavenly pleasures noted, because, indeed, they *have lost their way*.

Reader, do you know that you are on the right path? Do some of the same denomination as you know? Can you say, “I know that my Redeemer lives,” and “though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil?” The former-day Saints received knowledge, like the Latter-day Saints, by walking along the *same path*. Remember “that the soul without *knowledge*, it is not good.” And let everyone remember also, that an important matter in every sense, is *LOSING THE WAY!*

Georgetown.

THOMAS HARRIES.

THE SAINTS AND ZION.

TUNE—"Isle of Mary."

THE Saints are traveling onwards always,
 Through a difficult world of obstacles,
 According to their Father's pure command,
 Till they arrive in the land of their privileges,
 That have been promised them,
 A myriad more than to any other men;
 How great is the mercy of God—
 They'll live on Zion's mount.

'Tis true that here there are many obstacles,
 Every hour through temptations,
 By man and the devil, day and night,
 Which are against the authorities;
 But when on mount Zion far off,
 The lovely time is nigh,
 They'll have a land of good fruits,
 Without the plague of a worrisome enemy.

They'll live beneath the protection of pure justice,
 Like a wall to keep them safe;
 There will be not a single oppressive enemy,
 Kind Jesus will reign;
 And the land will bear her lovely fruits,
 By the grace of God continually,
 To give to all the godly throng
 Their needs away in Zion.

How beautiful will be the myriad on Zion's hill,
 And blessed they will be there
 Awaiting (while fulfilling their office)
 The Lord when He comes,
 In his pure glory from heaven,
 When on his head a crown will be;
 To govern forever in peace,
 An eternal feast in Zion.

They'll have a toothsome feast,
 Full of fattened animals;
 Justice like the waves of the sea,
 And the peace of the Lord like a river;
 And Jesus sitting at the table,
 When he shall meet the redeemed,
 Harps playing praise to the Lord God,
 And sweet songs of Zion.

All the godly seed will meet,
 And the family will be complete,
 Giving praise and joy to God,
 And the living King, Jesus;
 The brave patriarchs that were,
 Prophets, apostles,
 And Saints of the latter day will come,
 Without fear, to meet in Zion.

T. JEREMIAH.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

PAYMENTS FROM AUGUST 22 TO SEPTEMBER 4.—Monmouthshire, £2; Carmarthenshire, £6; West Glamorgan (send information); Merionethshire, £4; Denbighshire, £1; Pembrokeshire, £1; Dinas, 4s. and 8s; Llanilltyd, 1s. 3c.; Pontytypridd, 12s. 7c.; Llanfabon, 18s 1½c.; Cardiff, £1 7s.; Hirwaun, £3 14s. 6c.; Merthyr, £1 10s.; Pendaren, 13s.; Cefn, 11s. 3½c.; Ynysgau, 2s. 1c.; Total, £23 11s. 10c.

CONFERENCES.—The East Glamorgan District Quarterly Conference will be held in Merthyr, on the 5th of October; Monmouthshire, in Tredegar, on the 12th; West Glamorgan, on the 19th; Carmarthenshire, in Carmarthen, on the 26th; and Cardiganshire, on the 2nd of November. Also, the Breconshire conference will be held, in Brecon, on the 28th of September.

BOOK OF MORMON AGAIN.—We are sorry that we have received but 1,223 subscribers here. We must delay until many more are received. The little branch of Pontytypridd has sent for 138, which is a truly a good effort; and if every branch and district were to follow the example of the above branch, we would have over 5,000 subscribers. Brethren, keep striving; your Father is all-wealthy, and he will give money to you.

ERROR.—In our last issue, page 275, we omitted a line at the end of the song of W. Thomas. It should read, "All happy and in beauty," before the last line.

 Newly published, price 3s., bound in sheepskin, THE COMPILMENT; or a Collection of Treatises, Songs, and Letters, pertaining to the Latter-day Saints. It has a title page and a table of contents, and a total of 278 pages.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 19.]

SEPTEMBER 20, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.]

REVIEW.

PRINCIPLES OF THE LATTER-DAY SAINTS *weighed in the Scales of Logic and the Scriptures.* By WILLIAMS JONES, Bethesda.

[Continued from page 287.]

(8.) "They believe that, after they go to California," he says further, "Jesus Christ will come to meet them, and that they will reign with him for a thousand years, when everyone else will be destroyed." Perhaps William Jones has read this, for the biggest part is true. Zion is commanded to get up on a high mountain, and to build a city and a house for God; and when Jesus Christ comes on the clouds of heaven, those who are alive and dead in Christ will be caught up to meet the Lord in the air; and we shall reign with him for a thousand years. (See Isaiah xl, 9; 1 Thes. iv, 17; Rev. xx, 4, 6.) With respect to the destruction of others, we believe that "the Lord Jesus shall be revealed from heaven with his mighty angels, in flaming fire, taking vengeance on them that *know not* God [namely, those who do not believe in the revelations of that time], and that obey not the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ," not as it is preached by the sects of the age, and our fathers, rather as it was preached by Jesus himself and by his apostles, or as it is preached by the Latter-day Saints. (See 2 Thes. i, 7, 8.) All who do not know God, and who fail to say by the Holy Ghost that Christ is the Lord, a witness which is received by revelation, will be destroyed. Saints is the name of those to whom he will come in

glory, and not any who call themselves by the names of men.

"I shall not mention the deceit of the Book of Mormon," he says further on; no, he will not, we hope, before he reads it. Our author knows as much as the Koran of Muhammad, as he knows about the Book of Mormon, and as much about the two as he knows about "the whirlpool of perdition."

Now, we shall go further along in our author's book, and quote what he says on page 10:—"Theologians view the general government of our world in three parts, namely, from the fall of Adam until John the Baptist, the Father governed; from John the Baptist until the day of Pentecost, the Son governed, and from the day of Pentecost until the end of the world, the Holy Ghost shall govern. * * * In the Mosaic dispensation, God spoke on the earth through his angels; in the dispensation of John the Baptist, God spoke on the earth in the flesh; but in the present dispensation God speaks on the earth through his Spirit; and the ministry; and the ministry of the Spirit is called the last days," (referring to Acts ii, 17, 18). We prefer to believe that the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost govern from the beginning to the end, than to believe what the theologians say. God spoke through his *Spirit* before John the Baptist, and also spoke through his *angels* after him, which shows the foolishness of the theologians.

In the foregoing quote, our author says that the ministry of the Spirit is called the last days; and then he recites the following verses:—"But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel. 'And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out my Spirit upon all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams: and on my servants and on my handmaidens I will pour out in those days of my Spirit; and they shall prophesy.'" Here he asks, "Was it on the day of Pentecost, 1800 years ago, or in the time of Joseph Smith, 23 years ago, that the dispensation of the last days began?" It is very easy to know which days are the last days; they are the *last* days, and not the others. These days are closer to being the last days than is the day of Pentecost. When God spoke of the last days, he knew which ones they were; and he said that in the last days he would pour out his Spirit upon *all flesh*, which did not take place on the day of Pentecost, or any other day since then.

Who on that day prophesied, or saw visions, or dreamed dreams? Yes, let us read the two following verses, which are as follows:—"And I will shew wonders in heaven above, and signs in the earth beneath; blood, and fire, and vapor of smoke. The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before that great and notable day of the Lord come." Did all these things happen on the day of Pentecost, or on the following days? No, never. What happened on those days was a pouring out of the "firstfruits of the Spirit," about which Joel prophesied, which will be poured upon all flesh. When the words of Joel are fulfilled, the wolf and the lamb will be seen dwelling together, for the Spirit of God will have been poured upon *all* flesh. What Peter said on the day of Pentecost was, that "This is *that* which was spoken by the prophet Joel," namely, the Spirit that was to be poured upon all flesh in the last days, and which was given as a firstfruit to them at that time. Therefore, it is not blasphemy and presumption to say that in the days of Joseph Smith, or the last days, the prophecy of Joel will be fulfilled. When God speaks of the last days, we can be sure that he knows that they are the last ones, and not some days previous to them. It is clear that our author has weighed this again with the incorrect weights.

Furthermore, on page 11, "The Mormons say," says he, "that Joseph Smith was the first of the Latter-day Saints, and there is no one else by that name except for his followers. I myself believe St. Peter, that the 3000 who received his word willingly on the day of Pentecost, were Latter-day Saints." If so, we must believe that the believers on the day of Pentecost were Latter-day Saints, and that the Saints of the former days were followers of Joseph Smith. It was quite easy for Paul to prophesy concerning the men who would leave the faith in the last days, when those days were in his own time!

On the same page, our author shows "the great foolishness of saying that the gospel and the church were taken from the earth!" "What a terrible thought," he says, "after gracious God gave his Son to die for sinners;—for him to leave the world, for which his Son had suffered pain and agony on the cross, in darkness, despair, and misery, without hope and without God in the world, for 1600 years." That is practically how it was, according to the sectarian creed of the country. Do they not know that it was Papism that overspread

the Christian world during the majority of the above time? God permitted the mother whore of the earth to fill the world with religion for centuries; and presently he gives the same permission to her daughters, or those which derived from her. But if the religion of Christ was not on the earth during the above time, who was at fault? we are certain that God was not at fault, rather it was men. And if we allow that true religion was in the world at that time, God did not care for more than just a small handful of his creatures, although “the gift had been purchased,” and “a fountain had been opened.” God is merciful and just, and has organized a plan to preach the gospel to every creature, whether in this world or in the other world, whether in this age or some other age. Cease to weigh so unfairly, Mr. Jones.

It is true that the Christian dispensation is to stand its ground, and that Jesus Christ said, “Upon this rock I will build my church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.” That rock is revelation, and not that which will be affected by flesh and blood, or human wisdom. No one is a worthy rock to be placed as the foundation of the Church, if he does not know by the Spirit that Christ is the Lord. That the Church or the woman flew from the dragon to the wilderness was no proof that it was defeated; for the church was “nourished there for a time, and times, and half a time, from the face of the serpent.” (See Rev. xii, 14.) It was necessary that there come a “*falling away* first,” before the Church could meet Jesus Christ (2 Thes. ii, 1—3); and it was not defeated by the serpent or the gates of hell, since it received “two wings of a great eagle, that she might fly into the wilderness, into her place.” If the bodies of the apostles and others were destroyed, the church was in no way destroyed: if it was not seen on the earth for a season, yet it was alive somewhere, and it is logical to suppose that its gospel was being preached also, though not among those who had refused it. Weigh more correctly, dear friend.

Next, on page 12, our author says that the Mormons claim “that some of them are apostles, some are prophets, some are teachers, and some have the gift of healings, others the gift of speaking with strange tongues, others the gift to interpret, and others the gift to work miracles.” Then he strives to prove by the light of reason and scriptural revelation, that those who call themselves apostles of the

latter days do not fill the characteristic of apostle, because there is no one who can say that he has received his sight from them. We wish for our author to read the different publications of the Saints, so he can have the opportunity of knowing what it is that is done by the Saints. We dare not offer proof of the divinity of our religion by referring to our miracles, for that is the way used by the false prophets, when they draw fire from heaven to prove their divinity. If our author says that the Mormons have many excuses not to work miracles, he should note that even Jesus Christ had some also; for he did not work many miracles in one place, because of their unbelief (Matt. xiii, 58); we could note *many* excuses if there were need to do so. "One reason they have is," says he, "that they cannot satisfy men; 2nd, they cannot without the faith of those who ask; 3rd, they cannot unless the one on whom the miracle is worked believes." Now we ask, did Christ satisfy men when on the cross or did he cast out the deaf and dumb devil from the young boy without faith or belief on the part of his father (Mark ix, 23, 24)? Read also as an answer, Matt. viii, 5—13; ix, 2; xv, 28; xvii, 14—21; besides scores of other places we could note. "Christ had not," he says further, "mentioned the thinking of the governors of the feast before turning the water into wine; rather he did it without the governor's knowledge." Christ's mother and the servants were faithful, and the miracle was worked because of their faith. "Whatsoever he saith unto you, do it," said his mother, which shows that she had considerable faith with respect to getting more wine. "Also," says our author, "Christ performed a miracle to satisfy strangers, yes, even his enemies.—St. Matthew xvii, 26, 27." Let Mr. Jones read these verses again. Who saw this miracle, except for Peter? The piece of money was to satisfy the strangers, and not the scene of Peter fishing, and opening the mouth of the fish. That was a private miracle, and was worked because money was lacking.

On the following page, (namely 13) he says, "It is reasonable to ask for the proofs they have of their authority, in order to have the standard of their doctrines in accordance with the truth of the scriptures, if it is so." If the Saints cannot give miraculous proofs, then their doctrines are not in accordance with the Scriptures, even though the doctrines of the sectarians of the age are amply in accordance without giving one proof whatsoever. Oh, such

inconsistency and blindness! Christ did not do miracles to satisfy anyone in this matter, for miracles are not proofs to prove truth. The Spirit of God is what proves truth. "If any man," says Jesus Christ, "will do his will, he shall know of the *doctrine*, whether it be of God, or whether I speak of myself." Now, the men who ask for miracles, if they have read that, are behaving foolishly, and deserve to be called a wicked and adulterous generation; and indeed, no sign will be given them, though they request their entire lives, except the sign of the false prophets.

At the bottom of the same page, and the beginning of the other, our author mentions Christ's raising of the daughter of Jairus, his casting out the devil from the young boy, and his healing of the lame man at the temple, as deeds that were done without faith, and without anyone's asking for them. Our friend does not even try to understand his Bible. Did not Jairus have faith? and did not Jesus command him, "Only believe?" (See Mark v, 35—43.) With respect to the young boy, Jesus said to his father, "If thou canst believe, all things are possible to him that believeth" (Mark ix, 23); and after he believed, the devil was cast out. The reason the apostles could not cast it out was because of their unbelief (Matt. xvii, 20). And with respect to the lame man of the temple, it is better to read our halfpenny pamphlet, namely, "Prove all things." There we prove that the gift of receiving health was in possession of the lame man, and that through that he received the blessing. It is too much work for us to answer the same things several times.

It is Mr. Jones who says that the miracles of Christ and the apostles were public, and that through them they proved their divine mission. The Jews tell another story; Christ and the apostles were killed by them because of their deceit. If the New Testament testifies of their miracles, a great number of other books among the Jews deny them. They reason that Christ had an opportunity to work a miracle on the cross, but he was unable to do so. In no way do we doubt the miracles of Christ and his apostles; rather we wish to show that there were not as many who believed in them at that time as believe in them now. If Christ were to come to the earth in this age, and if he were to do the same works as earlier, promising the Spirit of revelation to everyone, we believe that he would receive

just as bad treatment as he received earlier, treatment from the most prominent reverends and godly men. The people of every age of the world tend to disbelieve the works of God in their age. Now, the behavior of the world in this age, with respect to miracles, is the same as it was in the time of Jesus Christ. In primitive times, this proverb was said, "Physician, heal thyself: whatsoever we have heard done in Capernaum, do also here in thy country." In like manner our author says, on page 15, in this age; namely, "Now, I ask where have those who call themselves Latter-day Saints given a sign so obvious that it cannot be denied, or that it can be believed: it is said in this area that a remarkable miracle was performed in Machynlleth; there they say that it was in Carmarthen the thing happened, and in Carmarthen they say that it was in Merthyr Tydfil the blind man received his sight; there they say again that they heard that one of the apostles calmed the storm on the voyage to California." Are not the two languages similar? The two parties wish to be eyewitnesses themselves, and then they will believe. There will be those like this who depend on seeing signs, who will be deceived by false prophets and false teachers, when they come to show great signs and wonders, insomuch that, if it were possible, they shall deceive the very elect. There are no doubt many examples of men who believed in the time of Christ, and also in this age, by seeing the power of God, but those are not the men who seek signs. They are men, most often, who came to believe in the normal way, namely through preaching.

On pages 15 and 16, our author intimates that the Mormons believe that "the church of God cannot exist without having twelve Apostles in connection with it." Perhaps the church can exist, under some circumstances, without having twelve apostles; but it appears that twelve are more normal than fewer than that; and we also think that the church can also exist having more than twelve. But the church cannot exist without apostles. Mr. Jones says that Mathias was chosen in place of Judas; and he gives the impression that no other apostles were ordained. "Consider," he says also, "that all met with death, except the apostle John; but we have no account of twelve other apostles being ordained in their place. If the Latter-day Saints have an account of that, we would like to know who they were by their names;—and before their witness is solid, it must be

from the book of God, and not from the Book of Mormon." Our author now shows, not only his ignorance of the Book of Mormon, but also of the book of God. Does he not know of the apostles Barnabas and Paul (Acts xiv, 14), and of Andronicus and Junia, who are of note among the apostles" (Rom. Xiv, 7)? Furthermore, read the following:—"And that he was seen of *Cephas*, then of the twelve. After that, he was seen of above five hundred brethren at once, of whom the greater part remain unto this present, but some are fallen asleep. After that, he was seen of James; then of *all of the apostles*. And last of all he was of *me* also, as of one born out of due time" (1 Cor. xv, 5—9). It is seen from this that there were not only twelve apostles, but quite a few more of them. Is that witness solid enough, pray tell? there are more proofs available if necessary. "The opinion of the theologians [simpletons] of the ages is that no more than twelve apostles were ordained." That is not the opinion of the scriptures, nor the Book of Mormon. "An apostle was one," says our author, "who saw the Lord Jesus in the flesh, and who was a witness of his resurrection." Further, "The speech of St. Paul proves that he could not have been an apostle, if he did not see Christ in the *flesh*; and had he waited a little it would have been too late for him." Now, Paul did not see Christ before his resurrection, and he could not have been a witness of his resurrection; nevertheless, Paul was an apostle. That which the sectarians understand by seeing "Christ in the flesh," was to see him before his crucifixion, which Paul did not; but Paul did see him in his resurrected flesh, and apostles in this age could see him thus also; and how does Mr. Jones know that the apostles of the latter days have not seen him also. How much better was anyone for seeing Jesus Christ before his crucifixion, to be a witness? they could not say, in spite of that, that Christ was the son of the living God, without having a revelation from heaven. Paul was, despite not having seen Christ before resurrecting, as much a witness of him as they; for not one of them saw him resurrect any more than Paul did; and the apostles in this age, by revelation, can be as good witnesses of that as can any of the early apostles.

Further on the above topic, our author says, on page 17, "Have I

not chosen you the twelve, and ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel. St. John saw, in the Revelation, the New Jerusalem descending out of heaven from God; and the wall of the city had twelve foundations, and in them the names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb. From this it appears beyond any argument that only one apostolic age was ordained." Did not the Lamb have twelve apostles when he began to edify his church? We do not see that there is any impropriety in having the names of those twelve apostles placed on the twelve foundations. But were Paul and Barnabas, &c., not apostles, because their names are not on those foundations? They were, says everyone. Well, if they were, can others not be in this age also? Indeed, how are the saints perfected without apostles and prophets? It is said in Eph. iv, 11—13, "And he gave some, *apostles*; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers; for the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ; till we *all* come in the *unity of the faith*, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ." By this we see that a church cannot exist without apostles, for it is necessary to have them for the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, and for the edifying of the body of Christ; and they will be necessary until we all come together in the unity of the faith, or until the edifying of the church is finished. The scaffolding is not taken down from the building until after it is finished; and apostles, prophets, &c., are not taken from the church until its edifying is finished. If Jesus Christ is to be with his church until the end of the world, and to continue as its Chief Architect, he will no doubt keep the apostles and prophets working, until he completes his purpose, namely, finishing building the body of Christ. The apostles are the head of the church or the woman on the earth, and Christ is the Bridegroom, who is another head, in the same sense as the man is the head of his wife. The body cannot ever exist without a head, as it possibly could without feet. A head was the first member which God placed on the body, for it was one of the most essential members for leading the body. Read our treatise *The Body*

of Christ, or the Church, and you will see many additional reasons for the continuation of apostles in the church, and the necessity of having them to complete the building.

We see nothing on pages 18 and 19 that is worthy of attention, since it is all nothing more than the author's supposition; and on page 20, our author quotes a few verses that shatter his whole building; they are as follows:—"For he will yet come a second time in all the majesty and glory of his Father, taking vengeance on them that *know* not God, and that obey not the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ." "For I determined not to know any thing among you, save Jesus Christ, and him crucified. And whoever takes it upon himself to preach any *other* gospel than this, let him be anathema Maranatha." "Preach the word being instant in season, and out of season; for the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine; but after their own lusts shall they heap to themselves teachers, having itching ears; and they shall turn away their ears from the truth, and shall be turned unto fables." Now, we ask, who is it that professes to *know* God? Not those who deny revelation. And who but the Saints preach the same gospel as Paul, by exhorting men to seek the best gifts, and do not forbid speaking with tongues, and scorning prophecies? And who fails to tolerate that which the apostles preached earlier from being preached in this age? The sectarians of the country: it is they who dare to persecute the Saints for preaching all things as did the apostles; and it is they also who heap to themselves teachers, as we prove in our treatise "Sound Doctrine." The above verses speak so clearly in favor of the Mormons, that there is no need to say another word.

At the end of the 20th page, Mr. Jones says, "For my part, I would believe Muhammad as soon as I would believe Joseph Smith, and the Koran as soon as the Book of Mormon; and it would be a full hundred times easier for me to give credence to the foolish and insane assertions of Joanna Southcott, or to any other of the religious deceivers who arose *before him*, or *after him*, as it would be for me to believe theirs." That is true, for our author knows nothing about any of them. He describes Joanna Southcott as a man, poor thing; and a little further, he shows more of his ignorance, by mentioning the "Valley of the Salt *Glen*."

On page 21, our author tries to prove that Joseph Smith was not a prophet. "They say," says he, "that he (J. S.) was the sun of the justice." Oh, the foolishness of the man, when he still listens to the little old ladies, instead of reading our books: let him show that in any book if he can. If he wants to see the prophecies of Joseph Smith, let him read the "Book of Doctrine and Covenants," newly published in Welsh, and he will see how many have been fulfilled. He could also benefit from reading more in his Bible, instead of saying things such as what he says on page 22, namely, that "*all* will be caught up to the air to meet" Jesus Christ. The dead and those who are alive in Christ will meet him, and not everyone, unless they are *all* "ever with the Lord." With respect to the coming of Christ to his temple on the earth, there is nothing more logical and scriptural. Inasmuch as John, in the Book of Revelation, proves that Christ will reign on the earth for a thousand years, then why can he not go to his temple? We have neither space nor time now to note the scriptures; and therefore, we shall leave the reader to search for himself, while we hasten to finish.

Now, we shall leave the "Principles of the Latter-day Saints" in the scales of logic and scriptures, confident that no one will shout "Tekel," until he looks at the weights. This, our author, on the whole, has made a better effort than many; but we hope that he will read a little more before he ventures to write another treatise. Since he ended with a bit of poetry, we shall do the same, confident that it will be beneficial.

Let Mormonism continue in its progress,
It is succeeding remarkably throughout the world;
Let the sectarians come to the light,
Before they are all deceived;
The false prophets, &c., will come,
To trip them up presently.

Before long the kingdom will be given,
Not to the sects, but to the Saints;
The unrighteous will be destroyed,
And the righteous will be rewarded.
May the time come, &c.,
When the Saints are seen at the head.

“INCONSISTENCIES OF THE DOCTRINE AND COVENANTS AND THE BOOK OF MORMON,” &c., AGAIN.

MR. ED.,—I am pleased to see your readiness to impart a little light, from your scarcity, to the foolish virgins who have no light in their lamps, together with everyone in general who is in need, of course. I do not know how many you have enlightened, but I know that everyone I have heard talking about your response, are greatly amazed at seeing such poor response that you gave; but one must be satisfied, and we should love you, since you did your best. No one can do better than one's best. I feel desirous, despite that, to let you know that I do not entirely agree with you in your views. You said that no one could deny except for those who know. But I prefer to believe that which Thomas Harries said, in the TRUMPET, page 290. “They (the sectarians) have denied him (namely the Spirit), by saying, ‘It is not needed.’” How much do these churches know about the Spirit of God, pray tell? Paul said also that there will be some men in the last days who have “a form of godliness, but who deny its power;” and the Saints say that these men are the sectarians; and the way they prove that the sects deny the power of godliness is, because they say there is no need for the spiritual gifts now. That is sufficient, I think, to prove that men can deny the Holy Ghost, without receiving it for themselves, according to the words of Paul.

Next, you said that Job was to return from his grave, although he said, “I shall go the way whence I shall not return.” I say that he must return along some other path when he comes; otherwise, he will be as dishonest as if he had returned the same day he went. Mention is made in 1 Kings xiii, of some man who had been commanded by the word of the Lord, to refrain from returning from Bethel along the path he had gone; but it did not occur to the man that he could return some other way: and thus in the case of Job. It cannot be concluded fairly from the words, “I shall go the way whence I shall not return,” that he did not intend to ever return, but only that he would not return along the same path. You said also, that one can return from the place from which the Book of Mormon definitely says there is no return, because the Book did not say “ever,” or “forever and ever,” &c. I say, if they come from there some time,

that is returning; and consequently, the Book of Mormon would be as dishonest as if they were to return from there the second day after going there, for the book says, "*from which there is no return.*"

If you look again at page 321 of the Book of Mormon, you will see there something similar to that which I have said, namely that after going to prison there is no hope of coming out of it. I understand this from the explanation that Alma gives of the word "Restoration." It says in some other place in the Book of Mormon that men are to be put in prison until they pay the uttermost ———; and where asks the one who said that, can they obtain a ——— in the prison? This is as good as saying that they could not ever get one there; and consequently, they will have to stay there forever. At the moment I cannot give the pages, but I saw it somewhere in the Book of Mormon.

You said that there was nothing in the life of Oliver Cowdery that made him guilty of the evil mentioned about him in the Doc. and Cov. I cannot believe your assertion until I have reasons to prove that his excommunication from the Church, and his eleven-year absence, did not make him guilty of turning completely from the covenant of the priesthood. Although I am out of the church, it is fair for me to be enlightened in this matter, if it is possible to do so. This at present, from

WILLIAM THOMAS.

[We are sorry we cannot satisfy this man: he needs so much light, that the *Star* of the Saints cannot supply it. Let him find the *Sun*, and perhaps he will be satisfied there. Nevertheless, we shall make one more attempt.—It is likely that we said, "One cannot *deny*, except what one *knows*." That is what we think is the proper meaning of the word *deny*, and that is what the dictionaries say also. Yet perhaps the word can have a broader meaning, such as in the following example:—We ask a man who was not in Merthyr, if he was there. If he says, No, then we can say that he *denies* it, the same as the sects denying the power of godliness. Language is imperfect, and it is difficult to understand the mind of God without the Spirit of God to help us. This denial is different from the denial of those who have "denied what they knew by the Spirit of God," as we said before. The Book of Mormon says that whosoever denies Christ and his works, to get gain, is like unto a son of perdition. One who does that to get gain, like Judas, denies the one he knew to be the Son of God, and thus commits an unpardonable sin.—Next, with respect to the words, "I

shall go the way whence I shall not return." Is there a way for Job to come from his grave, except by the way he went there? We think not; but there was another way for that man to return from Bethel, as we can judge. Let our correspondent be content to believe us or not concerning the "return" in the Book of Mormon, for that is not of great importance. If there are faults in the Book of Mormon, "they are the mistakes of men," as stated on its first page; "wherefore, condemn not the things of God, that ye may be found spotless at the judgment-seat of Christ." When we look on page 321 of the Book of Mormon, we understand the return mentioned there in a different manner from that of our correspondent, and it is fruitless to say much of our opinion when he knows so much better. We are unable to say much about that which he saw somewhere in the Book of Mormon, except that there is some word he wrote in his letter that we cannot distinguish.—With respect to Oliver Cowdery, if that which we said previously is not enough, we prefer that W. Thomas believe himself.—Now, we feel to say to this our correspondent, that we have conversed with him sufficiently for the time being, and that he ought to repent speedily before he goes too far.—ED.]

POLYGAMY AMONG THE MORMONS.

CURRENTLY there are several publications in the country that are creating a great ruckus about polygamy among the Mormons. They claim to have received a letter from someone that reveals that President Brigham Young has about twenty-five wives; and some say that Capt. D. Jones also has the same number, while others testify that he has two, and that one of them is a "spiritual wife," which he took from Carmarthenshire. The person who says this is an eye-witness, say the publications; but they are afraid to give the person's name. Polygamy among the Saints is an old story, and everyone can know that it is false like its devilish father. We think that the "spiritual wife" is Mrs. Lewis, formerly of Kidwelly, who emigrated the same time as Capt. Jones, leaving her husband and her sister behind to settle some legal matters, which were not finished in time for the emigration; and since Mrs. Lewis had made reservations on the ship for her family, and had made all the preparations, her husband and her sister consented to stay behind until the next emigration, in order to receive some other money that was coming to them. Her husband and her sister emigrated with the first shipload after her; and we have heard that they have joined the family in the Valley.

Those are not the first lies about Brigham Young and Capt. Jones, nor will they be the last. For those who wish to know for a surety in relation to the truth, let them read the following from the "Doctrine and Covenants," page 300:—"Inasmuch as this church of Christ has been reproached with the crime of fornication, and polygamy, we declare that we believe, that one man should have one wife; and one woman, but one husband, except in case of death, when either is at liberty to marry again." Polygamy is not tolerated in the church, and neither the president nor anyone else is allowed to practice it.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

CALL FOR WELSH BOOKS IN ENGLAND.—President F. D. Richards has requested that we send one hundred copies of the Doctrine and Covenants in Welsh without delay, and has promised to receive two hundred copies of the Book of Mormon in Welsh, after it is published. This shows the spirit of assisting the Welsh, for which we should be grateful. Before long the Saints will become desirous of purchasing the foregoing books in every language in which they are available.

RAILWAY.—Last Wednesday ground was broken for the first Great Salt Lake City and Mountain Railway. An agreement has been made for *sleepers* and *rails*, and now work is the only thing necessary to get the way open for direct service. Everything will be made of wood; and as soon as it is finished, immediate preparations will be made to begin work on the Temple. If every Saint were to do his duty, three months would not pass before the rock would be moved to be made into walls. What will you do?—*Deseret News*.

"MORMONS BOG."—One hundred "Mormons Bog," namely the Book of Mormon in the Danish language, have arrived in Liverpool, and some of them will be sent without delay for the Welsh, those who wish to have books ready to set before the foreign brethren who may perhaps come to their homes in Zion.

NEWS FROM THE VALLEY.—General good health is thriving throughout the Valley, and plenty of wheat has been sown. The completion of houses is a daily event; and it is reported that clay vessels are beginning to be made. Every haste is being made to finish the public buildings, in order to begin work on the Temple.—It is intended to celebrate the 24th of July in an ostentatious way, by having a *picnic party* and a procession to the Great Salt Lake, with the musical choir in their coach drawn by fourteen horses, together with a military escort; and there will be a

splendid boat on the lake for entertainment; and there will be feasts, discourses, &c., to entertain the company.

THE WISE MAN.—The wise man will organize the time gone by for comment and reflection, the present time to fulfill duties, and the time yet to come he will put in the care of Providence.

WEALTH.—Lost wealth can be regained, and health lost can be restored; but if valuable time is lost, it can never be called back.

SPACE.

The builder of all existence—is the intermediary
Of the vast space;
Neither the *Lord*, nor *all* he has made,
Can immortalize away from his dwelling place.

Dinas.

W. ROBERTS, JR.

PAYMENTS FROM SEPTEMBER 5 TO SEPTEMBER 18.—Monmouthshire, £2; West Glamorgan, £2 16s 6½c. and £2 5s 10c; Llanilltyd, 1s 3c; Pontytypriidd, £2 12s 6c; Llanfabon, 8s 6½c; Cwmbach, £1; Cardiff, 8s 6c; Aberdare, £1 4s 1½c; Dowlais, 16s; Georgetown, £2 13s 3c; Merthyr, 10s; Cefn, 7s 9c; Gorllwyn, 7s 3c; Ffynnon Tydfil, 6s 2c.—Total, £17 17s 8½c.

DOC. AND COV.—We will give twopence each for as many as you may have of the 6th Segment of the Doc. and Cov.; and we wish for those who have sent here for odd segments, to be patient, and we shall supply them as we are able. There are many who have not sent information as yet. We hope that the segments for the Book of Mormon will be more well cared for.

BOOK OF MORMON.—Names for the Book of Mormon have nearly reached 1500, not counting the order from Liverpool for 200 after it is published. The first Segment will come out with this TRUMPET; and if the subscriptions increase to *two thousand* by the 10th segment, the segments from the 20th on will sell for one penny each! Understand this, brethren.

 Large posters are being sent with this Issue to be placed in the rooms of the Saints, and also in windows, and other public places; and the place where the books are on sale can be written on them, in the space left for that.

 Let the treasurers for the Emigrating Fund send the money on hand to Merthyr by the appointed times. This quarter ends on the 24th of this month, and the money is to be sent from all places by that time.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 20.]

OCTOBER 4, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

COMING OF THE SON OF MAN.

BY CAPT. D. JONES.

“Therefore, be ye also ready, for in such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.”—MATT. xxiv, 44.

THE SUBJECT noted,—namely the coming of the Son of Man; it is obvious that it is his *second* coming that is meant, because he himself was speaking while on the earth for the first time. This is a firm statement,—irrefutable and sure proof that he is to come a second time; and if one asks where he will come that time? the statement proves that—namely he would return to the place he came the first time, *on the earth*. Since every denomination that professes Christianity acknowledges that the second coming will be on the earth, there is no need to provide further confirmation. There are many different opinions in this age, as to the manner, the time, the purpose, and the signs or the work that are to be accomplished before then, yea, perhaps there are as many different views about these remarkable things, as there are different religious denominations in the world; proof, then, that there is a need to search further into the matter, and that is what we shall do, namely examine the testimonies of recognized and spiritual men; let those be the touchstone, and that will be sufficient to end every argument, if they are under the guidance of the same Spirit. We shall strive also to obtain the Spirit in order to understand this important matter as they do. We shall examine

I. THE MANNER OF HIS COMING.

II. THE PURPOSE FOR HIS COMING.

III. THE TIME OF HIS COMING.

IV. THE SIGNS THAT WILL PRECEDE, THE WORK THAT WILL BE DONE ON THE EARTH BEFORE HIS COMING.

I. THE MANNER, OR THE WAY HE WILL APPEAR THE SECOND TIME. Almost everyone who has considered this topic, and come to a decision about it, has some way opened, some path organized, or a rule by which they expect him to come, and these differ greatly from one another, and (but to put reason to work) it must be admitted that all but one of us will be disappointed in this; it is not possible that more than one of them all has the right idea, for he is coming only one more time, and he cannot come in different ways this time; thus, we see the necessity of understanding how he will come, who of them all (if even one is admitted) is right, and that one is not right either if it is not according to the "law and the witness;" for he will come in his own way, even if all the people of the world say the opposite—and he himself has said the way, described the form, and shown how he will come. It says in verse 30, that he will come "on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory." "When the Son of man shall come in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then shall he sit upon the throne of his glory" (chapter xxv, 31). "And then shall they see the Son of Man coming in a cloud with power and great glory" (Luke xxi, 27). This is his own witness, but let us hear the witness of two angels to his disciples, "And while they (the apostles) beheld, He (namely Jesus) was taken up; and a cloud received him out of their sight. And while they looked steadfastly toward heaven, as he went up, behold, two men (angels) stood by them in white apparel; which also said, Ye men of Galilee, why stand ye gazing up into heaven? this same Jesus, which is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come in like manner as *ye have seen* him go into heaven" (Acts i, 9, 10, 11). Here it is proved that the Son of Man will come in the same carriage in which he went, namely a cloud, and since it was from the mount of Olives that he ascended, it is on the mount of Olives that he will come, thus in "like *manner* will he *come*," &c. And to this the prophets bear testimony; Zach. xii, 10, says, "And they (namely the house of David and the inhabitants of Jerusalem) shall look upon me whom they have pierced." "And one shall say unto him, What are these wounds in thine hands? Then he shall answer, Those with which I was wounded in the house of my friends" (chap. xiii, 6).

The above statement about the manner of the coming of the Son of Man is conclusive in proving that he will come on a cloud, personally; the same body that was crucified, resurrected; the same wounds that Christ showed to Thomas, and others, when he said, "handle me, and see; for a spirit hath not flesh and bones, as ye see me have." The same scars, namely the mark of the nails, and the spear, and the crown of thorns Christ will show when he comes the second time; for that they will grieve, because they rejected him and disrespected him so much; but he will come this time triumphant over all his enemies, and by these features they will recognize their Messiah, and he will be King, not over the Jews only, but his rule will be over all the world; and lest there be any doubt about the manner or the place where he will come, the Prophet says in chap. xiv, 4, "And his feet shall stand in that day upon the mount of Olives," namely those feet that walked upon our earth, those feet that walked to the top of Golgotha, and were nailed to the cross, yes, those holy feet that trod the top of the mount of Olives, when he had earlier ascended to tread with those same feet the golden dust of the hills of Jerusalem, within the third heaven, and those feet will yet stand on the same mount, namely the mount of Olives, and it will rend in two, and one half will move toward the north, and the other half toward the south, and there will be a very large valley; perhaps some will allege that this has already taken place, but no historian who knows of the situation in that land will allege that the mount of Olives has thus rent, for it has not. There was to be a very large valley, to which the house of David and the inhabitants of Jerusalem would flee for safety, but it cannot have happened yet, because they have not come there, rather to this day they are scattered over all the families of the earth; but they were to be gathered to their land, and to build Jerusalem before that, and all nations were to come against them, and overcome half the city, as is seen in the foregoing account; and after they flee to this valley, with their enemies surrounding them, the great darkness was to take place, with all the hosts of the nations destroying each other, until there would be only a few remaining from each nation under heaven. At this time "the Lord will come and all his Saints with Him" (verse 5). And if it is alleged that these things have taken place, it is necessary to prove that all the saints have come also, since they are to come "with Him." If anyone says that

this refers to those who rose when Jesus was resurrected, then even the darkness of night, every night since then deny the allegation, "For in that day, the light shall not be clear, nor dark" (verse 6). "But it shall be one day, which shall be known to the Lord, not day, nor night; but at evening time it shall be light" (verse 7). See also the entire chapter; that the restoration of the Jews is to possess the land eternally, but that they were scattered at, or after the resurrection of Jesus; consequently, all these things are going forward, and we shall look for the second coming of the Son of Man on the clouds of heaven, and all the saints with Him. He will come personally to the same place, and in like manner that he went to heaven. Paul says, 1 Thes. iv, 15, 16, 17, "We which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep. For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God, and the dead in Christ shall rise first: then we which are alive, and remain, shall be caught up together with them, in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord." Where? in the air? No, rather on the earth, see Rev. v, 10, where John hears the sweet voice of the harps of the seraphim and the golden vials of heaven resounding so gently; he listened to what the song said, and behold, do not marvel, this was their song in joy and rejoicing in that happy place, "And he hath made us unto our God kings and priests." Well, you say, no wonder they were singing gently, after receiving such high offices in heaven; but understand, that was not all of their song, for the last part was the sweetest by far, namely, "and we shall reign on the earth." In chap. xx, 4, he sees them on thrones, "and they lived and reigned with Christ a thousand years." We see that Christ is to come on the clouds of heaven, in his kingdom with his powerful angels, and all his saints will rise, as He rose, and with such bodies as he has, and he will reign personally as King of the whole world, and those who were faithful in their lives in serving him, and who died in him, will resurrect when he comes, and will reign with him, as officers in his broad and splendid kingdom, to carry his government forward across the whole world. Many comparisons have been handed down to show the way the Son of Man would come.

1. Comparison of the flood,—“as it was in the days of Noah, so shall it be in the days of the Son of Man.” What is similar in

it? 1. Raising a Prophet to warn the country of his coming, &c. 2. Few were saved in the days of Noah; despite the warning, hardly anyone believed, rather they called the old prophet a deceiver, and thus it will be again. 3. The flood came suddenly on them, when they were not expecting it, and thus it will be again. A large part of this age thinks the direct opposite to this, namely that that day will come gradually, and that the inhabitants of the world, and the Jews also will come to believe the religions that they call the Gospel, and they have prepared this way for him to come, and are doing their best to hasten the time, and prepare his way before him, namely by sending missionaries to evangelize the world; but thus they have a very lengthy work, or that day is very far off, providing that he does not come until all the Jews and Gentiles come to believe, and judging from the time that has gone past, and the success they have had until now; if the people of the world are to come to believe these gospels, before that day comes, there must be some miracles following them according to their admission; thus, either they should admit the gospel of miracles, or they should give up their work, it seems to me. But in the

2. Comparison of the flood it proves that only a few people of the world will be saved at that day: it says in Luke xvii, 28, "Likewise also as it was in the days of Lot," they had no warning, they did not believe the witness, although it was divinely sent, but fire came and burned them, except for a few, namely the family of Lot: thus it will be in the days of the Son of Man, and that because he will not come in the way people expect him to.

3. It shall come like a snare on all them that dwell on the face of the earth; therefore, be ye ready. "Therefore, take heed to yourselves, watch and pray always, lest that day come upon you unawares," Luke xxi, 34, 35. Isaiah says, "The earth and the work that is in it shall burn, and few men left."

4. It shall come like the coming of lightning, generally, or rather as beams of light from the east and fill the world, until all people see him. Lightning does not always come from the east and go to the west; and it does not go across the world, rather a small part of it; but when the Son of Man shall come all his saints will see him, the Jews will see him in Jerusalem, and that when they say, "Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord;" but everyone in all places

will see his presence, namely that fire, that destroys before it all lies and pollution: and the breath of his mouth will destroy the liar, &c. "Our God is a consuming fire." Thus there will be light, generally across the whole world, and since everyone must see and suffer that day, prepare yourselves to meet it, "for he shall come like a purifier and refiner of silver, like a refiner's fire, and a fuller's soap."

II. PURPOSE OF HIS SECOND COMING.

1. To receive his kingdom unto himself. 2. To destroy the ungodly. 3. To glorify himself in his Saints.

1. To be a King in his kingdom. See Luke xxii, 30, "That ye may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom, and sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel." Again chapter 1, 32, 33, "He (Jesus) shall be great, and shall be called the Son of the Highest: and the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of his father David, and he shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever; and of his kingdom there shall be no end." See also Psalm cxiv, 11, 12, 13, "They shall speak of the glory of thy kingdom; and talk of thy power: to make known to the sons of men his mighty acts, and the glorious majesty of his kingdom. Thy kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and thy dominions endureth throughout all generations." It says in Dan. ii, 44, "the God of heaven shall set up a kingdom, which shall never be destroyed," &c. And in chapter iv, 3, it says, "his kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and his dominion is from generation to generation." Again in Matt. vi, 10, 13, "Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen." Also in chap. xxv, 31, 32, 33, 34, it says, "When the Son of Man shall come in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then shall he sit upon the throne of his glory. And before him shall be gathered all nations; and he shall separate them one from another, as a shepherd divideth his sheep from the goats: and he shall set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on the left. Then shall the King say unto them on his right hand, Come, ye blessed of my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world." It says in 1 Cor. xv, 50, "Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God." See 2 Tim. iv, 1, 8., "Who shall judge the quick and the dead at his appearing and his kingdom. Henceforth, there is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, shall give me

at that day: and not to me only, but unto all them also that love his appearing." Again, Rev. xi, 15, "The kingdoms of this world are become the kingdoms of our Lord, and of his Christ; and he shall reign for ever and ever." Many additional verses prove that Christ is to come in person to take possession of the earth, and to become king over the whole world, and his government will be from the rivers to the ends of the earth; at that day there will be one King, and his name will be one, with all his enemies under his feet. But enough has been shown to affirm the statement irrefutably on a scriptural base.

2. He is coming to destroy the ungodly who will be on the earth at the day of his coming, but not those who have already died will he judge when he comes. See Psalm xi, 6, "Upon the wicked he shall rain snares, fire and brimstone, and an horrible tempest: this shall be the portion of their cup." Psalm lxxviii, 2, "As wax melteth before the fire, so let the wicked perish at the presence of God;"—therefore, be ye ready. Psalm xc, 6, He shall judge among the heathen, he shall fill the places with the dead bodies; he shall wound the heads over many countries." See also Isaiah ix, 18, 19, 20, "For wickedness burneth as the fire; it shall devour the briers and thorns, and shall kindle in the thickets of the forest, and they shall mount up like the lifting up of smoke. Through the wrath of the Lord of hosts is the land darkened, and the people shall be as the fuel of the fire: no man shall spare his brother. And he shall snatch on the right hand, and be hungry; and he shall eat on the left hand, and they shall not be satisfied: they shall eat every man the flesh of his own arm." Again in chap. xiii, 6, 7, 8, 9, "Howl ye; for the day of the Lord is at hand; it shall come as a destruction from the Almighty. Therefore shall all hands be faint, and every man's heart shall melt. And they shall be afraid; pangs and sorrows shall take hold of them; they shall be in pain as a woman that travaileth; they shall be amazed one at another; their faces shall be as flames. Behold the day of the Lord cometh, cruel both with wrath and fierce anger, to lay the land desolate; and he shall destroy the sinners thereof out of it." And in chap. xxiv, 6, 17, 21, it is said, "Therefore hath the curse devoured the earth, and they that dwell therein are desolate; therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, and few men left. Fear, and the pit, and the snare, are upon thee, O inhabitant of the earth. In that day the Lord shall punish the host of the high ones, that are on high, and the

kings of the earth upon the earth." Again ver. 22, "And they shall be gathered together, as prisoners are gathered in the pit, and shall be shut up in the prison, and after many days shall they be visited." See Psalm cxlix, 6, 7, "And a twoedged sword in their hands; to execute vengeance upon the heathen, and punishments upon the people." Isaiah xi, 4, "And he shall smite the earth with the rod of his mouth, and with the breath of his lips shall he slay the wicked." Jer. xxx, 23, 24, "Behold, the whirlwind of the Lord goeth forth with fury, a continuing whirlwind; it shall fall with pain upon the head of the wicked. The fierce anger of the Lord shall not return, until he have done it, and until he have performed the intents of his heart: in the latter days ye shall consider it." Again in Zeph. iii, 8, "For all the earth shall be devoured with the fire of my jealousy." See also Mal. iv, 1, "For behold the day cometh, that shall burn as an oven; and all the proud, yea, and all that do wickedly, shall be stubble; and the day that cometh shall burn them up, saith the Lord of hosts, that it shall leave them neither root nor branch," &c. And in 2 Thes, i, 7, 8, 9, "The Lord Jesus shall be revealed from heaven, with his mighty angels, in flaming fire taking vengeance on them that know not God, and that obey not the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ. Who shall be punished, with everlasting destruction from the presence of the Lord, and from the glory of his power." From this that is said, we see that the Son of Man when he comes on the cloud to his kingdom, is to give revenge on all that do not know God: and there is no way to know him except by his Spirit, and no one can have his Spirit except through the Son; no one knew the Father except the Son, and it is he who reveals the Son to him, and the Holy Ghost who emanates from the Father who reveals, or comes to the knowledge of the one and the other, and that by obedience to the gospel of the Lord Jesus, which knowledge is eternal life; and without obeying his gospel, we cannot escape from the avenging flood of fire; there is no other way, and let us give thanks that there is one way of escape on one condition, possible; and Oh, let us not destroy it, or neglect it for anything, for justice to our souls persuades us, and the great and dreadful day of the Lord in his wrath, urges us to embrace his gospel quickly, which it is called today; therefore, be ye ready, &c.

Another purpose for the second coming of the Son of Man, is to glorify himself in his Saints; for those who slept in Jesus, to

be released to the freedom of the glory of the children of God, awaiting the adoption, namely the redemption of the body, "Since God provided some better thing for us, that they without us should not be made perfect." "Fear not, dear ones, for it is your Father's good pleasure to give you the kingdom." Also read the following verses: Matt. v, 5, "Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth." Mal. iii, 16, 17, 18, "And a book of remembrance was written before him for them that feared the Lord, and that thought upon his name. And they shall be mine, saith the Lord of hosts, in that day when I make up my jewels; and I will spare them, as a man spareth his own son that serveth him. Then shall ye return (the Jews) and discern between the righteous and the wicked, between him that serveth God and him that serveth him not." Phil. iii, 20, 21, "For our conversation is in heaven; from whence also we look for the Savior. Who shall change our vile body, that it may be fashioned like unto his glorious body," &c. 2 Tim. iv, 8, "There is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, and for all them that love his appearing the second time." 1 Cor. i, 7, 8, "Waiting for the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, who shall also confirm you unto the end, that ye may be blameless in the day of our Lord Jesus." 1 John iii, 2, "Now are we the sons of God, and it doth not yet appear what we shall be; but we know that, when he shall appear, we shall be like him; for we shall see him as he is." 2 Thes. i, 7, 10, "And to you who are troubled rest with us, when the Lord Jesus shall be revealed from heaven. When he shall come to be glorified in his saints, and to be admired in all them that believe (because our testimony among you was believed) in that day." 1 Thes. iv, 14, "For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him." Again ver. 16, 17, "And the dead in Christ shall rise first; then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air; and so shall we ever be with the Lord." Matt. xix, 28, "Ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel." 1 Cor. vi, 2, "Do ye not know that the saints shall judge the world," &c. Here we see that those who obey the eternal gospel (and they only) will be snatched on the wings of faith, like the eagle to the air to meet the great King of peace: when he comes in his kingdom, he will honor them, love them, save them, and will take pride in them, and say, Behold me

and the children God gave to me, owning them like his brethren in the presence of God and all his angels, saying to them, "Come, ye blessed of my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you," &c.; "those that thou gavest, I desire where I am, that they may also be with me;" and not only the living, but the resurrected dead; and at once the two glorious throngs will rise up to the air through the power of their faith, while the whole earth and the work that is in it will be burned, the hills leaping like lambs, the rocks rending, the ungodly because of fear and dread shouting for the hills to fall on them, and hide them from the presence of the Son of Man, and from the wrath of the Lamb. But there will be no escape at that time, now is the time. Oh, embrace the gospel of his Son, and be reconciled with God, so that that day will not come upon you like a snare. Here we see that not everyone will be dead, but when he comes there will more inhabitants on the earth than ever before, and although the ungodly will be killed by the breath of his mouth, yet will the Saints not die; but what does the scripture say? "It is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment;" thus will the ungodly die, and after that they will be resurrected to the judgment of the last day; after that many will be appointed to die twice, namely, to be cast into the lake of fire following the general judgment. But it is not to this that the previously quoted scriptures refer, rather to everyone who is on the earth will the above judgment come, when the Son of Man comes, and the transformation that will take place on the Saints will be equivalent to death, for those who slept will rise with bodies like his glorified body. And thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise, "And we," says Paul, "shall be changed to the same image;" here all the Saints will have bodies like his body. There will be some who have arisen from the grave, and many who have never been there, nor will they ever go there, for they will not ever die, but will be forever with him. And since they must rise up to the cloud to meet him to escape the vengeance, and that on wings, it is no wonder that Jesus asked, "And when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?"

His purpose in coming is to save his people, receive his kingdom, and to be glorified in his Saints, so they may reign with him on the earth a thousand years, as Paul says, it is so "that in the dispensation

of the fullness of times he might gather together in one all things in Christ, both which are in heaven, and which are on earth; even in Him," Eph. i, 10. Again in Rev. xiv, 1, 14, 15, "And lo, the Lamb of God stood on mount Zion, and with him an hundred forty and four thousand, having his Father's name written in their foreheads. And I looked, and behold a white cloud, and on the cloud one sat like unto the Son of man, having on his head a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle. Reap, for the harvest of the earth is come." Chap. xix, 5—9, "Praise our God, all ye his servants. Alleluia, for the Lord God omnipotent reigneth. Rejoice, for the marriage of the Lamb is come, and his wife hath made herself ready. And to her was granted that she should be arrayed in fine linen, namely the righteousness of the Saints. Blessed are they which are called unto the marriage supper of the Lamb; these are the true sayings of God." At the supper Christ commands his disciples to drink of the cup, and says unto them, "I will not drink henceforth this fruit of the vine until the kingdom of God is come," namely in his power and his glory, which will take place when, and not before his second coming to the world. This is the feast that Isaiah says the Lord will make on this mountain (Zion), of fat things full of marrow, &c. Oh, wondrous feast, with the Lord himself gloriously administering before his ancients, when he will wipe away every tear from their eyes; there will be no more grief or sorrow, but they may see his face always, and their joy will be like the river, and their comforts like the waves of the sea. Meeting together there will be the old patriarchs, prophets, and Saints, and the ancient of days, yea, and the poorest and most insignificant of his Saints until the hour of his coming. Then they will shout, raising their heads, Here is our God, in whom we have hoped; and they will wear white gowns, namely the righteousness of Christ, whitened in the blood of the Lamb; and then I think they will shout with a song of praise, with golden and gentle harps to Him, who loved us, and bought us with his blood, from every kindred, tongue, people, and nation, and made us kings and priests to him and to God, and put the golden crowns on our heads, Thanks to him, to him, to him, &c.

These are the greatest purposes for the second coming of the Son of Man to the earth; he came the first time as a servant, but the second time as Lord of all, Prince, strong in war, Conqueror of

conquerors, and King of kings; the heavens his throne, and the earth his footstool, the light his robes, the clouds his chariots, thunder his voice, his power almighty, his retinue all the hosts of heaven and the excellent of the earth, to whom he gives unsearchable wealth, priceless treasures, and high offices by his own side, yes, as one with him; and also he will come to avenge all the inhabitants of the earth, on the earth, namely with the brightness of his coming,—with the breath of his mouth he will destroy the wicked. “For behold the Lord cometh out of his place to punish the inhabitants of the earth for their iniquity; the earth also shall disclose her blood, and shall no more cover her slain,”—Isaiah xxvi, 21. Therefore, be ye ready to meet him, for the Son of Man cometh at an hour when ye think not; and when he comes, who may abide the day of his coming?

(To be continued.)

TO THE CHURCHES.

MR. ED.,—Having traveled through various counties and conferences of Wales, I have discovered that some very unhealthy doctrine is being expounded, and I wish to make this known through means of the TRUMPET, so that all the faithful saints may be safeguarded against it. In every age bad men have been in the Church of God; and so it is with this age. Some have taught, regarding the books that have been published, that all of them are subject to their presidency, and that each book that has come out, is to be controlled by them entirely: and that if the Book of Doctrine and Covenants (which contains the revelations of God), says that thus and so is the behavior toward this and that transgression or the other; those who are puffed up, full of wind, and build their houses on the sand, say, “Oh, we attach no importance to what the Doctrine and Covenants or any other book says; we are the Presidents. We shall do as we please, and whatever we ourselves wish, that we shall do. Do not talk to us about books, since it is we who sit as judges.” Indeed, it does not surprise me how little obedience has been given to the *Star* and to the TRUMPET, for

as soon as they come to the hands of these puffed-up men, they say, "Oh, the authorities are obligated to write such and such; but the things which we say will stand." If the authorities of this Church say to these men not to use the money of the books, they say, "Oh, they do not mean what they say." Because of such men the Districts have gone into debt; there is no need to name them, as you know them, together with many of their other sins; for they gave no heed to those things that were written to them. We could mention many transgressions, but that would not be wise at the present time; and may those men repent before God and keep all the commandments from now on, lest they find themselves outside the kingdom of God, and die in that state. What do we say, is there a better place than hell for such people to stay? Therefore, fear and tremble, "Hearken, O ye people, and open your hearts and give ear from afar; and listen, you that call yourselves the people of the Lord, and hear the word of the Lord and his will concerning you; yea, verily, I say, hear the word of him whose anger is kindled against the wicked and rebellious; who willeth to take even them whom he will take, and preserveth in life them whom he will preserve; who buildeth up at his own will and pleasure; and destroyeth when he pleases, and is able to cast the soul down to hell. Behold, I, the Lord, utter my voice, and it shall be obeyed. Wherefore, verily I say, let the wicked take heed, and let the rebellious fear and tremble; and let the unbelieving hold their lips, for the day of wrath shall come upon them as whirlwind, and all flesh shall know that I am God. And he that seeketh signs shall see signs, but not unto salvation," (see Doctrine and Covenants, page 132). The responsibilities of the Elders is to carry forth with the meetings as they are directed by the Holy Ghost, in accordance with the commandments and revelations of God in the Book of Doctrine and Covenants, and nothing is to be carried forth differently. It is the responsibility of all who hold offices in this Church, to do everything according to the revelations of God, namely preaching, teaching, reproving and counseling, before they can do the will of God. We counsel all the presidents to teach with emphasis and sobriety the

commandments of God, so that the fear of God will go to the hearts of all the Saints; for the fear of God is the beginning of wisdom; and whosoever is destitute of wisdom, is without the Holy Ghost. Therefore, refrain from all vain speech and disputes, and from all ungodly laughter, and from all your lusts, and from all your pride, and light-mindedness, and from all your wicked doings; always when you gather together in your houses, let not more than one speak at once, but let one speak at a time, and let the others listen to him, and let that which is spoken by you be for the benefit and edification of those who are present.

Another teaching that is entirely heretical, is that which has come to my knowledge, and which is being taught secretly among the Saints, namely to conceal sins instead of confessing them, something which is completely contrary to the Doctrine and Covenants, and the scriptures. Many have tried to stay in this Church by hiding their sins, but they all come to light; this Church is a most inappropriate place to try to hide sins; where sins are hidden, there is darkness. And those men see many things as heretical; and if they do not bring themselves to light, God will bring them, either through driving them out of the Church, or by making their sins obvious to the Church. I warn you presidents and traveling elders, to be watchful, to take care that false doctrine is not taught in the churches, or anything contrary to the commandments of God; I call you to be responsible for the Saints, and you shall give an accounting in the time in which you come before the authorities in Zion. And, Oh, brethren, strive with me to build the kingdom of God and to save the thousands who lie in darkness; and may your vineyards be clean; otherwise, it is vain for you to expect to have success, unless your vineyards are clean. And may God bless you to do the work which he has entrusted to you. I wish for this letter to be read in every Branch. May the blessing of God be on all those who are desirous of serving him faithfully to the end, is my prayer through Jesus Christ. Amen.

WM. PHILLIPS.

MISCELLANEOUS, &C.

FAILURE.—Failure does not take from us our true friends; it only scatters those who pretend to be.

BOOK OF MORMON AGAIN.—We have received about 1800 subscribers by now, and we believe that we will not fail to get an additional 200, to make up the *two thousand*, so that the segments will be a penny each from the 20th on. Just a little more effort, and the words of President Phillips will be fulfilled, namely that 2500 subscriptions of the Book of Mormon will be obtained.

DOC. AND COV.—So that the Districts and the Branches can be supplied with segments 1, 2, 3, &c., it is better for them to purchase them from those who have begun to receive some segments, but who have not received them all. Better to pay them double the price, than to be without them. There have been so many calls for segments 1, 2, 3, &c., that we do not have sufficient to supply a tenth of them. Let us work together in searching further, and perhaps some can be supplied. We ourselves would like to obtain 2, 6, 7, and 9, namely as many as four of each, and we shall pay for them.

TO THE DISTRIBUTORS.—We are sending you at this time our quarterly billing. Some wish to receive billings every fortnight, they say, in order to know the prices! which have been published so many times, and on such big papers! Brethren, read. If Liverpool gives a billing every fortnight, they give the totals only every quarter. We believe that our manner of doing business with our Distributors is totally irreproachable; when that which we send in answer to the *order* is not accurate, we are careful to enclose a notice in the package, which is equivalent to an *invoice*. Take care to count your books before distributing them, and notify us without delay, if there are too many or too few; for we cannot be perfect, any more than any other businessmen; but we continually strive for perfection. The profit for sales of the Book of Mormon will be the same as for the Doc. and Cov. up to the 20th segment, when a slight difference will be effected.

BINDING BOOKS.—We have sent a large number of the “Doc. and Cov.” to be bound in London, in *embossed roan, gilt edges*, which will look more handsome than anything the Saints have had until now. For all who wish to have such a binding for their “Doc. and Cov.,” we can do it for them for 1s. 3c. each, by sending many together. We will bind all kinds of other books, in whatever manner ordered, beautifully and well done, and for prices as low as anyone offers. We advise everyone not to bind pamphlets with the Doc. and Cov., or with any other large book, rather bind the pamphlets together. Who binds pamphlets with his Bible or his New Testament?

 Some places are going into shameful debt again, and we fear that they will lose their glory in the kingdom of God, because of their unfaithfulness and their indifference in this matter. Oh, brethren, consider whose work it is that you have.

 Newly published, price 1½c. "*Review of the Treatise of W. Jones, Bethesda*, which is called Principles of the Latter-day Saints weighed on the Scales of Reason and Scriptures." Price per hundred, 11s.

 The Bilingual Hymn Books will be ready shortly.

 "Miles" asks for an explanation of Luke xxi, 17, "And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake." Our answer is,—

The *sheep* of Jesus were hated by everyone,
The *Saints* in Wales are hated by everyone;
But *heresy* is not hated,
Nor is anything by way of *Explanation*.

BOOK DEBTS FROM THE DISTRICTS, BRANCHES AND OTHERS, FOR THE QUARTER ENDING SEPTEMBER 30, 1851.

Districts.—Monmouthshire, £23 7s 6½c; Breconshire, £3 14s 3½c; Cardiganshire, £4 3s 2c; Carmarthenshire, £15 1s 9¾c; West Glamorgan, £35 17s 1¾c; Flintshire, £11 15s 0¼c; Caernarvon, £14 15s 7½c; Merionethshire, £5 7s 2½c; Denbighshire, £11 17s 11¾c; Pembrokeshire, £1 3s 10½c; *Branches*.—Dinas, £1 1s 3½c; Llanilltyd, £3 11s 6½c; Pontytypridd, £4 9s 11c; Llanfabon, £1 12 s 1c; Cwmbach, £6 1s 5½c; Pendeulwyn, 18s 9c; Twynyrodyn, £1 2s 3c; Llandaff, £1 19s 3c; Gog, £1 1s 9c; Cardiff, £4 1s 6½c; Aberdare, £16 6s 3½c; Dowlais, £5 6s 11c; Hirwaun, £1 14s 10c; Rhymney, £4 4s 2½c; Cwmnedd, £1 12s 2½c; Georgetown, £8 0s 7½c; Merthyr, £4 9s 1½c; Pendaren, £4 10s 3½c; Pontfaen, £1 8s 2c; Cefn, £3 3s 9c; Ynysgau, 16s 0½; Eglwysnewydd, 8s 8c; Liverpool, 1s 7¼c; Gwernllwyn, £1 6s 6c; Ffynnon Tydfil, £2 15s 10c. *Persons*.—Robert Evans, Liverpool, £1 18s 8½c; David Davies, Clynmil, (formerly), 3s 4c; Joseph Rogers, 2s; D. Edwards, formerly of Tongwyrddlas, 6s 5c; David John, Carmarthenshire 9s 6c; Jonathan J. Thomas, £1 19s 8 ½ c.—Total, £214 8s 2¾c. (The errors to be corrected).

PAYMENTS FROM OCTOBER 19 TO OCTOBER 2.—Breconshire, 17 s 9c; Carmarthenshire, £3; West Glamorgan, £2 4s 5c; Denbighshire, £4; Pontytypridd, £1 6s 6c; Llanfabon, 11s; Cardiff, 7s 7c; Dowlais, 18s; Georgetown, 12s 5c; Merthyr, £1 6s; Ynysgau, 2s 6c; Liverpool, £1 10s; Ffynnon Tydfil, 7s 6c.—Total, £17 3s 8c.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr*.

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 21.]

OCTOBER 18, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

COMING OF THE SON OF MAN.

[Continued from page 320.]

III. TIME OF HIS COMING. *When?*

There are many different thoughts in the world about the time of his coming, some expecting him this year for certain, others expecting him in previous years; many can show the appointed times, as well as the manner, that have been determined by men for his coming; some say that he has already come since the destruction of Jerusalem—others say that he will not come until the general judgment of the last day: but the most dangerous and heretical of all, I think, are those who claim that he will never again come in person on the earth; there are some even in Wales, who say that he will come the second time through his Spirit to reign in the hearts of his people, and I do not know of any other view of his second coming that I have heard that is as dangerous as this one to men, more contradictory to the holy scriptures, and so opposed to the mind of heaven.

It is grievous to think how indifferent this age is about this important time. There are even many of those who are called teachers and pastors of Wales, who neglect this important matter; and when they are asked the reason for that, they say that it is not of so much importance for us to know, or to talk about, but that we should just believe in Christ, and then he will take care of that, and it has nothing to do with us.—Is this not the literal fulfillment of the prophecy of Peter and others, 2 Peter iii, 3, 4,

“Knowing this first, that there shall come in the last days scoffers, walking after their own lusts, and saying, Where is the promise of his coming? for since the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation.” Thus it is in the latter days, is it not? they publish peace, peace from year to year; and since there is no immediate judgment given against evil acts, they become accustomed to publishing peace above the people, yes, when there is no peace, for peace has already been taken from the earth; nevertheless, they are blind leaders, they do not know, and I fear that publishing peace will be the task of many, until sudden destruction comes on all of them, like a snare, or thief in the night, suddenly and swiftly; and Oh, how I pity the poor wretches who are beguiled by them, to the point that I feel it my duty to warn them to flee from the “wrath that will be,” by obeying the gospel of his Son. I ask you, Welshmen, how can you be so blind as to fulfill the foregoing prophecy so completely, while you have the Bible in your own hands? has the Lord sent you “strong delusion, that you should believe a lie?”

So it is of no importance, is it, for you to know, or even talk about! that kind of damning apathy is not in the language of the Bible or reason; Christ himself commanded just the opposite, namely “Watch and pray always, that ye may be accounted worthy to escape all these things that shall come on the earth, and to stand before the Son of Man. Take heed to yourselves, lest that day come upon you suddenly.” It was of importance to the apostles to know when he would come, for they asked him, what would be the sign that would show or foretell his coming? I think that that was the only time for them to ask for a sign, and I do not know of any other circumstance in which it would have been permissible to request a sign; and the occasion appears to have been appropriate to excuse them, since it was important for them to know; and he gave ample and obvious signs to prove the time of his coming. And since it was necessary for them to know the time, how much more important it is for us to search, concerning the time when the end will come. Paul exhorts the Thessalonians to comfort each other with these sayings, namely the resurrection of the just, and the transformation of those who remain, and who will be snatched up in the air to meet him. He says that he does not need to write to them to tell them the times, &c., because they already know that, he says, for it is one of the

basic topics of those who are in Christ; they had already searched and talked about it, until they knew about it (see 2 Thes. iv, 18; v, 1). Having portrayed that remarkable day, when he would fold the heavens in his hand like a book, &c., he says, "Therefore, we ought to give the more earnest heed to the things which we have heard, lest at any time we should let them slip." Peter also brings these things to mind, 2 Peter iii, 1, 2, "I stir up your pure minds by way of remembrance: That ye may be mindful of the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets, and of the commandment of us the apostles of the Lord, and Savior," &c. Negligence in considering this matter is in violation of the commandment, contrary to the scriptures, and endangers the souls of men, proclaiming peace when there is no peace in them, and telling them that he is delaying his coming, and that it will not come in their days, neither is there a promise of his coming to the earth; because of this that day will come as a thief in the night, as Peter says, "In the which the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat, the earth also and the works that are therein shall be burned up. Seeing then that all these things shall be dissolved, what manner of persons ought ye to be in all holy conversation and godliness, looking for and hasting unto the coming of the day of God, wherein the heavens being on fire shall be dissolved, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat? Wherefore, beloved, seeing that ye look for such things, be diligent that ye may be found of him in peace. And seeing ye know these things before, beware lest ye be led away with the error of the wicked," (see 2 Peter iii). "Searching what, or what manner of time the Spirit of Christ which was in them did signify, when it testified beforehand the suffering of Christ, and the glory that should follow. Girding up the loins of your mind, and being sober, ye hope to the end for the grace that is to be brought unto you at the revelation of Jesus Christ." "Be ye therefore ready also, for the Son of Man cometh at an hour when ye think not."

Now, since a crown has been placed in keeping for that day, for all who love His appearance, then it is important for all to understand, not only the manner, but also the time of his coming, lest that day come on them suddenly like a thief; and if we do not understand the time of his coming, how can we hope to the end for the grace that is to be brought to those (and only to those who hope,

wait for, and love His appearance). We see that this matter is one of the fundamental topics of the apostolic Church, and that Jesus says several things that are to precede this time, so that the Saints will lift up their heads, since the time of their deliverance is nigh, and so that they will watch and pray, and hope; and how can they hope without hope, and how can they have hope without knowledge of it? and thus I fear that this age, among other religionists who are proclaiming peace, will deny his coming in person on the earth, ignoring the prophecies that show that clearly, until they are caught by the snares, in misunderstanding his *second* coming, just as the Jews in the same manner failed to recognize in his first coming. We see that it is important for us to understand the matter, for not only the prophets, but also the apostles, exhort us to search for the time the Spirit refers to, when it foretells of his coming; but the time has been shown so clearly, that it is easy (if one is unbiased) to understand.

Objection.—Some say that these things have been fulfilled, that the Son of Man already came at the destruction of Jerusalem; because after noting all the foregoing things, it says in verse 34, “Verily I say unto you, this generation shall not pass, till all these things be fulfilled.”

Answer—That statement is as if confirming the first assertion; yet with closer scrutiny, the second thought shows the error of that, and shows it to be impossible, and if we have a glance at the things named by Christ previously, those that were to take place first, we can see that he was not referring in any way to the age in which he lived, or to the generation that was contemporary with that time either; for he told his disciples in verse 3, in answer to two very important questions; their life depended on the answer to the first, and the life of everyone of us in this age depends on recognizing and understanding the second; consequently, we shall try to understand as such.

(To be continued.)

REMARKS OF W. GIBSON ON THE BOOK OF MORMON.

MR. ED.,—Because I have benefited from the above remarks of brother Gibson on the Book of Mormon, I have supposed that the

same remarks would benefit others, by exercising their minds, and enriching them with reasons for believing in the divinity of that book. My wish is for the blessing of God to follow these remarks wherever they go.

Yours in Christ,

Llwyn-y-gell, Ffestiniog.

DAVID ROBERTS.

As our faith in the Book of Mormon, as a record of the ancient inhabitants of America, written by commandment of God, revealed by the ministration of an angel, and translated by the gift and power of God, is looked upon by this generation as a proof of the extreme folly and ignorance of the Latter-day Saints in general; I shall give a few reasons for believing that the coming forth of such a record, is perfectly consistent with reason, scripture, and the character of God.

I shall commence by quoting the testimony of the apostle Paul. Acts xvii, 24—26,—“God who made the world and all things therein, seeing that he is Lord of heaven and earth, dwelleth not in temples made with hands, neither is worshipped with men’s hands, as though he needeth anything; seeing he giveth to all life and breath, and all things; and hath made of one blood all nations of men to dwell on all the face of the earth, and hath determined the times before appointed, and the bounds of their habitation.” From this passage we learn first, that wherever we find men upon the face of the earth, that they are all of one blood (and the offspring of God, see verse 29); and if one man should come into the world in an age of darkness and ignorance, and another in an age of light and intelligence, it was God who determined the times before appointed, and thus the particular time when we should dwell on the earth has been determined before by God, and not only this, but the particular part of the earth, where we should dwell: thus, if one part of mankind is born in Britain, another in Hindostan, another in Turkey, and another in the wilds of America, it was God who appointed the bounds of their habitation.

I shall next take the testimony of Peter concerning the character

of God. Acts x, 34—"Then Peter opened his mouth and said, of a truth I perceive that God is no respecter of persons; but in every nation he that feareth him and worketh righteousness, is accepted of him."—See also Paul's testimony. 1 Timothy ii, 3, 4.—"For this is good and acceptable in the sight of God our Savior, who will have all men to be saved, and come to the knowledge of the truth." But I would here ask, can a man fear God who has never heard of him? can a man work righteousness, without a knowledge of His will? Again, if God wants all men to be saved, can a man be saved without faith in Jesus Christ? If not, how can a man believe in him of whom he hath never heard? And how can he hear without a preacher? and how can he preach except he be sent? See Romans x, 14. If, as Paul says, God wants all men to come to the knowledge of the truth, we find that knowledge cannot be obtained without revelation. Hear what Jesus Christ says on this subject. John xvii, 3.—"And this is life eternal, that they might know thee the only true God, and Jesus Christ whom thou has sent." Then, if it is eternal life to come to the knowledge of this truth, how is this knowledge to be obtained? See Luke x, 22.—Jesus says, "All things are delivered to me of my Father, and no man knoweth who the Son is but the Father, and who the Father is, but the Son, and he to whom the Son will reveal Him." So then we find that men cannot be saved without revelation. How can they hear without a preacher, and how shall they preach except they be sent?

Has God then ever given revelation, and sent inspired men to preach to any portion of mankind? O, yes, we are told that He sent them in ancient days to Asia, to Africa, and to Europe; but these things are all done away now, and none but the foolish Mormons believe that God ever gave any revelation, or had any inspired preachers in America. Why not, my Christian friends? could the red men be saved without revelation? No, or Christ speaks falsely; are they not of one blood with us? Yes, or Paul speaks falsely; and was it not God who appointed to the red man the bounds of his habitation? Now, prove to me that God gave revelation, and sent inspired men to Asia, to Africa, and to Europe, and gave none to America; and you

prove God to be a respecter of persons, Peter a liar, and the Bible a fable; so then, my Christian friends, you can take your choice.

(To be continued.)

TRANSLATION OF THE BOOK OF MORMON.

MR. ED.,—My heart cannot help but rejoice and leap for joy upon seeing that the time is near, for the Welsh to be privileged with a translation of that remarkable and useful book, namely the BOOK OF MORMON, into Welsh. And indeed, if the bards of Wales would just consider this great thing that is taking place in their age, it would be impossible for their poetic gift not to stir, and sing in great rejoicing; for while this book is in the English language, its light for the Welsh is only like the light of the moon; but when we have it in the Welsh language, we shall have it like the light of the sun. And upon seeing that that time is near, my spirit gladdened, and my poetic gift kindled within me; as a result I sang as follows:—

Rejoice, all you monoglot Welshmen,
 We shall have the wish of us all,
 Namely the translation of the BOOK OF MORMON
 Into our harmonious and unfading language;
 The fullness of times has come,
 For the God of heaven to give to us,
 The secrets he gave to Mormon,
 And his dear associates.

Here is the book that for many years,
 Namely for fourteen hundred,
 Was in the earth at Cumorah,
 Like some fair and beautiful treasure;
 It was like the setting sun
 For such a long time:
 Now it is like the shining sun
 Rising to do its work.

Its light is spreading,
 Through different languages of the world,
 Now it is coming to the Welsh,
 Oh, how lovely it gladdens our hearts;
 “And at that day the deaf
 Will hear the words of this book,
 The eyes of the blind will see out
 Of the cloud and darkness,” I know.

The light of the Book is so dazzling,
That it darkens the weak eyes,
But the eyes will grow strong again,
They will see better presently;
An object of great surprise to the Welsh,
Will be the Book of Mormon when it comes,
In the language of their birth;
Now it is almost here.

Flint.

THOMAS CONWAY.

THE MORMONS.

[Copied from the "New York Tribune" by "Reynold's Newspaper."]

THE Mormons have repossessed their old station in Carson Valley, and with greatly increased numbers, and they intend to settle there permanently. They desire to possess all of it, and in their hands it will become very valuable, since that is the only place convenient for settling between their lands in the Great Salt Lake Valley and California. All the valley is well watered, and is covered by excellent grass. The name "valley" in that part of the country means land that can be cultivated, and which lies at the base of the mountains, to the north, and facing the Great Salt Lake, and is about twenty-five miles long, and fifteen miles wide. The Mormons have extended their settlements at the foot of the mountains, to the north, and facing the Great Salt Lake, for seventy miles, and near the Bear River Ferry. They take up all the lands in the Valley quickly. Each one possesses and owns that which he can enclose and cultivate. Generally they are satisfied with a little farm holding, namely from forty to one hundred acres. They are a very industrious people, and their reforms are useful and good. Their houses are small and tidy, built from "adobes," which are made of blue clay. They have mills in the mountainous *canyons*: and they fell many trees which they sell in the city for 50 dollars per thousand (feet). The Mormons have gone together in making a railway to the mountains, for about seven or eight miles, to carry materials along it for their large temple. The city covers much land, and it is perhaps the most rural city in the world, since every man receives one acre-and-a-quarter for his house

and his garden. Their count of the city and the surrounding cities comes to 18,000.

[We can observe that there is no one in America, where they know best, who dares to say that the Mormons are lazy and idle men, as the occasional ignorant man in Wales suggests. If there are some here who do not work with their hands, they are not lazy, rather they are diligent in the work of God.—ED.]

THE "WELSH WOMAN" AND THE MORMONS.

AT the beginning of this month, we became acquainted, for the first time, with the "Welsh Woman" from Cardiff, and we understood at once that she had something to say about the Mormons; and in order to be able to listen to her, we gave twopence for her to come home with us. But, poor thing, she also has the same old tales, namely the great deceit about Joseph Smith and his Book of Mormon. What does the "Welsh Woman" know about Joseph Smith and the Book of Mormon? Nothing—she repeats what other people say, who have been proven false many times. We do not have patience at present to answer the tales the "Welsh Woman" tells us; let her read the various treatises, in Welsh and English, published by the Mormons, in order to know otherwise. But there is one thing she says that is worthy of a little of our attention, namely what she says about "Captain D. J." and his "spiritual wife," together with the twenty-five the president has. No matter who wrote this in a letter, the Welsh Woman, by publishing it in her monthly, transgresses the law of the land: and we would not be surprised, when Capt. D. Jones arrives back here, if this Welsh Woman and others, are punished, for their calumny. Ieuan Gwynedd, the head of the Welsh Woman, thinks perhaps he can escape, because he has not used the full name; but that is a lack of understanding. Perhaps he will be taught better, unless he repents greatly; it is time to silence men who tell *too many* lies, even if they were Reverends. On page 304 of the "Welsh Woman" under scrutiny, it says, "If these things are true [about Capt. D. J., &c.] it is our duty to publish them for the sake of the Mormons, and for the sake of the public. If they are not true, it is a shame that such things are being spread." Do you hear the "Welsh Woman" admitting that

she is publishing calumny of the worst nature, before determining if the thing is true! This is teaching for the women of Wales! teaching them to transgress the law of the land! Capt. D. J. would not do more than that, if he were to keep a "spiritual wife." We hope the editors take warning from now on, that they be not too ready to go into the snare: there are many in it at present, and they shall continue in it until "Capt. D. J." sees fit to set them free. We hope that the "Welsh Woman" will not be a "pillar of salt" for the editors, instead of "Salt Lake City being a pillar of salt to mankind."

THE TWENTY-FOURTH OF JULY.

A FESTIVAL was held in the Valley again this year, on the above date, in memory of the coming of the Pioneers to that place. The king of the day was welcomed by the roar of cannons, and lovely music flowing from the great musical carriage. There was a parade as usual, consisting of the Nauvoo Brass Band, the military band, *pioneers* '47, the regency, the aged fathers, young lads, followed by mothers in Israel, young girls, young men, and young women, the Presidency, together with the officers of the Territory. In their rear were the twenty-four bishops, four abreast: and it can be said of the banners, the emblems of art, the music, &c., that they could only be surpassed in the armies of heaven. The day was spent in the most pleasant way, with orations, singing, &c.; and in the evening a little dancing was permitted. There is no practice there of consuming intoxicating drinks, but all are free of their agitation, and consequently, able to enjoy themselves better. A full account has not yet come; and if we had it, we could not find space for it this time, but perhaps the next time.

WILLIAM THOMAS AGAIN.

MR. ED.,—I am very happy to inform you that the explanation you gave, together with what I received from your president William Phillips, on the points that appeared contradictory to me, have provided me with complete satisfaction. I feel grateful to God for that; for had I been left in darkness, concerning those things, my life

would have painful to me, because the reasons I had in favor of the work being from God were much stronger than those that caused me to doubt it. I now know through experience that it is difficult to kick against the pricks; I tried many times to harden myself, and not to notice you or your religion, but I could not, despite my best efforts to do so. My thoughts were troubled day and night. I was keeping myself apart from my fellow workers at meal times, pretending to be asleep, in order to be left alone by them to meditate somehow to calm my troubled mind; but I constantly failed in this, until I was enlightened by you. God knows that what I have said is true. Now, I am asking your forgiveness personally for all you have seen out of place with me.

I am also asking forgiveness from all the Saints for everything they have seen out of place with me. I am also asking for a part in their prayers, and for the Lord to strengthen me to keep the determination that is presently in me until the end; and that is to accept baptism without delay, and to live humbly among you until the end; for unless I do this, I cannot be at ease in this world; and how will it be for me in the world to come? I cannot expect less than to be guilty before the Judge. I cannot deceive myself into thinking it possible that I can please him by joining with any other party, for there is not one of them like the believers of the Gospel of Jesus Christ; and what good would it be to join with unbelievers?

Yours, &c.,

WILLIAM THOMAS.

[We are glad to see our correspondent repenting, according to our wish in a previous issue; and we feel happy to grant him forgiveness. He can expect better light from now on, since understanding the word of God. The meaning of the sayings of God cannot be found through arguing about words; for at best the language of man is quite imperfect. Only the Spirit of God comprehends the things of God; and if we have not the Spirit of God, there is no light in us, despite possessing good mental prowess. Therefore, let the Saints pray for the light of the Spirit of God, so they will not be in darkness; for if they go into too much darkness, neither we, nor anyone else, can enlighten them, for they will know too much for themselves.—ED.]

ON THE DEATH OF ELDER J. H. FLANIGAN.

TUNE—"Sweet Jessie."

O, FLANIGAN, Flanigan, why hast thou left us,
 To live in the midst of old oppressive Babel,
 Which is unceasingly corrupting its subjects?
 Without dread it despises the pure laws of our God;
 While thou wert here, thou didst defend us
 Against all device, slander, and betrayal,
 Thou wert our shield from the arrows of the enemy,
 Thou wert our tower, yea, thou wert our father.

Heavy was the blow, and great is our sorrow,
 At losing such a virtuous man as thou;
 With the words of life thou didst feed us,
 From terrible storms thou didst protect us;
 And again from falling between the hooves of the warhorse,
 Which wishes to destroy the beloved of heaven,
 O send, O send, from the courts of glory,
 Some powerful angel to fill thy place.

(ANSWER OF THE SPIRIT.)

You dear children of Zion, rest upon God,
 Why do you grieve after such a poor subject?
 You proponents of truth, lift up your heads;
 If you are in tribulation, there is bliss to be found.
 Proclaim through the countries the gospel of Jesus,
 Strive your hearts to keep pure;
 Let every fold listen to the voice of its brave shepherd,
 And then safe you will truly be.

Despite being shamed, rejected, and persecuted,
 Every second by false religionists of the world,
 Consider that it was thus also with the Prince of Life,
 And thus he promised to all of you:
 Though your tabernacles are shattered by the prince of death,
 Again you will appear in the courts of the light,
 And there among the heavenly beings,
 To God for his design you will sound his praise.

Merthyr.

JOHN REYNOLDS, JR.

 RESPONSE TO "DAVID TELL-THE-TRUTH" IN THE
 "INQUIRER" FOR OCTOBER, PAGE 236.

MR. ED.,—For two reasons I am sending this response to the TRUMPET, instead of to the "Inquirer," namely because I am not completely convinced that it would appear there, any more than my

last answer to Philoletes; and because my voice will be louder in a TRUMPET, and it will reach further, yes, to David's ears if possible, if not further.

David directs his letter to me personally, and testifies "that it is not out of a whim or peevishness, that I direct these few lines to you, J. R., Dinas, but out of a wish to convince you." To be sure, David; do you have the Spirit of God? "No," says David, "I do not secure that like the *Mormons*." Well, then, how can you convince me without the Spirit of God, for it is he that convinces the world of sin, of righteousness, and of judgment; and since you are destitute of that Spirit, you are unable to convince me of judgment; thus, David, your arrows cannot be anything more than rush-like and ineffective to reach their purpose. I leave unnoticed your condemnation of me, since you have not been placed as a judge over me, and remember the saying of the scriptures, that "with what judgment ye judge, ye shall be judged."

You said also that I say, that in the church I belong to, there are prophets, speaking in tongues, interpretation, and that I have a testimony, &c. True, David, you have testified the same things, but you have changed your opinion by now, that the prophets belong to Baal, and that the interpretation of tongues, &c., is fraudulent. Did you, David, not testify, that those like myself are godly, and truthful? If so, I ask, what sin did you commit to cause you to be excommunicated? and why did you testify of that, without knowing with certainty before hand? perhaps, David, you were guilty of the same thing of which you accused me; thus you are a libeler. "Oh," says David, "I did not testify as the saints do." Well, what was your errand, in meeting with a society of the Saints? was it to come in as a tall, unbending man to spy on our freedom? to continue there for a space of time, to search out the faults of those who had authority to teach you, instead of bowing as a small and humble man before God, and asking him for a witness of the divinity of the Mormon religion?

You proved that there are prophets in the church, through the example of the prophecy about the Cholera. The prophecy was fulfilled literally, except that David had "curtailed much" of it

according to his testimony at the end of his article; thus when the plague came, it brought terrible destruction on men, and it got hold of one of the preachers of the Saints, who shouted "Doctor, doctor!" He died, poor man, although, as it is with David, the promise was the opposite. The reason it is not all true is, because David disconnected the condition from it; all the prophecies, laws, and promises of God to the Saints, are conditional, but David curtailed the conditions from the promises contained in his entire article, and his testimony is that I know that he has "curtailed much." This is true, David, but not fair. You said that I said, that I had not seen "a single disorder" among the Saints. Where, and in what place did I say that, David? if possible, indicate that, so that your new name will not be inappropriate, and so that you will not fall into disgrace again because of that. You said that "all the prophecies were alike." Exactly, D., all true, had they not been curtailed, except for an occasional exception.

Next, you wish for a sign, or to know who wrote your article; have you, David, forgotten? or else do you not recognize yourself? or, do you want to scorn me? Pull your cloak tight around you, and then perhaps some of the Saints can recognize you, if you yourself cannot. As for your speaking in tongues, and interpretations, &c., you lower the tongues to a level beneath that of the animals of the field, but greatly elevate the power of the Mormons to interpret, interpreting easily a language more difficult than the language of the unreasoning creatures. I have not been in the same branch with David; I cannot know about the tongues he heard; but as for the interpretation, it was verified; for you, David, were there, but have now left, and are striving to harm the Saints greatly; that should convince you, by seeing the literal fulfillment of that which you testified of hearing! David, consider this! "Oh," says David, "I heard another interpretation for the same words, namely "Pray, my Spirit is being offered to you abundantly." Well, David, I do not know, since I was not there; but this I do know, that that is possible, and that the church is of God; for it is clear that there were such things previously, and why can they no longer exist? Paul says, "Let the prophets speak two or three, and let the other judge," &c.: thus, if it were not possible to speak under the direction of false spirits, there would have been no need for the apostle to say, "Prove the spirits, whether they are of God;" and what need was there to judge, unless it was of God?

Therefore, if you heard, David, that is what you said. Was that the foundation for you to say it was all false? No, no, for it was prophesied that the cholera would come, and it came; it was interpreted that some would leave the Saints, and do them great harm, and David left, and he is harming us. (Reader! see the sight of David, poor thing, with his cloak around his head for shame.) David, my Holy Ghost understands all languages (you can keep your shilling), but I do not understand what is *tara marra lal a fara*, &c.; but I do know there is a great increase among the Saints, and that the honest are pouring into our midst, and the dishonest are going out. *All the better.*

"Yes," says David, "I heard another interpretation to the same words." It is difficult for me to believe that you, D., are sufficiently clever to grasp the details of what you heard, or enough of a stenographer to set them down exactly as they were spoken, but that you had come into our midst to seek perfection, and failed to obtain it. Again, regardless of what the nine-year-old boy spoke, the interpretation was true, which was, "Some of you disbelieve, and that is why I have spoken this." You, David, were there, and you were a disbeliever; and Mr. *Diabele*, stirred you to observe the lad, instead of having a repentant spirit for your awful disbelief. Why did you, David, join with superstitious pagans? give your reasons for that. Your assertion, David, is that *phantoms of the brain* are the spiritual influences of the Saints. Anyone who looks at your image, will see that *phantoms* (illusions), of a very unsavory kind, are what keep you, David, in so much darkness, that you fail to see that which was, and still is obvious to every thinking man.

Now, I must finish, hoping that David will not curtail anything next time, and that he will take care rather of his own character, than that of the "Inquirer;" and I would greatly love for him to pull his cloak down. What need is there to fear embracing the truth?

Dinas.

J. RICHARDS.

WIFE—MISTRESS—LADY.

THE following is a correct translation from the German, which appeared in English in the "Frontier Guardian:"—

"He who marries for love, takes a wife; he who marries for

convenience, takes a mistress; he who marries out of consideration, takes a lady. You will be loved by your wife, respected by your mistress, and tolerated by your lady. You have a wife for yourself, a mistress for your house and friends, and a lady for the world. Your wife will agree with you, your mistress permits, and your lady rules over you. Your wife will take care of your family, your mistress will take care of your house, and your lady will take care of her appearance. When you are sick your wife will nurture you, your mistress will visit you, and your lady will inquire as to your health. You walk with your wife, ride on horseback with your mistress, and join in company with your lady. Your wife will share your troubles, your mistress your money, and your lady your debts. If you die, your wife will shed tears, your mistress will grieve, and your lady will wear clothes of mourning. Within a year after your death your wife will marry again, your mistress within six months, and your lady within six weeks, or sooner.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

 Those who send for fewer copies of the TRUMPET violate the promise they made at the beginning of the year, and deceive the Church into lowering the price of the publication, by sending for a large number at the beginning of the year, and then lowering it by half. Those who send for more are to be commended, and the others are to be judged as unfaithful stewards.

NORTHERN CONFERENCES.—The Flintshire Conference will be held on the 16th of November; Denbighshire, on the 23rd; Conwy Valley, on the 30th; Anglesey, on the 7th of December; and Merionethshire, on the 14th.

PAYMENTS FROM OCTOBER 3 TO OCTOBER 16.—Breconshire, 7s 6c; West Glamorgan, £2 1s 7c; Caernarvonshire, £1 10s; Monmouthshire, £8; Dinas, 14s 3½c; Llanilltyd, 3s 10c; Pontytypridd, £1 11s 9c; Llanfalon, 12s 4½c; Pendaulwyn, 18s 9c; Twynnyrodyn, £1 2s 3c; Llandaff, 11s 6c; Aberdare, £7 13s 5c; Dowlais, 6s 7½c; Hirwaun, 10s 6c; Rhymney, £4; Cwmnedd, 2s 10c; Merthyr, £2; Pendaren, 10s 7c; Cefn, £1 0s 5c; Ynysgau, 2s 10c; Eglwysnewydd, 5s 6c; Gorllwyn, £2 6s 6c; Ffynnon Tydfil, 4s 6c.—Total, £35 17s 6½c.

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ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 22.]

NOVEMBER 1, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.]

COMING OF THE SON OF MAN.

[Continued from page 320.]

THE FIRST question is, as is seen in verse 3, "Tell us, when shall these things be?" What things? verse 2, "There shall not be left here (the temple) one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down."

The second question was, "And what shall be the sign of thy coming, and of the end of the world?" Jesus answers the two questions in an important, clear, and irrefutable manner. He answers them twice, and in two manners, so they would be sure to understand. We have in this chapter, that he was, according to the usual custom of the prophets, answering the last question first, giving a collection of the most notable things that would take place from that time to the end; and he warns them to take heed lest the false Christians deceive them; and there would be wars; but despite that, the end was not to follow the first wars, namely the armies of the Romans against Jerusalem, which disproves the objection in itself, that is to say, although Jerusalem was destroyed, that was not the end, nor were all the things that preceded that verse. We also have in the same chapter, that nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom; and there would be famine and pestilence, and earthquakes; all this was the beginning of tribulation, in comparison to what would come afterwards. And after that we learn that sore persecution would come upon

the saints, that many would be killed, and they would be hated of all nations for his name's sake, whether all this took place in their time or not; but it is not likely that that could have been, for Christ in this chapter refers to the last time; and because of the persecution many would be obstructed, and they would betray one another. Also, many false prophets would rise, which proves the complete opposite of this general reference given to this statement, namely, that every one who professes to be a prophet, of necessity is a false prophet; the statement in and of itself proves irrefutably that there would be true prophets, or then that Jesus had used an idle word, for Christ did not warn them to beware of prophets, but the false ones; and why would he use the word false, unless there were true ones? It is impossible to have the former without having the latter also, any more than counterfeit bills could be made on one bank, if there were no authentic bills; thus our merciless accusers about false prophets, confirm our position, by destroying themselves with their own weapons, and proving that Christ said that when he would send true prophets, the devil would send false prophets, in the last days, which would introduce destructive heresies, until the love of many would wax cold. But those who remained faithful to the end, would be saved. It does not mean that those who remain until the end of the world, will be the only ones saved, or what would become of those who have died? nor does it mean just to the end of the tribulations and destruction of Jerusalem. But the word "end" in this place refers to the end of their lives, until death, and proves the need of watching and being faithful. He gives some extraordinary signs of that which would take place before the fulfillment of the second question, namely that the end would come, which are as follows: "and this gospel of the kingdom shall be preached in all the world, for a witness unto all nations, and then (and not before that), shall the end come." After saying these pestilences which would precede the end, he answers the first question, namely, about the destruction of Jerusalem, in verse 15, "When he therefore shall see the abomination of desolation," which was spoken by Dan. xi, 31; viii, 11, 12; xii, 7. Luke says clearly in chapter xxi, 20, what is that abomination of desolation: "And when he shall see Jerusalem compassed with armies, then know that the desolation thereof is nigh. For these be the days of vengeance, that all things which are written may be fulfilled." Those hosts were the armies of the Romans under Titus; and

historians say that he ordered his soldiers (after conquering the city) to knock down all the walls, and not to leave one stone on another; to fulfill the prophecy about it, having killed over one-and-a-half million Jews. These are the days of vengeance, says Christ; and they will lead captive among all the nations, and Jerusalem will be trodden down of the Gentiles, until the time of the Gentiles be fulfilled; "then there shall be great tribulation, such as was not (on the Jewish nation) since the beginning of the world to this time, no, nor ever shall be (on the Jews). And except those days should be shortened, there should no flesh be saved, but for the elect's sake those days shall be shortened." The Jews are these elect; those days, the time of their affliction and their captivity; the length of this time which will be shortened, is, says Daniel; "until a time, times, and half a time, from the time the holy people are scattered." Then they will be gathered back to their land, but until that time would be the days of vengeance, to fulfill all the things that were written. Luke says, "until the time of the Gentiles be fulfilled. And Paul, in Rom. xi, "until the fullness of the Gentiles be come in" to the new covenant which God would make in the last days; and then all Israel would be saved, says Moses, after being punished until they receive the double of all their sins, especially for having destroyed the Holy One of Israel, and killed their Messiah. See Deut. xxx, 4, "If any of thine be driven unto the outmost parts of heaven, from thence will the Lord thy God gather thee." But John says they would be scattered for one thousand two hundred and sixty days, or forty-two months, which is the same. Until this time there would be incomparable oppression on the Jews; in this very time, after the destruction of Jerusalem, false prophets, and false Christs would come, who would work miracles and wonders, which, say historians, were fulfilled by the beast that John saw, see Rev. xiii, "Unto him was given a mouth speaking blasphemy, and power was given unto him to continue forty and two months. And he doeth great wonders, so that he maketh fire come down from heaven on the earth in the sight of men," which was literally brought to pass. But these false Christs were to deceive the holy people most particularly, namely, the Jewish nation; and historians say that many came in the ages after that, and deceived many of the Jews, saying that the time was coming to build Jerusalem, that they were the Messiah; and thus many of the Jews were destroyed by trying to build the city in many ages, and they were scattered every time until

now, which proves that the time of the Gentiles has not been fulfilled; although many of the above signs have been fulfilled, yet not all of them; it must be recognized that the Jews are still wanderers across the entire world; thus, Christ cannot be referring to this age when he said, "This generation shall not pass, till all these things be fulfilled." Furthermore, that the Jews are in their scattered state proves these things, namely that the oppressive time, and those days of vengeance have not yet been fulfilled; Christ says, "the Son of Man would come the second time like lightning out of the east unto the west, and immediately after the tribulation of those days shall the sun be darkened, the moon shall not give her light, and the stars shall fall from heaven, and the powers of the heavens shall be shaken; then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn, and they (everyone) shall see him coming in the clouds of heaven, with power and great glory;" thus the matter shows clearly that the aforementioned days had not been fulfilled with the destruction of Jerusalem, nor in the twelve hundred and sixty years after that; but before the coming of the Son of Man, he will send his angels (his fishermen and his hunters) to gather his elect (the Jews, and all those who are brought into the new covenant, through obedience to the gospel, until they come to know God through it, and receive a right to the blessings of Abraham, &c.,) from the four winds. All this was to take place before the time to which Christ referred could happen, when he said, "this generation shall not pass, till all these things be fulfilled:" they were first to fall by the edge of the sword, and to be trodden under the feet of the gentiles, until the fulfilling of the time of the gentiles."—I ask those who assert that all those things have been fulfilled in this age, Where is it proved that the sun has become as sackcloth? It could be that they are thinking of that great darkness that lasted for three hours, when He was crucified: that was not at the time of his coming, but at his departure from the world the first time; and the great darkness before his second coming, says Zechariah, was to last for three days. When did the moon turn to blood, and when were all the family of the planetary depths seen as frightened, agitated, leaping from their orbits, and fleeing from his presence to the depths of space? When were the foundations of heaven shaken? It says that all this would be accomplished before his coming, and it says in Zechariah xiv, 6, when the Son of Man comes, with his feet standing on the mount of Olives, "that there would be no more night, there would be no more

sun, moon, or star, in the firmament of the sky." Peter says, Acts iii, that there will be a restitution of all things as they were created when they came from the hand of their Creator, when he said, "behold, it was very good." This blessed time has not yet come, has it? nevertheless, that generation has already passed, along with seventeen others after it, and all things stand as in the beginning, without all the things coming to pass. Then the brilliant rays of the sun, when like a giant it runs its course through the sky, the bright light of the moon that lights our steps along town and country in darkness of night; yes, the entire host of the heavenly bodies, and their little *satellites*, which travel their orbits, are as many witnesses that deny the argument, and confirm each time they appear, that it was not to *that age* the Son of God was referring when he said, "*this* generation shall not pass," &c.; and also that the Son of man was not to come in that age, but that he is to come in the determined and appointed time. All the lights of the planetary depths proclaim with one voice, We have been set to do nothing more than to travel our orbits for a determined time; but when that appointed time comes, we will all escape to the depths of the land of oblivion like things that were, before the brilliance of his presence; there will be no need for us to cast our light at that time, for He will be the light of all the world, when he comes; yes, all the wretchedness and moans of the earthly creatures, all the rocks and mountains, all the islands of the world, all the thorns and brambles, and thistles of the earth, will remind us when we feel their sting, and when we see their imperfections, and when we hear their lament and their groans, bearing a sure witness that all the above things have not been fulfilled; and when the Son of man comes, they will disappear from view, they will cease to be of the world, for the enmity between man and animal will end, and there will be peace over the whole earth.

In order to show the inconsistency and the foolishness of the above argument, let us see where it leads us. The prophets say, when the Son of Man comes the second time, his powerful angels and all his saints will come with him. Paul says that all who were dead in Christ will resurrect with him, with bodies like his glorified body; then the living and those who were left will be snatched up to meet him in the air. Isaiah says, "Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise;" and Enoch says that the Lord will come with myriads of his angels. Thus, we see, if he has already

come, all the dead in Christ must have arisen, and all the saints on the earth must have been changed into one form with his glorified body; and since they are to be with him forever after that, then they were to be kings and priests to God, and to reign with him on the earth. If this has all been fulfilled, and if they have come, where are they? Let us look for them in every corner of the earth, until we find them; perhaps they are in some corner of it yet! But the scriptures say, that he would be king over all the earth, and would govern over all things; that all the kingdoms of the world would become His—that the knowledge of him would fill the earth, as the waves of the waters of the sea. There will be no need to search for him; for at that day all will know the Lord, from the greatest to the least of them. All the saints will be with him, and like him; and all the ungodly will be burned with the breath of his mouth when he comes! Then, the argument is foolishness, namely that Christ refers to that age, when he says, “*This generation shall not pass, &c.—(To be continued.)*”

DUTIES OF THE PRESIDENTS.

MR. EDITOR,—I received an anonymous letter recently, but the person who wrote it was a counselor, so he said, in some place. He did not specify which place; and he was asking for a bit of light; namely what are the duties of the counselors with regard to their president, and those of the president with regard to his counselors? Now, I wish to make these things known through the TRUMPET, if you please, and shed some light on the matter.

The duty of every president is to be a president, and to be sure to act according to the appointment he has received, despite everything; and to take care not to be led by anyone under him, but only those who preside over him. Some presidents who are unlearned are sometimes tempted, to give way to their counselors who are learned to preside over them; and the instant that takes place, there is the cart before the horse; and that is totally awkward on the street, is it not? and it is much more awkward on God's path. It is a good thing to be learned, if the learned just govern themselves, and turn in their own circles. Some who are learned tend to go up to the garret. Presidents, *call them down.*

There is another group, completely useless to build the kingdom of God, namely those who think too poorly of themselves; and these are the people who go down to the *cellar* and become a *stop tap* there.

These two groups get lost very often, and we find some up, some down; and it causes a great deal of trouble for me and other brethren; and they are a great obstacle in carrying forth with the work of God. The world is not in the least, an obstacle in carrying the work of God forth. I count the wisest of the wise as nothing, and give a challenge to the world. The aforementioned groups, together with the sins of others, are the only ones who have the power to keep this wheel from turning. And that is but for a short season, until God has come to the field, to speak with power through his servants, until all flesh will tremble, and all devils flee.

But let us get to the point. The duty of the president is to love his counselors, and to counsel with them concerning the best way to carry things forward; and the duty of the counselors is to love their president. There are circumstances that permit when the president can put things before, or organize things, without counseling with anyone; and if they are nearby or present, it would be well for him to counsel with them. The abilities of three are greater; there are three faiths in place of one; and their plans will be sure to succeed, if they are in a unity of faith. The nearer they live to one another, the better, so they can work together to move things forward. It is not good for them to live far from each other, unless they have frequent meetings. The president can say to his counselors, you go this way, and you that way; and I shall stay home: for that is where the branch presidents are always needed, except for some occasions. No one is able to perform the task of presiding, except for the person who is appointed. And let every counselor consider it a privilege for him to obey, and put into action, the counsels of his president. That is enough light on that for now.

Another thing. Let the president of the districts send here to me the six-month reports of their districts, by the 5th day of next December. The report should be made up to the 1st day of December. The things that I am requesting, are the number of branches, high

priests, elders, priests, teachers, deacons; excommunicated, deaths, emigrations, baptisms; current number of members; and in every case let the number of members contain the number of officers and the scattered members which do not belong to any branch, together with the name of the president and the secretary. Let the branch presidents see that their secretaries send a correct report on time to the district secretary, so that he can send them here, in time for me to send them to Liverpool by the appointed time.

Let the chief district distributors send information to Liverpool by the 10th day of December, as to how many of the MILLENNIAL STAR are requested for next year, and let the chief branch distributors send here to Bro. Richard Morris the number they are requesting.

One other bit of counsel; let the district presidents look into, and insist on seeing that a greater effort is made with the Perpetual Emigrating Fund from now on, than has been made in the past; and may God bless you, and bless the Church in Wales, in the name of Jesus Christ. Amen.

WILLIAM PHILLIPS.

14, Castle St., MerthyrTydfil, October 28, 1851.

REMARKS OF W. GIBSON ON THE BOOK OF MORMON.

[Continued from page 331.]

IF, then, it be reasonable to believe that God gave revelation to the ancient inhabitants of America, is it unreasonable to expect that he would enable them to record those revelations, and thus hand them down to posterity? Would not such things be the word of God, as much as any contained in the Bible?

But it may be asked, if they once had revelation, why did they lose it? I answer, because of transgression. Were the writings of the Old Testament never lost? Let those who think so read the second book of Kings, from the xxii, 10, to xxiii, 4, and find their error; and even yet how many books are still wanting here? I shall enumerate a few, Book of the Wars of the Lord, Numbers, xxi, 14; Book of Jasher, Joshua x, 13; Book of the Statutes of the Kings of Israel, 1

Samuel, x, 25; Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel, 1 Kings xiv, 19; Book of Enoch, Jude 14; Book of Nathan the Prophet, and the Book of Gad the Seer, 1 Chronicles xxix, 29; Book of Ahijah, and the Book of Iddo the Seer, 2 Chronicles ix, 29; and the Book of Shemeiah the Prophet, 2 Chronicles xii, 15; Book of Jehu, 2 Chron. xx. 34; Book of the Sayings of the Seers, 2 Chron. xxxiii, 19. Book of the Story of the Kings, 2 Chronicles xxi, 27. Were not these books as good scripture as the rest of the Old Testament? and if they should ever be found, are we not bound to receive them as such as well as the rest of the scripture? No, we are told, unless we have better proof of their authenticity than any we have for the truth of the Book of Mormon.

Then tell me what proof you have that the part of the Old Testament that was lost, and found by Hilki'ah, was the law of God. Read the quotation I have given above, and you will find that you have only the word of a man and a woman, Hilki'ah and Huldah. And were the writings of the New Testament never lost; no man of common sense will say they have not: and have they all been found? if any one thinks so, let him read the following passages, 1 Corinthians, v, 9; Ephesians, iii, 3; Colossians, iv, 16; Luke, i, 1. And should they be found, how will you prove their authenticity, or rather how will you prove the authenticity of those you have, which compose what is called the New Testament? Had those men who voted that the books we now have are authentic any better guide in doing so than their own opinion? if not, where is the proof of their authenticity? Who ever saw the originals? And even if anyone could see them, how could he know them to be so, without revelation? And without the originals, how can you prove which of all the various translations of the scriptures is correct? Whereas for the truth of the Book of Mormon we have had, and still have on the earth, living men, who have seen and handled the plates, or the original thereof, and some of them bear witness that it was shown them by an angel of God; and thousands of living men have received testimony of its truth, and of the truth of the testimony of the first witnesses thereunto, by the voice of the Almighty, the ministration of Angels, visions, and the witness of the Spirit of truth.

But we are often told, if you have the plates, on which the original copy of the Book of Mormon is engraved, why not show them openly? And what better would the world be if they saw them, without revelation to know what they contained; and unless God gave every man a revelation for himself, the world would still have only the testimony of those who had received this for the truth of the translation.

Paul, says to the Hebrews xi, 1, that faith is the evidence of things not seen, and that it cometh by hearing the word of God, Romans x, 17, and he also who bears witness to the word of God must be sent by God; for how can we hear without a preacher, and how can he preach except he be sent, see Romans x, 14. We find in every age of the world, men's faith in God and the things of God were founded on the testimony of a few of their fellowmen whom God called and sent to them; for instance, the world in the days of Noah, had only his testimony that God had given him, a revelation concerning the coming flood; and the world now (except for the Latter-day Saints), have only what is said to be the testimony of Moses concerning that event, the creation of the world and the fall of man, &c.

The Children of Israel, after Moses' day, believed that the holy of holies contained the ark, and that the ark contained the tables of the law, which Moses put there, with the pot of manna, Aaron's rod, that budded, &c., &c., and that the glory of the Lord appeared over the mercy seat; and what testimony had they for this? were they shown to all the people, as the wise men of this day want us to do with the plates of the Book of Mormon? No, they had only the word of the high priest for it, and he went in there only once a year.

And again, the Christian world believe in the resurrection of Jesus Christ. Has he shown himself to you, my Christian friends? did any of you parsons ever see him? I think in consistency you ought to make the same demand of him that you do of us; namely to show himself to all the people if he wants them to believe in his resurrection; and what proof have you got that he rose from the dead at all? did he show himself to all the people when that event is said to have taken place, see Acts x, 40. Did not the holy men

of that day, namely the chief priests, the scribes, and the Pharisees declare that his body was stolen from the tomb? and did not the Roman soldiers, who watched the tomb, declare that they fell asleep, and while they slept, the body was stolen by his disciples, naturally? and did not the Jews believe them? Do you not think that, under these circumstances, they were at least as much entitled to demand that he would show himself to all the people, if he wanted them to believe in his resurrection, as good men of these days are to call for a showing of the plates? Did he ever do so? no, no one saw him after he rose from the dead, but his followers; and who were they? the poor fishermen, and their companions, men who were charged with stealing his body, men who were as much despised and discredited in their day as ever the Latter-day Saints can be by this generation; and these were the men to whom Jesus said, Mark xvi, 15, "Go ye into all the world and preach the Gospel (of course the resurrection formed an essential part of it), to every creature; he that believeth and is baptized, shall be saved; and he that believeth not, shall be damned." And had the world no way of proving their testimony? Certainly they had the same way that men of this age have to prove the testimony of those who bear witness to the truth of the Book of Mormon; for when Jesus sent them into all the world to preach the gospel to every creature, they were commanded, not only to promise men salvation in the world to come, through faith and obedience to the testimony, but they were commanded to promise to those who believed that, in the name of Jesus, they should cast out devils, speak in new tongues, take up serpents, heal the sick by the laying on of their hands, &c., see Mark xvi, 15. So then everyone could know whether or not their testimony was true or false; and by the same means can the people now prove those who bear testimony to the truth of the Book of Mormon; for God has sent us to bear testimony of its truth to all the world, and to preach the gospel to every creature, declaring that he that believeth and is baptized, shall be saved, and that believeth not shall be damned; and these signs shall follow them that believe in the name of Jesus; they shall cast out devils, speak in new tongues, take up serpents, if they drink any deadly thing (unknowingly, of course)

it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick and they shall recover. So then, my Christian friends, if you reject the Book of Mormon, and our testimony of its truth, for the same reasons you must reject the Bible. But the Latter-day Saints believe them both; because he has proven the testimony of Peter and Joseph Smith both to be true, for these signs do follow them that believe.

Having now shown, I hope, that the coming forth of such a record is perfectly consistent with reason, and the character of God, and his dealings with the human family, I will next proceed to show its harmony with scripture.

(To be continued.)

POLYGAMY AGAIN.

THERE is nothing more obvious that the Saints are greatly wronged by the publications of the country, when they say that Polygamy is in their midst; for what alliance of people would publish that polygamy is a sin, while at the same time practicing it? All the books of the Saints forbid it, especially the Book of Mormon and the Doctrine and Covenants; and if the Saints were to approve of polygamy, they would not be so foolish as to say anything against it, rather they would keep it hidden, or else they would defend it. Now, for the benefit of the readers of the TRUMPET, we quote a small piece of the Welsh printing of the Book of Mormon, page 101, 102, where Jacob addresses his brethren:—

“And now, my brethren, I have spoken unto you concerning pride; and those of you which have afflicted your neighbor, and persecuted him because ye were proud in your hearts, of the things which God hath given you, what say ye of it? Do ye not suppose that such things are abominable unto him who created all flesh? And the one being is as precious in his sight as the other. And all flesh is of the dust; and for the selfsame end hath he created them, that they should keep his commandments and glorify him forever. And now I make an end of speaking unto you concerning this pride. And were it not that I must speak unto you concerning a grosser crime, my heart would rejoice exceedingly because of you. But the word of God burdens me because of your grosser crimes. For behold, thus saith the Lord, This people

begin to wax in iniquity; they understand not the scriptures; for they seek to excuse themselves in committing whoredoms, because of the things which were written concerning David, and Solomon his son. Behold, David and Solomon truly had many wives and concubines, which thing was abominable before me, saith the Lord; wherefore, thus saith the Lord, I have led this people forth out of the land of Jerusalem, by the power of mine arm, that I might raise up unto me a righteous branch from the fruit of the loins of Joseph. Wherefore, I the Lord God will not suffer that this people shall do like unto them of old. Wherefore, my brethren, hear me, and hearken to the word of the Lord; for there shall not any man among you have save it be one wife; and concubines he shall have none; for I, the Lord God, delight in the chastity of women. And whoredoms are an abomination before me; thus saith the Lord of Hosts. Wherefore, this people shall keep my commandments, saith the Lord of Hosts, or cursed be the land for their sakes. For if I will, saith the Lord of hosts, raise up seed unto me, I will command my people; otherwise they shall hearken unto these things. For behold, I, the Lord, have seen the sorrow, and heard the mourning of the daughters of my people in the land of Jerusalem, yea, and in all the lands of my people, because of the wickedness and abominations of their husbands. And I will not suffer, saith the Lord of hosts, that the cries of the fair daughters of this people, which I have led out of the land of Jerusalem, shall come up unto me against the men of my people, saith the Lord of hosts; for they shall not lead away captive the daughters of my people because of their tenderness, save I shall visit them with a sore curse, even unto destruction; for they shall not commit whoredoms, like unto them of old, saith the Lord of hosts."

VERSES.

TUNE—"God save the King."

I'll sing a happy tune
 To Him who's on the throne,
 A King above;
 His kingdom before long
 Will be seen throughout all the land,
 And hail to it indeed,
 I'll say boldly.

All Saints will join together,
 Appreciating the privilege,
 In one heart;

And shout with one voice,
A welcome unto Him
To come down from heaven;
It is now time.

To mount Zion we'll go,
For there we can see
His shining face;
There we can also meet,
To sit at his table,
Beyond the useless noise,
In glorious feast.

Angelic praise will be,
With seraphic song
Together;
The heavenly host will lend an ear
To listen to the beloved praise,
And they also will strike up
The same song.

The Holy Ghost fills
The hearts of great and small,
Throughout the beautiful throng;
All will be in lovely joy,
Without any ache or pain,
Singing praises to the Lamb,
Without ceasing.

How glorious it will be
For the Saints who are now
The object of scorn;
They'll be crowned at some time
As fair kings of the dawn;
They'll reign on the earth
In great happiness.

All the ungodly
Will be rebuked for their sin,
They will be brought down;

At this time the devil will be,
Chained in the lake;
His binding will be secure,
He'll do no more harm.

How happy will be the place,
Oh, secure your part,
You good men;
Flee from the sword's edge,
No more peace will be seen,
A host will go down to the grave,
From a great plague.

My dear and beloved family,
I'll set this in black and white,
As a dire warning;
O, come says God now,
From the corners of great Babel;
Down she will fall—
'Tis an important event.

Efestiniog.

D. ROBERTS.

NOTES, &c.

BOOK OF MORMON.—We would like to inform the subscribers of the Book of Mormon, that its segments, from the 20th on, will be a *penny* each! We congratulate our brethren for the effort they have made on its behalf. We think that it is best not to cut its pages before it is bound, lest some are lost, and cannot be replaced. Since it will be out in about six months, it is better for the most careless not to read it, rather put the segments safely aside, for binding, and after that remember to read it.

DOC. AND COV.—The “Doc. and Cov.” is now bound in beautiful leather, and the edges of the pages have been gilded in the most excellent way, price 3s 6c. Its price for district distributors is 3s., and to branch distributors, 3s 3c.

THE TRUMPET.—While the effort is being made with respect to the Book of Mormon, on no account should the TRUMPET be neglected: this publication is as necessary as anything we have; for it contains God's directions for the church in this age, which all should know. Besides that,

it is the only means we have of defending ourselves; and if the TRUMPET is not spread across the length and breadth of the land, there is no way to defend ourselves. We do not want to argue our cause before one another, rather before the world: therefore, appreciate the TRUMPET, by striving to sell it and distribute it in their midst. Remember it at the beginning of the year, so that we may get three or four thousand subscribers, instead of the two thousand and two hundred we presently have. The Book of Mormon will be finished, probably, if we are alive and healthy, by about the end of April; and then the Saints will have but a light burden from then on, since the main books will have been published. Therefore, keep in mind a good circulation for the TRUMPET next year, so that the country may see it, and so that the distributors will have something more for distributing it.

STAR.—There should be an effort made everywhere to refrain from reducing the call for the *Star*, rather to increase it. If fewer are sent for, there can be no chance of getting it for a penny.

APPOINTMENTS.—Elder Thomas Pugh was released as President of the West Glamorgan District, and Elder Henry Evans was appointed in his stead. Also, brother Phillips was released as President of the East Glamorgan District, and Thomas Pugh was appointed in his stead, so that brother Phillips can take greater care of all the Welsh Districts.

 Several writings of Capt. D. Jones are in our possession, which we will publish from time to time in the TRUMPET, believing that many will be glad to see them, for they have never before been published. Although he has gone from our midst, his words are still with us.

 The song of our brother “D. E. J.” is particularly excellent, but we fear that we will do harm by publishing it. Would he be so kind as to present us with something of a different nature.

 We thank “D. W.” for his treatise, but we cannot publish that which tends to shatter feelings. Every sect has its feelings; and the less we mock them for their foolishness, the better for all.

PAYMENTS FROM OCTOBER 17 TO OCTOBER 30.—Breconshire, 2s 6c; West Glamorgan, £2 13s 6c; Pontypridd, £2 18s 2c; Cwmbach, £1 19s; Gog, 5s; Cardiff, 14s; Dowlais, £1 2s 6c; Rhymney, 4s 2½c; Georgetown, £3 6s 6c; Merthyr, £2; Pendaren, 6s 7½c; Cefn, £1 3s 1½c.—Total, £16 15s 1½.

ERRORS.—In our last issue, read “Llanilltyd, 10s 3c;” instead of “3s 10c;” and in the issue before last, the debt of Pontypridd should be 6s more.

 Send all correspondence, orders, and book payments to, *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 23.]

NOVEMBER 15, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

COMING OF THE SON OF MAN.

[Continued from page 346.]

BUT at once again, we see the confusion to which the former statement leads us, namely depriving us of any hope of a part in the first resurrection, or reigning with Him on the earth for a thousand years, in which hope the patriarchs, the prophets, the apostles, and all the saints rejoiced more than anything else, yes, even in the heaven they sang anthems of praise for that day, when they would come with Him to this earth: despite all that, even though all the elements, planets, and their positions, and everything, deny the above assertion, men who profess to believe in the scriptures, try to deprive us of all hope and comfort that are worth having, and pull us from the highest degree of hope and joy, to the lowest degree of misery and despair, saying that all the above things have gone by; that the first resurrection has already taken place, and that we did not have a part in it; consequently, there is no hope for us, but some “waiting.” Waiting for what? is it for the second resurrection to judgment? If so, we are disappointed in that, for there were only a thousand years from the first to the second; but according to their own admission, it has been nearly two thousand from the first, and the second is not yet. What shall we do as we wait longer for it? We are disappointed, and since there is only a resurrection to judgment at that time, there is no use for us to wait for it; for we are without hope, except for hearing

“Go, go,” constantly. Thus, we are without God in the world, nor any way of finding him more; without a gospel, and all atheists, or worse: therefore, let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die, and go to the demons. That is the end of the argument.

But let us give thanks that it was not that age that Christ meant when he spoke the above words. Let us give thanks that we yet have hope for a part in the first resurrection, and let us strive to be ready; for in the hour we think not the Son of Man will come. Since He has given so many witnesses of his coming, it is strange that the burning heat of the sun, or the light of all the huge lights of the firmament, would not have the appropriate effect to convince men of this error, and enlighten them from the confusion of the above darkness, to a land of reason or scripture. People say that if they were to see such things, they would believe; but it is completely contrary, even though they see the whole earthly and aerial world, and the things that are in them, as true witnesses; despite that they do not believe the witness of them all, namely that he is coming! Oh, if only they would take warning.

But, by now you are ready to ask what Christ meant when he said, “This generation will not pass,” &c.? It means what it says, and it says what it means, precisely; and two words in the previous verse to it shows quite clearly, “when ye shall *see all* these things.” Did that age see all the things indicated? If not, it was not to that age he referred, rather some age in which they *would see* these remarkable signs beginning to take place, namely the restoration of the Jews, the preaching of the eternal gospel, and wonders and signs in the heavens, &c. That generation (in which these things would begin to take place) will not pass away, until all of these things take place. This is the only reasonable description that is given of them; and if this portrayal is not admitted, then it does not agree with the prophet; yes, he contradicts himself; for he says that they (namely the Jews) would fall by the edge of the sword, until they were scattered among all the nations, until the time of the gentiles is fulfilled, which has not been fulfilled until this age; and Jesus said also, “This generation shall not pass, till all these things be done.” If it is said that Christ is referring to that age or generation, then it is necessary to prove that all those things were fulfilled in that age, namely that the time of the gentiles to trample and scatter the Jews has been fulfilled, and thus that all Israel is saved; for Paul says in Rom. xi, that they would be

saved at that time, but they could not be saved without believing in the Redeemer, namely that Jesus whom they crucified, and no one says that the Jews as a nation admit the son of the carpenter as the Son of God, but they say that he is the worst deceiver of all the false Christians; irrefutable proof then that the time Christ refers to, has not come until today! The scattered condition of the Jews proves clearly to all the nations, that that time has not yet come, while they see this people living in their midst. Paul says, "there shall come out of Sion the Deliverer, and shall turn away ungodliness from Jacob." But the destruction of Jerusalem was not deliverance for the Jews, rather a great massacre, and depredating destruction, and a scattering until today; thus, we see that the days of vengeance have not ceased, and that that time in which there would be oppression such as had never been on the Jews from the beginning of the world, as an answer to their prayer, namely "let his blood be upon us, and our children." These are the days that will be shortened for the sake of the elect (or the Jews, and as many of the gentiles as are received through the gospel into the covenant); we see that an equal number of days of vengeance are to be, and that there is to be an end to them, in the appointed time, and if we could but determine that time, and when it began, then we could say with certainty when it will end, and that based on Christ's statement. The prophet Daniel frequently asked the angel when those things would be, and why we could not, yea, why we should not search for the time? and since he received the answer from an angel, then the same answer will do for us. Well, you say, has Daniel already explained the matter? Yes, quite clearly, in chap. xii, "And I heard the man clothed in linen, when he held up his right hand and his left hand unto heaven, and swore by him that liveth for ever that it (namely the vision) shall be for a time, times, and half a time; and when he shall have accomplished to scatter the holy people (the Jews), all these things shall be finished." See verse 11, "And from the time that the daily sacrifice shall be taken away, and the abomination that maketh desolate set up, there shall be a thousand two hundred and ninety days," namely every day in a year, as time counted by the prophets, and the number given in the 7th verse is time, namely a year, 360 days, i.e., 360 years; times, in the plural number, twice as many as the first, 720; and half a time, namely 360, is 180; these three numbers make up 1260 years, the number that John says in Rev. xii, 14 that the woman, namely the

Christian Church, would be in the wilderness, after fleeing from the presence of the dragon and its persecutions; and in the 6th verse, it says that she would be there a thousand two hundred and threescore days, that is the number that was noted by Daniel, after the holy people were scattered, until all that was finished. The next thing is to prove when the scattering of the holy people was finished; if, as many say, their scattering was finished at the destruction of Jerusalem, then the end would be in 1330, that is 70 (the year that Titus destroyed Jerusalem, plus the above number); but since it is admitted that the end did not come at that time, it is proof that it was not at that time, namely at the destruction of Jerusalem, that the scattering was finished, when the appointed number would begin. Now let us use another approach as follows: after taking away the continual sacrifice (at the destruction of the temple), and setting up the abomination of desolation (namely the dragon, or the beast, the little horn that would rise last and would destroy three, and would be different from each preceding one), &c., which thing refers to the Papist Church, and the end, namely the time it was set up, and the Church is destroyed or driven into the wilderness it would be 1290; here there is a difference of 30, namely the time between taking away the one and setting up the other; but since the woman or the holy people were not driven into the wilderness, in the day or the year when the beast would sit on his throne, but at the end of some time after that, we must determine that time at which the scattering was finished. It is likely that as the beast became stronger, it weakened the other, until in a short time it completely destroyed it; and if we can know that year, and add 1290 to it, that will show when the time of the gentiles is fulfilled, when they have trampled the Jews under their feet, when the restoration would begin, when the days of vengeance are fulfilled, and the oppressions Christ referred to; we have no scripture as late as the placement of the beast, only a prophecy that pre-dates it, for the holy volume gives no account later than the year 96. Then we must determine the time in question through later historians, and I know of no better author than Mosheim, who said, "Although Constantine the great had taken the reins of government of the Church, and joined it with the state in the year 323, yet, all did not become corrupt at once, rather gradually until Pope I, by which time the pure in heart had left the Church and separated themselves so they could follow the manner and religion

of the apostles, and so the same gifts could be imparted to them by the same Spirit, and so they could administer in the ordinances, and work miracles also to an extent, until the year 570;" if it is admitted that this is the time when the true religion took its wings from among men, and when the man Child was caught up into heaven (namely the priesthood, by which miracles could be wrought), then we add 1260 to that, 570, and we get 1830, and it is shown how long it was after taking away the sacrifice before setting up the abomination, namely 50; and from that time until the time it succeeded in stopping the scattering of the holy people was 540. Thus, in the above year, namely 570, the scattering of the strength of the holy people was ended. Daniel and John agree in this, along with the historians of the following ages, that in that year the beast increased sufficiently in strength and cruelty, to completely destroy the few saints who were scattered throughout the world, under persecution until then, and there is no account of their living after that, that I have seen, i.e., of their being judged after that, I mean, as they had before that, namely by their fruits; and there is no account of those signs that followed the saints in every previous age, following any church after the above time, unless the Roman Church claims that, and it is not to the purpose to argue this topic with her, for in the appointed time will be the end, namely within 1260 years; after 570 A. D., would be the end of the days of vengeance and oppression that Christ mentioned, and when the woman returns from the wilderness, as John says, the dispensation of the fullness of times would begin, when the fullness of the Gentiles would come in, first, to the new covenant; and thus would Israel begin to build Jerusalem. This is the time to which Luke refers when he says that Jerusalem would be trodden under the feet of the Gentiles, until the time of the Gentiles is fulfilled; thus we see that this end, after being established by the above witnesses, is to be in the year 1830, which is the sum of the two above numbers. 570 A. D., when the beast has finished scattering the strength of the holy people, and add to that the *many days* they would be scattered by the edge of the sword, oppression, &c., or until the time that John saw the Church, in the wilderness 1260 years, and we have 1830, the determined time. And what was to take place at that time? was it the end of the world? No, nor the coming of the Son of Man either; and here Mr. Miller, &c, failed, namely in taking for granted that the Son of Man would come, and the earth would be burned with fire; but I

know of no place in the scriptures that shows that either of the two things is to take place in 1260, from any determined time. Well, what was to take place at that time, then? many great and wondrous things,—namely first, the beginning of the building of Jerusalem, which in that year began in a remarkably successful manner until the present time. 2. All those things that Christ indicated as being such obvious signs of his second coming. This gospel of the kingdom that will be preached through all the world, as a witness to all nations that the end is about to come—namely that same, powerful gospel that Christ and the apostles preached, after being lost from the world for 1260 years. John saw an angel coming down with it to be preached to those who dwell on the earth, to every nation, tongue, people, and kindred. Then every nation, tongue, people, and kindred were deprived of the eternal gospel, or did the angel bring an unnecessary message?

(*To be continued.*)

BAPTISM.

FOR THE SUBJECTS, AND THE PROPER WAY OF ADMINISTERING IT.

To the Independents, the Calvinistic Methodists, and the Wesleyans, and all who baptize babies.

KIND FRIENDS,—There has been no small dispute about the subjects, and yet not everyone is in agreement, and since you baptize (or sprinkle) babies, what are your main reasons for doing so?

Sprinkler.—We baptize them, because baptism has come in *place* of circumcision; they used to circumcise babies, therefore, we baptize them.

Saint.—Baptism came in place of circumcision?

Sp.—Yes, did they not circumcise on the eighth day earlier, and now there is no more circumcision, for baptism came in its place.

S.—Baptism in place of circumcision! Where do the scriptures say that? The scriptures say no such thing; if baptism had come in place of circumcision, no one who had been circumcised would be baptized, but all would be baptized who had not been circumcised, and no one would be circumcised, rather baptized, from the day that the one came in place of the other; that is how wise men behaved;

but, it was exactly the opposite. You see that John was a man sent from God, to the circumcised, and why? to *baptize* them, for the remission of sins! and he did not have the right to baptize anyone else, except for the circumcised, and if the one had come in place of the other, from God's order to do so, we would immediately believe John to be foolish, for his act of baptizing the circumcised, was contrary to the wish of the one who sent him; but that is not how it was, for Christ was baptized after being circumcised, and all the apostles, and the three thousand on the day of Pentecost: they were *all* circumcised.

Sp.—Yes, from then on, when Paul came, he said that circumcision was nothing, rather he baptized everyone.

S.—Well, from then on, Paul said that circumcision was nothing: true, nor uncircumcision either, rather a new man in Christ “from then on.” If baptism were in place of circumcision, Paul would not have circumcised Timothy, and baptized him afterwards, and Peter after being appointed by God to be a minister of the circumcised, (as was Paul to the uncircumcised) continued to circumcise and baptize while he could; this he would not have done of course, had God set one in place of the other. Now, Sir, you see that the gourd has disappeared; you can no longer baptize babies beneath its shade! Is there one stronger? if you are in earnest about the baptism of babies, bring them hither.

Sp.—Well, one must admit that Peter did so; did not Christ command to baptize all nations, and babies are in all nations.

S.—I do not wish to shorten the bounds of the commission, but I always take the scripture to explain the scripture. Remember that there is a paraphrase of this same commandment that Christ gave, which is in Mark xvi., where he says, that whoever believes, and is baptized, will be saved. Who received that commandment?

Sp.—Oh, the apostles, that is the eleven.

S.—Did they baptize all the nations?

Sp.—Yes, as far as they could get men to obey; but not everyone, in the widest sense.

S.—Do you admit that the apostles knew their duty so thoroughly about baptism, that they were not mistaken as to whom they should baptize?

Sp.—Oh, they certainly knew that.

S.—Did they, or Jesus, baptize as much as one baby?

Sp.—Jesus took babies in his arms, and blessed them, and baptism is a blessing.

S.—Do you think that baptizing them is what Christ did? Remember the saying from the scriptures, that Jesus did not baptize anyone, rather his disciples. It is true that Christ took babies in his arms and blessed them; but it does not say that he baptized a single baby; it is true also that a blessing is related to baptism, when it is properly administered by God's servants, namely for the forgiveness of sins; but on the other hand, for the unbeliever, and the unrepentant, it will not be a blessing, rather a curse.

Sp.—Yes, the apostles baptized entire families; it is unlikely that those entire families did not have a baby in them.

S.—Well, let us trace them, to have proof; if it can be proven from the scriptures that babies were baptized, we must believe that. Where is the first proof.

Sp.—In Acts x, namely, Cornelius and his entire family; were there no babies there?

S.—No, not one: see the proof in the second verse, "One that feared God, with all his house:"—verse 33, "We are all here present, before God:"—verse 44, "The Holy Ghost fell on all them which heard the word:"—verse 46, "For they heard them speak with tongues, and magnify God." Now, you see that *all* were at home, *all* feared God, *all* spoke with tongues, and magnified God, which an eight-month-old baby could not do, much less one that is eight days old; therefore, there were no babies there.

Sp.—Were there no babies in the family of the keeper of the prison?

S.—No, not one. See the proof in Acts xvi, 34. "And he (the keeper of the prison) rejoiced, believing in God with *all his house*." To everyone in the house was the word preached, and he and his entire family believed, and babies are not able to believe; therefore, you see that this gourd again has disappeared under my hands; there is no baptism of a baby beneath it.

Sp.—Well, there could be a baby in the family of Crispus.

S.—No, not one: see the proof in Acts xviii, 8. "And Crispus, the chief ruler of the synagogue, believed on the Lord with all his house;" therefore, if there was there a baby, it was one who could believe.

Sp.—Did Lydia of old have a baby? we think she was a widow, having buried her husband, and there could have been a baby there.

S.—Yes, the scriptures do not say there was one, and silence is no proof of anything; and if you have no better proof than silence, you do not have one; belief without proof, or a scriptural base, is similar to the vanished gourd. The gourd of Jonah served overnight, as well as a house; but when light and heat came, it disappeared: and so it is with the belief of men in infant baptism: human wisdom gave birth to a few shadows, or gourds, and they served over the centuries of the dark ages; but now, light and heat have come, and behold, the shadows like mist or fog flee from view, and the result is, an increase of the heat until it burns all the impurity, and the evil smelling and unhealthy savor which human wisdom has brought to the world.

Remember that the only subjects for baptism, are those who are able to believe. To prove this, see that those baptized by John confessed their sins; the three thousand on the day of Pentecost said, "Men and brethren, what shall we do?" "Repent," said Peter, "and be baptized every one of you, for the remission of sins," &c. "If thou believest," said Philip to the eunuch, "thou mayest." Thus, the families we have mentioned, all believed first, repented second, and were baptized after that.

Furthermore, lest being too lengthy, the Sprinklers insist that it is by sprinkling that baptism should be done, and not by immersion or by submersion; but the bases they have for believing that, vanish when they are tested, like chaff before the wind: they believe that entire families were baptized in their homes, when the scriptures do not say that as much as one did so. It is true that the scriptures are silent about Saul, Lydia, Cornelius, and the keeper of the prison of old; but silence is no proof of anything: thus, of course, it is a weak foundation to build on; yes, too poor for any attentive person to embrace. They say also that the three thousand on the day of Pentecost must have been baptized by sprinkling, because they were too many in number for them all to have been baptized by immersion in so little time: but, forsooth, the present-day sprinklers spend as much time to administer the ordinance as we do: the lessons are just as long, and fully as much time is spent to place the few drops, and dry them, as it takes to immerse a man in the element. Therefore, again it is obvious that one cannot be baptized by sprinkling under the shadow of that shrub; well, then, I shall bring

forward parts of the scriptures, to prove beyond all question, that it is through immersion, or submersion, that baptism should be performed, and not by sprinkling. First, Philip took the Eunuch “down into the water;” which I have never heard being done in order to sprinkle or to pour. Also, there went out unto John (Mark i, 5) all the land of Judea, and they of Jerusalem, and were all baptized of him *in* the river of Jordan; I have never heard of anyone going to the river to sprinkle. Also, John went to Aenon to baptize, because there was *much water* there; see John iii, 23; and if there was no need for more than a basin full, for the purpose of administering baptism, it seems to me that John worked contrary to the course of nature, and reason; this I cannot believe, because he was full of the Holy Ghost from his mother’s womb.

Furthermore, Paul teaches Titus (iii, 5), that it is according to his mercy that he (God) saves us, by the *washing* of regeneration, and the renewing of the Holy Ghost. It is well known that we are all unclean, from the soles of our feet to the crowns of our heads; reason teaches us, and the scriptures also, that *all* of us need to be washed, since all of us are unclean, and throw off the filthiness of the flesh, &c.

Furthermore, Paul teaches the Romans, and also the Colossians, of being buried in the baptism, namely being buried in the element, of course.

Now, this is sufficient to convince every sprinkler, who is convinced by reason and scripture. Let all leave their opinion aside, and the traditions received from their fathers, and realize that it is the Scriptures that will judge us in the last day, and not thoughts, beliefs, nor traditions.

Yours, &c.,

Dinas.

J. RICHARDS.

PERSECUTION IN TREDEGAR, MONMOUTHSHIRE.

On the 4th day of this month, it happened that Elder Lorenzo Snow and I were preaching in the Tredegar town hall, with a large crowd listening to us; brothers Davis, Pugh, Giles and others were also present. After the meeting ended, brother Snow and I were directed to an eating house to take lodging; and after eating supper, we went to our bed at about half past eleven.

After going into the bedroom, we looked to see if there was a lock on the door, but there was none. We went to our bed not thinking anything bad would happen, and we went to sleep; but within a few hours we heard the noise of some persons coming toward our room; and when we opened our eyes, the first thing we saw was a large man with a lighted candle in his hand, and the first word we heard was "OLD BUGGERS," for they were speaking in English. They went over to our *watches* that were on the table. We could make out three of them at that time, and we heard two others speaking outside the room. Their curses were enough to frighten any human being. We remained in the bed, and after they had looked at our *watches* and our clothes, and everything else, they came forward to the bed swearing terribly. We feared for our lives to say anything to them; and the first thing I asked them was what they wanted? and cursing, they answered that if we uttered another word that they would do for us good and proper. I said to them again, "Would you, friends, please go out?" Then they swore even more fiercely, saying not to call them friends; and they tried to hit us, but they failed to touch either one of us. Then after calming down a bit, they began to feel our faces, and we saw that it was better for us to be still and lie like innocent lambs. But finally they pulled our bedclothes off in order to see what kind of shirts we had. And one of them said to me, "*Old bugger*, why didn't you change your shirt instead of going to bed with a clean shirt?" After that they began to drip the tallow of the candle on us, by slanting it above our heads, but we tried to hide our faces as best we could. Then they tried to set fire to the blankets, but failed completely. Brother Snow had a nightcap on his head, and they ordered him to take it off, which he did immediately, and then they tried to burn the nightcap in his hand, but they failed. Then, cursing terribly, they said they wanted to get us out of the bed; and then they began to wrestle with us, but they failed to stir me; however, they were beginning to take brother Snow. When I saw that, I took hold of him, and then our enemy lost his grip, and fell down and hit his back against the wall; at that time the candle went out, as if by a miracle. Then we sat up in the bed, and they were now vowing and swearing that they would kill us after lighting the

candle. We feared lest they might harm us with a knife in the dark, but then we perceived that they had all gone out of our room. We were taken with fear upon thinking how much danger we were in, and we prayed to God to save us. After an instant we heard their noise coming up to us again, swearing frightfully; and when we saw the light of the candle coming in, we jumped out of the bed; and by then the head of one of them came into sight at the door. Then we closed the door against him, causing him to fall down over some of the stairs; and that is where we remained for about half an hour pushing our backs against the door, to keep them from coming in. At times they almost overcame us, and were about to come in; and when it became extremely hard for us, I heard brother Snow praying softly, "Oh, Father, help us, for it is very hard for us," to which I added "Amen, amen," in the midst of my groans. There was not time to offer a long prayer, and so one was not offered. We managed to keep them out through it all; and although we could hear them vowing, that if they could break in, they would kill us, and although they almost got in at times, yet we got renewed strength to keep them out; and although there were five of them, at least, big strong men, we overcame them with our strength. After seeing that they were not getting anywhere, one of them called for a chair and began to hit the door with it for a while, until the lady of the house shouted what was the matter; and she finally persuaded them to come down to their own room, but not without their swearing that they would come in again before morning. Then we *wedged* a chair tightly against the door and went back to bed almost numb. It was now about four o'clock, which we perceived by feeling our *watches*. We slept with one eye open, and the other closed, and with one foot in bed, and the other out; and I asked brother Snow if he was asleep. "Yes," he said, "one side. How are you sleeping, brother Phillips?" "Well," I said, "the same as you, but I am not shaking so much." "Oh," he said, "I have been in this situation before in America, when a chair kept *mobs* out." At times we heard our intruders swearing at us, and in this manner they continued to threaten us. At about half past eight, we went down after dressing, but we did not see one of our old fellow-

travelers, and we did not wish to see them the way we had seen them during the night.

Now, I cannot help but think that these rascals lived in town, or at least nearby, and that a council had been held, and these men had been appointed to search out where we would be sleeping, so that they could take lodging in the same place; but they failed to accomplish their objectives, because we overcame them at the door. We believe that the lady of the house was totally ignorant of the situation. We thank God for saving us again this time: and we counsel all the elders, that if they sleep in such places, to make sure to lock the door of the room they sleep in; and if there is not a lock on it, let them sleep with one eye open.

WILLIAM PHILLIPS.

Despite the domination of the evil one and his war,—hideous,
In demonic demeanor;
Our two angels escaped,
And in good spirits,—“*All is well.*”

DEWI ELFED.

GROANS OF THE REVERENDS.

TUNE—“Sectarianism in Danger.”

WALES, Wales, awake soon,
Lift thy voice, and do not slumber;
Come in strength and endless energy,
To vanquish all the Mormons.
Oh, how sad is our heart;
The Saints of this age,
And their influence must be overcome.
Oh, how sad is our heart;
See, the camp of Methodism,
Trembles because of these men;
Ouch, the kingdom of old sectarianism,
Is being shattered by Mormonism.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.
See, the Great Cause is withering,
Oh, how ill it is in Llangeithio;

With the same fate remember, remember,
Will befall the great Session in Bala.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

We can do nothing but groan,
Beneath a polluted and guilty conscience;
What shall we do? our trade
Is coming to an end, before Mormonism.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Ouch, ouch, ouch, losing the profit,
Is almost as wretched as dying;
We can no longer deceive men,
Let us burn, let us burn the Book of Mormon.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

The translation of the Book of Mormon,
Is bringing pain to the strings of our heart:
Before the heat of its pure doctrine,
Sectarianism is melting into extinction.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

The penetrating doctrine of the Saints,
Is working through our flesh and our nerves;
Here is some very strange knowledge,
That is killing us by the inch.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Let us turn to God for strength to shout,
May that old angel MORONI be killed;
Oh, woe is us that he was not strangled,
Before taking Joseph to Cumorah.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

If men only knew,
Of our great affliction and our tribulation.
They would arise now in droves,
To lay waste all of the Saints.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

We would give the world or two, if we could,
Throw them all to perdition;
But old hell will refuse them,—
Before long they will reign:
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Ugly disagreements are what divide
The road for all the denominations to follow;
The churches are in tumult because of them,
Like the sea in the roar of a whirlwind.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

What will become of the restless world,
That bodes sadness daily?

What will become of the frigid sects,
But some weary, awful end.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Despite our loud cries and our babble,
Let the world see, how miserable is our condition!
The proud and puffed-up Sectarians,
Are now like a slumping ruin.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Despite inventing a thousand tales,
All of which are filled with calumny
About the Saints, there is no hope,
That we shall triumph over them.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

'Tis vain to pay the old balladeers,
To scribble senseless rubbish;
'Tis vain to write deceitful letters,
To deride any of the Saints.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Vain is our lying facetiousness,
About all the women of California;
Vain is the foolishness of the "Times"
Turning into "*Rhys of the blatant lie.*"
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

'Tis vain to promote massacres,
'Tis vain to speak against miracles;
Vain are the treachery, and ugly plots;
Onward the Saints continue.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

'Tis better to change our speech,
'Tis better to leave the Saints alone;
Is it not, if they go further,
It will finish, and put an end to our trade.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Our preaching is nothing, our prayers are nothing,
Our religious fervor is nothing, and our shouting is nothing,
Our gift is nothing, and our cause is nothing,
The strength of our religion is nothing of nothing.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Our wisdom and our teaching,
Are found to be nothing before Mormonism;
This is the speech of our conscience,—
We are sinking in a sea of misery.
Oh, how sad is our heart, &c.

Hush, wretches, come, come,
With faith and repentance;

Turn in haste to the God of the Saints,
 And obtain deliverance of your sins.
 Come, oh, come without denying,
 It is late, come swiftly,
 And obtain deliverance of your groanings,
 Come, Oh, come without denying.

Gwawr Chapel, Aberaman.

DEWI ELFED.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

OVERABUNDANCE is troublesome, need is grievous, honor is a burden, and being lifted up is dangerous; but happiness is contained in sufficiency.

He who is not content in his situation, would not be content in any situation whatever; for the fault is not with the situation, rather in the mind.

HONOR and wealth are the two wheels on which all the world turns; these are the mainsprings of our contentment.

MORMONS BOG.—The Book of Mormon in Danish has appeared in Wales. Fifty of them have come down to brother Phillips, and they are for sale for 4s. each.—The same book is close to being ready in Italian. After that it will appear in French and German, and then in other languages, until eventually no nation under heaven will be without the Book of Mormon in its own language.

PAYMENTS FROM OCT. 31 TO NOV. 13.—Monmouthshire, £4; Breconshire, 15s 8c; Cardiganshire, £2 9s; Carmarthenshire, £15 1s 9¼c; West Glamorgan, £3 10s 6c; Flintshire, £2; Anglesey, £1 6s; Denbighshire, £1 10s; Pembrokeshire, £1; Dinas, 12s 6c; Pontytyridd, 18s; Llanfabon, 19s 9c; Aberdare, £1 2s 6c; Dowlais, £1 4s; Hirwaun, £1 3s 1c; Georgetown, £1 8s; Pendaren, £1 13s 9½c; Cefn, 8s 8c; Ffynnon Tydfil, 19s 6c.—Total, £42 2s 9¼c.

 We wish to inform the Saints that Thomas Morgan, formerly the President of the Anglesey District, has been excommunicated from the Church, that the person by the name of Liffin, in the town of Caernarvon, has no further connection with the Saints.

 The Bilingual Hymnal, containing the two Welsh hymnals and the new English edition, is ready, bound in calfskin, for 3s. each.

 Send all correspondence, orders, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 24.]

NOVEMBER 29, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

COMING OF THE SON OF MAN.

[Continued from page 362.]

THAT which was mentioned previously, namely the preaching of the gospel, is to take place before the last end; and since he uses men as instruments to preach this gospel, he will give them time to go and declare their message, and time for the people to believe and obey, to be saved; otherwise, why would they preach it except for the people to be able to escape from the wrath that is to be: thus, by obeying this gospel they will be saved. And all who are saved, then, will have to obey this one; and how will they obey it, unless they believe it? how will they believe in something they have never heard of? how will they hear it without a preacher? and how will they preach unless they are sent? And how will they be sent? by the message of that angel from heaven. Thus, we see that this will all take quite a lot of time after the time that it began, namely in 1830, although Christ said that it was in the age, or that generation, that they would see them (these things) beginning, that all of them would be finished; yet he shows very clearly how long that time would be, for he gave them the sign of the fig tree to confirm that it was that age that would see the beginning of them, and they would see the end also.

Some people think they should not seek to know when that would happen, as Christ said, "The day and the hour no man knoweth, not even the angels of heaven, only the Father." Nevertheless he states the actual age, the dispensation, and he also gave signs indicating the year, these being for the ones who

see the signs coming. And the angel gave some suggestions of this to Daniel (xii, 12). After describing the noteworthy things that were to come first, and the times they would come, the time the great work of restoration would begin among the Jews. The gospel would be preached by men, namely the fishermen and the hunters, &c., and the glory they would see, &c. But that which Daniel asked most about of all things was, when would the end of all these things be? The end was the subject that most concerned Daniel, and the angel receives permission to give a full answer to all other things, but he does not speak in very specific terms about the end, although he said enough to satisfy Daniel. "Blessed is he that waiteth, and cometh to the thousand three hundred and five and thirty days." What will be at that time? He does not say more, and there is no need for any reasonable creature to have more; that is sufficient to prove that in that year will be some great blessing, some very blessed time; yes, no less so than that time when the patriarchs and the prophets would rejoice when thinking of it, when the apostles would die in hopes of having it—that time in which Daniel (as the angel says in the next verse) would stand in his lot, namely at the end of the days, which days are the last days, when the Son of Man would come on the clouds of heaven, and the saints would rise from their graves, and the living saints would be changed into the same form with him. More appears here between the time of the end of the days of that vengeance and oppression, and the end of the vision, or the end of the ungodly, when the righteous will rise to meet the Son of Man—as much more as there is between 1299 and 1335, since the first number was the end of the vengeance on the Jews to scatter them, and beginning to gather them together; then the last number that was noted, is when the work of the dispensation of the fullness of times will be finished, and all things will be gathered and perfect in Christ. The difference between them, 45 years, is the appointed time to gather the Jews, to preach this gospel as a witness to all the world; and then will the end come. Not the end of the world, rather the end of the appointed time, to put an end to sin, and to purify the earth, as a kingdom over which Christ may reign, and all his Saints with him, for a thousand years.

After saying as much as this about the time of his coming, we come to the second question that the apostles asked Christ, namely

IV. "AND WHAT WILL BE THE SIGN OF THY COMING, AND OF THE END OF THE WORLD?"

We have already indicated what many of the signs are that will take place on the earth before his second coming, together with the time that was mentioned above; thus, there is no need to be so detailed as to reiterate them here, rather we shall show others in their appropriate places, which have not yet been mentioned. It has already been proven when the time of the gentiles began, and when it was ended; the great oppression that was to be on the Jews at that time, and when the gathering of Israel to their land was begun. It has already been shown that that restoration will be fulfilled at the same time as that gospel is preached that was sent with the angel from heaven, throughout the whole world, as a witness to all nations;—that the time those things would begin would be in the year 1830, and that they would continue for 45 years; and I shall name some of the other things that were to take place also during this remarkable time until its end, and that so that all the honest and faithful will be warned, so if they wish, they can understand and watch for the coming of that day upon them like sudden destruction, or a thief in the night.

The prophets clearly show that the Jews will be gathered to their land after the wrath has ended, and that they would build the walls of Jerusalem, and that it would be inhabited in the last days, that old people and children would play in its streets, that they would dwell in safety without towers or fortresses; but thinking that all the vengeance was past, they expect peace evermore, and then the Lord will bring up all the nations of the earth to war against one another, and to take the spoil of gold and silver, and they would succeed in taking half the city into captivity,—two prophets would rise up, those who would prophesy for three-and-a-half years, those whom the gentiles would kill, because they had prevented them from taking another part of the city into captivity, and they did not suffer them to be buried, but their bodies would lie in the street for three days and a half,—after that they would come to life, and they would be taken up to heaven, and also great darkness would come over everyone, until they did not know one another,—in that darkness the nations would kill one another without knowing, until they would see the brightness of the glory of the coming of the Son of Man on the mount of Olives,—Jacob would be saved, they would recognize their Messiah by the wounds in his hands and his feet, every family would grieve by itself. But “then would all Israel be saved.” He delivered them from the hand of their enemies, when no one else could; He would dry every tear from their eyes. Then, but not before then, there shall be a fountain opened to the house of David and to the

inhabitants of Jerusalem for sin and for uncleanness; and I have not seen one promise in the Bible that the Jews would be gathered back through the gospel, nor that they would believe the gospel, until they would see their Messiah, for that is the way he has arranged to save them, although there is not one promise that the gentiles will thus be saved either, because the gospel will have been preached to them as a witness of these things, before they go up to war against Jerusalem.

[Perhaps our readers will be a bit disappointed, that this excellent treatise by Capt. D. Jones, has not been completely finished by him. When we began to publish it, we thought we would have time to finish it; but after considering how much of our time would be required to search for the scriptures, we have decided to postpone it for the time being, hoping to finish it sometime in the future.—ED.]

GREETING TO THE SAINTS IN GREAT BRITAIN,

BY ELDER LORENZO SNOW.

One of the Twelve Apostles of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

BELOVED SAINTS,—A short sojourn in this land has served to bind more closely those feelings of interest which must ever be called into action during an intimate acquaintance with the Saints. As the period now approaches, when, for other climes, I must bid adieu to the kindly smiling faces and warm hearts of the brethren in the British Isles, I can but express my deep and heartfelt wishes for the prosperity and continued progress of the work in this country, and the well-being and happiness of all those who have the privilege of cooperating in the great and glorious cause of spreading light and intelligence amongst the children of men.

To my brethren in the Priesthood I beg to offer a few words of counsel, instruction, and exhortation. Upon you rest high and sacred responsibilities, which relate not only to the salvation of this generation, but of many past generations, and many to come. The glorious ensign of Emanuel's kingdom once again established in the world must be unfurled in every nation, kingdom and empire; the voice of warning, the voice of the bridegroom, "Prepare ye, prepare ye, the way of the Lord," must be carried forth unto all people; you

are the ones whom the Lord has selected for this purpose, even the horn of Joseph, to push together the people. Surely you cannot be too anxiously, nor too industriously engaged, seeking how best, the manner most useful to yourselves and mankind, to magnify your holy and sacred offices. 'Tis the Priesthood that will give you character, renown, wisdom, power, and authority, and build you up here below among the children of men; and above, exalt you to peace and happiness, to glory, to thrones and dominions, even through countless eternities. This world, in its kingdoms and empires, possesses in some degree glory and greatness, faintly shadowing forth what is embraced in regions above: but here, to these is joined little happiness, little durability. The world we seek offers to its inhabitants unfading glory, immortal renown, dominions of continued increase, where families grow into nations, nations into generations, generations into worlds, worlds into universes; this is THE PATH of the Priesthood—THE PATH of the Holy Ones. Well did the Apostle say, “Eye hath not seen, nor ear heard, neither hath it entered the heart of man to conceive the things which God hath prepared for them that love him, but God hath revealed them unto us by his Spirit, for the Spirit searcheth all things, yea, even the deep things of God.”

Authoritative rule is not the proper rule by which to govern Saints, but rather seek to administer in the spirit of humility, wisdom, and goodness, teaching not so much by theory as practice. Though one teach with the eloquence of an angel, yet one's good practices, good example, one's acts, constantly manifesting wholeheartedness for the interests of the people, teach much more eloquently, much more effectually. 'Tis indeed, few, who have enough moral courage to be strictly honest, faithful, virtuous, and honorable in all positions—these few will hold the priesthood and receive its fullness, but none other. Purity, virtue, fidelity, godliness must be sought ambitiously, or the crown cannot be won. Those principles must be incorporated with ourselves, woven into our constitutions, becoming a part of us, making us a center, a fountain of truth, of equity, justice, and mercy,

of all that is good and great, that from us may proceed the light, the life, the power, and the law to direct, to govern and assist to save a wandering world; acting as the sons of God, for and in behalf of our Father in heaven. We expect in the resurrection to exercise the powers of our priesthood—we can exercise them only in proportion as we secure its righteousness and perfections; these qualifications can be had only as they are sought and obtained, so that in the morning of the resurrection we will possess those acquisitions only which we secured in this world! Godliness cannot be *conferred* but must be *acquired*, a fact of which the religious world seem strangely unconscious. Seek to benefit others, and others will seek to benefit you; and he that would be great, let him be good, studying the interests of the whole, becoming the servant of all, whereby he will secure to himself most of the wisdom and power of God, the love, esteem, and veneration of his people.

The elders must become persons of the highest responsibilities. The happiness of people, of nations, of generations, will depend upon the right and faithful exercise of the powers of their offices. If in a lesser sphere of action they fail to be trustworthy, who will depend upon them in the greater? In view of the vast responsibilities to be placed upon men in this high calling, they are in a measure left to themselves to act upon their agency; if they pass onward to the close of this probation, without being overthrown by evil powers, keeping their spirits pure, and through the power of the Holy Ghost, educate and build themselves up in those qualifications essential to such exaltations, then, in due time, God will elevate them to those positions. In all your acts and conduct ever have the consciousness that you are now preparing and making yourselves a life to be continued through eternities; act upon no principle that you would be ashamed or unwilling to act upon in heaven, employ no means in the attainment of an object that a celestial enlightened conscience would disapprove. Whilst feelings and passions excite you to action, let principles pure, honorable, holy, and virtuous, always rule and

govern. Deity is within us, our spiritual organization is Deity—the child of God, begotten in his image; therefore, brethren, “Let the same mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus, who, finding himself in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God.” “The creature,” or children of God were introduced into this world, “not willingly,” becoming subject to vanity, sorrows and pains, but to do the will of the Father and obtain a glory and a heavenly inheritance, to become one with God;” And he that hath this hope in him purifieth himself even as God is pure.”

We are here that we may be educated in a school of suffering and of fiery trials, which school was necessary for Jesus our elder brother, who, the scriptures tell us, was made perfect through suffering. It is necessary we suffer in all things, that we may be qualified and worthy to rule and govern all things, even as our Father in heaven and his eldest son Jesus. God has revealed to us the mystery which all the world seek after, but fail in knowing, because of pride, wickedness, and the power of Satan darkening their minds, and that is the path of the salvation and happiness of our being.

And now, where is the man among you having once burst the veil and gazed upon this purity, the glory, the might, majesty, and dominion of a perfected man, in celestial glory, in eternity, will not cheerfully resign life, suffer the most excruciating tortures, let limb be torn from limb, sooner than dishonor or resign his Priesthood. In truth, did our Savior utter this parable, “The kingdom of heaven is like unto a merchantman, seeking goodly pearls and having found one of great price, went and sold all he had to buy the same; and again, like unto a man finding a treasure in a field, sold all he had to purchase the field.” The glory revealed to our view, and which we seek, is tangible, can be felt, seen and heard; but its length, its breadth, its depth, its majesty, its peace, its joy, its happiness, surpass all understanding: tongue cannot express it, and language failed to portray its vastness of extent.

(To be continued.)

REMARKS OF W. GIBSON ON THE BOOK OF MORMON.

[Continued from page 352.]

I shall next proceed, according to promise, to show its harmony with the scriptures.

The greatest portion of the book is taken up with recording the history of a people who are said to be a part of the seed of Abraham, and descendants of Joseph. Do the prophecies contained in the Bible lead us to expect that the descendants of Joseph should ever go to America, become a great people, and receive revelations for themselves? We shall see: and in this investigation, let the reader endeavor to throw aside prejudice, and give the same amount of credence to the prophecies on this subject, as is given to those concerning the first coming of the Messiah.

I shall commence with the 49th chapter of Genesis, 1st verse, "And Jacob called unto his sons, and said, Gather yourselves together, that I may tell you that which shall befall you in the last days." Then, speaking of Joseph and his seed in the 26th verse, he says, "The blessings of thy father (Jacob) have prevailed above the blessings of my progenitors (Abraham and Isaac) unto the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills: they shall be on the head of Joseph, and on the crown of the head of him that was separate from his brethren." What, then, I ask, were the blessings that Abraham conferred on Isaac, and Isaac conferred on Jacob? it was the land of Canaan for an everlasting inheritance. Therefore, if Joseph's blessing exceeded theirs so far, that his inheritance should extend to the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills, and that according to the common sense, he must mean those most distant from the land of Canaan, then would any of our wise men tell me where that inheritance can be if not in America? for there alone can we find the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills from the land of Canaan, or the inheritance of his brethren; and as we could not reasonably expect that Joseph's seed would inherit all the land between the land of Canaan and the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills, we must expect, if the Bible be true, that the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills (from the inheritance of their brethren) Joseph's seed should have for an inheritance peculiar to themselves.

I will next compare this with the blessings which Jacob gave the sons of Joseph, recorded in the 48th chapter of Genesis, from the 15th verse to the 20th. In the 16th verse, he says, "let them grow into a multitude in the midst of the earth;" and in the 19th verse, speaking of the younger son, Ephraim, he says, "his seed shall become a multitude of nations." Now, then, comes the question, Did the portion of them who remained with their brethren in the land of Canaan, become a multitude of nations there? The answer is, no; then we must look from there to the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills, and if we do not find them as a multitude of nations there, then old Jacob was a false prophet. Let us then look to America, to see what do we find; there we find a multitude of nations, having different languages, laws, governments, territories, and yet all evidently springing from one common stock. If we take this in connection with Jacob's blessing, we must come to the conclusion, if we believe the Bible to be the word of God, that they are the seed of Joseph.

I will next quote a few prophecies referring to where the seed of Joseph are to be found when their brethren are gathered back to receive their inheritance, in the land of Canaan. Zechariah, in the 10th chapter of his prophecy, from the 7th to the 11th verse, speaking of Ephraim, says, in verse 9, "I will sow them among the people, and they shall remember me in far countries;" and in verse 10, he speaks of bringing another portion of them from Egypt and Assyria, to Gilead and Lebanon, for Ephraim was to have an inheritance with his brethren in the land of Canaan, besides that promised at the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills. The question then is, where are these far countries to be found, where the descendants of Ephraim are to remember the Lord, when their brethren are brought back from Egypt and Assyria? Shall we search east, west, north or south for them? Hosea will tell us: see Hosea, 11th chapter, from the 9th verse; there, speaking of Ephraim, he says in the 10th verse, "When he (the Lord), shall roar, then the children shall tremble from the *west*," and in the 11th verse he speaks, like Zechariah, of another portion of them in Egypt and Assyria.

Now, we have found a part of the seed of Joseph (that is, of

course, west from Canaan), consequently, the next question is, how far west? Zechariah says it is a far country, and it would indeed be a far country if it be at the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills from the land of Canaan: but Zephaniah throws still more light on this subject, for in his 3rd chapter and 10th verse he says, "from beyond the rivers of Ethiopia my suppliants, even the daughter of my dispersed, shall bring mine offering;" if, then, they were to be beyond the rivers of Ethiopia, how far did what was called Ethiopia in ancient days extend? For answer I will give an extract from the "Edinburgh Evening Courant," of October 16, 1848. In an article there on the late discoveries in America, the writer remarks,—“Egypt, though strictly speaking an African power, yet her sway extended both in Africa and Asia, and above all was (in the African portion), comprehended in what was called the land of Cush or Ethiopia, in its early and most extended sense, including both Arabia and Africa, from the Red Sea to the banks of the Nile throughout its course.” If then, Ethiopia, in its ancient sense, included both Arabia and Africa, and a part of the dispersed seed of Abraham are in the latter days to bring an offering to the Lord, from beyond its rivers, which in the western part run into the Atlantic Ocean, it must be from some place beyond that continent, that this offering is to be brought, or it could never be beyond the rivers of Ethiopia. Then look at your maps, my friends, and see if this could be fulfilled anywhere but in America.

Isaiah, in his prophecies, makes it still more plain, by giving us the very form of this land beyond the rivers of Ethiopia, from which an offering is to be brought to the Lord of Hosts in the last days.—See Isaiah xviii. In the 7th verse he speaks of an offering to be brought to the Lord, and in the 1st verse he gives us a description of the land from whence it (namely the offering) is to be brought. He says, “Woe (or as some old translations have it, “Ho,”) to the land shadowing with wings, which is beyond the rivers of Ethiopia.” Now, friends, spread out the map of America before you, and see if you could give a better description of its form than a land shadowing with wings, or in the form of wings. Let us see now what these few passages have proven. First, Zechariah says, a part of the seed of Ephraim are in far countries, where they are

yet to remember the Lord. Hosea tells us these countries are in the west. Zephaniah tells how far west, namely, beyond the rivers of Ethiopia; and Isaiah tells us that the land beyond the rivers of Ethiopia is a land with wings.

(To be continued.)

VALLEY OF THE MOUNTAINS.

TUNE.—“Fair Morning.”

OH BABYLON, Oh Babylon,
 How long wilt thou keep my heart captive?
 Thy sad longing is, as it were, a swelling tune,
 That follows thy borders;
 But Oh, my heart delights now,
 With its profound trust every second of the hour,
 For the city of the Great Salt Lake,
 In the Valley of the Mountains.

My dear loved ones have almost all,
 Turned into the world's worst enemies;
 That moves my mind,
 To the Valley of the Mountains:
 This shows readily to me,
 That my home is no longer here;
 Rather I shall go and build my home,
 In the Valley of the Mountains.

Why does the world continually bestir itself,
 Against this gospel,
 Which calls the sorrowful of heart,
 To the Valley of the Mountains?
 But God will gather all of them together
 From his saints, from the four corners of the world,
 For their safe and joyful inheritance,
 In the Valley of the Mountains.

Pleasures from everywhere will be enjoyed,
 And they'll receive the fruits of their worthy labor,
 And live beneath their honeysuckles,
 In the Valley of the Mountains;

And eat their fill without any ridicule,
 With a cheery greeting from a dear brother,
 Poor unfortunates will no longer be seen,
 In the Valley of the Mountains.

Where is the strong and powerful sailing vessel,
 That will receive the excellent breezes of heaven,
 To carry me across the sea to my home,
 In the Valley of the Mountains;
 Oh! smooth thy face, unruly sea,
 And the north, restrain thy cold winds,
 So that I may go to praise my Lord,
 In the Valley of the Mountains.

Glynmil.

JOHN WILKINS.

TO THE DISTRIBUTORS, SUBSCRIBERS, AND READERS OF THE "TRUMPET."

DEAR BRETHREN,—In the midst of our labor in bringing forth the Book of Mormon in Welsh, we pause, so that at the end of the year, we greet you with respect to the TRUMPET. You know that the TRUMPET, by now, has been sounding for nearly three years, with reasonable success; and its trumpeter, to this point, feels no desire to give it up, although his mind perhaps has been more on the Book of Mormon, at the present time. We think there are some Saints who think less about the TRUMPET, ever since they have been receiving the Doctrine and Covenants and the Book of Mormon, in Welsh: that is quite natural, for we ourselves cannot think as much about the TRUMPET, while being at the task of translating the two above books. But now, our thoughts are beginning to lean more toward the TRUMPET, since we intend to finish the translation, if we are alive and well, within about three months, which will be a very difficult task, in order to have our head free for the TRUMPET and other things. Yet, the TRUMPET is not being neglected at present, for in it there are many very interesting things. But when we have more time for it, we promise to make it much more worthy of being received, by writing more ourselves, by way of treatises and accounts of the Valley and

other countries. There is a great call from everyone for accounts, and we shall strive to satisfy them with respect to that and all other things.

Now, the TRUMPET for this year is very cheap, considering that just under two thousand are received; yes, it is too cheap, and it cannot be sold for a PENNY next year, unless there are many more subscribers to it. We were greatly disappointed at the beginning of this year; we intended to have at least three thousand, instead of two. Therefore, it has been decided by the First Presidency of Wales, that the price for the TRUMPET, next year, for the Branches that receive a lesser number than this year, the price will be a PENNY AND A HALFPENNY each; and a PENNY each for those that receive the same number or more than this year. Remember that this will be in effect in every District, except for the Districts of the North, which will receive the TRUMPET for a penny, because of their distance. One in every twenty is allowed, as at present, unless we get three thousand subscribers, in which case a change will be made. Let the distributors of the Districts take note which branches send for fewer or more, so that they can keep to the rule.

Send information to us from every place throughout Wales, as to how many of the TRUMPET can be received, during next year, in every branch and district, by the 20th of December, without fail; and let no one order more than he has faith to sell; and if anyone requests more than he orders at the first, he can have them by giving a fortnight's notice. Let all the presidents remember that the sale of the books depends more on them than on anyone else; therefore, let them put forth effort, and they shall be rewarded by God. Those who are lazy and unconcerned about this work, are lazy and unconcerned about the best work.

THE TROUBLED CRY OF GOD'S CHILDREN IN GREAT BABYLON OF THE LATTER DAYS.

How long will we be, Oh Father,
In the land of the great affliction,
Where our dear Jesus was slain,
And where we are now oppressed?

Chorus.

Be patient still, my children,
I know of the oppression of the world;
I have promised, and I shall
Gather you all together;
You shall inherit the earth,
You, the meek, before long,
You shall leave the land of Babel
Toward Zion before long,
I feel for you, my children,
You shall go before long.

Despite being gentle with the world,
Our love cannot be found;
And our innocence is great,
Despite which they persecute us.

The Spirit thou gavest us,
Convinces the world;
Because of that we are oppressed,
Like hated objects of scorn.

Whatever we say to the world,
The Spirit is opposed,
And he is judged the worst
Of the evils under heaven.

Wherever we go, Oh our Father,
We are recognized:
Nowhere are we left alone,
Because we are thy children.

To remain hidden in the world,
We cannot ever be;
The savor of thy knowledge
Is through us everywhere:

For obeying thy laws
We receive only evil;
Earlier we had the fellowship of the world,
But now their hatred and their wrath.

Flint.

THOMAS CONWAY.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

NEWS FROM THE CONTINENT.—Elder Erastus Snow has published recently an edition of the Songs of Zion in Danish, and the Doctrine and Covenants has been translated into that language, and is receiving the final revision before going to press.—We understand that Elder Taylor is in Germany, and that he has begun to publish the Book of Mormon in German; he intends to bring out a publication in Hamburg without delay.—*Star*.

ELDER Parley P. Pratt, perchance, is by now in Chile, or Peru, in South America, for the special purpose of preaching the Gospel among the families in that part of the earth. How quickly the candles of the Lord are being lit in the various countries of the world; and blessed are those who are guided by their light home to Zion and to their God.—*Star*.

AUSTRALIA.—It appears from the letter we saw in the latest *Star*, that Elders G. W. Wandell and John Murdock, are laboring in the above distant land, where they are confident of seeing an abundant harvest.

IN a letter from Elder David Candland, dated Halifax, Nova Scotia, Oct. 24, it is reported that the work of the Lord is being renewed in life and strength in that island, and that the Saints there have a comfortable chapel, and a call for elders.

SALT LAKE VALLEY.—According to the accounts we have seen, everything is going forward very nicely in the Valley; despite that, no special news has come from there lately, except for an account of the festival, which we would be happy to be able to publish, if we had space.

TITLES of honor are given to unworthy men, at best, but the royal imprint is put on bad money.

NEW FEMININE ATTIRE.—This world is very changeable, for the women are beginning to wear trousers and jackets! No wonder, for they have been sweeping the streets in their dresses *long* enough, in every sense of the word; it is the men's turn to do that now; and there are already several young boys in London who have been hired to sweep the streets in their place. Many of the fair sex are seen in America in their new apparel, and we have heard that there are also some in England, and that some are going about proclaiming that the old style is outmoded. Success to them in getting something better than the old apparel, so they may follow the men through the mud, more easily than at present.

WARNING.—Whoever is found smoking in the house we live in, will have the distinction of seeing his name published in the “Trumpet,” together with some observations about his transgression. The law is, that no one of the Saints is to smoke in the residence of the Editor.

DENMARK.—The Church in Denmark, where Elder Erastus Snow presides, now numbers over three hundred members, and had over sixty baptized in two months.

DO NOT tell lies even in jest, for humorous lies bring heavy sorrows; foolish is the man who destroys his own soul, in order to make humor for other men.

HE who practices hypocrisy toward God, is not worthy of a man's trust.

HE who goes to the tavern first for the company, will go there in the end for the drink.

Do not miss an opportunity to do good; then you will not have an opportunity to do evil.

GOOD RULES TO REMEMBER.—1. Do not let time go to waste; rather always practice diligence. 2. You do not lose anything by telling the truth. 3. Do not say anything bad about a person when you cannot say anything good about him; not only speak generously, but feel thus. 4. Do not provoke or be unkind to anyone. 5. Do not indulge in any unnecessary luxuries. 6. Do all things with consideration; and when obstacles arise in your path to act appropriately, put your trust in that Power which is able to assist you, making use to the extent possible of your own powers.

PAYMENTS FROM NOV. 14 TO NOV. 27.—West Glamorgan, £3 7s 6c; Flintshire, £1; Pontypridd, £3 1s 8c; Cwmbach, 7s; Aberdare, £1; Georgetown, £1 6s 4c; Merthyr, £1 10s; Cefncoedycymmer, 8s 8½c; Ynysgau, 4s; Aberaman, £1.—Total, £13 5s 2½c.



We call everyone's special attention to the article in this issue, written “To Distributors, Subscribers, and Readers of the TRUMPET.” Let all strive to understand it.



Whoever wishes to have his “Doc. and Cov.” bound in London, for 1s. 2c., in leather, and gilded, send it here within a week from today, since there will be no opportunity to have it done for a long time after that.



Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 25.]

DECEMBER 13, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

WRITING LETTERS.

BY JOSEPH SMITH.

[From the *Evening and Morning Star*, September, 1832.]

THE art of writing is one of the greatest blessings we enjoy. To cultivate it is our duty, and to use it is our privilege. By these means the thoughts of the heart can act without the body, and the mind can speak without the head, while thousands of miles apart, and for ages after the flesh has moldered back to its mother dust. Beloved reader, have you ever reflected on this simple, this useful, this heavenly blessing? It is one of the best gifts of God to man, and it is the privilege of man to enjoy it. By writing, the word of the Lord has been handed to the inhabitants of the earth, from generation to generation. By writing, the inventions and knowledge of men have been received, age after age, for the benefit of the world. By writing, the transactions of life, like the skies over the ocean, are spread out upon the current of time, for the eyes of the rising multitudes to look upon. And while we are thus summing up some of the blessings and enjoyments, which result from this noble art, let us not forget to view a few of the curses and mischiefs which follow an abuse of this high privilege. While we behold what a great matter a little fire kindles, let us not stand mute. Let us not forget to set a better example, when we see

the slanderer dip his raven's quill in gall to blot the fair fame of some innocent person. Let us weep, for so will the heavens do, when the great men of the earth write their glory in the tears of the fatherless and the widow. Let us mourn, while this world's vanity is written for deception in letters of gold. But enough, for the wicked are writing their own death warrant, and the hail of the Lord shall sweep away the refuge of lies. We, as the disciples of the blessed Jesus, are bound by every consideration that makes religion a blessing to the inhabitants of the earth, while we see this exalted privilege abused, to set a more noble example: to do our business in a more sacred way, and, as servants of the Lord, that would be approved in all things, hide no fault of our own, nor cover any imperfections in others; neither offend, lest we bring a reproach upon the great cause of our holy Father.

It is pleasing to God to see men use the blessing which he gave them, and not abuse them. For this reason, if the Saints abide in the faith wherewith they have been called, the land shall yield her increase, and the blessings of heaven shall attend them, and the Lord will turn to them a pure language, and the glory of God will again be upon the righteous on earth. All things are for men, not men for all things. Beloved brethren, before we can teach the world how to do right, we must be able to do so ourselves: therefore, in the love of Him who is altogether lovely, whose yoke is easy, and whose burden is light, who spake as never man spake, let us offer a few ideas on this important subject, for the consideration of such as mean to love their neighbors as themselves, for the sake of righteousness and eternal life.

1. Never write a letter to friend or foe, unless you have business which cannot be done as well in some other way; or, unless you have news to communicate, that is worth time and money. In this way you will increase confidence, and save postage.

2. Never write anything in a letter to friend or foe, that you are afraid to read to friend or foe; for letters from a distance, especially one or two thousand miles, are sought for with great anxiety; and also, as no one is a judge of men and things, you are liable to

misrepresent yourself, your country, your friends, and your enemies, and put in the mouth of the honest, as well as the dishonest, a lie; which truth, in her gradual but virtuous way, may not contradict till your head is under the silent clods of the valley.

3. Never write anything but truth, for truth is heavenly, and like the sun, is always bright, and proves itself without logic, without reason, without witnesses, and never fails. Truth is of the Lord, and will prevail.

4. Never reprove a friend or foe for faults in a letter, except by revelation; for in the first place, your private intentions, be they ever so good, are liable to become public, because, all letters may be broken open, and your opinion only on one side of the question, can be scattered to the four winds; and he to whom you meant good, receives evil; and you are not benefited. Again, we can hardly find a language, written or spoken, on earth, at this time, that will convey the true meaning of the heart to the understanding of another; and you are liable to be misunderstood, and to give unpleasant feelings: and you merely, to use a simile, bleed an old sore, by probing it for proud flesh, when it only wanted a little oil from the hand of the good Samaritan, in person, to heal it. No matter how pure your intentions may be; no matter how high your standing is, you cannot touch man's heart when absent as when present. Truly, you do not cast your pearls before swine; but, you throw your gold before man, and he robs you for your folly. Instead of reproof, give good advice; and when face to face rebuke a wise man, and he will love you; or do so to your friend, that should he become your enemy, he cannot reproach you: thus you may live, not only unspotted, but unsuspected.

5. Never write what you would be ashamed to have printed; or, what might offend the chastest ear, or hurt the softest heart. If you write what you are ashamed to have printed, you are partial: and if you write what would offend virtue, you have not the Spirit of the Lord; and if you write what would wound the weak hearted, you are not feeding the Lord's lambs, and thus you may know that you are not doing to others, what you would expect others to do to you. The only rule we would give to regulate writing letters is this:

Write what you are willing should be published in this world, and the world to come. And would to God, that not only the disciples of Christ, but the whole world, were willing to follow this rule: then the commandments would be kept, and no one would write a word against the Lord his God. No one would write a word against his father or mother. No one would write a word against his neighbor. No one would write a word against the creatures of God. No one would need write a word against aught but sin: and then the world would be worth living in, for there would be none to offend.

Trans. D. AB NATHAN.

REMARKS OF W. GIBSON ABOUT THE BOOK OF MORMON.

[Continued from page 343.]

Now, will all the foregoing things apply to America? First, let us see; it can with the strictest propriety be called a far country from Canaan. Second, it is in the west from Canaan. Third, it is beyond the rivers of Ethiopia; and fourth, it is a land in the form of wings; and I may add, with strict propriety, it can be said that there the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills are found, taking Canaan as the starting point. Now, if that is not the land where Ephraim's seed is to be found in the latter days, then let some of my wise friends find me, if they can, another land that will answer in all things the description given by the prophets I have quoted; and if you cannot, then look to find the descendants of Joseph there, or deny your Bible.

I will next refer to some of the prophecies to prove that Ephraim was to have a revelation for himself apart from the Bible which is the record of Judah. Hosea viii, 9, says, "For they are gone up to Assyria, a wild ass alone by himself: Ephraim hath hired lovers." On reading this verse, it will be evident to every candid mind that the first clause of this verse ought to be the last clause of the eighth verse, as it could not be true that Ephraim was alone by himself, if it referred to those who went to Assyria, for the ten tribes went there. But if a part of the tribe of Ephraim went to the land shadowing with wings, which is beyond the rivers of Ethiopia, even to the utmost bounds of the everlasting hills, then they would be alone by themselves indeed. But when Ephraim was to be alone by himself, would God leave

him without revelation, and continue to give revelation to Judah? No. Read the twelfth verse of the same chapter. There God says, "I have written to him (Ephraim) the great things of my law, but they were counted as a strange thing." Ezekiel, speaking of these two records, namely, that of Judah, (the Bible,) which has come to us through them, and the one God gave to Ephraim (namely the Book of Mormon), when he was away from his brethren, and as a wild ass alone by himself, says, they shall become one in the hand of the Lord, to give Israel a knowledge of their fathers, and assist in the great work of the gathering.—See Ezekiel xxxvii, from the 15th verse.

Isaiah also, speaking of this event, tells us something concerning the coming forth of one of these records in the 28th chapter of his prophecy. When speaking concerning Ephraim and Judah in the beginning of the chapter, he predicts a curse on the inheritance of Ephraim, for their transgressions; and in the 14th verse, he does the same concerning Jerusalem, or the city where David dwelt, as it is called in the first verse of the 29th chapter. In the second verse, we find two things spoken of; first Ariel, that the Lord said he would distress, and some other place that should be to Him *as* Ariel.

Now, it would be contrary to the sense of the passage to say that Ariel would be as Ariel, or Jerusalem *as* Jerusalem; we must, therefore, conclude that he refers to the valley of Ephraim, spoken of in the fourth verse of the 28th chapter, as being cursed for the sin of Ephraim, as Jerusalem is said in the 14th verse to be cursed for the sin of Judah. If we say that the valley or inheritance of Ephraim, shall be to the Lord as Jerusalem, then we can understand it; otherwise, there is no meaning in the second verse of the 29th chapter. Taking this view of the passage, the third, fourth, fifth, and sixth verses evidently apply to the inheritance of Ephraim. Read the Book of Mormon, where it gives an account of the destruction of that people, and see how exactly every word has been fulfilled. It can be said of them, but it cannot be so said of Judah, that all these things, namely, thunder, earthquake, great noise, the flame of devouring fire, and tempest, came upon them in an *instant* and *suddenly*, and by these means the multitude of their terrible ones passed away like the chaff in a moment.

This is the account given on page 450 of the Book of Mormon,

second European edition,—“And it came to pass in the thirty and fourth year, in the first month, on the fourth day of the month, there arose a great storm, such an one as never had been known in all the land. And there was also a great and terrible tempest; and there was terrible thunder, insomuch that it did shake the whole earth as if it was about to divide asunder; and there were exceedingly sharp lightnings, such as never had been known in all the land. And the city of Zarahemla did take fire, and the city of Moroni did sink into the depths of the sea, and the inhabitants thereof were drowned; and the earth was carried up upon the city of Moronihah, that in the place of the city thereof, there became a great mountain; and there was a great and terrible destruction in the land southward. But behold, there was a more great and terrible destruction in the land northward, for behold the whole face of the land was changed because of the tempest, and the whirlwinds, and the thunderings, and the lightnings, and the exceeding great quaking of the whole earth: and the highways were broken up, and the level roads were spoiled, and many smooth places became rough, and many great and notable cities were sunk, and many were burned, and many were shaken till the buildings thereof had fallen to the earth, and the inhabitants thereof were slain; and the places were left desolate. And there were some cities which remained, but the damage thereof was exceeding great, and there were many of them who were slain, and there were some who were carried away in the whirlwind, and whither they went no man knoweth, save they know that they were carried away. And thus the face of the whole earth became deformed, because of the tempests, and the thunderings, and the lightnings, and the quaking of the earth. And behold, the rocks were broken up upon the face of the whole earth, insomuch that they were found in broken fragments, and in seams, and in cracks upon the face of the land.”

Have not Isaiah's words been literally fulfilled on the inheritance of Ephraim? In the seventh verse of his 29th chapter, Isaiah begins to speak of the restoration of Israel. And Isaiah, like Ezekiel, speaks of some record or book, that is to come forth to help to accomplish it. See verse 18. Ezekiel speaks of two records, one of Ephraim, and another of Judah. What book is here meant? the Bible or the Book

of Mormon? Let us read the account given of its coming forth. In the eleventh verse we find that when this book comes forth it will be "as the words of a book that is sealed, which are delivered to one that is learned, saying to him, Read this, I pray thee: and he (the learned man) says, I cannot, for it is sealed; and the book is delivered to one that is not learned, saying, Read this, I pray thee: and he says, I am not learned." Is this the Bible that is here spoken of? If so, what must we think of our learned parsons, who go to college to learn, in order to understand it? Why, this book was to be a sealed book, both to the learned and to the unlearned, when it did come forth; and to be so it must have been written in a language that was lost to the world when the book came forth. Now, this is not the case with the Bible, but with the Book of Mormon it is, therefore, God did his marvelous work and his wonder, causing the wisdom of the wise to perish and the understanding of the prudent to be hid, by making known, through the instrumentality of the unlearned, the contents of that book that would teach the descendants of Ephraim concerning their fathers, and by showing the gospel in its purity, making the meek to increase their joy in the Lord, and the poor among men to rejoice in the Holy One of Israel, and through obedience to the same, the power of God be made manifest, and the ancient blessings of the gospel be restored, so that the deaf should hear the words of the book, and the eyes of the blind see out of darkness.

(To be continued.)

LETTER FROM APOSTLE J. TAYLOR, TO PRESIDENT W. PHILLIPS.

Rosenstrasse No. 27, Nov. 24, 1851.

BROTHER PHILLIPS,—Dear Sir,—I take the present opportunity to greet you with a few words; for, while it is always a pleasure for me to write to my friends, perhaps it is no less satisfactory for you to hear from me. With continual pleasure I recall my visits to Wales; such a warm and honest feeling, and such kindness and respect shown to me are what causes me to feel at home in your midst.

I was glad to hear through the "Star" that you have gone so far with

the Book of Mormon, and that the Doctrine and Covenants is finished; and I am sure that you will be glad to finish such a difficult task, not only because it will free brother Davis from such a huge responsibility which rests on him at present, but also because it will be a means of making the gospel known among the old Britons, as they are taught by the seed of Joseph, as well as a comfort to the hearts of the Saints, and edifying the faithful servants of God. The truth is always pleasing; but it is never as effective as it is in the native tongue of a nation.

Perhaps it will not be uninteresting to you to hear that things are going along well in France. Brother Bolton baptized thirteen at Le Havre lately; he also organized a branch and ordained a priest. Elder Hurt, who was formerly in Birmingham, has gone there to preach; and there are also other missionaries in Paris. We intend to hold a conference in Paris on the 20th of December; and I would be very happy if you could come to our meeting on that occasion. The Book of Mormon is going forward steadily in French, and we hope to have it ready soon for sale.

I find myself here in the midst of another nation, speaking a different language; and after battling and overcoming French, I encounter the same difficulties here as well. I have just published the first issue of a monthly periodical, in German, namely "Zions Panier." I am sending two to you and two to brother Davis. Tell brother Davis that I have mentioned "Zion's Trumpet" in it, for I do not think that he can read it.* I have also begun to publish the Book of Mormon in

* Although we do not profess to be able to read the publication of brother Taylor, we have translated some of it at random, hoping that when he comes here he can translate it back from Welsh. The translation is as follows:—"We have various publications which are printed in various parts of the world. In Utah Territory, in California, we have a newspaper called 'Deseret News,' and another one in Kanesville, in the State of Iowa, namely the 'Frontier Guardian;' and there is a publication in Liverpool called the 'Millennial Star,' and another one in Wales, namely '*Zion's Trumpet*'; another in Paris, namely the 'Star of Deseret,' and another in Copenhagen, namely the 'Star of Scandinavia.' All of these are being carried forth in a skillful and talented manner."—ED.

German, and it is to be finished in three months and stereotyped as well. I wish to have all my papers and books stereotyped in France, as well as here, so that any number of them can be printed. I know that it is expensive; but it saves a great deal of cost and trouble afterwards. Between writing, editing, reading, learning, and teaching others, I have plenty to do. I generally have plenty of work; and if I do not have it, I make it.

You will be glad to hear that I have made all the necessary arrangements in connection with the sugar business, so that I shall be ready, if I have the sugar beets, to produce 300 tons per year, and as good sugar as there can be.

I shall soon have to change my work, and be in the midst of woolen and *worsted* machines, to prepare for the move to the valley; at any rate, since we have bodies and spirits, and our kingdom is temporal and spiritual, I think that one is as important as the other. Our work is to teach how to live well in this world, and to prepare for the world to come. I rejoice frequently that I am not connected with anyone from the narrow systems which men have, and which bind and shackle the feelings, restrict the view, weaken the abilities, and deprive man from that excellent independence, that philanthropy, those lofty ideas, and those reasonable hopes, which nothing but the gospel can impart. Our religion enjoys meditation, it broadens one's abilities, it nurtures peace and happiness, it lifts hopes; it magnifies and elevates man to his true position; it believes that in this world he is a son of God, and that the earth and all its blessings were created for his sake. It opens the eternal scenes to his soul, and he then ponders his future and glorious fate. The heavens and the earth, are his; for his sake the sun shines, the earth bears its fruit, the trees leaf, the flowers bloom, and the birds sing. For his sake the earth produces its most splendid beauty and pours out its most pleasant aromas. For him the holy city was built, the New Jerusalem, and for him the earth will be purified. For him angels were prepared as companions; and a new heaven and earth will soon await to receive him. "All things are ours; and we are Christ's; and Christ is God's." Therefore, let us strive to teach men

to appreciate the blessings which the gospel brings within their reach; and while turmoil disturbs the world—while fire, sword, and sickness, and blood destroy the nations—while earthquakes tremble, thrones roll down, empires are destroyed, and the wrath of God is felt among the nations—our endeavor will be to stand as publishers of salvation, messengers of heaven, and missionaries of truth; to pour oil on the wounds of an injured world; and while walking amid plagues, swords, and death to show to a corrupt and lost world the hopes of the gospel, salvation of Zion, and the establishment of the kingdom of God.

I was led to some of the above reflections because of the condition in which I found the nations of Europe. It seems that the black clouds of war are descending from every side; mistrust and uncertainty flourish everywhere; and that which was at first but a prophecy in our midst, is now beginning to be uncovered. The condition of France, Germany, Austria, Italy, Denmark and Sweden, foreshadows something terrible to come. All people look for change, for turmoil, blood, &c.—yea, everyone expects something frightful in 1852; and while they appear to fear the coming storm, everyone rushes as if thirsting for blood to the battle. Emperors, kings, princes and people all fear it, and they all await it. It appears as though woe had been written on everything. I pity the people, and mourn because of their condition, for I fear that thousands of wretches will be put down in the dust. This is that which was spoken of by our Lord; “Men’s hearts failing them for fear, and for looking after those things which are coming on the earth.” They are things that were prophesied by Joseph Smith. They are things that I saw myself years ago. Therefore, I feel it more acutely as the day draws near. Yet the nations are drunk and mad. Isaiah says, “And it shall be, as with the people, so with the priest; as with the buyer, so with the seller; because they have transgressed the laws, changed the ordinance, broken the everlasting covenant; therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, and few men left.” Our revelations tell us, that

after our testimony will come the testimony of earthquakes, wars, blood, &c. In any event, our work is to do our duty, and let the Lord arrange his own causes.

I expect I shall have the pleasure of visiting with you before I leave England. After my conference in Paris, I intend to visit the Isle of Jersey, and hold a conference on the 26th of December. Perhaps I shall be with you sometime in the beginning of January; but since I shall hear from you yet, there is no cause to name the time at present.

What is the condition of the pastor which you mentioned to me? Is his condition such that he can go? If so, how is his condition with a look at his family? I am speaking of these things, because the time is getting near. Be so kind as to let me know, and have him write to brother Pack, No. 4, Bond Street, St. Heliers, Jersey, since brother Pack is taking care of the sheep.

If you see anything in the above clumsy writing worth publishing, it is at your service for the end that you see best.

Give my love to brother and sister Davis, sister Phillips and yourself, together with all the Saints.

Yours in the eternal gospel,

JOHN TAYLOR.

GREETING TO THE SAINTS IN GREAT BRITAIN.

[Continued from page 379.]

To the Saints I would affectionately add: Your prospects in every respect are the most encouraging that could be wished. The Lord, who fails not in his promises, has undertaken your deliverance, spiritual and temporal, and you yourselves are witnesses of the accomplishment of the first. Your fetters of superstition and priestcraft have been burst asunder; the dark and false mantle of tradition has been rent; you have been shown the Mother of Harlots, and her daughters, in all their characteristic ignorance, folly, and filthiness; and have hearkened to, and obeyed the voice, "Come

of out her my people, that ye be not partakers of her sins, that ye receive not of her plagues." Your hearts, your thoughts, and feelings, are no longer associated with those Babylonish schemes which chain thought and reason, making it blasphemy for man to dare speak of the nobility of his birth, and true being of his Father in heaven. You feel that you are delivered—restored to reason and to yourselves—under the government of but one law, that which made you free, even the law of glorious Truth, the word and will of God, by whom we are begotten all children of the one great Parent; yea, in this that we are made free, will we lift up our voice and make melody with thanksgivings to our God, that he has listened to the cries of his people—has seen their bondage, and sent forth his angels with the fullness of the Gospel to redeem, and save, and glorify His elect, make them kings and priests in heaven and over earth, that thereby he might bring to pass in due time his goodwill and purposes respecting all the families of mankind. As the Lord has made you spiritually free, herein you have assurance also of your temporal deliverance. How great soever be your poverty, however stupendous your difficulties, it matters little: the word has gone forth in your favor, and no opposing arm can stay its course;—Zion must be established, her lands inhabited, her cities built, her temple reared, her sons become mighty and powerful; that she may rise fair as the moon, clear as the sun, and terrible as an army with banners; and all nations shall fear and tremble, and stand afar off in the day of her majesty.

But you have need of patience, that after you have done the will of God, you may receive the promise; a caution which should not be forgotten. Many of you may have severe trials, that your faith may become more perfect, your confidence be increased, your knowledge of the powers of heaven be augmented: and this before your redemption takes place. If a stormy cloud sweep over the horizon of your course in this land, as in America; if the cup of bitter suffering be offered, and you compelled to partake; Satan let loose to go among you, with all his seductive powers of deceivings and cunning craftiness; the strong relentless arm of persecution lifted against you;—then, in *that* hour, lift up your heads and rejoice that

you are accounted worthy to suffer thus with Jesus Christ, the Saints, and holy prophets; and know that the period of your redemption has approached.

I feel, my brethren and sisters, to exhort you with heartfelt expression. Be of good cheer—be not disheartened; for assuredly the day rapidly comes when your tears shall be dried, your hearts comforted, and you shall eat of the products of your labors, sit under your fig tree and in the shade of your vine, unmolested, and no more know or feel the hand of tyranny. You shall possess the riches and fat of the land, gold and silver, fields and vineyards, flocks and herds, houses and palaces; your sons shall grow up like young plants of renown, and your daughters as polished corner stones of the temple, that you may boast yourselves in all the glory of the Gentiles. And unto you verily shall the scripture be fulfilled, “Seek first the kingdom of heaven and its righteousness, and all these things shall be added.”

Be honest, be virtuous, be honorable, be meek and lowly, courageous and bold, cultivate simplicity, and be like the Lord; hold to the truth though through fire or sword, torture or death; act honorably towards all men, for they are our brethren; a part of the family of God, but are ignorant and blind, having forgotten their God and their covenants with him in eternity.

I feel to express in the highest terms my sanction and approbation of F. D. Richards' Presidency of the British Isles; the prudent, wise, and profitable spirit and manner with the press, merits the highest praise. The many publications he has issued, together with the enlarged and improved edition of the Hymns, used by the Saints, in addition to his other labors, furnish a true testimony of his indefatigable zeal and enterprising spirit. The deep interest he has taken in forwarding our foreign missions, has secured him not only the warmest thanks and feelings of gratitude from us on whom is imposed the heavy burdens and responsibilities of those missions, but from thousands and tens of thousands, whose deliverance from sectarian bondage is now taking place in all those vast extended fields of our foreign labors. In the arrangement of the conferences, much wisdom has been displayed in selecting good and faithful men to preside over

them; men, who will do well, with the Saints generally, to receive his instructions, thereby lightening and relieving his anxieties and responsibilities, as far as possible. My long acquaintance with him gives me the most unqualified confidence in his wisdom, excellence of heart and mind, entire devotedness to the work and service of the Lord, and faithfulness in his exalted position. His counselors I know to be wise men, and men of God, and as such, I recommend them to the confidence and esteem of the brethren.

Respecting the progress of those missions which I have undertaken, the prospects of the future, and the field of labor assigned to the various Elders, it may be gratifying to the Saints to have the following particulars, that their faith, interest, and prayers on behalf of them may ever be kept in lively exercise. Elder Willis, whom I appointed to take charge of the Calcutta mission, is supposed to have about reached his destination: Elder Findlay, late president of the Hull conference, to the Bombay Mission, is now on his way. Elder Obray, late president of Sheerness, whom I have appointed to Malta, is now prepared, and will soon set sail for that island; Elder Stenhouse presides in Switzerland; Elder Woodard in Italy. The translation of the Book of Mormon into the Italian is about completed, parts are in the hands of the printer, and will be finished ready for issuing in about two months.

Having set in operation the above missions, I turn my thoughts to the far distant fields of labor I contemplate shortly undertaking—a mission requiring all my energies, extending over nations, continents, islands, seas, empires—encountering the freezing Alps, the heat of the torrid zone, the dangers of the trackless waters; the cholera, the miasma of various climes, together with all the casualties of sea and land which must be encountered. To aid and assist me in this enterprise deeply do I feel to call upon Israel's God, and for the prayers of my brethren for support. To the service of the Lord I have devoted my life; my *all* has been placed upon the altar of sacrifice, that I may honor him, do his will acceptably, and spread the principles of life among the children of men. When I reflect upon the past, and trace the hand of the Lord marvelously opening my way, and prospering me in everything relative to these missions beyond my

highest expectations, I feel doubly encouraged to press forward to the future; language indeed fails to express the deep gratitude of my heart for his blessings. May the Most High bless those brethren and Saints who have been liberal for the work of God, in connection with these missions; and when in after years they shall hear the sweet sound of thousands, and tens of thousands of those nations shouting the praises of the Almighty for the light of revelation, then will their hearts also rejoice in the glad consciousness that they likewise took a part in bringing to pass their glorious redemption.

I take my departure from here to Switzerland, thence to Italy, to Malta, to Bombay, and from thence to Calcutta, and shall probably accomplish the circumnavigation of the globe, by returning home, after completing the duties of these missions, by way of San Francisco, San Diego, and our newly established settlements through the valleys of California.

Need I say how deeply I feel in all matters respecting my own missions, notwithstanding, this does not prevent me taking the most lively concern in the welfare and happiness of the numerous conferences of Saints with which I have formed an acquaintance since my labors in the British Isles; and to those, and all in the bond of the Spirit, I would with warmest feelings subscribe myself, their brother in the Everlasting Covenant.

THE MOST AVAILABLE SIN.

THE MOST available sin that surrounds me is
The pipe and the tobacco—they torment me constantly;
When I am working diligently at some time,
I think of the pipe and the tobacco of evil smell;

And if I do not have such to satisfy my great craving,
I'll be working to no avail, with no sweat on my brow.
Angrily I look at all who come to the house,
If they do not have a pipe to give me a puff.

After I have had a very tasty meal,
I can find no comfort without a full pipe;
And then I begin to puff until the house is full of smoke,
With all the family coughing, and the man of the house scowling.

But alas, what am I doing? am I breaking God's counsel?
 Did he give a revelation that is hateful and loathsome?
 Yes, yes—I shall decide against being bound;
 Farewell, I bid to the tobacco, and its stinking meals of death.

Georgetown.

THOMAS HARRIES.

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

COUNSEL.—Be prudent in choosing a friend, and even more prudent in changing him; be pleasant to all, but friendly to few; do not disregard anyone because of his poverty, and do not flatter anyone because of his riches.

Do not condemn a friend unheard, neither without informing him of his accuser and his transgression.

CONFERENCES.—The Monmouthshire District Quarterly Conference will be held, in Tredegar, on the 4th of January; East Glamorgan, in Merthyr, on the 11th; West Glamorgan, in Swansea, on the 18th; Carmarthenshire, in Llanelli, on the 25th; Cardiganshire, on the 1st of February; North Pembroke, on the 8th; and South Pembroke, on the 15th.

REPRESENTATION OF WALES.—The semiannual representation of Wales, ending in December, 1851, is as follows:—137 branches, 2 high priests, 629 elders, 300 priests, 276 teachers, 204 deacons, 291 cut off, 37 died, 5 emigrated, 595 baptized. The total is 5244.

PAYMENTS FROM NOV. 27 TO DEC. 11.—Monmouthshire, £4; West Glamorgan, £4 4s 6c; Carnarvonshire, £1 10s; Merionethshire, £3; Denbighshire, £2; Dinas, 15s; Pontypridd, £1 4s; Llanfabon, 8s 6c; Dowlais, £1 6s; Rhymney, £4 13s 1½c; Georgetown, 18s 9c; Merthyr, £2 4s; Ynysgau, 2s 9c; Robert Evans, £1 18s 8½c.—Total, £28 5s 4c.

 "J. J., Victoria."—After typesetting your poem, we had to leave it out to place it in the next issue.

 The Epistle of President F. D. Richards to the Saints who comprise the British Districts will appear in the next, because we cannot make space for it in this issue.

 Send all correspondence, orders, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

ZION'S TRUMPET,

OR

Star of the Saints.

No. 26.]

DECEMBER 27, 1851.

[PRICE 1c.

EPISTLE TO THE SAINTS COMPRISING THE BRITISH CONFERENCES.

BELOVED IN THE LORD,—It is now nearly one year since the Presidency of the Church in the British Isles, was committed to my charge. In entering upon the performance of its high and holy duties, I was most impressively reminded of my own incapability, by the great, and rapidly growing importance of the work of the Lord, which had become so extensive and powerful as to present almost daily new features of interest and importance, which required the wisdom, energy, and foresight of the Holy Spirit to guide and control, so as to secure prosperity and blessing upon all its varied interests.

The efficient manner in which the Conferences were then organized, together with the discreet, and substantial tone which had been given to all their affairs by my predecessor—Elder Orson Pratt—rendered the duty far less onerous, and the hope of success much more certain than it otherwise might have appeared; but as success in the Holy Priesthood is “not by might, nor by power, but by my Spirit, saith the Lord:” to His name be all the glory, for the prosperity which he has vouchsafed to grant unto his Church in these realms.

During the past twelve months a general effort has been made by nearly all of the conferences, to lay before the people a declaration of our Holy Faith—the doctrines of the Church of Christ. Most of their general agents have ordered books and tracts by thousands, so that, in the aggregate, some hundreds of thousands of copies have been put into circulation among the people, through the agency of tract societies, and the voluntary efforts of the Saints

in the various cities, towns, and villages of the empire. It was not enough, nay it did not evince a becoming zeal, to merely offer the publications for sale at their several depots, and in their chapels and halls of worship, but they have been kindly handed into the dwellings of the people, and in consecutive order, so as to impart a general knowledge of our views to such as were willing to do themselves the favor of a gratuitous perusal. A general spirit of emulation as been manifested among both the ministry and members, to inform the people of the heavenly message which has been delivered by angels to men, insomuch that some, unless they added a certain number to the Church in a given period of time, felt dissatisfied with the non-performance of their self-set task. The general efforts of the Church, together with the frequent, and sometimes copious effusions of the press, both in favor of, and in opposition to the Truth, have had a powerful tendency to extend our acquaintance among a class of society, hitherto inaccessible to the Saints. Indeed, so extensively has this labor of love been carried forward, that, if the people of this great nation were half as eager to know the will and purpose of the great Jehovah concerning them, as they are to amass the perishable wealth of this world, every habitation in the United Kingdom, from her Majesty's palace to the residence of her humblest subject, would resound with thanksgiving and hallelujah to God and the Lamb for the remission of sins, the gift and power of the Holy Ghost, the ministry of angels, and the setting up of the Kingdom of God again on the earth for the last time.

The efforts of the Church, embodying the enterprising labors of an active and efficient ministry, and of the world, have not been fruitless; several thousands have confessed the faith, and attested the same by going down into the waters of baptism for the remission of their sins, during the present year.

It is truly a glorious task to win souls to the knowledge of God, and he that doeth this is *wise*; but it is a far nobler and wiser act to govern well, than to make conquest. Many mighty men of the earth have become eminent in conquest, but because they failed to give their captive subjects enlightened and liberal laws, such as would bind their hearts to their conquerors, and inspire them with gratitude to their emancipators, their ill-gotten power has passed away by treachery and revolt, and they have become as eminently foolish rulers, as they were illustrious victors: so also it is in the Kingdom of God, they that turn many to righteousness shall shine as the stars forever and ever; but he that ruleth well, shall be accounted worthy of *double honor*. The Captain of our salvation, who has sent us forth to conquer by the sword of the Spirit, has supplied us with laws and rules of government, pure and perfect; and with gifts and blessings,

to bestow upon such as take the oath of allegiance. They are at once relieved from guilt and remorse, they have the assurance that if they continue loyal to the end, they shall be saved from all their sins; and for this precious boon, feel an attachment inexpressible, and incomprehensible to those who impart it to them.

Inasmuch as the past year has been one of such vast effort, and of such general success in winning souls into the Church, let me call your attention to the subject of church Government.

So great has been the call for Elders to carry the Gospel into new places, and so general and powerful have been the efforts of the Church to add to their numbers, that the duties of the Priests, Teachers, and Deacons—the standing ministry to the Church—have in a measure been overlooked. While members have been added by thousands, the Church itself has lacked that diligent, faithful instruction in daily, practical duty, which the laws and ordinances of the church contemplate. This is mainly accounted for by the fact, that the numerous calls for Elders have induced the ordination of faithful Priests to that office. The faithful Teacher has been promoted to the office of Priest, and the Deacon who magnified his calling, has been ordained a Teacher; and thus have these standing officers in the Church—the main helps in government—have rendered so transitory as to become measurably ineffectual in their callings, which has caused them to be lightly esteemed in many instances.

What is the ostensible object of any person in joining the Church of Christ? Is it not that their sins may be washed away by baptism, that they may obtain the aid of the various officers and ordinances of the Church, to enable them to overcome their evil propensities, and lay aside the weights and sins that easily beset them; that they may, through the sanctification of the Spirit, and belief of the Truth, be cleansed and perfected from all their sins? Most certainly! This is the great object of a membership in the Church of Christ; and most effectually has kind heaven provided for this, by instituting the offices of a Priest, Teacher, and Deacon, in the Church.

The Priest's duty is to preach, teach, expound, exhort, baptize, administer the sacrament, visit the house of each member, exhort them to pray vocally and in secret, and attend to all family duties.

The Teacher's duty is to watch over the Church always, to be with and strengthened them, to see that there is no iniquity in the Church,—neither hardness with each other,—neither lying, backbiting, nor evil speaking,—to see that the Church meet together often, and that all the members do their duty.

The Deacon is to assist the Teacher in *all* his duties, if occasion requires.

Who cannot see at one glance that with the honest, faithful

performance of these duties under the searching auspices of the Holy Spirit, it is impossible for sin to dwell in the Church without detection. If it were not so, the Church of Christ would be imperfect, and would not accomplish the high and holy purpose of Salvation for which it was instituted. This is that Holy Institution, and there are some of the holy offices and callings appointed of God to aid man in divesting himself of his sins, and clothing himself with the righteousness of Christ; and he who enters in by baptism and the laying on of hands, if he transgresses not, but abides in the doctrines and ordinances of the Church, will have the gift and power of the Holy Ghost accompanying him. O blessed gift of heaven to man! How unlike the sickly, decrepit, and impotent institutions of men, which are conceived in ignorance, brought forth in folly, and matured by priestcraft, and which lull men's souls to perdition, in the way of their own choice.

The Church of Christ is not the place for men or women who wish to practice iniquity under cover of religion; some have tried it, but their sins have found them out, and they have been cast out from us, that it might be known they were not of us. But it is emphatically the place for such as wish to come to the light, that their deeds may be reproved, that they may walk in the light and sin not; where if they are sick they may be healed; if they are tempted and tried, they may receive the word of encouragement from their Teachers, that shall enable them to overcome; where if they are sorrowful they may be comforted; if any err they may be taught, and come to understanding; if any sin inadvertently they may confess, forsake, and find mercy; but from which if they will not repent they will be cast out, that the Church be not defiled with their evil ways; and if any are destitute and needy their wants will be known and supplied;—that the members may walk together by the aid of their Priests, Teachers, and Deacons in all the ordinances of the Church, as the heirs of the grace of life, bearing one another's burdens, and so fulfill the royal law.

Seeing, then, that the life, the health, the stability, the energy, and the purity of the Church are, to so great an extent, resultant from a faithful performance of the duties of these offices, but especially those of the Teacher; it is highly important that these officers should be humble, faithful men, full of the Holy Ghost and good works; men of experience in the knowledge and power of God; men who are apt to teach by their example, as well as by precept, the careworn sons of men, how they may work out their salvation, and overcome the evils that are in the world.

The Presidents of Branches and Conferences, and particularly the American brethren, are instructed to give their attention to

this subject; let good and faithful men be selected from among the Branches, men of good reputation, of exemplary conduct, such as rule well in their own houses, men of experience in the work of God, men of sound minds; if they are men of years, and are parents, so much the better, that they may teach and be honored as fathers, that their presence and their counsels may command reverence in the Church of God; and if the persons who are best adapted to the performance of these important duties are Elders, no matter, let them be set part to the higher and more important duty of instructing the Saints.

It requires but little experience in the work, comparatively, to preach and defend the first principles of the Gospel successfully before the world; but to be an able minister to the Saints requires a man skilled in the words of life, full of faith, and the spirit of revelation.

Let no man despise this office, but let him that is wise honor the calling, and add grace unto it, that while the Gospel is preached with diligence unto the congregations of unbelievers, the Saints may get their portion of meat in due season.

Said an ancient Prophet, "my people perish for lack of knowledge." The knowledge of God and of his Son Jesus Christ is Eternal Life. Let, therefore, those who embrace the faith be well and truly taught in the knowledge of God that they may always be able to give a reason of the hope which is within them, and adorn their profession with a well-ordered life and conversation. If this course be pursued with the faithfulness and energy which the salvation of souls demands, when the clouds of adversity gather thick around the Saints, instead of resorting to the inebriating cup to drown their sorrows as do the wicked, they will resort to their closets, and through the prayer of faith, drink from the cup of life the gifts and blessings of the Spirit, which will refresh and sustain them under every affliction. Then the power of God will increase in the Church, the gifts and blessings of the Gospel will be more gloriously displayed in their midst. Their light will break forth as the morning upon all that surround them, iniquity will be brought to light and put away, they shall ask whatsoever they will, that is expedient, and it shall be granted them. They shall be a blessing to all that associate with them, and the Nation shall be blessed by their existence in its midst.

The Spirit manifests clearly that vile and corrupt men who have been, and shall be severed from the Church for their iniquities, will stir up others, who, like themselves, have pleasure in unrighteousness, and they will speak lies in hypocritical sanctity against the truth and against the Saints; and they will have power, through their puffed up lying and deceitful words, to turn away

many to apostasy who have not the testimony of Jesus within them. They will also cause many to harden their hearts against the truth, and to believe all manner of evil of the Saints falsely, in order to stir up persecution against them, that the weak and feeble will stumble, while others will turn away for the very Truth's sake, and follow no more with us.

Forasmuch as these things must needs be, let the presiding elders throughout the Conferences set in order the various functions of the Holy Priesthood in all the ordinances and duties which belong to the Church, "that the whole body being fitly joined together, and compacted by that which every joint supplieth, according to the effectual working in the measure of every part, may make increase of the body unto the edifying of itself in love," then it will grow up into Christ its living head, through the gifts and administrations of the Holy Ghost; without which, all our work is vain.

The call for labourers is now very great from every quarter, and will soon be very much increased, therefore let faithful and just men be called to the ministry, but no faster than they are prepared to enter upon their labors, ever remembering the blessed rule given by our Savior to the prophet Joseph, viz.: that only "such as having faith, hope, and charity desire to thrust in their sickles and reap with their mights," are called. Let not the holy priesthood be bestowed indiscriminately, or unworthily, but let it be used for the high and holy purpose for which it was designed—the salvation of immortal souls. As a general rule, those least experienced will best employ their talents in preaching the Gospel to the world; while they whose duty it is "*to be always with, to watch over, and see that there is no iniquity in the CHURCH,*" should be the most experienced, wise, and holy men among you.

THE PRESIDENTS AND AGENTS OF both Conferences and Branches will allow me to remind them, that their immense efforts to spread abroad the Gospel to the people, have, in many instances, involved their conferences in liabilities to this office for the publications they have had, and unless we are favored with more prompt remittances we shall be obliged to limit our credit with them.

The present amount of outstanding debts, due this office, is very large—quite enormous for the extent of business we are doing, and the presidents are required to see that Tract Societies which are owing their agents for books, tracts, &c., settle for the same, if possible before the new year. Also that the Branches in like manner settle for what STARS they have on hand, that the same may become the property of the Branches, then the Branches and societies can dispose of their STARS and tracts as they please,—by sale, loan, or gift, and we can appropriate the cash to pay our debts to the printer

and bookbinder." Let these items receive your early and careful attention, that neither the tracts nor the STARS which we have sent out to the conferences may be reckoned to us as *stock*, or *debts*, but *cash in hand*.

Some of the conferences have generously extended their efforts for various benevolent objects upon terms of credit. It is particularly desirable, and should now become the ambition of all the churches, as far as possible, to clear off all their debts, and cast off these clogs to their progress, so that they may commence the new year in a renewed and improved condition.

Saints in the British Isles, we have not yet echoed back the response to that shout which went up from the Temple Block in Great Salt Lake City last April, in reply to the question, "SHALL WE BUILD A TEMPLE?" We shall soon be called upon to answer this question. Let us have all these small matters disposed of, so that we may be fully prepared to *do*, as well as to *say* YES. The Lord will require his people to bring their *tithes* and *offerings* into his storehouse, from all parts of the earth wherever they may be found, for this is a law of the Celestial Kingdom, and none can enter into the fullness of Eternal Life, unless they keep this holy commandment in connection with all others.

Our intelligence from the Church in the west is thrilling with interest. The energy that is displayed in all their movements is unequalled, unless by the untiring zeal of the Saints and Elders in dispensing the Gospel in this and other nations. The blessing of a munificent Providence seems to rest upon them, and crown their labors with unexampled success. Their crops are generally good. The climate is peculiarly healthy; many who were broken down in their constitutional vigor, are renewing their bodily, as well as spiritual strength. They have extended abroad during the present year into distant portions of that wilderness country, and formed new settlements for the development of the resources of the earth, both mineral and vegetable; extensive tracts of land have been fertilized, and rendered productive. Every variety of talent and profession is called into requisition, and best applied to promote the growing interest of a youthful nation, whose union excludes litigation, and whose ambition is to build and establish Zion. In pursuance of an Act of Congress, they have been organized into the Territory of Utah, with Legislative and Judicial powers. Monthly mails are established from the Great Salt Lake City to the States, and to San Francisco on the Pacific coast. Mails are also established from their metropolis to the shire towns of several different counties in the Territory. A State House is in progress of erection; the University building is progressing. The seventies are erecting a rotunda—a hall of science.

Last and best, the most ample and competent arrangements are entered upon for the construction of a magnificent Temple unto the Most High God, in which the ordinances of eternal life can be administered to the just.

An amicable feeling exists in the States towards the Saints, which was recently evinced by the prompt and efficient refutation of slanderous charges against President Brigham Young, in his governmental capacity. These charges we understand were set on foot by an unprincipled vagabond, who, for attempting to practice his wicked schemes, was sentenced to a term of hard labor on the public works. The Saints have no sympathy for such characters, the peace of their homes has long been disturbed by their maraudings, and it is a glorious epoch for the Church, that it has attained a position to punish criminals by the civil law, as well as disorderly members by excommunication. Nor is it less worthy of note, that when the characters of our rulers are aspersed by such outlaws, in public prints, that high-minded, honorable men, like T. L. Kane, Esq. should be found ready to roll back the mountain waves, and let injured innocence appear.

The Saints in the Eastern States are very few indeed; those who still remain are as the gleanings of grapes after the vintage is done; and it is to be feared they will scarcely escape the judgments of God. No Saints from England should emigrate to the Eastern States, unless compelled through the most absolute necessity. Those who are residing in St. Louis and on the frontiers, are making the most diligent efforts to get off to the Valley the coming spring.

The present year has been one of unusual peace and prosperity in this nation; probably never since Britain was a nation, has it experienced at once the liberty, peace, and universal prosperity, upon all its interests, together with such general goodwill from the whole family of nations which inhabit our globe, as during the expiring year; and much the same may be said of the western States of Europe, indeed the world seems to have almost ceased active hostilities—to come up to the great metropolis of Babylon and pay their devotions at the shrine of human invention in the Crystal Temple. Like the distressed, consumptive patient, the human family has seasons of respite from convulsive pains, and bystanders are flattered by the apparent tranquility, into hopes of recovery, while disease is silently acquiring a more potent hold upon the vitals and in an unexpected moment active dissolution commences. God has decreed a consumption upon the whole earth, and by the shedding of the blood of the prophets and apostles, Joseph, Hyrum, David, and others, that consumption has become immoveably seated. During this peaceful interlude, the Apostles of the Church made

godly exertions to extend the kingdom of our blessed Redeemer. That divine record which contains the *fullness of the Gospel*—The BOOK OF MORMON—has been published in part, and in whole, in five different languages of Europe, viz, the Danish, Italian, French, Welsh, and German. The “Doctrine and Covenants” is now in circulation in Welsh, and is translated into Danish, ready for the press. These, together with the monthly periodicals now issuing from Paris, Copenhagen, and Hamburg, with the *Udgorn Seion*, published in Wales, and our own MILLENNIAL STAR of twenty-three thousand circulation fortnightly, constitute some of the bolder features of our holy cause, which give promise of a more immense growth of the Kingdom of God, and of its dawning glories to the benighted virgins, who slumbered among those nations, and will hallow the memory of 1851 as a distinguished epoch in the history of the Dispensation of the Fullness of Times.

What glorious prospects are before the Saints, already the shouts of the harvest reapers in the vineyard of the Lord break upon our ears from the four quarters of the earth, calling for Elders, books, &c., to be sent over to their help.

O ye Saints of the Most High, lift up your heads and rejoice, it is by you the Lord designs to bring to pass his Act, his strange Act, in the eyes of all nations; though now you are bowed down you shall be lifted up, though now you are sorrowful you shall rejoice evermore in an eternal weight of glory, which the sufferings of this life are working out for you, if you continue to the end in the integrity of your hearts. Though like the Saviour you are poor, yet like him you make many rich; for though you are illiterate you have the Knowledge of God, and this is Eternal Life. Though you may lack worldly substance, you can accomplish prodigies of valor in your united exertions, whether in publishing the Gospel, or in gathering together and building cities and Temples; and this because the Spirit and wisdom of Jehovah are with you, which is better than strength, or weapons of war.

I hoped for something to communicate to you at this time upon the subject of emigration by the Perpetual Emigration Fund, but have not yet received any conclusive information as to the route. I still hope the next mail from the Valley may bring something cheering upon this subject. Do not let the fund be neglected. Every penny which has been forwarded to this office is safely preserved for that particular use, and when the route is determined the same will be appropriated to the removal of the greatest possible number of the worthy. This Fund will be the means of gathering far greater numbers than those who will gather upon their own resources, for in it will be concentrated the means and faith of the whole Church, which will render it a most powerful engine for the Gathering.

PRESIDENTS OF CONFERENCE.—As the Gospel net of the Kingdom is spreading itself abroad, and gathering into it of every kind, your duties and responsibilities must increase in number, in variety, and in importance. You are appointed to preside over all the affairs of your Conferences, both of a temporal and of a spiritual nature. It will require great diligence on your parts to search out, and comprehend all the interests of your Conferences. The work, already large, is but a drop in the bucket. The Lord, abundant in mercy, is pouring out his spirit copiously upon his faithful laborers in all places. He who seeks to spread abroad his energies with the greatest diligence, will realize the most of the blessing and power of God; therefore let all who are called, thrust in their sickles and reap before the summer is spent, while judgment is stayed; for yet a little season, and pestilence, the sword, and the direful catalogue of God's heavy judgments will follow in rapid succession, and reveal his hot wrath upon the ungodly in their destruction, while the righteous will scarcely escape. Let your faces be uncompromisingly set against all manner of unrighteousness: Remember mankind are to be saved from their sins, not in them. And he or she who will not, after proper admonition and instruction, put away their sins from them, let them be cast out from you, that the Holy Spirit may delight to dwell in all the habitations of the Saints. To you is entrusted the welfare of immortal souls, and your ability to minister the words of life and salvation unto them, will be proportionate with your own *estimate* and *practice* of the words of God. If you esteem lightly the precious precepts which He has condescended to reveal, by which mankind may be saved, so will your people; for your example will teach with vastly greater power than any arguments you can use. If you appreciate the counsels of the Almighty above fine gold, or all the treasures of the earth, and seek wisdom and life, spirit and faith, by keeping the words of *wisdom* as well as commandment, your people will also esteem the words of the Lord as priceless; they will delight to make sacrifice that they may win souls they will be mighty in faith toward God; the spirit of revelation will abound in you and them; disease will have little or no power among you; evil and seducing spirits will be unable to enter in, and make havoc with your flocks, for the wisdom and power of the Spirit shall be sufficient for you. The counsels of the Almighty shall fill your bosoms; you shall be to the people as wells of living water, from which they may draw the words of life and salvation under every circumstance of life; your Priesthood shall distil upon you as the dew of heaven; you shall have

power with God, and be the sons of God, among the people, having power to bless them, and dispense salvation on every hand.

May the increased righteousness and faith of the Saints in these islands induce the greater blessings of God's favor upon all the efforts of his people, hasten the day of their deliverance, and establishment in goodly heritages among the righteous in Zion.

F. D. RICHARDS,

One of the Twelve Apostles, and President of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in the British Isles.

“LET ME GO”

DEAR BROTHER DAVIS,—At the request of several of my friends, I ventured to make some kind of rough translation, or rather an imitation of the splendid poem of Apostle Taylor, not that I consider myself worthy or skilled for the task, but rather because no one else was taking it on. This is the first time I have sent anything to your valuable TRUMPET; and the reason I have ventured to take on this task was, because I know of your readiness and your skill to set right whatever is wrong.

I am, your sincere brother and well wisher,

Victoria.

JAMES JAMES.

Let me go to the western Valley far away,
To friends and brethren—whom do I love better?
Where affection and true love through their hearts abound;
To my home in the mountains, let me go.

Let me go to the Valley—a place of rest to be found,
And live with the righteous and the best without fail;
True peace and satisfaction like rivers abound;
To the beautiful and lovely Valley, let me go.

I'll go to my loved ones, oppressed so long,
Some fled to the Valley, to the western land,
Where the contentious and the wicked do not abound;
To the lovely and the virtuous, let me go.

I'll go to Zion to live with the saints,
And travel the Valley—to me a resting place;
Impart to me some of their joy, or my woe will abound,
To the town of the righteous, let me go.

I'll go to the Zion which our God prepared,
Fond hope of the Saints, and their reward it is;
I'll find there fountains in purity that abound,
And the land of plenty, let me go.

I'll go where there is eternal light and splendor,
 To join with the faithful in prayer and praise;
 I'll have heavenly streams of our God that abound;
 To the pure and the just, let me go.

I'll go where there is always the banner of true freedom,
 To every one of the religions throughout the wide world;
 All tribes, all colors, and nations abound,
 Free from oppression, let me go.

Oh, Phillips, dear man, I await the day,
 When through your best I shall from my bonds live free;
 I shall revere your name, I'll remember you, and call you friend,
 Therefore with haste, let me go.

I'll rush from Babel, her grasp is tight;
 After going to Zion, I'll have the means to obtain true nourishment;
 After the long journey sweetness and comfort will abound—
 To the place where my heart is, let me go.

[These lines are published with hardly a change; and if in them there are defects in rhyme, yet the substance is good. We say to our brother, that the Presidency of Wales permits him to go, since there is a call for a Welshman or two in the Valley to begin the ironworks there. May the Lord bless this our brother, together with those who go with him, so they may reach the mountains of Ephraim safely.—ED.]

MISCELLANEOUS, &c.

PAYMENTS FROM DEC. 12 TO DEC. 24.—Monmouthshire, £2; Carmarthenshire, £6 1s 9c; Denbighshire, £2 5s; Pembrokeshire, £1; Pontytypridd, £1 8s; Llanfabon, 14s 2c; Cwmbach, £1 4s (Nov. 16, £1 9s); Aberdare, £1 16s 10c; Hirwaun, £1 10s; Merthyr, £2 4s; Pendaren, £1 14s 2c; Cefn, 14s; Gorllwyn, 7s 3c; Ffynnon Tydfil, £1; Aberaman, £2; West Glamorgan, £3 1s; Total, £30 9s 2c.

 Upon going to press, we received the Sixth General Epistle, together with much news from the Valley, which we will publish in the next.

 Remember to read our Address about the TRUMPET in Number 24, so that no one will be disappointed concerning its price.

 The bills for this quarter will come with the next issue.

 Send all correspondence, requests, and book payments, to *John Davis, Printer, John's Street, Georgetown, Merthyr.*

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